

Gorgias

ΓΟΡΓΙΑΣ

Plato

translated by David Horan

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447a

CA: Well, Socrates, you know the saying, ‘When going to war or a battle, it may be too late to join in!’

447a

S: Oh! Does this mean that a banquet has ended and we are late?

447a

CA: Yes, a very elegant banquet indeed, for Gorgias¹ gave us an exhibition² of great variety and beauty a short time ago.

447a

S: Actually, it was all the fault of Chaerephon³ here for forcing me to spend so long in the Agora.⁴

ΚΑΛ. πολέμου καὶ μάχης φασὶ χρῆναι, ὧ Σώκρατες, οὕτω μεταλαγχάνειν. ΣΩ. ἀλλ’ ἦ, τὸ λεγόμενον, κατόπιν ἐορτῆς ἤκομεν καὶ ὑστεροῦμεν; ΚΑΛ. καὶ μάλα γε ἀστείας ἐορτῆς· πολλὰ γὰρ καὶ καλὰ Γοργίας ἡμῖν ὀλίγον πρότερον ἐπεδείξατο. ΣΩ. τούτων μέντοι, ὧ Καλλίκλεις, αἴτιος Χαιρεφῶν ὅδε, ἐν ἀγορᾷ ἀναγκάσας ἡμᾶς διατρίψαι.

447b

CH: It does not matter, Socrates. I shall also solve the problem. Yes, Gorgias is a friend of mine, so he will give the exhibition for you now if you like, or some other time if you prefer.

447b

CA: What’s this, Chaerephon? Does Socrates want to hear Gorgias?

447b

CH: That is the very reason we are here.

447b

CA: In that case, come and visit me at my house whenever you wish. Yes, Gorgias is staying with me, and he will give the exhibition for you.

ΧΑΙ. οὐδὲν πρᾶγμα, ὧ Σώκρατες· ἐγὼ γὰρ καὶ ἰάσομαι. φίλος γάρ μοι Γοργίας, ὥστ’ ἐπιδείξεται ἡμῖν, εἰ μὲν δοκεῖ, νῦν, ἐὰν δὲ βούλῃ, εἰς αὔθις. ΚΑΛ. τί δέ, ὧ Χαιρεφῶν; ἐπιθυμεῖ Σωκράτης ἀκοῦσαι Γοργίου; ΧΑΙ. ἐπ’ αὐτό γέ τοι τοῦτο πάρεσμεν. ΚΑΛ. οὐκοῦν ὅταν βούλησθε παρ’

ἐμὲ ἥκειν οἴκαδε· παρ' ἐμοὶ γὰρ Γοργίας καταλύει καὶ ἐπιδείξεται ὑμῖν.
ΣΩ. εὖ λέγεις, ὦ Καλλίκλεις. ἀλλ' ἄρα ἐθελήσειεν ἄν

447c

S: It is kind of you to offer, Callicles, but would he agree to converse with us? In fact, I want to find out from him what power this skill of his possesses, and what it is that he proclaims and teaches. He may present the other exhibition on some other occasion, as you suggest.

447c

CA: There's nothing like asking the man himself, Socrates. Actually, this was one part of his exhibition, for a moment ago he called upon anyone who was inside to ask any question they wished, and he said that he would answer them all.

447c

S: That is wonderful news! You ask him, Chaerephon.

447c

CH: What should I ask?

447c

S: Ask him who he is.

ἡμῖν διαλεχθῆναι; βούλομαι γὰρ πυθέσθαι παρ' αὐτοῦ τίς ἡ δύναμις τῆς τέχνης τοῦ ἀνδρός, καὶ τί ἐστὶν ὃ ἐπαγγέλλεται τε καὶ διδάσκει· τὴν δὲ ἄλλην ἐπιδείξιν εἰς αὐθις, ὥσπερ σὺ λέγεις, ποιησάσθω. ΚΑΛ. οὐδὲν οἶον τὸ αὐτὸν ἐρωτᾶν, ὦ Σώκρατες. καὶ γὰρ αὐτῷ ἐν τοῦτ' ἦν τῆς ἐπιδείξεως· ἐκέλευε γοῦν νυνδὴ ἐρωτᾶν ὅτι τις βούλοιτο τῶν ἔνδον ὄντων, καὶ πρὸς ἅπαντα ἔφη ἀποκρινεῖσθαι. ΣΩ. ἦ καλῶς λέγεις. ὦ Χαιρεφῶν, ἐροῦ αὐτόν. ΧΑΙ. τί ἔρωμαι;

447d

CH: What do you mean?

447d

S: For example, if he happened to be a maker of shoes, I presume he would answer that he is a cobbler. Do you understand what I mean?

ΣΩ. ὅστις ἐστίν. ΧΑΙ. πῶς λέγεις; ΣΩ. ὥσπερ ἂν εἰ ἐτύγχανεν ὢν ὑποδημάτων δημιουργός, ἀπεκρίνατο ἂν δήπου σοι ὅτι σκυτοτόμος· ἦ

οὐ μανθάνεις ὡς λέγω; ΧΑΙ. μανθάνω καὶ ἐρήσομαι. εἰπέ μοι, ὦ Γοργία, ἀληθῆ λέγει Καλλικλῆς ὅδε ὅτι ἐπαγγέλλη ἀποκρίνεσθαι ὅτι ἂν τίς σε ἐρωτᾷ;

448a

CH: I understand and I shall ask. Tell me, Gorgias, is Callicles⁵ here speaking the truth, that you proclaim that you will answer whatever question anyone may ask you?

448a

GO: It is true, Chaerephon. Yes, indeed, I made that very announcement, and I can tell you that no one has yet asked me a new question, not for many years.

448a

CH: Then I expect you will find this easy to answer.

448a

GO: Now is your chance, Chaerephon, to put that to the test.

448a

PO: Come on, Chaerephon, why don't you put me to the test instead? For I think that Gorgias is quite tired since he has just been doing a lot of talking.

448a

CH: What is this, Polus?⁶ Do you think that you can give better answers than Gorgias?

448a

PO: What difference does that make, as long as they are good enough for you?

448a

CH: None. Anyway, since you want to, you should answer.

448a

PO: Ask.

448a

CH: My question is this. If Gorgias happened to be knowledgeable in the skill that his brother Herodicus possesses, what would we be right

to call him? The same thing we call his brother?

ΓΟΡ. ἀληθῆ, ὦ Χαιρεφῶν· καὶ γὰρ νυνδὴ αὐτὰ ταῦτα ἐπηγγελλόμεν, καὶ λέγω ὅτι οὐδεὶς μέ πω ἠρώτηκε καινὸν οὐδὲν πολλῶν ἐτῶν. ΧΑΙ. ἦ που ἄρα ῥαδίως ἀποκρινῆ, ὦ Γοργία. ΓΟΡ. πάρεστι τούτου πείραν, ὦ Χαιρεφῶν, λαμβάνειν. ΠΩΛ. νῆ Δία· ἂν δέ γε βούλῃ, ὦ Χαιρεφῶν, ἐμοῦ. Γοργίας μὲν γὰρ καὶ ἀπειρηκέναι μοι δοκεῖ· πολλὰ γὰρ ἄρτι διελήλυθεν. ΧΑΙ. τί δέ, ὦ Πῶλε; οἶει σὺ κάλλιον ἂν Γοργίου ἀποκρίνασθαι;

448b

PO: Certainly.

448b

CH: So, if we called him a physician we would have described him accurately.

448b

PO: Yes.

448b

CH: Yes, and if he practised the skill of Aristophon, the son of Aglaophon, or his brother,⁷ what would we be right to call him?

448b

PO: Obviously a painter.

448b

CH: And now, what would be the correct title to give Gorgias, in view of the skill in which he is knowledgeable?

ΠΩΛ. τί δὲ τοῦτο, ἐὰν σοί γε ἱκανῶς; ΧΑΙ. οὐδέν· ἀλλ' ἐπειδὴ σὺ βούλει, ἀποκρίνου. ΠΩΛ. Ἐρώτα. ΧΑΙ. ἐρωτῶ δὴ. εἰ ἐτύγχανε Γοργίας ἐπιστήμων ὢν τῆς τέχνης ἥσπερ ὁ ἀδελφὸς αὐτοῦ Ἡρόδικος, τί ἂν αὐτὸν ὠνομάζομεν δικαίως; οὐχ ὅπερ ἐκείνον; ΠΩΛ. πάνυ γε. ΧΑΙ. ἰατρὸν ἄρα φάσκοντες αὐτὸν εἶναι καλῶς ἂν ἐλέγομεν. ΠΩΛ. ναί. ΧΑΙ. εἰ δέ γε ἥσπερ Ἀριστοφῶν ὁ Ἀγλαοφῶντος ἢ ὁ ἀδελφὸς αὐτοῦ ἔμπειρος ἦν τέχνης, τίνα ἂν αὐτὸν ὀρθῶς ἐκαλοῦμεν;

448c

PO: Chaerephon, humanity possesses numerous skills that have been discovered in a practical way through experience. For practicality

makes our time on earth proceed on the basis of skill, impracticality on the basis of chance. Various people partake of these particular skills in various ways, and the best partake of the best. And Gorgias here is one of the best, and he practises the most sublime skill of all.

ΠΩΛ. δῆλον ὅτι ζωγράφον. ΧΑΙ. νῦν δ' ἐπειδὴ τίνος τέχνης ἐπιστήμων ἐστίν, τίνα ἂν καλοῦντες αὐτὸν ὀρθῶς καλοῖμεν; ΠΩΛ. ὦ Χαιρεφῶν, πολλὰ τέχνη ἐν ἀνθρώποις εἰσὶν ἐκ τῶν ἐμπειριῶν ἐμπείρως ἡρῆμεναι. ἐμπειρία μὲν γὰρ ποιεῖ τὸν αἰῶνα ἡμῶν πορεύεσθαι κατὰ τέχνην, ἀπειρία δὲ κατὰ τύχην. ἐκάστων δὲ τούτων μεταλαμβάνουσιν ἄλλοι ἄλλων ἄλλως, τῶν δὲ ἀρίστων οἱ ἄριστοι. ὧν καὶ Γοργίας ἐστὶν ὅδε, καὶ μετέχει τῆς καλλίστης τῶν τεχνῶν.

448d

S: Gorgias, when it comes to speeches, Polus appears to have been equipped well and truly. And yet he is not keeping the promise he made to Chaerephon.

448d

GO: What exactly do you mean, Socrates?

448d

S: He appears to me not to have answered the question at all.

448d

GO: Then you should question him, if you'd like to.

448d

S: If you yourself were willing to answer, I would much prefer to ask you. In fact, it is evident to me from what Polus has said that he has studied so-called rhetoric more than dialectic.

448d

PO: Why is that, Socrates?

448d

S: Because, Polus, when Chaerephon asked you what skill Gorgias knows about, you praised this skill of his as if someone were criticising it, but you did not give an answer as to what it is.

ΣΩ. καλῶς γε, ὦ Γοργία, φαίνεται πῶλος παρεσκευάσθαι εἰς λόγους· ἀλλὰ γὰρ ὃ ὑπέσχετο Χαιρεφῶντι οὐ ποιεῖ. ΓΟΡ. τί μάλιστα, ὦ Σώκρατες; ΣΩ. τὸ ἐρωτώμενον οὐ πάνυ μοι φαίνεται ἀποκρίνεσθαι. ΓΟΡ. ἀλλὰ σύ, εἰ βούλει, ἐροῦ αὐτόν. ΣΩ. οὐκ, εἰ αὐτῷ γε σοὶ βουλομένῳ ἐστὶν ἀποκρίνεσθαι, ἀλλὰ πολὺ ἂν ἥδιον σέ. δῆλος γάρ μοι πῶλος καὶ ἐξ ὧν εἶρηκεν ὅτι τὴν καλουμένην ῥητορικὴν μᾶλλον μεμελέτηκεν ἢ διαλέγεσθαι.

448e

PO: Did I not answer that it is the most sublime skill?

ΠΩΛ. τί δή, ὦ Σώκρατες; ΣΩ. ὅτι, ὦ Πῶλε, ἐρομένου Χαιρεφῶντος τίνος Γοργίας ἐπιστήμων τέχνης, ἐγκωμιάζεις μὲν αὐτοῦ τὴν τέχνην ὥσπερ τινὸς ψέγοντος, ἣτις δέ ἐστιν οὐκ ἀπεκρίνω. ΠΩΛ. οὐ γὰρ ἀπεκρινάμην ὅτι εἴη ἡ καλλίστη; ΣΩ. καὶ μάλα. ἀλλ' οὐδεὶς ἐρωτᾷ ποῖα τις ἡ Γοργίου τέχνη, ἀλλὰ τίς, καὶ ὄντινα δέοι καλεῖν τὸν Γοργίαν· ὥσπερ τὰ ἔμπροσθέν σοι ὑπετείνατο Χαιρεφῶν καὶ αὐτῷ καλῶς

449a

S: You did, indeed. But nobody asked you what Gorgias' skill is like, but what it is and what we should call Gorgias. Just as Chaerephon set out questions for you earlier and you answered him clearly and concisely, so should you speak now and say what this skill is and what we should call Gorgias. Or better yet, Gorgias, tell us yourself what you should be called on account of your knowledge, of what skill.

449a

GO: The skill of rhetoric, Socrates.

449a

S: So, you should be called a rhetorician?

449a

GO: Yes, Socrates, but I am a good one, if you are prepared to call me what, in Homer's phrase, 'I boast myself to be'!⁸

449a

S: I am quite prepared to do so.

449a

GO: Then call me that.

καὶ διὰ βραχέων ἀπεκρίνω, καὶ νῦν οὕτως εἶπε τίς ἡ τέχνη καὶ τίνα Γοργίαν καλεῖν χρή ἡμᾶς. μᾶλλον δέ, ὦ Γοργία, αὐτὸς ἡμῖν εἶπε τίνα σε χρή καλεῖν ὡς τίνος ἐπιστήμονα τέχνης. ΓΟΡ. τῆς ῥητορικῆς, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. ῥήτορα ἄρα χρή σε καλεῖν; ΓΟΡ. ἀγαθόν γε, ὦ Σώκρατες, εἰ δὴ ὅ γε εὖχομαι εἶναι, ὡς ἔφη Ὅμηρος, βούλει με καλεῖν. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ βούλομαι. ΓΟΡ. κάλει δὴ.

449b

S: And should we say that you are able to turn other people into rhetoricians?

449b

GO: Yes, I profess to do just that, not only here but in other places too.

449b

S: Now, Gorgias, would you agree to continue our conversation as we are now doing – one person asking questions, the other answering – and defer to another occasion any lengthy speeches such as the one with which Polus began? And be true to your promise, but please answer each question briefly.

ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ ἄλλους σε φῶμεν δυνατόν εἶναι ποιεῖν; ΓΟΡ. ἐπαγγέλλομαί γε δὴ ταῦτα οὐ μόνον ἐνθάδε ἀλλὰ καὶ ἄλλοθι. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν ἐθελήσais ἄν, ὦ Γοργία, ὥσπερ νῦν διαλεγόμεθα, διατελέσαι τὸ μὲν ἐρωτῶν, τὸ δ' ἀποκρινόμενος, τὸ δὲ μῆκος τῶν λόγων τοῦτο, οἷον καὶ πῶλος ἤρξατο, εἰς αὐθις ἀποθέσθαι; ἀλλ' ὅπερ ὑπισχνῇ, μὴ ψεύσῃ, ἀλλὰ ἐθέλησον κατὰ βραχὺ τὸ ἐρωτώμενον ἀποκρίνεσθαι. ΓΟΡ. εἰσὶ μὲν, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἔναι τῶν ἀποκρίσεων ἀναγκαῖαι διὰ μακρῶν τοὺς λόγους ποιεῖσθαι· οὐ μὴν ἀλλὰ

449c

GO: Well, Socrates, some answers demand that long speeches be made. However, I shall try anyway to be as brief as possible. And, indeed, what is more, one of my claims is that no one can express himself as concisely as I on the same issues.

449c

S: That is what is needed, Gorgias. Just give me an exhibition of this concise form of speech and defer the lengthy form to another occasion.

449c

GO: That's what I shall do, and you will say that you have heard no one speak more concisely.

πειράσομαί γε ὥς διὰ βραχυτάτων. καὶ γὰρ αὖ καὶ τοῦτο ἔν ἐστιν ὧν φημι, μηδένα ἂν ἐν βραχυτέροις ἑμοῦ τὰ αὐτὰ εἰπεῖν. ΣΩ. τούτου μὴν δεῖ, ὦ Γοργία· καί μοι ἐπιδείξιν αὐτοῦ τούτου ποιῆσαι, τῆς βραχυλογίας, μακρολογίας δὲ εἰς αὐθις. ΓΟΡ. ἀλλὰ ποιήσω, καὶ οὐδενὸς φήσεις βραχυλογωτέρου ἀκοῦσαι. ΣΩ. φέρε δὴ· ῥητορικῆς γὰρ φῆς ἐπιστήμων τέχνης

449d

S: Come on, then. You say that you are knowledgeable in the skill of rhetoric and can make a rhetorician of someone else. With which of the things that are, is rhetoric concerned? For instance, weaving is concerned with the manufacture of garments, isn't it?

449d

GO: Yes.

449d

S: And isn't music concerned with composing melodies?

449d

GO: Yes.

449d

S: By Hera, Gorgias, I am delighted with these answers. You are answering as briefly as you possibly could.

449d

GO: Yes, Socrates, I really think that I am doing quite well.

449d

S: Well said. Come now, answer me in the same way about rhetoric. About which of the things that are, is rhetoric the knowledge?

εἶναι καὶ ποιῆσαι ἂν καὶ ἄλλον ῥήτορα· ἡ ῥητορικὴ περὶ τί τῶν ὄντων τυγχάνει οὕσα; ὥσπερ ἡ ὑφαντικὴ περὶ τὴν τῶν ἱματίων ἐργασίαν· ἢ γάρ; ΓΟΡ. ναί. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ ἡ μουσικὴ περὶ τὴν τῶν μελῶν ποίησιν; ΓΟΡ. ναί. ΣΩ. νῆ τὴν Ἥραν, ὦ Γοργία, ἄγαμαί γε τὰς ἀποκρίσεις, ὅτι ἀποκρίνη ὡς οἶόν τε διὰ βραχυτάτων. ΓΟΡ. πάνυ γὰρ οἶμαι, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἐπιεικῶς τοῦτο ποιεῖν. ΣΩ. εὖ λέγεις. ἴθι δὴ μοι ἀποκρίναι οὕτως καὶ περὶ τῆς ῥητορικῆς, περὶ τί τῶν ὄντων ἐστὶν ἐπιστήμη;

449e

GO: About speeches.

449e

S: What sort of speeches, Gorgias? Speeches that show sick people the regimen by which they may become healthy?

449e

GO: No.

449e

S: So, rhetoric is not concerned with all speeches anyway.

449e

GO: Of course not.

449e

S: And yet it does make people capable of speaking.

449e

GO: Yes.

449e

S: And to understand what they are speaking about?

449e

GO: Inevitably.

ΓΟΡ. περὶ λόγους. ΣΩ. ποίους τούτους, ὦ Γοργία; ἄρα οἱ δηλοῦσι τοὺς κάμνοντας, ὡς ἂν διαιτῶμενοι ὑγιαίνουσιν; ΓΟΡ. οὐ. ΣΩ. οὐκ ἄρα περὶ πάντας γε τοὺς λόγους ἡ ῥητορικὴ ἐστίν. ΓΟΡ. οὐ δῆτα. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ μὴν λέγειν γε ποιεῖ δυνατούς. ΓΟΡ. ναί. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν περὶ ὧν περ λέγειν, καὶ φρονεῖν; ΓΟΡ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὐν,

450a

S: Now, does medicine, which we just mentioned, make someone capable of understanding and speaking about those who are ill?

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GO: It must.

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S: So, medicine, it seems, is also concerned with speeches.

450a

GO: Yes.

450a

S: Speeches concerning illnesses?

450a

GO: Certainly.

450a

S: And isn't gymnastic also concerned with speeches about the good or bad condition of the body?

450a

GO: Entirely so.

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S: And, indeed, Gorgias, the same applies to the other skills. Each of them is concerned with speeches relating to the subject matter of that particular skill.

450a

GO: So it appears.

ἦν νυνδὴ ἐλέγομεν, ἡ ἰατρικὴ περὶ τῶν καμνόντων ποιεῖ δυνατοὺς εἶναι φρονεῖν καὶ λέγειν; ΓΟΡ. ἀνάγκη. ΣΩ. καὶ ἡ ἰατρικὴ ἄρα, ὡς ἔοικεν, περὶ λόγους ἐστίν. ΓΟΡ. ναί. ΣΩ. τοὺς γε περὶ τὰ νοσήματα; ΓΟΡ. μάλιστα. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ ἡ γυμναστικὴ περὶ λόγους ἐστὶν τοὺς περὶ εὐεξίαν τε τῶν σωμάτων καὶ καχεξίαν; ΓΟΡ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν καὶ αἱ ἄλλαι τέχναι, ὧς Γοργία, οὕτως

450b

S: Then why don't you ever refer to the other skills as rhetorical, since they are concerned with speeches, if, in fact, you call the skill that is

concerned with speeches rhetoric?

450b

GO: Because, Socrates, the other skills are almost entirely concerned with knowledge of practical dexterity and activities of that sort, whereas no aspect of rhetoric involves practical dexterity. Rather, its action and efficacy work entirely through words. For these reasons, I regard the skill of rhetoric as being concerned with speeches, and that, I say, is a correct account.

ἔχουσιν· ἐκάστη αὐτῶν περὶ λόγους ἐστὶν τούτους, οἳ τυγχάνουσιν ὄντες περὶ τὸ πρᾶγμα οὗ ἐκάστη ἐστὶν ἡ τέχνη. ΓΟΡ. φαίνεται. ΣΩ. τί οὖν δὴ ποτε τὰς ἄλλας τέχνας οὐ ῥητορικὰς καλεῖς, οὔσας περὶ λόγους, εἴπερ ταύτην ῥητορικὴν καλεῖς, ἢ ἂν ἦ περὶ λόγους; ΓΟΡ. ὅτι, ὦ Σώκρατες, τῶν μὲν ἄλλων τεχνῶν περὶ χειρουργίας τε καὶ τοιαύτας πράξεις ὡς ἔπος εἰπεῖν πᾶσά ἐστιν ἡ ἐπιστήμη, τῆς δὲ ῥητορικῆς οὐδὲν ἐστὶν τοιοῦτον χειρούργημα, ἀλλὰ πᾶσα ἡ πρᾶξις καὶ ἡ κύρωσις διὰ λόγων

450c

S: Now, do I really understand the sort of skill that you wish to call it? But perhaps I shall come to know this more clearly. So, answer me this. We do possess skills, is this not so?

450c

GO: Yes.

450c

S: Well, I think that the vast majority of skills involve practical dexterity and very little speaking, and some involve none at all because the objective of the skill may be attained through silence, as in the case of painting and sculpting, and numerous other skills. I think you are saying that rhetoric is not concerned with skills such as these. Is this so?

450c

GO: You have understood my meaning very well, Socrates.

ἐστίν. διὰ ταῦτ' ἐγὼ τὴν ῥητορικὴν τέχνην ἀξιῶ εἶναι περὶ λόγους, ὀρθῶς λέγων, ὥς ἐγὼ φημι. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν μανθάνω οἷαν αὐτὴν βούλει καλεῖν; τάχα δὲ εἶσομαι σαφέστερον. ἀλλ' ἀπόκριναι· εἰσὶν ἡμῖν τέχναι. ἦ γάρ; ΓΟΡ. ναί. ΣΩ. πασῶν δὴ οἶμαι τῶν τεχνῶν τῶν μὲν ἐργασία τὸ πολὺ ἐστίν καὶ λόγου βραχέος δέονται, ἔναι δὲ οὐδενὸς ἀλλὰ τὸ τῆς τέχνης περαίνοιτο ἂν καὶ διὰ σιγῆς, οἷον γραφικὴ καὶ ἀνδριαντοποιία καὶ ἄλλαι πολλάι. τὰς τοιαύτας

450d

S: And yet there is a different set of skills that operates entirely through speech, and requires almost no action or very little. Take arithmetic for instance, or calculation, geometry, or even draughts-playing, and numerous other skills. Some of these involve almost as much speech as activity, but in many such cases, most, if not all, of their entire activity and their efficacy is based upon words. And I think it is a skill belonging to such activities as these that you say is rhetoric.

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GO: True.

μοι δοκεῖς λέγειν, περὶ ἃς οὐ φῆς τὴν ῥητορικὴν εἶναι· ἢ οὐ; ΓΟΡ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν καλῶς ὑπολαμβάνεις, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. ἕτεροι δέ γέ εἰσι τῶν τεχνῶν αἱ διὰ λόγου πᾶν περαίνουσι, καὶ ἔργου ὥς ἔπος εἰπεῖν ἢ οὐδενὸς προσδέονται ἢ βραχέος πάνυ, οἷον ἡ ἀριθμητικὴ καὶ λογιστικὴ καὶ γεωμετρικὴ καὶ πεττευτικὴ γε καὶ ἄλλαι πολλαὶ τέχναι, ὧν ἔναι σχεδόν τι ἴσους τοὺς λόγους ἔχουσι ταῖς πράξεσιν, αἱ δὲ πολλαὶ πλείους, καὶ τὸ παράπαν πᾶσα ἢ πράξις καὶ τὸ

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S: But I do not think you wish to refer to any particular one of these skills as the skill of rhetoric, even though the formulation you used implies that a skill that is effected through words is rhetoric. Indeed, someone who wanted to contrive difficulties in these arguments might respond, “So, Gorgias, are you saying that arithmetic is rhetoric?” But I do not think you are saying that either arithmetic or geometry is rhetoric.

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GO: Indeed, Socrates, your thinking is correct, and you rightly understand my meaning.

κῦρος αὐταῖς διὰ λόγων ἐστίν. τῶν τοιούτων τινά μοι δοκεῖς λέγειν τὴν ῥητορικὴν. ΓΟΡ. ἀληθῆ λέγεις. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' οὗτοι τούτων γε οὐδεμίαν οἶμαί σε βούλεσθαι ῥητορικὴν καλεῖν, οὐχ ὅτι τῷ ῥήματι οὕτως εἶπες, ὅτι ἡ διὰ λόγου τὸ κῦρος ἔχουσα ῥητορικὴ ἐστίν, καὶ ὑπολάβοι ἄν τις, εἰ βούλοιο δυσχεραίνειν ἐν τοῖς λόγοις, τὴν ἀριθμητικὴν ἄρα ῥητορικὴν, ὧς Γοργία, λέγεις; ἀλλ' οὐκ οἶμαί σε οὔτε τὴν ἀριθμητικὴν οὔτε τὴν γεωμετρίαν ῥητορικὴν λέγειν.

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S: Come on, now. You should also work through the answer to the question in the way that I asked it. Since rhetoric happens to be one of those skills that relies for the most part upon speech, and since there are also other skills of this sort, try to state what words the efficacy of rhetoric is concerned with. Words about what? For instance, if someone were to ask me about any of the skills I mentioned just now, “Socrates, what is the skill of arithmetic?”, I would tell him, as you did just now, that it is one of the skills that is effected by means of speech. And if he were to ask again, “Speech about what?”, I would reply that it is speech about odd and even numbers, and the extent of each. And if he were to go on and ask, “What skill do you refer to as ‘calculation’?”, I would say that it is one of the skills that is effective entirely through speech. And if he were also to ask, “About what?”, I would say, as the recorders in the Assembly might say, that for the most part calculation is just like arithmetic for it is concerned with the same thing, the odd and the even. Yet they differ insofar as calculation considers the quantity associated with the odd and the even, both in relation to themselves and in relation to one another. And if someone asked about astronomy because I said that it is effective entirely through speech, and said, “What are the pronouncements of astronomy concerned with?”, I would reply that

they deal with the motion of the stars and sun and moon, and their speed relative to one another.

ΓΟΡ. ὀρθῶς γὰρ οἶει, ὦ Σώκρατες, καὶ δικαίως ὑπολαμβάνεις. ΣΩ. ἴθι νυν καὶ σὺ τὴν ἀπόκρισιν ἣν ἡρόμην διαπέρανον. ἐπεὶ γὰρ ῥητορική τυγχάνει μὲν οὕσα τούτων τις τῶν τεχνῶν τῶν τὸ πολὺ λόγῳ χρωμένων, τυγχάνουσιν δὲ καὶ ἄλλαι τοιαῦται οὕσαι, πειρῶ εἰπεῖν ἢ περὶ τί ἐν λόγοις τὸ κῦρος ἔχουσα ῥητορική ἐστιν. ὥσπερ ἂν εἴ τις με ἔροιτο ὧν νυνδὴ ἔλεγον περὶ ἡστινοσοῦν τῶν τεχνῶν ὦ Σώκρατες, τίς ἐστιν ἡ ἀριθμητικὴ τέχνη; εἵποιμ' ἂν αὐτῷ, ὥσπερ σὺ ἄρτι, ὅτι τῶν διὰ λόγου τις τὸ κῦρος ἐχουσῶν. καὶ εἴ με ἐπανεῖροιτο· τῶν περὶ τί; εἵποιμ' ἂν ὅτι τῶν περὶ τὸ ἄρτιόν τε καὶ περιττὸν γνῶσις, ὅσα ἂν ἐκάτερα τυγχάνη ὄντα. εἰ δ' αὖ ἔροιτο· τὴν δὲ λογιστικὴν τίνα καλεῖς τέχνην; εἵποιμ' ἂν ὅτι καὶ αὕτη ἐστὶν τῶν λόγῳ τὸ πᾶν κυρουμένων· καὶ εἰ ἐπανεῖροιτο· ἢ περὶ τί; εἵποιμ' ἂν ὥσπερ οἱ ἐν τῷ δήμῳ

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Go: Well, you are right to say all that anyway, Socrates.

συγγραφόμενοι, ὅτι τὰ μὲν ἄλλα καθάπερ ἡ ἀριθμητικὴ ἢ λογιστικὴ ἔχει—περὶ τὸ αὐτὸ γὰρ ἐστὶν, τό τε ἄρτιον καὶ τὸ περιττόν—διαφέρει δὲ τοσοῦτον, ὅτι καὶ πρὸς αὐτὰ καὶ πρὸς ἄλληλα πῶς ἔχει πλήθους ἐπισκοπεῖ τὸ περιττόν καὶ τὸ ἄρτιον ἢ λογιστική. καὶ εἴ τις τὴν ἀστρονομίαν ἀνέροιτο, ἐμοῦ λέγοντος ὅτι καὶ αὕτη λόγῳ κυροῦται τὰ πάντα, οἱ δὲ λόγοι οἱ τῆς ἀστρονομίας, εἰ φαίη, περὶ τί εἰσιν, ὦ Σώκρατες; εἵποιμ' ἂν ὅτι περὶ τὴν τῶν ἄστρον φορὰν καὶ ἡλίου καὶ σελήνης, πῶς πρὸς ἄλληλα τάχους ἔχει. ΓΟΡ. ὀρθῶς γε λέγων σὺ, ὦ Σώκρατες.

451d

S: Then you should try this too, Gorgias. Rhetoric is one of those skills that operates and is effective through speech. Is this so?

451d

Go: That's what it is.

451d

S: Can you explain what it is concerned with? Among things that are, what is it that the particular words employed by rhetoric are concerned with?

451d

Go: With the most important and sublime of human affairs, Socrates.

ΣΩ. ἴθι δὴ καὶ σύ, ὦ Γοργία. τυγχάνει μὲν γὰρ δὴ ἡ ῥητορικὴ οὕσα τῶν λόγῳ τὰ πάντα διαπραττομένων τε καὶ κυρουμένων· ἢ γάρ; ΓΟΡ. ἔστι ταῦτα. ΣΩ. λέγε δὴ τῶν περὶ τί; τί ἐστι τοῦτο τῶν ὄντων, περὶ οὗ οὗτοι οἱ λόγοι εἰσὶν οἷς ἡ ῥητορικὴ χρῆται; ΓΟΡ. τὰ μέγιστα τῶν ἀνθρωπείων πραγμάτων, ὦ Σώκρατες, καὶ ἄριστα. ΣΩ. ἀλλ', ὦ Γοργία, ἀμφισβητήσιμον καὶ τοῦτο λέγεις

451e

S: But, Gorgias, this too is ambiguous, and you are still not saying anything that is clear. In fact, I am sure you have heard the round that men sing at parties in which they make a list in song, according to which it is best to be healthy, second best to be beautiful, and third best, according to the composer of the song, is to be wealthy by honest means.

451e

Go: Yes, I have heard this, but why are you referring to it?

καὶ οὐδέν πω σαφές. οἶομαι γάρ σε ἀκηκοέναι ἐν τοῖς συμποσίοις ἔδόντων ἀνθρώπων τοῦτο τὸ σκολιόν, ἐν ᾧ καταριθμοῦνται ἔδοντες ὅτι ὑγιαίνειν μὲν ἄριστόν ἐστιν, τὸ δὲ δεύτερον καλὸν γενέσθαι, τρίτον δέ, ὡς φησιν ὁ ποιητὴς τοῦ σκολιοῦ, τὸ πλουτεῖν ἀδόλως. ΓΟΡ. ἀκήκοα γάρ· ἀλλὰ πρὸς τί τοῦτο λέγεις;

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S: What if artificers of whatever is praised by the composer of the song were to stand before you right now? I mean a physician, a trainer, a businessman. First the physician would say, “Socrates, Gorgias is deceiving you. This skill of his is not concerned with the most important good of humankind. Mine is.” Now, if I were to ask him, “Who are you to say so?” he would probably say that he is a

physician. “What do you mean?” I would say. “Is the product of your skill the most important good?” “Of course it is,” he would probably reply. “Socrates, the product of my skill is health, and what good is more important to humanity than health?”

And if the trainer spoke next and said, “I too would be surprised, Socrates, if Gorgias was able to show you that there is a greater good in this skill of his than I could show in mine,” I would in turn ask him, “Who are you, my man, and what is your job?” And he would reply, “I am a trainer and my job is to make men’s bodies strong and fair.” After the trainer, the businessman would say, I imagine, with total contempt for everyone else, “Think about this, Socrates. Does any good seem more important to you than wealth, whether it belongs to Gorgias or anyone else at all?” We might then say, “Oh! Are you the artificer of this?” and he would say, “Yes.” “Who are you?” we would ask. “A businessman.” And we shall say, “Well then, do you regard wealth as the greatest good for us humans?” “Of course it is,” he will say. And we would reply, “And yet Gorgias here is arguing that the skill he possesses is the cause of greater good than yours.” Of course, he would then ask, “And what is this good? Put that question to Gorgias.” So come on, Gorgias, you should regard yourself as being questioned by these people and by me. Tell me what it is that you describe as the greatest good to humanity, a good of which you are the artificer.

ΣΩ. ὅτι εἴ σοι αὐτίκα παρασταῖεν οἱ δημιουργοὶ τούτων ὧν ἐπήνεσεν ὁ τὸ σκολιὸν ποιήσας, ἱατρός τε καὶ παιδοτρίβης καὶ χρηματιστής, καὶ εἴποι πρῶτον μὲν ὁ ἱατρός ὅτι ὦ Σώκρατες, ἔξαπατᾷ σε Γοργίας· οὐ γάρ ἐστιν ἡ τούτου τέχνη περὶ τὸ μέγιστον ἀγαθὸν τοῖς ἀνθρώποις, ἀλλ’ ἡ ἐμή —εἰ οὖν αὐτὸν ἐγὼ ἐροίμην· σὺ δὲ τίς ὧν ταῦτα λέγεις; εἴποι ἂν ἴσως ὅτι ἱατρός. τί οὖν λέγεις; ἢ τὸ τῆς σῆς τέχνης ἔργον μέγιστόν ἐστιν ἀγαθόν; πῶς γὰρ οὔ, φαίη ἂν ἴσως, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὑγεία; τί δ’ ἐστὶν μεῖζον ἀγαθὸν ἀνθρώποις ὑγείας; εἰ δ’ αὖ μετὰ τοῦτον ὁ παιδοτρίβης εἴποι ὅτι θαυμάζοιμί τ᾽ αὖν, ὦ Σώκρατες, καὶ αὐτὸς εἴ σοι ἔχοι Γοργίας μεῖζον ἀγαθὸν ἐπιδείξαι τῆς αὐτοῦ τέχνης ἢ ἐγὼ τῆς ἐμῆς· εἴποιμι’ ἂν

αὐτὸ καὶ πρὸς τοῦτον· σὺ δὲ δὴ τίς εἶ, ὦ ἄνθρωπε, καὶ τί τὸ σὸν ἔργον; παιδοτρίβης, φαίη ἄν, τὸ δὲ ἔργον μού ἐστιν καλοὺς τε καὶ ἰσχυροὺς ποιεῖν τοὺς ἀνθρώπους τὰ σώματα. μετὰ δὲ τὸν παιδοτρίβην εἴποι ἂν ὁ χρηματιστής, ὡς ἐγῶμαι πάνυ καταφρονῶν ἀπάντων· σκόπει δῆτα, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἐάν σοι πλούτου φανῇ τι μεῖζον ἀγαθὸν ὃν ἢ παρὰ Γοργία ἢ παρ' ἄλλῳ ὁτῶσιν. φαίμεν ἂν οὖν πρὸς αὐτόν· τί δὲ δῆ; ἢ σὺ τούτου δημιουργός; φαίη ἄν. τίς ὢν; χρηματιστής. τί οὖν; κρίνεις σὺ μέγιστον ἀνθρώποις ἀγαθὸν εἶναι πλοῦτον; φήσομεν. πῶς γὰρ οὐκ; ἔρεϊ. καὶ μὴν ἀμφισβητεῖ γε Γοργίας ὅδε τὴν παρ' αὐτῷ τέχνην μεῖζονος ἀγαθοῦ αἰτίαν εἶναι ἢ τὴν σὴν, φαίμεν ἂν ἡμεῖς. δῆλον οὖν ὅτι τὸ μετὰ τοῦτο ἔροισ' ἄν· καὶ τί ἐστιν

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GO: What it is in truth, Socrates, is a great good, and the cause on the one hand of freedom for humanity itself, and at the same time of dominion over others, for each person in his own city.

452d

S: And what do you call this good?

τοῦτο τὸ ἀγαθόν; ἀποκρινάσθω Γοργίας. ἴθι οὖν νομίσας, ὦ Γοργία, ἐρωτᾶσθαι καὶ ὑπ' ἐκείνων καὶ ὑπ' ἐμοῦ, ἀπόκριναι τί ἐστιν τοῦτο ὃ φῆς σὺ μέγιστον ἀγαθὸν εἶναι τοῖς ἀνθρώποις καὶ σὲ δημιουργὸν εἶναι αὐτοῦ. ΓΟΡ. ὅπερ ἐστίν, ὦ Σώκρατες, τῇ ἀληθείᾳ μέγιστον ἀγαθὸν καὶ αἴτιον ἅμα μὲν ἐλευθερίας αὐτοῖς τοῖς ἀνθρώποις, ἅμα δὲ τοῦ ἄλλων ἄρχειν ἐν τῇ αὐτοῦ πόλει ἐκάστω. ΣΩ. τί οὖν δὴ τοῦτο λέγεις;

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GO: I call it the ability to persuade by means of speeches, to persuade jurors in a law court, councillors in the Council, assembly men in the Assembly, or anyone else at a gathering convened for political purposes. In fact, in virtue of this power, the physician will be your slave and the trainer will be your slave, and this businessman will turn out to be making money for someone else and not for himself – for you, actually, the man with the power to speak and persuade crowds of people.

ΓΟΡ. τὸ πείθειν ἔγωγ' οἷόν τ' εἶναι τοῖς λόγοις καὶ ἐν δικαστηρίῳ δικαστὰς καὶ ἐν βουλευτηρίῳ βουλευτὰς καὶ ἐν ἐκκλησίᾳ ἐκκλησιαστὰς καὶ ἐν ἄλλῳ συλλόγῳ παντί, ὅστις ἂν πολιτικὸς σύλλογος γίγνηται. καίτοι ἐν ταύτῃ τῇ δυνάμει δοῦλον μὲν ἔξεις τὸν ἱατρόν, δοῦλον δὲ τὸν παιδοτρίβην· ὁ δὲ χρηματιστὴς οὗτος ἄλλῳ ἀναφανήσεται χρηματιζόμενος καὶ οὐχ αὐτῷ, ἀλλὰ σοὶ τῷ δυναμένῳ λέγειν καὶ πείθειν τὰ πλήθη. ΣΩ. νῦν μοι δοκεῖς δηλῶσαι, ὦ Γοργία, ἐγγύτατα τὴν

453a

S: I think you have now come as close as possible to showing what you consider rhetoric to be. And if I understand at all, you are asserting that rhetoric is an artificer of persuasion, and its entire function and summation consists in this. Or can you say that rhetoric is able to do anything more than produce persuasion in the soul of those who hear it?

453a

GO: Not at all, Socrates. I think you are defining it quite adequately. Yes, that is the summation of rhetoric.

453a

S: Listen, Gorgias. You need to appreciate something. I am convinced that if anyone ever converses with anyone else with the intention of understanding precisely what it is that the discussion is concerned with, I am one of those people, and I count you among them too.

ῥητορικὴν ἦντινα τέχνην ἡγῆ εἶναι, καὶ εἴ τι ἐγὼ συνίημι, λέγεις ὅτι πειθοῦς δημιουργὸς ἐστὶν ἡ ῥητορική, καὶ ἡ πραγματεία αὐτῆς ἅπασα καὶ τὸ κεφάλαιον εἰς τοῦτο τελευτᾷ· ἢ ἔχεις τι λέγειν ἐπὶ πλέον τὴν ῥητορικὴν δύνασθαι ἢ πειθῶ τοῖς ἀκούουσιν ἐν τῇ ψυχῇ ποιεῖν; ΓΟΡ. οὐδαμῶς, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἀλλὰ μοι δοκεῖς ἰκανῶς ὀρίζεσθαι· ἔστιν γὰρ τοῦτο τὸ κεφάλαιον αὐτῆς. ΣΩ. ἄκουσον δὴ, ὦ Γοργία. ἐγὼ γὰρ εὖ ἴσθ' ὅτι, ὥς

453b

GO: What point are you making, Socrates?

453b

S: I shall tell you now. You need to be fully aware that when you speak of this persuasion produced by rhetoric, I do not know what exactly it is, or what sort of issues it relates to. And yet I do have my suspicions somehow, based upon what I think you are saying it is, and what it relates to. Nevertheless, I shall ask you what precisely you mean by the persuasion produced by rhetoric, and what subjects it relates to. Now, since I have my suspicions, why do I proceed to ask you rather than telling you myself? Well, it is not for your sake, but for the sake of the argument, so that it may proceed in this way to render the issue we are discussing as evident to us as possible. You should consider whether you regard my questioning as justified. For instance, suppose I were to ask you what sort of painter Zeuxis is,⁹ and you were to reply that he painted animals, wouldn't I be justified in asking what sort of animals he paints, and where?

ἐμαυτὸν πείθω, εἴπερ τις ἄλλος ἄλλῳ διαλέγεται βουλόμενος εἰδέναι αὐτὸ τοῦτο περὶ ὅτου ὁ λόγος ἐστίν, καὶ ἐμὲ εἶναι τούτων ἕνα· ἀξιῶ δὲ καὶ σέ. ΓΟΡ. τί οὖν δή, ὦ Σώκρατες; ΣΩ. ἐγὼ ἐρῶ νῦν. ἐγὼ τὴν ἀπὸ τῆς ῥητορικῆς πειθῶ, ἣτις ποτ' ἐστὶν ἢν σὺ λέγεις καὶ περὶ ὧντινων πραγμάτων ἐστὶν πειθῶ, σαφῶς μὲν εὔ ἴσθ' ὅτι οὐκ οἶδα, οὐ μὴν ἄλλ' ὑποπτεύω γε ἢν οἶμαί σε λέγειν καὶ περὶ ὧν· οὐδὲν μέντοι ἤττον ἐρήσομαι σε τίνα ποτὲ λέγεις τὴν πειθῶ τὴν ἀπὸ τῆς

453c

GO: Entirely so.

453c

S: And is the reason that there are other painters who paint numerous other animals?

453c

GO: Yes.

453c

S: But if no one else besides Zeuxis did any painting, would your response have been adequate?

453c

GO: Of course.

ρήτορικῆς καὶ περὶ τίνων αὐτὴν εἶναι. τοῦ ἔνεκα δὴ αὐτὸς ὑποπεύων
σὲ ἐρήσομαι, ἀλλ' οὐκ αὐτὸς λέγω; οὐ σοῦ ἔνεκα ἀλλὰ τοῦ λόγου, ἵνα
οὕτω προῖη ὡς μάλιστα ἂν ἡμῖν καταφανὲς ποιοῖ περὶ οὗτου λέγεται.
σκόπει γὰρ εἴ σοι δοκῶ δικαίως ἀνερωτᾶν σε· ὥσπερ ἂν εἰ ἐτύχανόν σε
ἐρωτῶν τίς ἐστιν τῶν ζωγράφων Ζεῦξις, εἴ μοι εἶπες ὅτι ὁ τὰ ζω-
γράφων, ἄρ' οὐκ ἂν δικαίως σε ἠρόμην ὁ τὰ ποῖα τῶν ζώων γράφων
καὶ ποῦ; ΓΟΡ. πάνυ γε.

453d

S: Come on then, and speak about rhetoric. Do you think that rhetoric alone produces persuasion, or do other skills do this too? I mean, does anyone who teaches any subject whatsoever engage in persuasion or not?

453d

GO: He does, of course. He is more persuasive than anyone else.

453d

S: Let us talk again about the same skills we referred to a moment ago. Doesn't arithmetic, and the person who is arithmetical, teach us whatever relates to number?

453d

GO: Entirely so.

453d

S: And doesn't he also persuade?

453d

GO: Yes.

453d

S: So, arithmetic is also an artificer of persuasion?

453d

GO: So it appears.

ΣΩ. ἄρα διὰ τοῦτο, ὅτι καὶ ἄλλοι εἰσὶ ζωγράφοι γράφοντες ἄλλα πολλὰ
ζῶα; ΓΟΡ. ναί. ΣΩ. εἰ δέ γε μηδεὶς ἄλλος ἢ Ζεῦξις ἔγραφε, καλῶς ἂν σοι
ἀπεκρίναιτο; ΓΟΡ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΣΩ. ἴθι δὴ καὶ περὶ τῆς ῥητορικῆς εἰπέ·

πότερόν σοι δοκεῖ πειθῶ ποιεῖν ἢ ῥητορικὴ μόνη ἢ καὶ ἄλλαι τέχναι; λέγω δὲ τὸ τοιόνδε· ὅστις διδάσκει ὅτιοῦν πρᾶγμα, πότερον ὃ διδάσκει πείθει ἢ οὐ; ΓΟΡ. οὐ δῆτα, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἀλλὰ πάντων μάλιστα πείθει.

453e

S: Therefore, if someone asks us what kind of persuasion it is, and what it relates to, I presume we would answer him that it is instructive persuasion concerning the extent of the even and the odd. And for all of the other skills we mentioned just now, we shall be able to show that they are artificers of persuasion, what sort it is, and what it relates to. Is this so?

ΣΩ. πάλιν δὴ ἐπὶ τῶν αὐτῶν τεχνῶν λέγωμεν ὥνπερ νυνδὴ ἡ ἀριθμητικὴ οὐ διδάσκει ἡμᾶς ὅσα ἐστὶν τὰ τοῦ ἀριθμοῦ, καὶ ὁ ἀριθμητικὸς ἄνθρωπος; ΓΟΡ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ πείθει; ΓΟΡ. ναί. ΣΩ. πειθοῦς ἄρα δημιουργός ἐστιν καὶ ἡ ἀριθμητικὴ; ΓΟΡ. φαίνεται. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἐάν τις ἐρωτᾷ ἡμᾶς ποίας πειθοῦς καὶ περὶ τί, ἀποκρινόμεθα που αὐτῷ ὅτι τῆς διδασκαλικῆς τῆς περὶ τὸ

454a

GO: Yes.

454a

S: So, rhetoric is not the sole artificer of persuasion.

454a

GO: That's true.

454a

S: Then since it is not the only skill that performs this function, but others do so too, we would be justified in questioning once more anyone who asserts this, just as we put a further question in relation to painting. Of what kind of persuasion is rhetoric a skill, and concerning what? Or don't you think it is right to ask this question once more?

ἄρτιόν τε καὶ τὸ περιττὸν ὅσον ἐστίν· καὶ τὰς ἄλλας αἷς νυνδὴ ἐλέγομεν τέχνας ἀπάσας ἔξομεν ἀποδείξαι πειθοῦς δημιουργοὺς οὕσας καὶ ἥστινος καὶ περὶ ὅτι· ἢ οὐ; ΓΟΡ. ναί. ΣΩ. οὐκ ἄρα ῥητορικὴ μόνη πειθοῦς

ἐστιν δημιουργός. ΓΟΡ. ἀληθῆ λέγεις. ΣΩ. ἐπειδὴ τοίνυν οὐ μόνη ἀπεργάζεται τοῦτο τὸ ἔργον, ἀλλὰ καὶ ἄλλαι, δικαίως ὥσπερ περὶ τοῦ ζωγράφου μετὰ τοῦτο ἐπανερούμεθ' ἂν τὸν λέγοντα· ποίας δὴ πειθοῦς καὶ τῆς περὶ τί πειθοῦς ἡ ῥητορική ἐστιν τέχνη; ἢ οὐ δοκεῖ σοι

454b

GO: I do.

454b

S: Well, Gorgias, since that is what you think, you should answer the question.

454b

GO: Socrates, I am referring to the sort of persuasion that occurs in courts of law and in other gatherings, as I said earlier, and it concerns matters that are just and unjust.

454b

S: Yes, Gorgias, and I suspected that this was the sort of persuasion you meant, and that this was its concern. But I do not want you to be surprised if I ask you another question like this quite soon, the sort of question that seems obvious but which I repeat in any case. For, as I say, I am not asking for your sake but for the sake of the completion of the argument, so that we do not get into the habit of snatching at one another's pronouncements through guesswork. Instead, you should come to your own conclusions in whatever manner you wish on the basis of the hypothesis.

δίκαιον εἶναι ἐπανερέσθαι; ΓΟΡ. ἔμοιγε. ΣΩ. ἀποκρίναι δὴ, ὦ Γοργία, ἐπειδὴ γε καὶ σοὶ δοκεῖ οὕτως. ΓΟΡ. ταύτης τοίνυν τῆς πειθοῦς λέγω, ὦ Σώκρατες, τῆς ἐν τοῖς δικαστηρίοις καὶ ἐν τοῖς ἄλλοις ὄχλοις, ὥσπερ καὶ ἄρτι ἔλεγον, καὶ περὶ τούτων ἅ ἐστι δίκαιά τε καὶ ἄδικα. ΣΩ. καὶ ἐγὼ τοι ὑπώπτευον ταύτην σε λέγειν τὴν πειθὴ καὶ περὶ τούτων, ὦ Γοργία· ἀλλ' ἵνα μὴ θαυμάζῃς ἐὰν καὶ ὀλίγον ὕστερον τοιοῦτόν τί σε ἀνέρωμαι, ὃ δοκεῖ μὲν δῆλον

454c

GO: Yes, I think that's the right way to do it, Socrates.

454c

S: Come on then, and let us consider this. Do you use the expression ‘to have learned’?

454c

GO: I use it.

454c

S: And ‘to have believed’?

εἶναι, ἐγὼ δ’ ἐπανερωτῶ—ὅπερ γὰρ λέγω, τοῦ ἐξῆς ἔνεκα περαίνεσθαι τὸν λόγον ἐρωτῶ, οὐ σοῦ ἔνεκα ἀλλ’ ἵνα μὴ ἐθιζώμεθα ὑπονοοῦντες προαρπάζειν ἀλλήλων τὰ λεγόμενα, ἀλλὰ σὺ τὰ σαυτοῦ κατὰ τὴν ὑπόθεσιν ὅπως ἂν βούλῃ περαίνῃς. ΓΟΡ. καὶ ὀρθῶς γέ μοι δοκεῖς ποιεῖν, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. ἴθι δὴ καὶ τόδε ἐπισκεψώμεθα. καλεῖς τι μεμαθηκέναι; ΓΟΡ. καλῶ. ΣΩ. τί δέ; πεπιστευκέναι; ΓΟΡ.

454d

GO: I do.

454d

S: Now, do you think ‘to have learned’ and ‘to have believed’, and ‘learning’ and ‘belief’ are the same or different?

454d

GO: In my view anyway, Socrates, they are different.

454d

S: Yes, you are right to think so and you may confirm it as follows. For if someone were to ask you, “Gorgias, is there true belief and false belief?” you would agree, I presume.

454d

GO: Yes.

454d

S: What about this? Is there true and false knowledge?

454d

GO: Not at all.

454d

S: So it is obvious that they are not the same.

454d

GO: What you say is true.

ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. πότερον οὖν ταῦτόν δοκεῖ σοι εἶναι μεμαθηκέναι καὶ πεπιστευκέναι, καὶ μάθησις καὶ πίστις, ἢ ἄλλο τι; ΓΟΡ. οἶομαι μὲν ἔγωγε, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἄλλο. ΣΩ. καλῶς γὰρ οἶει· γνώση δὲ ἐνθένδε. εἰ γὰρ τίς σε ἔροιτο· ἄρ' ἔστιν τις, ὃ Γοργία, πίστις ψευδῆς καὶ ἀληθῆς; φαίης ἄν, ὡς ἐγὼ οἶμαι. ΓΟΡ. ναί. ΣΩ. τί δέ; ἐπιστήμη ἐστὶν ψευδῆς καὶ ἀληθῆς; ΓΟΡ. οὐδαμῶς. ΣΩ. δηλὸν ἄρ' αὖ ὅτι οὐ ταῦτόν ἐστιν. ΓΟΡ. ἀληθῆ λέγεις. ΣΩ.

454e

S: And yet those who have learned have been persuaded, and so have those who believe.

454e

GO: This is so.

454e

S: So, do you want us to posit two forms of persuasion, one furnishing belief without knowing, and the other furnishing knowledge?

454e

GO: Entirely so.

454e

S: In that case, which persuasion does rhetoric produce in law courts and other gatherings in relation to matters of justice and injustice? Is it the sort from which believing arises without the knowing, or the sort from which the knowing arises?

454e

GO: It is obvious, surely, that it is the sort from which believing arises.

ἀλλὰ μὴν οἱ τέ γε μεμαθηκότες πεπεισμένοι εἰσὶν καὶ οἱ πεπιστευκότες. ΓΟΡ. ἔστι ταῦτα. ΣΩ. βούλει οὖν δύο εἶδη θῶμεν πειθοῦς, τὸ μὲν πίστιν παρεχόμενον ἄνευ τοῦ εἰδέναι, τὸ δ' ἐπιστήμην; ΓΟΡ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. ποτέραν οὖν ἡ ῥητορικὴ πειθῶ ποιεῖ ἐν δικαστηρίοις τε καὶ τοῖς ἄλλοις ὄχλοις περὶ τῶν δικαίων τε καὶ ἀδίκων; ἐξ ἧς πιστεύειν γίγνεται ἄνευ

τοῦ εἰδέναι ἢ ἐξ ἧς τὸ εἰδέναι; ΓΟΡ. δῆλον δήπου, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὅτι ἐξ ἧς τὸ πιστεύειν. ΣΩ. ἡ ῥητορικὴ ἄρα, ὡς ἔοικεν, πειθοῦς

455a

S: So, rhetoric is, it seems, the artificer of belief-based rather than instructive persuasion about the just and the unjust.

455a

GO: Yes.

δημιουργός ἐστιν πιστευτικῆς ἀλλ' οὐ διδασκαλικῆς περὶ τὸ δίκαιόν τε καὶ ἄδικον. ΓΟΡ. ναί. ΣΩ. οὐδ' ἄρα διδασκαλικὸς ὁ ῥήτωρ ἐστὶν δικαστηρίων τε καὶ τῶν ἄλλων ὅχλων δικαίων τε πέρι καὶ ἀδίκων, ἀλλὰ πιστικὸς μόνον· οὐ γὰρ δήπου ὅχλον γ' ἂν δύναίτο τοσοῦτον ἐν ὀλίγῳ χρόνῳ διδάξαι οὕτω μεγάλα πράγματα. ΓΟΡ. οὐ δῆτα. ΣΩ. φέρε δή, ἴδωμεν τί ποτε καὶ λέγομεν περὶ τῆς

455b

S: So, the rhetorician is not instructive towards law courts and the other gatherings with regard to matters of justice and injustice, he is merely persuasive. For, of course, he would not be able to instruct a gathering of that sort in a limited time on such important matters.

455b

GO: Of course not.

455b

S: Come on then, let us look at what precisely we are saying about rhetoric. For I myself am unable to understand, as yet, what I am saying. Whenever there is a meeting in the city about the selection of physicians or shipbuilders, or some other category of artificers, that is not the occasion when the rhetorician will give advice, is it? For it is evident that in each of these selections, the most skilled person should be selected. Nor do they advise us when the subject is the construction of walls or the fitting out of harbours and dockyards. No, the architects advise us then. Again, when there is deliberation about the selection of generals or our formation against our enemies or the capture of territories, it is military men who give advice then, and not

the rhetoricians. Or how would you describe deliberations of this kind, Gorgias? Indeed, since you say that you are yourself a rhetorician and can make rhetoricians of others, it would be worthwhile to find out about the details of this skill from you. And you should regard me too as someone who is concerned for your interests, for there may be someone inside who wishes to become a pupil of yours. I notice some, quite a number actually, and they would probably be embarrassed to question you. So, when you are being questioned by me, regard yourself as being questioned by them too: “What will be ours, Gorgias, if we consort with you? On what affairs of the city shall we be enabled to advise? Is it only about what is just and unjust, or also about the topics Socrates mentioned a moment ago?” Now, try to respond to them.

ρήτορικῆς ἐγὼ μὲν γάρ τοι οὐδ’ αὐτός πω δύναμαι κατανοῆσαι ὅτι λέγω. ὅταν περὶ ἱατρῶν αἰρέσεως ἢ τῇ πόλει σύλλογος ἢ περὶ ναυπηγῶν ἢ περὶ ἄλλου τινὸς δημιουργικοῦ ἔθνους, ἄλλο τι ἢ τότε ὁ ῥητορικὸς οὐ συμβουλεύσει; δῆλον γὰρ ὅτι ἐν ἐκάστη αἰρέσει τὸν τεχνικώτατον δεῖ αἰρεῖσθαι. οὐδ’ ὅταν τειχῶν περὶ οἰκοδομήσεως ἢ λιμένων κατασκευῆς ἢ νεωρίων, ἀλλ’ οἱ ἀρχιτέκτονες οὐδ’ αὖ ὅταν στρατηγῶν αἰρέσεως πέρι ἢ τάξεώς τινος πρὸς πολεμίους ἢ χωρίων καταλήψεως συμβουλὴ ἢ, ἀλλ’ οἱ στρατηγικοὶ τότε συμβουλεύουσιν, οἱ ῥητορικοὶ δὲ οὐ· ἢ πῶς λέγεις, ὦ Γοργία, τὰ τοιαῦτα; ἐπειδὴ γὰρ αὐτός τε φῆς ῥήτωρ εἶναι καὶ ἄλλους ποιεῖν ῥητορικούς, εὖ ἔχει τὰ τῆς σῆς τέχνης παρὰ σοῦ πυνθάνεσθαι. καὶ ἐμὲ νῦν νόμισον καὶ τὸ σὸν σπεύδειν· ἴσως γὰρ καὶ τυγχάνει τις τῶν ἔνδον ὄντων μαθητῆς σου βουλόμενος γενέσθαι, ὥς ἐγὼ τινὰς σχεδὸν καὶ συχνοὺς αἰσθάνομαι, οἳ ἴσως αἰσχύνονται ἂν σε ἀνερέσθαι. ὑπ’

455d

Go: Well, Socrates, I shall try to reveal the entire power of rhetoric to you in a clear manner. You led the way very nicely yourself. For you know, of course, that those dockyards and the walls of Athens and the fitting out of the harbours owe their origin to the advice of

Themistocles, and the others to the advice of Pericles, but not to the advice of artificers.¹⁰

ἐμοῦ οὖν ἀνερωτώμενος νόμισον καὶ ὑπ' ἐκείνων ἀνερωτᾶσθαι τί ἡμῖν, ὦ Γοργία, ἔσται, ἐάν σοι συνῶμεν; περὶ τίνων τῇ πόλει συμβουλευεῖν οἷοί τε ἐσόμεθα; πότερον περὶ δικαίου μόνον καὶ ἀδίκου ἢ καὶ περὶ ὧν νυνδὴ Σωκράτης ἔλεγεν; πειρῶ οὖν αὐτοῖς ἀποκρίνεσθαι. ΓΟΡ. ἀλλ' ἐγὼ σοι πειράσομαι, ὦ Σώκρατες, σαφῶς ἀποκαλύψαι τὴν τῆς ῥητορικῆς δύναμιν ἅπασαν· αὐτὸς γὰρ καλῶς ὑφηγήσω. οἶσθα γὰρ δήπου ὅτι τὰ νεώρια ταῦτα

455e

S: Yes, Gorgias, that is what they say about Themistocles, and I heard Pericles myself when he advised us about the Middle Wall.¹¹

455e

GO: And whenever there is a decision of the kind you mentioned just now, you see that the rhetoricians are those who give advice and whose opinions prevail on these matters.

455e

S: Yes, these are the issues I wonder about, and for some time I have been asking what precisely the power of rhetoric is. For when I consider it in this way, its greatness appears to me as something supernatural.

καὶ τὰ τεῖχη τὰ Ἀθηναίων καὶ ἡ τῶν λιμένων κατασκευὴ ἐκ τῆς Θεμιστοκλέους συμβουλῆς γέγονεν, τὰ δ' ἐκ τῆς Περικλέους ἀλλ' οὐκ ἐκ τῶν δημιουργῶν. ΣΩ. λέγεται ταῦτα, ὦ Γοργία, περὶ Θεμιστοκλέους· Περικλέους δὲ καὶ αὐτὸς ἤκουον ὅτε συνεβούλευεν ἡμῖν περὶ τοῦ διὰ μέσου τείχους.

456a

GO: If only you knew all of it, Socrates, that it somehow incorporates all of the powers within itself! I'll give you strong evidence for this. On many occasions, I have gone along with my brother and with the other physicians to someone who was ill but was unwilling to swallow the medicine or submit to cutting or burning at the physician's hands.

Now, the physicians were unable to persuade him, but I persuaded him by means of no other skill than rhetoric. And I also assert that if the physician and the rhetorician went to any city you care to name, and it was necessary to have a verbal contest in the Assembly, or some other meeting, as to which of them should be chosen as physician, the physician would not feature at all, but the one with the power to speak would be chosen, if he so wished. And if he were to compete against any other artificer whatsoever, the rhetorician would persuade people to choose himself rather than anyone else at all. For there is no issue on which the rhetorician could not speak more persuasively at a gathering than any other artificer. Now then, such is the power of this skill, and such is its extent.

However, Socrates, one should make use of rhetoric just as one uses any other competitive skill. And, indeed, no other competitive skill is learned in order to be used against the entire human race. Because one learns boxing and fighting, and fighting in full armour so as to be superior to friends and to enemies, one does not, on that account, strike one's friends or stab them or kill them. Nor, by Zeus, if someone has frequented a gymnasium, gets his body into good shape, becomes a skilled boxer, and then punches his father or mother or some family members or friends, should we, on that account, hate the trainers or the teachers of armour-fighting, and expel them from our cities? No, those men imparted the skill to others to be used in a just manner against enemies and miscreants, defensively, not on their own initiative. But the pupils pervert it and use their strength and skill in an improper manner.

Therefore, those who teach it are not corrupt, nor, on this account, is the skill either blameworthy or corrupt. No, I think the fault lies with those who do not use it properly. Now, the same argument also applies to rhetoric. The rhetorician has the power to oppose everyone and to speak on every topic, and so he is more persuasive before large

gatherings on any issue he chooses, almost anything at all. However, he need not, on that account, be any more inclined to take away the reputation of physicians or other artificers just because he has the power to do so. Instead, as with any other competitive skill, he needs to use rhetoric justly. But in my view, if someone who has become a rhetorician acts unjustly by means of this power and this skill, we should not hate the person who taught him, and expel him from our cities. For that man imparted the knowledge to be used justly, but the pupil used it in the opposite way. So, it is right to hate the one who used it improperly, and exile him or kill him, but not the one who taught him.

ΓΟΡ. καὶ ὅταν γέ τις αἵρεσις ἧ ὧν νυνδὴ σὺ ἔλεγες, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὁρᾷς ὅτι οἱ ῥήτορες εἰσιν οἱ συμβουλευόντες καὶ οἱ νικῶντες τὰς γνώμας περὶ τούτων. ΣΩ. ταῦτα καὶ θαυμάζων, ὦ Γοργία, πάλοι ἐρωτῶ τίς ποτε ἡ δύναμις ἐστὶν τῆς ῥητορικῆς. δαιμονία γάρ τις ἔμοιγε καταφαίνεται τὸ μέγεθος οὕτω σκοποῦντι. ΓΟΡ. εἰ πάντα γε εἰδείης, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὅτι ὡς ἔπος εἰπεῖν ἀπάσας τὰς δυνάμεις συλλαβοῦσα ὑφ' αὐτῇ ἔχει. μέγα δέ σοι τεκμήριον ἐρῶ· πολλάκις γὰρ ἤδη ἔγωγε μετὰ τοῦ ἀδελφοῦ καὶ μετὰ τῶν ἄλλων ἱατρῶν εἰσελθὼν παρὰ τινα τῶν καμνόντων οὐχὶ ἐθέλοντα ἢ φάρμακον πιεῖν ἢ τεμεῖν ἢ καῦσαι παρασχεῖν τῷ ἱατρῷ, οὐδυναμένου τοῦ ἱατροῦ πεῖσαι, ἐγὼ ἔπεισα, οὐκ ἄλλη τέχνη ἢ τῇ ῥητορικῇ. φημὶ δὲ καὶ εἰς πόλιν ὅπη βούλει ἐλθόντα ῥητορικὸν ἄνδρα καὶ ἱατρόν, εἰ δέοι λόγῳ διαγωνίζεσθαι ἐν ἐκκλησίᾳ ἢ ἐν ἄλλῳ τινὶ συλλόγῳ ὁπότερον δεῖ αἰρεθῆναι ἱατρόν, οὐδαμοῦ ἂν φανῆναι τὸν ἱατρόν, ἀλλ' αἰρεθῆναι ἂν τὸν εἰπεῖν δυνατόν, εἰ βούλοιο. καὶ εἰ πρὸς ἄλλον γε δημιουργὸν ὄντιναοῦν ἀγωνίζοιτο, πείσειεν ἂν αὐτὸν ἐλέσθαι ὁ ῥητορικὸς μᾶλλον ἢ ἄλλος ὅστισοῦν· οὐ γὰρ ἔστιν περὶ ὅτου οὐκ ἂν πιθανώτερον εἴποι ὁ ῥητορικὸς ἢ ἄλλος ὅστισοῦν τῶν δημιουργῶν ἐν πλήθει. ἡ μὲν οὖν δύναμις τοσαύτη ἐστὶν καὶ τοιαύτη τῆς τέχνης· δεῖ μέντοι, ὦ Σώκρατες, τῇ ῥητορικῇ χρῆσθαι ὥσπερ τῇ ἄλλῃ πάσῃ ἀγωνίᾳ. καὶ γὰρ τῇ ἄλλῃ ἀγωνίᾳ οὐ τούτου ἕνεκα δεῖ πρὸς ἅπαντας χρῆσθαι ἀνθρώπους, ὅτι ἔμαθεν πυκτεύειν τε καὶ παγκρατιάζειν καὶ ἐν ὅπλοις μάχεσθαι, ὥστε κρείττων εἶναι καὶ φίλων

καὶ ἐχθρῶν, οὐ τούτου ἔνεκα τοὺς φίλους δεῖ τύπτειν οὐδὲ κεντεῖν τε καὶ ἀποκτεινύναι. οὐδέ γε μὰ Δία ἓάν τις εἰς παλαιστραν φοιτήσας εὖ ἔχων τὸ σῶμα καὶ πυκτικὸς γενόμενος, ἔπειτα τὸν πατέρα τύπτῃ καὶ τὴν μητέρα ἢ ἄλλον τινὰ τῶν οἰκείων ἢ τῶν φίλων, οὐ τούτου ἔνεκα δεῖ τοὺς παιδοτρίβας καὶ τοὺς ἐν τοῖς ὅπλοις διδάσκοντας μάχεσθαι μισεῖν τε καὶ ἐκβάλλειν ἐκ τῶν πόλεων. ἐκεῖνοι μὲν γὰρ παρέδοσαν ἐπὶ τῷ δικαίως χρῆσθαι τούτοις πρὸς τοὺς πολεμίους καὶ τοὺς ἀδικοῦντας, ἀμυνομένους, μὴ ὑπάρχοντας· οἱ δὲ μεταστρέψαντες χρῶνται τῇ ἰσχύϊ καὶ τῇ τέχνῃ οὐκ ὀρθῶς. ΓΟΡ. οὐκ οὖν οἱ διδάξαντες πονηροί, οὐδὲ ἡ τέχνη οὔτε αἰτία οὔτε πονηρὰ τούτου ἔνεκά ἐστιν, ἀλλ' οἱ μὴ χρώμενοι οἷμαι ὀρθῶς. ὁ αὐτὸς δὲ λόγος καὶ περὶ τῆς ῥητορικῆς. δυνατὸς μὲν γὰρ πρὸς ἅπαντάς ἐστιν ὁ ῥήτωρ καὶ περὶ παντὸς λέγειν, ὥστε πιθανώτερος εἶναι ἐν τοῖς πλήθεσιν ἔμβραχυ περὶ ὅτου ἂν βούληται· ἀλλ' οὐδέν τι μᾶλλον τούτου ἔνεκα δεῖ οὔτε τοὺς ἰατροὺς τὴν δόξαν ἀφαιρεῖσθαι—ὅτι δύναίτο ἂν τοῦτο ποιῆσαι—οὔτε τοὺς ἄλλους δημιουργούς, ἀλλὰ δικαίως καὶ τῇ ῥητορικῇ χρῆσθαι, ὥσπερ καὶ τῇ ἀγωνίᾳ. ἔάν δὲ οἷμαι ῥητορικὸς γενόμενός τις κᾶτα αὐτῇ τῇ δυνάμει καὶ τῇ τέχνῃ ἀδικῇ, οὐ τὸν διδάξαντα δεῖ μισεῖν τε καὶ ἐκβάλλειν ἐκ τῶν πόλεων. ἐκεῖνος μὲν γὰρ ἐπὶ

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S: I imagine, Gorgias, that you, like me, have experience of a whole range of speeches, and that you have observed something about them – that the speakers are not easily capable of mutually defining the issues they are trying to discuss, and of learning and teaching themselves, and concluding their meeting upon that basis. Instead, when they dispute over something, and one says that the other is not speaking correctly or clearly, they become angry and they believe that the other is speaking from resentment towards them, from a thirst for victory, rather than pursuing the issue in front of them for discussion. And some of them end up behaving most disgracefully, engaging in slander, and saying and hearing such things as make even their audience angry on their own account, because they deemed such fellows worth listening to.

Well, why am I saying this? It is because I think that what you are now saying is neither entirely consistent nor consonant with what you first said about rhetoric. Yet I am afraid to refute you in case you assume that I am out for victory and my words are aimed at you rather than the issue and its elucidation. Now, if you are the sort of person that I am, I would gladly continue to question you, but otherwise I shall have done with it.

What sort of person am I? I am one of those who would gladly be refuted if I say anything untrue, and would gladly engage in refutation if someone else were to say something untrue, and yet I am no less averse to being refuted than to engaging in refutation. Indeed, I think that being refuted is a greater good insofar as it is a greater good to be released oneself from the greatest evil, rather than releasing someone else. For I believe that nothing is so evil for a person as a false opinion on the issues with which our present discussion is concerned. So, if you claim to be someone of this sort, let us have a discussion, but if you think we should have done with it, let us bid the issue farewell now, and bring our discussion to an end.

δικαίου χρεία παρέδωκεν, ὁ δ' ἐναντίως χρήται. τὸν οὖν οὐκ ὀρθῶς χρώμενον μισεῖν δίκαιον καὶ ἐκβάλλειν καὶ ἀποκτεινύναι ἀλλ' οὐ τὸν διδάξαντα. ΣΩ. οἶμαι, ὦ Γοργία, καὶ σὲ ἔμπειρον εἶναι πολλῶν λόγων καὶ καθεωρακέναί ἐν αὐτοῖς τὸ τοιόνδε, ὅτι οὐ ῥαδίως δύνανται περὶ ὧν ἂν ἐπιχειρήσωσιν διαλέγεσθαι διορισάμενοι πρὸς ἀλλήλους καὶ μαθόντες καὶ διδάξαντες ἑαυτούς, οὕτω διαλύεσθαι τὰς συνουσίας, ἀλλ' ἐὰν περὶ τοῦ ἀμφισβητήσωσιν καὶ μὴ φῇ ὁ ἕτερος τὸν ἕτερον ὀρθῶς λέγειν ἢ μὴ σαφῶς, χαλεπαίνουσί τε καὶ κατὰ φθόνον οἶονται τὸν ἑαυτῶν λέγειν, φιλονικοῦντας ἀλλ' οὐ ζητοῦντας τὸ προκείμενον ἐν τῷ λόγῳ καὶ ἔνιοί γε τελευτῶντες αἰσχιστα ἀπαλλάττονται, λαιδορηθέντες τε καὶ εἰπόντες καὶ ἀκούσαντες περὶ σφῶν αὐτῶν τοιαῦτα οἷα καὶ τοὺς παρόντας ἄχθεσθαι ὑπὲρ σφῶν αὐτῶν, ὅτι τοιούτων ἀνθρώπων ἡξίωσαν ἀκροαταὶ γενέσθαι. τοῦ δὴ ἔνεκα λέγω

ταῦτα; ὅτι νῦν ἐμοὶ δοκεῖς σὺ οὐ πάννυ ἀκόλουθα λέγειν οὐδὲ σύμφωνα οἷς τὸ πρῶτον ἔλεγες περὶ τῆς ῥητορικῆς φοβοῦμαι οὖν διελέγχειν σε, μή με ὑπολάβῃς οὐ πρὸς τὸ πρᾶγμα φιλονικοῦντα λέγειν τοῦ καταφανὲς γενέσθαι, ἀλλὰ πρὸς σέ. ΣΩ. ἐγὼ οὖν, εἰ μὲν καὶ σὺ εἶ τῶν ἀνθρώπων ὧν περ καὶ ἐγώ, ἡδέως ἂν σε διερωτώην· εἰ δὲ μή, ἐφῆν ἂν. ἐγὼ δὲ τίνων εἰμί; τῶν ἡδέως μὲν ἂν ἐλεγχθέντων εἴ τι μὴ ἀληθὲς λέγω, ἡδέως δ' ἂν ἐλεγχάντων εἴ τις τι μὴ ἀληθὲς λέγοι, οὐκ ἀηδέστερον μεντὰν ἐλεγχθέντων ἢ ἐλεγχάντων· μεῖζον γὰρ αὐτὸ ἀγαθὸν ἡγοῦμαι, ὅσῳ περ μεῖζον ἀγαθὸν ἐστὶν αὐτὸν ἀπαλλαγῆναι κακοῦ τοῦ μεγίστου ἢ ἄλλον ἀπαλλάξαι. οὐδὲν γὰρ οἶμαι τοσοῦτον κακὸν εἶναι ἀνθρώπῳ, ὅσον δόξα ψευδὴς περὶ ὧν τυγχάνει νῦν ἡμῖν ὁ λόγος ὧν. εἰ μὲν οὖν καὶ σὺ φῆς τοιοῦτος εἶναι, διαλεγώμεθα· εἰ δὲ καὶ δοκεῖ χρῆναι ἔαν, ἔωμεν ἤδη χαίρειν καὶ διαλύωμεν τὸν λόγον. ΓΟΡ. ἀλλὰ φημί μὲν ἔγωγε, ὦ Σώκρατες, καὶ αὐτὸς τοιοῦτος εἶναι οἷον σὺ ὑφηγῇ· ἴσως μέντοι χρῆν ἐννοεῖν καὶ τὸ τῶν παρόντων. πάλαί γάρ τοι, πρὶν καὶ ὑμᾶς ἐλθεῖν, ἐγὼ τοῖς παροῦσι πολλὰ ἐπεδειξάμην, καὶ νῦν ἴσως πόρρω ἀποτενοῦμεν,

458c

GO: No, Socrates, I say that I myself am the sort of person you have described. However, we should probably take our audience into consideration too. Yes, I should tell you that a while ago, before you arrived, I gave numerous exhibitions to these people, and we are now likely to prolong this unduly if we engage in discussion. So, we should also consider their circumstances in case we are detaining some of them who wish to do something else.

458c

CH: Socrates and Gorgias, listen for yourselves to the commotion from these men, who wish to hear anything you have to say. As for myself, I pray that I never become so busy that I would set aside such discussions as these, conducted in this manner, because it became more important to do something else.

ἦν διαλεγώμεθα. σκοπεῖν οὖν χρή καὶ τὸ τούτων, μή τινας αὐτῶν κατέχομεν βουλομένους τι καὶ ἄλλο πράττειν. ΧΑΙ. τοῦ μὲν θορύβου, ὦ

Γοργία τε καὶ Σώκρατες, αὐτοὶ ἀκούετε τούτων τῶν ἀνδρῶν βουλομένων ἀκούειν ἐάν τι λέγητε· ἐμοὶ δ' οὖν καὶ αὐτῷ μὴ γένοιτο τοσαύτη ἀσχολία, ὥστε τοιούτων λόγων καὶ οὕτω λεγομένων ἀφεμένῳ προύργιαίτερόν τι γενέσθαι ἄλλο πράττειν.

458d

CA: Yes, by the gods, Chaerephon, I myself have been present at many discussions over the years, but I don't know if I have ever before been so delighted as I am now. Accordingly, if you wish to converse for the whole day, you will be doing me a favour anyway.

458d

S: And, indeed, Callicles, there is no impediment on my part as long as Gorgias is willing.

458d

GO: Well, Socrates, after all that it would be a disgrace for me to prove unwilling, since I was the one who announced that anyone could ask whatever they wanted. So, if this is how these people see it, proceed with the discussion and ask any question you want.

ΚΑΛ. νῆ τοὺς θεούς, ὦ Χαιρεφῶν, καὶ μὲν δὴ καὶ αὐτὸς πολλοῖς ἤδη λόγοις παραγενόμενος οὐκ οἶδ' εἰ πώποτε ἦσθην οὕτως ὥσπερ νυνί· ὥστ' ἔμοιγε, κἂν τὴν ἡμέραν ὅλην ἐθέλῃτε διαλέγεσθαι, χαριεῖσθε. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ μήν, ὦ Καλλίκλεις, τό γ' ἐμὸν οὐδὲν κωλύει, εἴπερ ἐθέλει Γοργίας. ΓΟΡ. αἰσχρὸν δὴ τὸ λοιπόν, ὦ Σώκρατες, γίγνεται ἐμέ γε μὴ ἐθέλῃν, αὐτὸν ἐπαγγειλάμενον ἐρωτᾶν ὅτι τις βούλεται.

458e

S: Then listen, Gorgias, to what surprised me in the statements that you made. Indeed, it is possible that what you say is correct, and I am not understanding you correctly. Do you say that you can make someone a rhetorician, if he wishes to learn from you?

458e

GO: Yes.

458e

S: So that he may be persuasive before a crowd, not teaching them but persuading them?

458e

GO: Entirely so.

ἀλλ' εἰ δοκεῖ τουτοισί, διαλέγου τε καὶ ἐρώτα ὅτι βούλει. ΣΩ. ἄκουε δὴ, ὦ Γοργία, ἃ θαυμάζω ἐν τοῖς λεγομένοις ὑπὸ σοῦ· ἴσως γάρ τοι σοῦ ὀρθῶς λέγοντος ἐγὼ οὐκ ὀρθῶς ὑπολαμβάνω. ῥητορικὸν φῆς ποιεῖν οἷός τ' εἶναι, ἐάν τις βούληται παρὰ σοῦ μανθάνειν; ΓΟΡ. ναί. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν περὶ πάντων ὥστ' ἐν ὅλῳ πιθανὸν εἶναι, οὐ διδάσκοντα ἀλλὰ

459a

S: And you also said just now that even on health matters, the rhetorician will be more persuasive than the physician.

459a

GO: Yes I did, before a crowd anyway.

459a

S: Does not 'before a crowd' mean 'before those who do not know'? For surely before those who know he would not be more persuasive than the physician.

459a

GO: What you say is true.

459a

S: And since he will be more persuasive than the physician, he turns out to be more persuasive than the one who knows.

459a

GO: Certainly.

459a

S: Although he is not a physician. Is this so?

459a

GO: Yes.

πείθοντα; ΓΟΡ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. ἔλεγές τοι νυνδὴ ὅτι καὶ περὶ τοῦ ὑγιεινοῦ τοῦ ἱατροῦ πιθανώτερος ἔσται ὁ ῥήτωρ. ΓΟΡ. καὶ γὰρ ἔλεγον,

ἐν γε ὄχλῳ. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τὸ ἐν ὄχλῳ τοῦτό ἐστιν, ἐν τοῖς μὴ εἰδόσιν; οὐ γὰρ δήπου ἐν γε τοῖς εἰδόσι τοῦ ἱατροῦ πιθανώτερος ἔσται. ΓΟΡ. ἀληθὴ λέγεις. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν εἴπερ τοῦ ἱατροῦ πιθανώτερος ἔσται, τοῦ εἰδότος πιθανώτερος γίγνεται; ΓΟΡ. πάνυ

459b

S: But the non-physician is, of course, not knowledgeable on matters of which the physician is knowledgeable.

459b

GO: Obviously.

459b

S: So, whenever the rhetorician is more persuasive than the physician, the person who does not know will be more persuasive than the person who knows, before those who do not know. Does this follow or does it not?

459b

GO: It follows from what went before, anyway.

459b

S: Therefore, in relation to all the other skills, the position of the rhetorician or rhetoric is the same. It does not need to know anything about the actual details since it has discovered some means of persuasion by which, before those who do not know, it appears to know more than those who know.

γε. ΣΩ. οὐκ ἱατρός γε ὢν· ἦ γάρ; ΓΟΡ. ναί. ΣΩ. ὁ δὲ μὴ ἱατρός γε δήπου ἀνεπιστήμων ὢν ὁ ἱατρὸς ἐπιστήμων. ΓΟΡ. δῆλον ὅτι. ΣΩ. ὁ οὐκ εἰδὼς ἄρα τοῦ εἰδότος ἐν οὐκ εἰδόσι πιθανώτερος ἔσται, ὅταν ὁ ῥήτωρ τοῦ ἱατροῦ πιθανώτερος ᾖ. τοῦτο συμβαίνει ἢ ἄλλο τι; ΓΟΡ. τοῦτο ἐνταῦθά γε συμβαίνει. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ περὶ τὰς ἄλλας ἀπάσας τέχνας ὡσαύτως ἔχει ὁ ῥήτωρ καὶ ἡ ῥητορικὴ· αὐτὰ μὲν τὰ πράγματα οὐδὲν δεῖ αὐτὴν εἰδέναι ὅπως ἔχει, μηχανήν

459c

GO: Well, doesn't it make things much easier, Socrates, when, without having learned the other skills but just this one skill, you are no worse

off than the other artificers?

δέ τινα πειθοῦς ἡγρηκέναι ὥστε φαίνεσθαι τοῖς οὐκ εἰδόσι μᾶλλον εἰδέναι τῶν εἰδότων. ΓΟΡ. οὐκοῦν πολλή ραστώνη, ὦ Σώκρατες, γίγνεται, μὴ μαθόντα τὰς ἄλλας τέχνας ἀλλὰ μίαν ταύτην, μηδὲν ἐλαττοῦσθαι τῶν δημιουργῶν; ΣΩ. εἰ μὲν ἐλαττοῦται ἢ μὴ ἐλαττοῦται ὁ ῥήτωρ τῶν ἄλλων διὰ τὸ οὕτως ἔχειν, αὐτίκα ἐπισκεψόμεθα, ἐάν τι ἡμῖν πρὸς λόγου ἦ· νῦν δὲ τόδε πρότερον σκεψώμεθα, ἄρα

459d

S: We shall investigate presently whether or not the rhetorician is worse off than the others under such circumstances, if that is relevant to our discussion. But there is something we should consider first. When it comes to just and unjust, base and noble, good and bad, is the situation of the rhetorician the same as it was in the case of health, and the various concerns of the other skills? Without knowing what is good and bad, base and noble, just and unjust, could he bring about persuasion in relation to these so that, before those who do not know, he seems to know more than those who actually know, even though he doesn't know? Or is it necessary to know these, and should the person who intends to learn rhetoric know these things before he arrives in front of you? And if not, will you, the teacher of rhetoric, decline to teach these subjects to the new arrival since it is not your job? And instead, although he does not know such matters, will you make him seem to know before the multitude, and seem to be good when he is not? Or will you be unable to teach him rhetoric at all if he does not know the truth about these matters in advance? What is the situation here, Gorgias? And by Zeus, as you said you would do earlier, please reveal rhetoric and state what precisely its power is.

τυγχάνει περὶ τὸ δίκαιον καὶ τὸ ἄδικον καὶ τὸ αἰσχρὸν καὶ τὸ καλὸν καὶ ἀγαθὸν καὶ κακὸν οὕτως ἔχων ὁ ῥητορικὸς ὡς περὶ τὸ ὑγιεινὸν καὶ περὶ τὰ ἄλλα ὧν αἱ ἄλλαι τέχναι, αὐτὰ μὲν οὐκ εἰδώς, τί ἀγαθὸν ἢ τί κακὸν ἐστὶν ἢ τί καλὸν ἢ τί αἰσχρὸν ἢ δίκαιον ἢ ἄδικον, πειθῶ δὲ περὶ αὐτῶν μεμηχανημένος ὥστε δοκεῖν εἰδέναι οὐκ εἰδὼς ἐν οὐκ εἰδόσιν

μᾶλλον τοῦ εἰδότος; ἢ ἀνάγκη εἰδέναι, καὶ δεῖ προεπιστάμενον ταῦτα ἀφικέσθαι παρὰ σὲ τὸν μέλλοντα μαθήσεσθαι τὴν ῥητορικὴν; εἰ δὲ μή, σὺ ὁ τῆς ῥητορικῆς διδάσκαλος τούτων μὲν οὐδὲν διδάξεις τὸν ἀφικνούμενον—οὐ γὰρ σὸν ἔργον —ποιήσεις δ' ἐν τοῖς πολλοῖς δοκεῖν εἰδέναι αὐτὸν τὰ τοιαῦτα οὐκ εἰδότα καὶ δοκεῖν ἀγαθὸν εἶναι οὐκ ὄντα; ἢ τὸ παράπαν οὐχ οἷός τε ἔσῃ αὐτὸν διδάξαι τὴν ῥητορικὴν, ἐὰν μὴ προειδῇ περὶ τούτων τὴν ἀλήθειαν; ἢ πῶς τὰ τοιαῦτα ἔχει, ὦ Γοργία;

460a

GO: Well, I believe, Socrates, that if he happens not to know, then he will learn these matters from me too.

460a

S: Hold there! Yes, that is well expressed. If you are to make a rhetorician of someone, it is necessary for him either to know the just and the unjust beforehand, or learn these subsequently from you.

καὶ πρὸς Διός, ὥσπερ ἄρτι εἶπες, ἀποκαλύψας τῆς ῥητορικῆς εἰπὲ τίς ποθ' ἢ δύναμίς ἐστιν. ΓΟΡ. ἀλλ' ἐγὼ μὲν οἶμαι, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἐὰν τύχῃ μὴ εἰδώς, καὶ ταῦτα παρ' ἐμοῦ μαθήσεται. ΣΩ. ἔχε δὴ καλῶς γὰρ λέγεις. ἐάνπερ ῥητορικὸν σύ τινα ποιήσης, ἀνάγκη αὐτὸν εἰδέναι τὰ δίκαια καὶ τὰ ἄδικα ἥτοι πρότερόν γε ἢ ὕστερον μαθόντα παρὰ σοῦ.

460b

GO: Yes, certainly.

460b

S: What about this? Someone who has learned carpentry is a carpenter, is he not?

460b

GO: Yes.

460b

S: And is not someone who has learned music a musician?

460b

GO: Yes.

460b

S: And is someone who has learned medicine a physician? And does the same argument apply to the other subjects? Whoever learns any of them is, in each case, the sort of person that the knowledge makes him.

460b

GO: Yes, certainly.

460b

S: Therefore, according to this argument, the person who has learned justice is just?

460b

GO: Entirely, of course.

460b

S: And presumably the just man performs just actions?

460b

GO: Yes.

ΓΟΡ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. τί οὖν; ὁ τὰ τεκτονικὰ μεμαθηκὼς τεκτονικός, ἢ οὐ;
ΓΟΡ. ναί. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ ὁ τὰ μουσικὰ μουσικός; ΓΟΡ. ναί. ΣΩ. καὶ ὁ τὰ
ιατρικὰ ἱατρικός; καὶ τᾶλλα οὕτω κατὰ τὸν αὐτὸν λόγον, ὁ μεμαθηκὼς
ἕκαστα τοιοῦτός ἐστιν οἷον ἡ ἐπιστήμη ἕκαστον ἀπεργάζεται; ΓΟΡ. πάνυ
γε. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν κατὰ τοῦτον τὸν λόγον καὶ ὁ τὰ δίκαια μεμαθηκὼς
δίκαιος; ΓΟΡ. πάντως δήπου. ΣΩ. ὁ δὲ δίκαιος δίκαιά που πράττει. ΓΟΡ.
ναί.

460c

S: Therefore, it is necessary that the rhetorician be just, and that the just man wishes to perform just actions.

460c

GO: So it appears anyway.

460c

S: So, the just man will never wish to act unjustly.

460c

GO: Necessarily.

460c

S: And according to the argument it is necessary that the rhetorician be just.

460c

GO: Yes.

460c

S: So, the rhetorician will never wish to act unjustly.

460c

GO: It appears not anyway.

ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἀνάγκη τὸν ῥητορικὸν δίκαιον εἶναι, τὸν δὲ δίκαιον βούλεσθαι δίκαια πράττειν; ΓΟΡ. φαίνεται γέ. ΣΩ. οὐδέποτε ἄρα βουλήσεται ὁ γέ δίκαιος ἀδικεῖν. ΓΟΡ. ἀνάγκη. ΣΩ. τὸν δὲ ῥητορικὸν ἀνάγκη ἐκ τοῦ λόγου δίκαιον εἶναι. ΓΟΡ. ναί. ΣΩ. οὐδέποτε ἄρα βουλήσεται ὁ ῥητορικὸς ἀδικεῖν. ΓΟΡ. οὐ φαίνεται γέ. ΣΩ. μέμνησαι οὖν λέγων ὀλίγω πρότερον ὅτι οὐ δεῖ τοῖς

460d

S: Now, do you remember saying a little earlier that we should not blame the trainers or expel them from our cities if a trained boxer makes use of his boxing skill to act unjustly? And on the same basis, that if the rhetorician uses rhetoric unjustly, we should not blame the instructor or drive him out of our cities, but we should blame the one who acted unjustly and did not use rhetoric correctly? Is that what was said or is it not?

παιδοτρίβαις ἐγκαλεῖν οὐδ' ἐκβάλλειν ἐκ τῶν πόλεων, ἐὰν ὁ πύκτης τῇ πυκτικῇ χρηταί τε καὶ ἀδίκως χρηται καὶ ἀδικῇ, ὡσαύτως δὲ οὕτως καὶ ἐὰν ὁ ῥήτωρ τῇ ῥητορικῇ ἀδίκως χρηται, μὴ τῷ διδάξαντι ἐγκαλεῖν μηδ' ἐξελαύνειν ἐκ τῆς πόλεως, ἀλλὰ τῷ ἀδικοῦντι καὶ οὐκ ὀρθῶς χρωμένῳ τῇ ῥητορικῇ; ἐρρήθη ταῦτα ἢ οὐ; ΓΟΡ. ἐρρήθη. ΣΩ. νῦν

460e

GO: That's what was said.

460e

S: But now it turns out that the same person, the rhetorician, would not ever act unjustly. Is this not so?

460e

GO: Apparently.

460e

S: And in our initial discussion it was said that rhetoric was concerned with speeches, not about number, odd and even, but about the just and the unjust. Is this so?

460e

GO: Yes.

460e

S: What is more, at the time you were saying all this, I understood that rhetoric would never be an unjust activity, since the speeches it makes are always about justice. But later on, when you said that the rhetorician could also use rhetoric unjustly, I was amazed at this, and being of the view that your statements were not concordant, I made those pronouncements, that if you were of the view, as I am, that there is an advantage in being refuted, it would be worthwhile to carry on a discussion, but if not, we should bid farewell to the matter. But of late, as we continue our investigation, you see for yourself that we are in agreement once more, that the rhetorician is unable to use rhetoric unjustly or to desire to act unjustly. So, Gorgias, by the dog,¹² we shall need considerable time together to investigate precisely how matters stand here.

δέ γε ὁ αὐτὸς οὗτος φαίνεται, ὁ ῥητορικός, οὐκ ἂν ποτε ἀδικήσας. ἢ οὐ;
ΓΟΡ. φαίνεται. ΣΩ. καὶ ἐν τοῖς πρώτοις γε, ὦ Γοργία, λόγοις ἐλέγετο ὅτι
ἡ ῥητορική περὶ λόγους εἴη οὐ τοὺς τοῦ ἀρτίου καὶ περιττοῦ, ἀλλὰ τοὺς
τοῦ δικαίου καὶ ἀδίκου· ἢ γάρ; ΓΟΡ. ναί. ΣΩ. ἐγὼ τοίνυν σου τότε ταῦτα
λέγοντος ὑπέλαβον ὡς οὐδέποτε ἂν εἴη ἡ ῥητορική ἄδικον πράγμα, ὃ γ'
ἀεὶ περὶ δικαιοσύνης τοὺς λόγους ποιεῖται· ἐπειδὴ δὲ ὀλίγον ὕστερον
ἔλεγες ὅτι ὁ ῥήτωρ τῇ ῥητορικῇ καὶ ἀδίκως χρῶτο, οὕτω θαυμάσας καὶ
ἡγησάμενος οὐ συνᾶδεν τὰ λεγόμενα ἐκείνους εἶπον τοὺς λόγους, ὅτι
εἰ μὲν κέρδος ἡγοῖο εἶναι τὸ ἐλέγχεσθαι ὥσπερ ἐγώ, ἄξιον εἴη
διαλέγεσθαι, εἰ δὲ μή, ἔαν χαίρειν. ὕστερον δὲ ἡμῶν ἐπισκοπούμενων
ὁρᾷς δὴ καὶ αὐτὸς ὅτι αὐτὸ ὁμολογεῖται τὸν ῥητορικὸν ἀδύνατον εἶναι

ἀδίκως χρῆσθαι τῇ ῥητορικῇ καὶ ἐθέλειν ἀδικεῖν. ταῦτα οὖν ὅπῃ ποτὲ ἔχει, μὰ τὸν

461b

PO: What's this, Socrates? Do you really believe what you are now saying about rhetoric? Or do you imagine that because Gorgias was ashamed not to agree with you about the man who studies rhetoric knowing the just and noble and good, and even if he were to frequent Gorgias without knowing these, he would teach him. Perhaps it was from this concession that a contradiction then showed up in his propositions, something that delights you as you draw people into questions of this sort. Yes, do you believe that anyone would totally deny that he himself knew about justice and would teach this to others? No, it is very crude of you to lead the discussions in such directions.

κύνα, ὦ Γοργία, οὐκ ὀλίγης συνουσίας ἐστὶν ὥστε ἱκανῶς διασκέψασθαι. ΠΩΛ. τί δέ, ὦ Σώκρατες; οὕτω καὶ σὺ περὶ τῆς ῥητορικῆς δοξάζεις ὥσπερ νῦν λέγεις; ἢ οἶε—ὅτι Γοργίας ἡσχύνθη σοι μὴ προσομολογῆσαι τὸν ῥητορικὸν ἄνδρα μὴ οὐχὶ καὶ τὰ δίκαια εἰδέναι καὶ τὰ καλὰ καὶ τὰ ἀγαθὰ, καὶ ἐὰν μὴ ἔλθῃ ταῦτα εἰδὼς παρ' αὐτόν, αὐτὸς διδάξειν, ἔπειτα ἐκ ταύτης ἴσως τῆς ὁμολογίας ἐναντίον τι συνέβῃ ἐν τοῖς

461c

S: Please, most noble Polus, this surely is why we acquire companions and sons, so that when we ourselves get older and stumble, you younger men are there to put our lives right once more, both in word and in deed. And now, if Gorgias and I have made some stumble in our discussions, here you are to put us right. It is your duty, and if it seems to you that anything that has been agreed has not been agreed fairly, then I am willing to retract whatever you wish, if you would just watch out for one thing for my sake.

λόγοις—τοῦτο ὃ δὴ ἀγαπᾷς, αὐτὸς ἀγαγὼν ἐπὶ τοιαῦτα ἐρωτήματα—ἐπεὶ τίνα οἶε ἀπαρνήσεσθαι μὴ οὐχὶ καὶ αὐτόν ἐπίστασθαι τὰ δίκαια

καὶ ἄλλους διδάξειν; —ἀλλ' εἰς τὰ τοιαῦτα ἄγειν πολλή ἀγροικία ἐστὶν τοὺς λόγους. ΣΩ. ὦ κάλλιστε Πῶλε, ἀλλά τοι ἐξεπίτηδες κτώμεθα ἐταίρους καὶ ὑεῖς, ἵνα ἐπειδὴν αὐτοὶ πρεσβύτεροι γενόμενοι σφαλλώμεθα, παρόντες ὑμεῖς οἱ νεώτεροι ἐπανορθῶτε ἡμῶν τὸν βίον καὶ ἐν ἔργοις καὶ ἐν λόγοις, καὶ νῦν εἴ τι ἐγὼ καὶ

461d

PO: What are you referring to?

461d

S: That you restrain the lengthy manner of speaking that you tried to use earlier, Polus.

461d

PO: What's this? Shall I not be allowed to say just as much as I want to?

461d

S: Best of men, you would surely be in an outrageous predicament if, having arrived in Athens, where there is more freedom of speech than anywhere else in Greece, you were the only person there who did not attain it. But look at it the other way. If you speak at length and are not willing to answer what you are asked, would not my predicament be even more outrageous if I was not allowed to leave and stop listening to you? Rather, if anything in the discussion that has just taken place bothers you and you wish to put it right, then, as I said just now, retract whatever you wish, take your turn in questioning and being questioned, just like myself and Gorgias, and practise refuting and being refuted. Now, I presume you also claim to know the same things as Gorgias. Is this so?

Γοργίας ἐν τοῖς λόγοις σφαλλόμεθα, σὺ παρὼν ἐπανόρθου— δίκαιος δ' εἶ—καὶ ἐγὼ ἐθέλω τῶν ὁμολογημένων εἴ τί σοι δοκεῖ μὴ καλῶς ὁμολογῆσθαι, ἀναθέσθαι ὅτι ἂν σὺ βούλῃ, ἐάν μοι ἔν μόνον φυλάττης. ΠΩΛ. τί τοῦτο λέγεις; ΣΩ. τὴν μακρολογίαν, ὦ Πῶλε, ἣν καθέρξης, ἥ τὸ πρῶτον ἐπεχείρησας χρῆσθαι. ΠΩΛ. τί δέ; οὐκ ἐξέσται μοι λέγειν ὅποσα ἂν βούλωμαι;

461e

PO: I do indeed.

461e

S: In that case, do you also frequently call upon people to ask you any question they want, on the basis that you are knowledgeable in answering?

ΣΩ. δεινὰ μεντὰν πάθοις, ὧ βέλτιστε, εἰ Ἀθήναζε ἀφικόμενος, οὗ τῆς Ἑλλάδος πλείστη ἐστὶν ἐξουσία τοῦ λέγειν, ἔπειτα σὺ ἐνταῦθα τούτου μόνος ἀτυχήσῃς. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ ἀντίθεος τοι· σοῦ μακρὰ λέγοντος καὶ μὴ ἐθέλοντος τὸ ἐρωτώμενον ἀποκρίνεσθαι, οὐ δεινὰ ἂν αὖ ἐγὼ πάθοιμι, εἰ μὴ ἐξέσται

462a

PO: Yes, certainly.

μοι ἀπιέναι καὶ μὴ ἀκούειν σου; ἀλλ' εἴ τι κήδη τοῦ λόγου τοῦ εἰρημένου καὶ ἐπανορθώσασθαι αὐτὸν βούλει, ὥσπερ νυνδὴ ἔλεγον, ἀναθέμενος ὅτι σοι δοκεῖ, ἐν τῷ μέρει ἐρωτῶν τε καὶ ἐρωτώμενος, ὥσπερ ἐγὼ τε καὶ Γοργίας, ἔλεγχέ τε καὶ ἐλέγχου. φῆς γὰρ δήπου καὶ σὺ ἐπίστασθαι ἅπερ Γοργίας ἢ οὐ; ΠΩΛ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ σὺ κελεύεις σαυτὸν ἐρωτᾶν ἐκάστοτε ὅτι ἂν τις βούληται, ὥς ἐπιστάμενος ἀποκρίνεσθαι; ΠΩΛ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν.

462b

S: So, you should now do whichever of these you prefer, ask or answer.

462b

PO: That's what I'll do then, and you should answer me, Socrates. Since Gorgias seems to you to be in perplexity in relation to rhetoric, what do you say that it is?

462b

S: Are you asking me what kind of skill I say that it is?

462b

PO: I am.

462b

S: Since I should speak the truth to you, Polus, it seems to me anyway that it is not a skill at all.

462b

PO: Then what do you think rhetoric is?

ΣΩ. καὶ νῦν δὴ τούτων ὁπότερον βούλει ποίει, ἐρώτα ἢ ἀποκρίνου. ΠΩΛ. ἀλλὰ ποιήσω ταῦτα. καὶ μοι ἀπόκριται, ὃ Σώκρατες· ἐπειδὴ Γοργίας ἀπορεῖν σοι δοκεῖ περὶ τῆς ῥητορικῆς, σὺ αὐτὴν τίνα φῆς εἶναι; ΣΩ. ἄρα ἐρωτᾷς ἥντινα τέχνην φημὶ εἶναι; ΠΩΛ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. οὐδεμία ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ, ὃ Πῶλε, ὥς γε πρὸς σὲ ἀληθῆ εἰρησθαι. ΠΩΛ. ἀλλὰ τί σοι δοκεῖ ἡ ῥητορικὴ εἶναι; ΣΩ. πρᾶγμα ὃ φῆς σὺ ποιῆσαι τέχνην ἐν τῷ συγγράμματι

462c

S: An activity which you claim to have made into a skill in your treatise, which I have recently read.

462c

PO: What activity do you mean?

462c

S: I mean a practice.

462c

PO: So, does rhetoric seem to you to be a practice?

462c

S: To me it does, unless you can suggest an alternative.

462c

PO: Practice of what?

462c

S: A practice of bringing about some gratification and pleasure.

462c

PO: Don't you think rhetoric is noble since it is able to gratify people?

ὃ ἐγὼ ἔναγχος ἀνέγνω. ΠΩΛ. τί τοῦτο λέγεις; ΣΩ. ἐμπειρίαν ἔγωγε τίνα. ΠΩΛ. ἐμπειρία ἄρα σοι δοκεῖ ἡ ῥητορικὴ εἶναι; ΣΩ. ἔμοιγε, εἰ μὴ τι σὺ ἄλλο λέγεις. ΠΩΛ. τίνος ἐμπειρία; ΣΩ. χάριτός τινος καὶ ἡδονῆς

ἀπεργασίας, ΠΩΛ. οὐκοῦν καλόν σοι δοκεῖ ἡ ῥητορικὴ εἶναι, χαρίζεσθαι οἷόν τε εἶναι ἀνθρώποις; ΣΩ. τί δέ, ὦ Πῶλε; ἤδη πέπυσαι παρ' ἐμοῦ ὅτι φημὶ

462d

S: What is this, Polus? Have you already found out from me what I assert that rhetoric is? Is that why you are asking the subsequent question about whether I think it is noble?

462d

PO: Well, didn't I find out that you say it is a practice?

462d

S: Well, since you have such respect for gratification, are you prepared to gratify me, just a little?

462d

PO: I am indeed.

462d

S: Ask me now what skill I think cookery is.

462d

PO: I am asking you then. What skill is cookery?

462d

S: It is not a skill, Polus.

462d

PO: I am saying so.

462d

S: It is a practice.

462d

PO: I am saying so.

αὐτὴν εἶναι, ὥστε τὸ μετὰ τοῦτο ἐρωτᾷς εἰ οὐ καλὴ μοι δοκεῖ εἶναι; ΠΩΛ. οὐ γὰρ πέπυσμαι ὅτι ἐμπειρίαν τινὰ αὐτὴν φῆς εἶναι; ΣΩ. βούλει οὖν, ἐπειδὴ τιμᾷς τὸ χαρίζεσθαι, σμικρόν τί μοι χαρίσασθαι; ΠΩΛ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. ἐροῦ νῦν με, ὁψοποιία ἥτις μοι δοκεῖ τέχνη εἶναι. ΠΩΛ. ἐρωτῶ δὴ, τίς τέχνη ὁψοποιία; ΣΩ. οὐδεμία, ὦ Πῶλε. ΠΩΛ. ἀλλὰ τί;

φάθι. ΣΩ. φημὶ δὴ, ἐμπειρία τις. ΠΩΛ. τίς; φάθι. ΣΩ. φημὶ δὴ, χάριτος καὶ ἡδονῆς

462e

S: Of bringing about gratification and pleasure, Polus.

462e

PO: So, is cookery the same thing as rhetoric?

462e

S: Not at all, but it is a part of the same pursuit.

462e

PO: What pursuit do you mean?

462e

S: It may sound somewhat crude if I speak the truth. Indeed, I am reluctant to speak on Gorgias' account in case he thinks I am mocking his own pursuit. Now, what I call rhetoric is part of an activity that is not the fairest of activities, but I do not know if this is the rhetoric that Gorgias engages in, for earlier on nothing clear emerged from our discussion as to what precisely this man believes.

ἀπεργασίας, ὃ Πῶλε. ΠΩΛ. ταῦτόν ἄρ' ἐστὶν ὀψοποιία καὶ ῥητορικὴ; ΣΩ. οὐδαμῶς γε, ἀλλὰ τῆς αὐτῆς μὲν ἐπιτηδεύσεως μῦριον. ΠΩΛ. τίνας λέγεις ταύτης; ΣΩ. μὴ ἀγροικότερον ἢ τὸ ἀληθές εἶπεῖν· ὁκνῶ γὰρ Γοργίου ἔνεκα λέγειν, μὴ οἴηταί με διακωμῶδεῖν τὸ ἑαυτοῦ ἐπιτήδευμα. ἐγὼ δέ, εἰ μὲν τοῦτό ἐστιν ἡ ῥητορικὴ ἣν Γοργίας

463a

GO: Say what it is, Socrates. Don't be ashamed on my account.

463a

S: Well then, it seems to me, Gorgias, to be a pursuit devoid of skill, and yet it belongs to an intuitive soul that is also courageous and naturally clever in dealing with humanity. And, in summary, I call this flattery. Now, I do think that there are many other parts of this pursuit, but one of them is indeed cookery, which actually seems to be a skill but, according to my account, it is not a skill, but practice and habit. I also refer to rhetoric as part of this, as are beautification and

sophistry – four parts associated with four activities. Now, if Polus wishes to enquire, he should enquire, although he has not yet enquired as to what sort of part of flattery I assert that rhetoric is. No, he has not noticed that I have not yet answered that question, so he proceeds to ask if I regard it as noble. But I shall not answer him as to whether I regard rhetoric as noble or base until I have first answered what it is. No, that would not be right, Polus. But if you really do wish to engage in enquiry ask me what sort of part of flattery I say that rhetoric is.

ἐπιτηδεύει, οὐκ οἶδα—καὶ γὰρ ἄρτι ἐκ τοῦ λόγου οὐδὲν ἡμῖν καταφανὲς ἐγένετο τί ποτε οὗτος ἡγεῖται—ὃ δ' ἐγὼ καλῶ τὴν ῥητορικὴν, πράγματός τινός ἐστι μόνιον οὐδενὸς τῶν καλῶν. ΓΟΡ. τίνας, ὦ Σώκρατες; εἰπέ· μηδὲν ἐμὲ αἰσχυνθῆς. ΣΩ. δοκεῖ τοίνυν μοι, ὦ Γοργία, εἶναι τι ἐπιτήδευμα τεχνικὸν μὲν οὐ, ψυχῆς δὲ στοχαστικῆς καὶ ἀνδρείας καὶ φύσει δεινῆς προσομιλεῖν τοῖς ἀνθρώποις· καλῶ δὲ αὐτοῦ ἐγὼ τὸ κεφάλαιον κολακείαν. ταύτης μοι δοκεῖ τῆς ἐπιτηδεύσεως πολλὰ μὲν καὶ ἄλλα μόνια εἶναι, ἔν δὲ καὶ ἡ ὁψοποιική· ὃ δοκεῖ μὲν εἶναι τέχνη, ὥς δὲ ὁ ἐμὸς λόγος, οὐκ ἔστιν τέχνη ἀλλ' ἐμπειρία καὶ τριβή. ταύτης μόνιον καὶ τὴν ῥητορικὴν ἐγὼ καλῶ καὶ τὴν γε κομμητικὴν καὶ τὴν σοφιστικὴν, τέτταρα ταῦτα μόνια ἐπὶ τέτταρσιν πράγμασιν. εἰ οὖν βούλεται πῶλος πυνθάνεσθαι, πυνθανέσθω· οὐ γάρ πω πέπυσται ὁποῖόν φημι ἐγὼ τῆς κολακείας μόνιον εἶναι τὴν ῥητορικὴν, ἀλλ' αὐτὸν λέληθα οὐπω ἀποκεκριμένος, ὃ δὲ ἐπανερωτᾷ εἰ οὐ καλὸν ἡγοῦμαι εἶναι. ἐγὼ δὲ αὐτῷ οὐκ ἀποκρινοῦμαι πρότερον εἴτε καλὸν εἴτε αἰσχυρὸν ἡγοῦμαι εἶναι τὴν ῥητορικὴν πρὶν ἂν πρῶτον ἀποκρίνωμαι ὅτι ἐστίν. οὐ γὰρ δίκαιον, ὦ Πῶλε· ἀλλ' εἴπερ βούλει πυθέσθαι, ἐρώτα ὁποῖον μόνιον τῆς κολακείας φημι εἶναι τὴν ῥητορικὴν. ΠΩΛ. ἐρωτῶ δὴ, καὶ ἀπόκριναι ὁποῖον μόνιον.

463d

PO: That's my question, then. So tell me what sort of part it is.

463d

S: Now, will you understand my answer? Rhetoric, according to my account, is an image of part of politics.

463d

PO: What else? Are you saying that it is noble or base?

463d

S: Base, in my view anyway, for I refer to what is bad as base, since I must respond to you as if you have already understood what I mean.

463d

GO: By Zeus, Socrates, I don't understand what you mean either.

ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν ἂν μάθοις ἀποκριναμένου; ἔστιν γὰρ ἡ ῥητορική κατὰ τὸν ἐμὸν λόγον πολιτικῆς μορίου εἶδωλον. ΠΩΛ. τί οὖν; καλὸν ἢ αἰσχροὺν λέγεις αὐτὴν εἶναι; ΣΩ. αἰσχροὺν ἔγωγε—τὰ γὰρ κακὰ αἰσχροὺς καλῶ—ἐπειδὴ δεῖ σοι ἀποκρίνασθαι ὡς ἤδη εἰδότει ἃ ἐγὼ λέγω. ΓΟΡ. μὰ τὸν Δία, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἀλλ' ἐγὼ οὐδὲ αὐτὸς συνίημι ὅτι λέγεις.

463e

S: Gorgias, it is quite likely that I am not making my meaning clear, but Polus here is young and impetuous.

463e

GO: Just leave him be and tell me what you mean by saying that rhetoric is an image of part of politics.

463e

S: Then I shall try to state what rhetoric appears – to me anyway – to be. And if it happens not to be what I say it is, Polus here will refute me. I presume there is something you call body and something you call soul?

463e

GO: How could there not be?

ΣΩ. εἰκότως γε, ὦ Γοργία· οὐδὲν γάρ πω σαφὲς λέγω, πῶλος δὲ ὅδε νέος ἐστὶ καὶ ὀξύς. ΓΟΡ. ἀλλὰ τοῦτον μὲν ἔα, ἐμοὶ δ' εἰπὲ πῶς λέγεις πολιτικῆς μορίου εἶδωλον εἶναι τὴν ῥητορικήν. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' ἐγὼ πειράσομαι φράσαι ὅ γέ μοι φαίνεται εἶναι ἡ ῥητορική· εἰ δὲ μὴ τυγχάνει ὃν τοῦτο, πῶλος ὅδε

464a

S: In that case, do you also think that there is some good condition of each of these?

464a

GO: I do indeed.

464a

S: What about this? Can they seem to be in good condition when they are not? I am referring to a situation such as the following. Many people seem to have their bodies in good condition, and it is not easy for anyone to discern that they are not in good condition, but the physician and any physical trainer can do so.

464a

GO: What you say is true.

464a

S: I am referring to the sort of thing, present in body and in soul, which makes body and soul seem to be in good condition, when, in fact, they possess no more than that seeming.

464a

GO: There are such things.

ἐλέγξει. σῶμά που καλεῖς τι καὶ ψυχὴν; ΓΟΡ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ τούτων οἶει τινὰ εἶναι ἐκατέρου εὐεξίαν; ΓΟΡ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. τί δέ; δοκοῦσαν μὲν εὐεξίαν, οὔσαν δ' οὐ; οἷον τοιόνδε λέγω πολλοὶ δοκοῦσιν εὖ ἔχειν τὰ σώματα, οὓς οὐκ ἂν ῥαδίως αἰσθοιτό τις ὅτι οὐκ εὖ ἔχουσιν, ἀλλ' ἢ ἰατρός τε καὶ τῶν γυμναστικῶν τις. ΓΟΡ. ἀληθῆ λέγεις. ΣΩ. τὸ τοιοῦτον λέγω καὶ ἐν σώματι εἶναι καὶ ἐν ψυχῇ, ὃ ποιεῖ μὲν δοκεῖν εὖ ἔχειν τὸ σῶμα καὶ τὴν ψυχὴν,

464b

S: Come on now, and if I can I will give you a clearer demonstration of what I mean. Since there are two activities, I am saying there are two skills. One is directed to the soul and I call it politics, but the single skill directed to the body I cannot name for you off-hand. Yet, I am saying that care of the body is one, though it has two parts – gymnastic and medicine. And in the field of politics, the legislative

part corresponds to gymnastic, while justice is the counterpart of medicine. Now, each of these does indeed have something in common, one with the other – medicine with gymnastic, and justice with law-making – inasmuch as they are associated with the same thing, and yet they are somewhat different from one another. So, there are these four, and they always aim for the best in caring for what belongs to the body, on the one hand, and what belongs to the soul, on the other. Now, flattery notices this. I do not mean that she knows, but she guesses. She divides herself into four, adopts the guise of each of the four, and pretends to be the one whose guise she adopts. Then, devoid of any understanding of what is best, she uses the pleasure of the moment to hunt instead for folly, and she practises deception so as to seem to be of the utmost value. So cookery, having adopted the guise of medicine, also pretends to know what foods are best for the body so that if the cook and the physician had to contest the matter before children, or before men who were just as silly as children, as to whether the physician or the cook had more expertise about wholesome or harmful foods, the physician would die of starvation. Now, this is what I call flattery, and I say that something of this sort is base because it guesses at pleasure regardless of what is best, Polus, and that is my reply to you. But I say that it is not a skill, but a practice, because it does not possess any rational account of the nature of what it applies to, or of what those things are applied to, so that it is unable to express the cause of each. And I do not call an activity devoid of an account a skill. Yet, if you wish to contest these assertions, I am prepared to defend the argument.

Now, cookery is the flattery that hides behind medicine, while in the very same way beautification hides behind gymnastic, and in this sense it is a bad influence, deceptive, ignoble and slavish. It practises deception through shaping, colouring, smoothing and dressing-up in such a way as to make an alien beauty intrude, to the neglect of the native beauty brought about by means of gymnastic. Now, to avoid

being long-winded, I wish to talk to you as the geometers do, for at this stage you are probably following me. What beautification is to gymnastic, so is cookery to medicine; and, more to the point, what beautification is to gymnastic so is sophistry to law-making; and what cookery is to medicine so is rhetoric to justice. Well, as I say, on this basis they are distinct by nature, yet insofar as they are closely related, sophists and rhetoricians become confounded into sameness,¹³ concerned also with the same issues, and they themselves do not know how to make use of themselves, nor does the rest of humanity know how to use them. And, indeed, if the soul did not rule over the body but the body ruled over itself, and cookery and medicine were not contemplated by means of soul and distinguished from one another, but the body itself were to decide using its own delectation as the measure, the sameness of Anaxagoras would take over, my dear Polus. Indeed, you are familiar with his sayings. Everything would be confounded into sameness, and medicine, health and cookery would be indistinguishable.

So, now you have heard what I say that rhetoric is: the counterpart in the soul of cookery, doing in the soul what cookery does in the body. And yet, I have surely done something unusual, because, whilst not allowing you to deliver lengthy speeches, I myself have delivered an extremely protracted one. However, I do deserve forgiveness, for when I spoke briefly you did not understand, nor were you able to make use of the answer I gave you; rather, you required further elaboration. And, indeed, if I am unable to make use of your answers when you respond to me, you should protract your speech too, but if I can use them, allow me to use them. That is only fair. And now, if you are able to make any use of this answer, use it.

ἔχει δὲ οὐδὲν μᾶλλον. ΓΟΡ. ἔστι ταῦτα. ΣΩ. φέρει δὴ σοι, ἐὰν δύνωμαι, σαφέστερον ἐπιδείξω ὃ λέγω. δυοῖν ὄντοιν τοῖν πραγμάτοιιν δύο λέγω τέχνας· τὴν μὲν ἐπὶ τῇ ψυχῇ πολιτικὴν καλῶ, τὴν δὲ ἐπὶ σώματι μίαν μὲν οὕτως ὀνομάσαι οὐκ ἔχω σοι, μιᾶς δὲ οὕσης τῆς τοῦ σώματος

θεραπείας δύο μόρια λέγω, τὴν μὲν γυμναστικήν, τὴν δὲ ἰατρικήν· τῆς δὲ πολιτικῆς ἀντὶ μὲν τῆς γυμναστικῆς τὴν νομοθετικήν, ἀντίστροφον δὲ τῇ ἰατρικῇ τὴν δικαιοσύνην. ἐπικοινωνοῦσι μὲν δὴ ἀλλήλαις, ἅτε περὶ τὸ αὐτὸ οὔσαι, ἐκάτεραι τούτων, ἢ τε ἰατρικὴ τῇ γυμναστικῇ καὶ ἡ δικαιοσύνη τῇ νομοθετικῇ· ὅμως δὲ διαφέρουσιν τι ἀλλήλων. τεττάρων δὴ τούτων οὓων, καὶ αἰεὶ πρὸς τὸ βέλτιστον θεραπευουσῶν τῶν μὲν τὸ σῶμα, τῶν δὲ τὴν ψυχὴν, ἡ κολακευτικὴ αἰσθομένη—οὐ γνοῦσα λέγω ἀλλὰ στοχασαμένη—τέτραχα· ἑαυτὴν διανείμασα, ὑποδῶσα ὑπὸ ἕκαστον τῶν μορίων, προσποιεῖται εἶναι τοῦτο ὅπερ ὑπέδω, καὶ τοῦ μὲν βελτίστου οὐδὲν φροντίζει, τῷ δὲ αἰεὶ ἡδίστῳ θηρεύεται τὴν ἄνοιαν καὶ ἐξαπατᾷ, ὥστε δοκεῖ πλείστου ἀξία εἶναι. ὑπὸ μὲν οὖν τὴν ἰατρικήν ἡ ὀψοποικὴ ὑποδέδυκεν, καὶ προσποιεῖται τὰ βέλτιστα σιτία τῷ σώματι εἰδέναι, ὥστ' εἰ δέοι ἐν παισὶ διαγωνίζεσθαι ὀψοποιόν τε καὶ ἱατρόν, ἢ ἐν ἀνδράσιν οὕτως ἀνοήτοις ὥσπερ οἱ παῖδες, πότερος ἐπαῖτει περὶ τῶν χρηστῶν σιτίων καὶ πονηρῶν, ὁ ἱατρὸς ἢ ὁ ὀψοποιός, λιμῷ ἂν ἀποθανεῖν τὸν ἱατρόν. ΣΩ. κολακεῖαν μὲν οὖν αὐτὸ καλῶ, καὶ αἰσχρόν φημι εἶναι τὸ τοιοῦτον, ὧ Πῶλε—τοῦτο γὰρ πρὸς σέ λέγω—ὅτι τοῦ ἡδέος στοχάζεται ἄνευ τοῦ βελτίστου· τέχνην δὲ αὐτὴν οὐ φημι εἶναι ἀλλ' ἐμπειρίαν, ὅτι οὐκ ἔχει λόγον οὐδένα ὃ προσφέρει ἢ προσφέρει ὅποι' ἄττα τὴν φύσιν ἐστίν, ὥστε τὴν αἰτίαν ἐκάστου μὴ ἔχειν εἰπεῖν. ἐγὼ δὲ τέχνην οὐ καλῶ ὃ ἂν ἢ ἄλογον πρᾶγμα· τούτων δὲ πέρι εἰ ἀμφισβητεῖς, ἐθέλω ὑποσχεῖν λόγον. τῇ μὲν οὖν ἰατρικῇ, ὥσπερ λέγω, ἡ ὀψοποικὴ κολακεῖα ὑπόκειται· τῇ δὲ γυμναστικῇ κατὰ τὸν αὐτὸν τρόπον τοῦτον ἡ κομμωτικὴ, κακοῦργός τε καὶ ἀπατηλὴ καὶ ἀγεννὴς καὶ ἀνελεύθερος, σχήμασιν καὶ χρώμασιν καὶ λειότητι καὶ ἐσθῆσιν ἀπατῶσα, ὥστε ποιεῖν ἀλλότριον κάλλος ἐφελκομένους τοῦ οἰκείου τοῦ διὰ τῆς γυμναστικῆς ἀμελεῖν. ἴν' οὖν μὴ μακρολογῶ, ἐθέλω σοι εἰπεῖν ὥσπερ οἱ γεωμέτραι—ἤδη γὰρ ἂν ἴσως ἀκολουθήσαιοις—ὅτι ὁ κομμωτικὴ πρὸς γυμναστικήν, τοῦτο σοφιστικὴ πρὸς νομοθετικήν, καὶ ὅτι ὁ ὀψοποικὴ πρὸς ἰατρικήν, τοῦτο ῥητορικὴ πρὸς δικαιοσύνην. ὅπερ μέντοι λέγω, διέστηκε μὲν οὕτω φύσει, ἅτε δ' ἐγγὺς ὄντων φύρονται ἐν τῷ αὐτῷ καὶ περὶ ταῦτα σοφιστὰι καὶ ῥήτορες, καὶ οὐκ ἔχουσιν ὅτι χρήσονται οὔτε αὐτοὶ

ἑαυτοῖς οὔτε οἱ ἄλλοι ἄνθρωποι τούτοις, καὶ γὰρ ἄν, εἰ μὴ ἡ ψυχὴ τῷ σώματι ἐπεστάται, ἀλλ' αὐτὸ αὐτῷ, καὶ μὴ ὑπὸ ταύτης κατεθεωρεῖτο καὶ διεκρίνετο ἢ τε ὀψοποιικὴ καὶ ἡ ἱατρικὴ, ἀλλ' αὐτὸ τὸ σῶμα ἔκρινε σταθμώμενον ταῖς χάρισι ταῖς πρὸς αὐτό, τὸ τοῦ Ἀναξαγόρου ἂν πολὺ ἦν, ὦ φίλε Πῶλε—σὺ γὰρ τούτων ἔμπειρος—ὁμοῦ ἂν πάντα χρήματα ἐφύρετο ἐν τῷ αὐτῷ, ἀκρίτων ὄντων τῶν τε ἱατρικῶν καὶ ὑγιεινῶν καὶ ὀψοποιικῶν. ὃ μὲν οὖν ἐγὼ φημι τὴν ῥητορικὴν εἶναι, ἀκήκοας ἀντίστροφον ὀψοποιίας ἐν ψυχῇ, ὡς ἐκεῖνο ἐν σώματι. ἴσως μὲν οὖν ἄτοπον πεποίηκα, ὅτι σε οὐκ ἔων μακροὺς λόγους λέγειν αὐτὸς συχνὸν λόγον ἀποτέτακα. ἄξιον μὲν οὖν ἐμοὶ συγγνώμην ἔχειν ἐστίν· λέγοντος γάρ μου βραχέα οὐκ ἐμάνθανες, οὐδὲ χρῆσθαι τῇ ἀποκρίσει ἦν σοι ἀπεκρινάμην οὐδὲν οἷός τ' ἦσθα, ἀλλ' ἐδέου διηγέσεως. ΣΩ. ἐὰν μὲν οὖν καὶ

466a

PO: What's your point then? Do you think that rhetoric is flattery?

466a

S: I said, in fact, that it is part of flattery. Can you not remember at your age, Polus? What will happen to you in later life?

466a

PO: And do the good rhetoricians seem to you to be held in low regard in the cities because they are flatterers?

ἐγὼ σοῦ ἀποκρινομένου μὴ ἔχω ὅτι χρήσωμαι, ἀπότεινε καὶ σὺ λόγον, ἐὰν δὲ ἔχω, ἔα με χρῆσθαι· δίκαιον γάρ. καὶ νῦν ταύτη τῇ ἀποκρίσει εἴ τι ἔχεις χρῆσθαι, χρῶ. ΠΩΛ. τί οὖν φῆς; κολακεία δοκεῖ σοι εἶναι ἡ ῥητορικὴ; ΣΩ. κολακείας μὲν οὖν ἔγωγε εἶπον μόριον. ἀλλ' οὐ μνημονεύεις τηλικούτος ὢν, ὦ Πῶλε; τί τάχα δράσεις; ΠΩΛ. ἄρ' οὖν δοκοῦσί σοι ὡς κόλακες ἐν ταῖς πόλεσι φαῦλοι νομίζεσθαι οἱ ἀγαθοὶ ῥήτορες;

466b

S: Is this a question, or are you starting to deliver a speech?

466b

PO: I am just asking.

466b

S: In my view, anyway, they are not regarded at all.

466b

PO: How could they not be regarded? Don't they exercise enormous power in our cities?

466b

S: Not if you mean that the exercise of power is something good for the powerful person.

466b

PO: But of course I mean that.

466b

S: Then it seems to me that the rhetoricians exercise less power than anyone else in the city.

ΣΩ. ἐρώτημα τοῦτ' ἐρωτᾷς ἢ λόγου τινὸς ἀρχὴν λέγεις; ΠΩΛ. ἐρωτῶ ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. οὐδὲ νομίζεσθαι ἔμοιγε δοκοῦσιν. ΠΩΛ. πῶς οὐ νομίζεσθαι; οὐ μέγιστον δύνανται ἐν ταῖς πόλεσιν; ΣΩ. οὐκ, εἰ τὸ δύνασθαι γε λέγεις ἀγαθόν τι εἶναι τῷ δυναμένῳ. ΠΩΛ. ἀλλὰ μὴν λέγω γε. ΣΩ. ἐλάχιστον τοίνυν μοι δοκοῦσι τῶν ἐν τῇ πόλει δύνασθαι οἱ ῥήτορες. ΠΩΛ. τί δέ; οὐχ, ὥσπερ οἱ τύραννοι, ἀποκτείνουσιν τε

466c

PO: But why? Aren't they just like tyrants? Don't they kill anyone they wish, confiscate property, and expel from the cities whoever seems to them to deserve it?

466c

S: By the dog, Polus, I am in two minds on each of the points you are making. Do you yourself mean this, and are you expressing your own opinion or are you asking me a question?

ὃν ἂν βούλωνται, καὶ ἀφαιροῦνται χρήματα καὶ ἐκβάλλουσιν ἐκ τῶν πόλεων ὃν ἂν δοκῇ αὐτοῖς; ΣΩ. νῆ τὸν κύνα, ἀμφιγνοῶ μέντοι, ὧ Πῶλε, ἐφ' ἐκάστου ὧν λέγεις πότερον αὐτὸς ταῦτα λέγεις καὶ γνώμην σαυτοῦ ἀποφαίνῃ, ἢ ἐμὲ ἐρωτᾷς. ΠΩΛ. ἀλλ' ἔγωγε σὲ ἐρωτῶ. ΣΩ. εἶεν,

ὦ φίλε· ἔπειτα δύο ἅμα με ἐρωτᾷς; ΠΩΛ. πῶς δύο; ΣΩ. οὐκ ἄρτι οὕτω πῶς ἔλεγες· ἢ οὐχὶ ἀποκτεινύασιν

466d

PO: Yes, I am asking you a question.

466d

S: So be it, my friend. In that case, are you asking me two questions at once?

466d

PO: In what way are there two?

466d

S: Did you not just say something of this sort: “Can’t the rhetoricians kill anyone they wish, just like tyrants, confiscate property, and expel from the cities whoever seems to them to deserve it?”

466d

PO: I did, indeed.

466d

S: Then, I am saying that there are two questions here, and I shall give you an answer in relation to both. Indeed, I assert, Polus, that both the rhetoricians and the tyrants exercise the least power in the cities, as I said a moment ago. For, in a sense, they do nothing they wish. Instead, they do whatever seems to them to be best.

οἱ ῥήτορες οὓς ἂν βούλωνται, ὥσπερ οἱ τύραννοι, καὶ χρήματα ἀφαιροῦνται καὶ ἐξελαύνουσιν ἐκ τῶν πόλεων ὃν ἂν δοκῇ αὐτοῖς; ΠΩΛ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. λέγω τοίνυν σοι ὅτι δύο ταῦτ’ ἐστὶν τὰ ἐρωτήματα, καὶ ἀποκρινοῦμαί γέ σοι πρὸς ἀμφοτέρω. φημί γάρ, ὦ Πῶλε, ἐγὼ καὶ τοὺς ῥήτορας καὶ τοὺς τυράννους δύνασθαι μὲν ἐν ταῖς πόλεσιν σμικρότατον, ὥσπερ νυνδὴ ἔλεγον· οὐδὲν

466e

PO: Isn’t that the exercise of enormous power?

466e

S: Not according to Polus anyway.

466e

PO: Am I denying this? No, I am asserting this.

466e

S: By the... No, you are not, since you assert that the exercise of enormous power is a good to the powerful person.

466e

PO: Yes, that's what I assert.

466e

S: Well, do you think it is good if someone who does not possess intelligence does whatever seems to him to be the best? And do you refer to this as the exercise of enormous power?

466e

PO: I do not.

γὰρ ποιεῖν ὧν βούλονται ὡς ἔπος εἰπεῖν, ποιεῖν μέντοι ὅτι ἂν αὐτοῖς
δόξη βέλτιστον εἶναι. ΠΩΛ. οὐκοῦν τοῦτο ἔστιν τὸ μέγα δύνασθαι; ΣΩ.
οὐχ, ὡς γέ φησιν πῶλος. ΠΩΛ. ἐγὼ οὐ φημι; φημι μὲν οὖν ἔγωγε. ΣΩ.
μὰ τὸν—οὐ σύ γε, ἐπεὶ τὸ μέγα δύνασθαι ἔφης ἀγαθὸν εἶναι τῷ
δυναμένῳ. ΠΩΛ. φημι γὰρ οὖν. ΣΩ. ἀγαθὸν οὖν οἶε εἶναι, ἐάν τις ποιῇ
ταῦτα ἃ ἂν δοκῇ αὐτῷ βέλτιστα εἶναι, νοῦν μὴ ἔχων; καὶ τοῦτο καλεῖς
σὺ μέγα δύνασθαι; ΠΩΛ. οὐκ ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἀποδείξεις τοὺς
ρήτορας νοῦν ἔχοντας καὶ

467a

S: In that case, once you have refuted me, will you demonstrate that the rhetoricians possess intelligence, and rhetoric is a skill and not flattery? And if you leave me unrefuted, the rhetoricians, who do whatever seems best to them in the cities, and the tyrants will have acquired nothing good thereby. But, according to you, the power is good. Yet you also agree that doing what seems best without intelligence is bad, do you not?

467a

PO: I do.

467a

S: So, how could rhetoricians exercise enormous power in the cities, or tyrants either, unless they really are doing what they wish, and Socrates is thus refuted by Polus?

τέχνην τὴν ῥητορικὴν ἀλλὰ μὴ κολακείαν, ἐμὲ ἐξελέγξας; εἰ δέ με ἑάσεις ἀνέλεγκτον, οἱ ῥήτορες οἱ ποιοῦντες ἐν ταῖς πόλεσιν ἃ δοκεῖ αὐτοῖς καὶ οἱ τύραννοι οὐδὲν ἀγαθὸν τοῦτο κεκτήσονται, ἡ δὲ δύναμις ἐστίν, ὥς σὺ φῆς, ἀγαθόν, τὸ δὲ ποιεῖν ἄνευ νοῦ ἃ δοκεῖ καὶ σὺ ὁμολογεῖς κακὸν εἶναι ἢ οὐ; ΠΩΛ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. πῶς ἂν οὖν οἱ ῥήτορες μέγα δύναιτο ἢ οἱ τύραννοι ἐν ταῖς πόλεσιν, ἐὰν μὴ Σωκράτης ἐξελεγχθῇ ὑπὸ Πώλου ὅτι ποιοῦσιν ἃ βούλονται;

467b

PO: This man!

467b

S: I deny that they are doing what they wish. Now refute me!

467b

PO: Didn't you just agree that they do what seems best to them?

467b

S: And I still agree now.

467b

PO: In that case, don't they do what they wish?

467b

S: That I deny.

467b

PO: Are they doing what seems best to them?

467b

S: That's what I am saying.

467b

PO: What you are saying is shocking, Socrates, extremely so.

467b

S: Do not make accusations, precious Polus, if I may address you in your own manner. Rather, question me if you are able to and prove that I am speaking falsely. Otherwise you should respond to me.

ΠΩΛ. οὗτος ἀνὴρ— ΣΩ. οὐ φημι ποιεῖν αὐτοὺς ἃ βούλονται· ἀλλὰ μ' ἔλεγε. ΠΩΛ. οὐκ ἄρτι ὠμολόγεις ποιεῖν ἃ δοκεῖ αὐτοῖς βέλτιστα εἶναι, τούτου πρόσθεν; ΣΩ. καὶ γὰρ νῦν ὁμολογῶ. ΠΩΛ. οὐκ οὖν ποιοῦσιν ἃ βούλονται; ΣΩ. οὐ φημι. ΠΩΛ. ποιοῦντες ἃ δοκεῖ αὐτοῖς; ΣΩ. φημί. ΠΩΛ. σχετλιά γε λέγεις καὶ ὑπερφυῆ, ὧ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. μὴ κακηγόρει, ὧ λῶστε Πῶλε, ἵνα προσεῖπω σε

467c

Po: Then I'm willing to respond so that I actually understand what you are saying.

467c

S: Well, what do you think people wish for, the action they are performing at the time or that for the sake of which they perform the action they are performing? Take, for instance, those who drink medicine at the behest of the physicians. Do you think they wish for the action they are performing – drinking the medicine and suffering its effects – or is it for something else, for the healthy condition, that for the sake of which they drink it?

κατὰ σέ· ἀλλ' εἰ μὲν ἔχεις ἐμὲ ἐρωτᾶν, ἐπίδειξον ὅτι ψεύδομαι, εἰ δὲ μή, αὐτὸς ἀποκρίνου. ΠΩΛ. ἀλλ' ἐθέλω ἀποκρίνεσθαι, ἵνα καὶ εἰδῶ ὅτι λέγεις. ΣΩ. πότερον οὖν σοι δοκοῦσιν οἱ ἄνθρωποι τοῦτο βούλεσθαι ὃ ἂν πράττωσιν ἐκάστοτε, ἢ ἐκεῖνο οὗ ἕνεκα πράττουσιν τοῦθ' ὃ πράττουσιν; οἷον οἱ τὰ φάρμακα πίνοντες παρὰ τῶν ἱατρῶν πότερόν σοι δοκοῦσιν τοῦτο βούλεσθαι ὅπερ ποιοῦσιν, πίνειν τὸ φάρμακον καὶ ἀλγεῖν, ἢ ἐκεῖνο, τὸ ὑγιαίνειν, οὗ ἕνεκα πίνουσιν; ΠΩΛ. δῆλον ὅτι τὸ

467d

Po: Obviously it is the healthy condition.

467d

S: And in the case of those who undertake sea voyages or engage in other money-making activities, it is not the activity that they wish for, the one they are performing at the time, for who wishes to be at sea, running risks and enduring hardship? No, I think they travel by sea

for the sake of something else, to be wealthy, for they take to the sea for the sake of wealth.

467d

PO: Yes, certainly.

467d

S: So, does not the same go for all other actions? If anyone does anything for the sake of something, he does not wish for the action he is performing, but for that for the sake of which he performs the action.

ὕγιαίνειν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ οἱ πλείοντές τε καὶ τὸν ἄλλον χρηματισμὸν χρηματιζόμενοι οὐ τοῦτό ἐστιν ὃ βούλονται, ὃ ποιῶσιν ἐκάστοτε (τίς γὰρ βούλεται πλεῖν τε καὶ κινδυνεύειν καὶ πράγματ' ἔχειν;) ἀλλ' ἐκεῖνο οἶμαι οὗ ἔνεκα πλέουσιν, πλουτεῖν· πλούτου γὰρ ἔνεκα πλέουσιν. ΠΩΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. ἄλλο τι οὖν οὕτω καὶ περὶ πάντων; ἔάν τις τι πράττη ἔνεκά του, οὐ τοῦτο βούλεται ὃ πράττει, ἀλλ' ἐκεῖνο

467e

PO: Yes.

467e

S: Now, among things that are, is not everything either good or bad, or in between these two, neither good nor bad?

467e

PO: This simply must be so, Socrates.

467e

S: Would you not say that wisdom, health and wealth and the like are good, while the opposites of these are bad?

467e

PO: I would indeed.

οὗ ἔνεκα πράττει; ΠΩΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν ἔστιν τι τῶν ὄντων ὃ οὐχὶ ἤτοι ἀγαθὸν γ' ἐστὶν ἢ κακὸν ἢ μεταξὺ τούτων, οὔτε ἀγαθὸν οὔτε κακόν; ΠΩΛ. πολλὴ ἀνάγκη, ὦ Σώκратες. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν λέγεις εἶναι ἀγαθὸν μὲν σοφίαν τε καὶ ὑγίειαν καὶ πλούτον καὶ τᾶλλα τὰ τοιαῦτα, κακὰ δὲ

τάναντία τούτων; ΠΩΛ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. τὰ δὲ μήτε ἀγαθὰ μήτε κακὰ ἄρα τοιάδε λέγεις, ἃ ἐνίστε μὲν μετέχει τοῦ ἀγαθοῦ,

468a

S: And do you say that the things that are neither good nor bad are those which sometimes partake of the good and sometimes of the bad and sometimes of neither, like sitting, walking, running and sailing, or indeed stones and wood and anything else of that sort? Are you not referring to these? Or do you refer to some other things as neither good nor bad?

468a

PO: No, just these.

468a

S: Now, which is it? Whenever people perform actions, do they perform those in-between actions for the sake of whatever is good, or the good actions for the sake of the in-between?

ἐνίστε δὲ τοῦ κακοῦ, ἐνίστε δὲ οὐδετέρου, οἷον καθῆσθαι καὶ βαδίζειν καὶ τρέχειν καὶ πλεῖν, καὶ οἷον αὖ λίθους καὶ ξύλα καὶ τᾶλλα τὰ τοιαῦτα; οὐ ταῦτα λέγεις; ἢ ἄλλ' ἅττα καλεῖς τὰ μήτε ἀγαθὰ μήτε κακὰ; ΠΩΛ. οὐκ, ἀλλὰ ταῦτα. ΣΩ. πότερον οὖν τὰ μεταξὺ ταῦτα ἔνεκα τῶν ἀγαθῶν πράττουσιν ὅταν πράττωσιν, ἢ τὰγαθὰ τῶν μεταξὺ; ΠΩΛ. τὰ

468b

PO: The in-between for the sake of the good, of course.

468b

S: So, whenever we walk, we walk in pursuit of the good, thinking it better to do so. And in the opposite case we stand, when we do stand, for the same reason, for the sake of the good. Is this not so?

468b

PO: Yes.

468b

S: Therefore, too, if we kill someone, do we not kill them, or banish them or confiscate their property, thinking that it is better for us to do so rather than not do so?

468b

PO: Yes, certainly.

468b

S: So, those who do all of these things do them for the sake of the good.

468b

PO: I agree.

468b

S: Have we agreed, then, that whenever we perform actions for the sake of something else, we do not wish for those activities, but for that for the sake of which we do them?

μεταξὺ δήπου τῶν ἀγαθῶν. ΣΩ. τὸ ἀγαθὸν ἄρα διώκοντες καὶ βαδίζομεν ὅταν βαδίζωμεν, οἰόμενοι βέλτιον εἶναι, καὶ τὸ ἐναντίον ἔσταμεν ὅταν ἐστῶμεν, τοῦ αὐτοῦ ἔνεκα, τοῦ ἀγαθοῦ· ἢ οὐ; ΠΩΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ ἀποκτείνουμεν, εἴ τιν' ἀποκτείνουμεν, καὶ ἐκβάλλομεν καὶ ἀφαιρούμεθα χρήματα, οἰόμενοι ἄμεινον εἶναι ἡμῖν ταῦτα ποιεῖν ἢ μὴ; ΠΩΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. ἔνεκ' ἄρα τοῦ ἀγαθοῦ ἅπαντα ταῦτα ποιοῦσιν οἱ ποιοῦντες. ΠΩΛ. φημί. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ὡμολογήσαμεν, ἃ ἔνεκά του ποιοῦμεν, μὴ ἐκεῖνα βούλεσθαι,

468c

PO: Very much so.

468c

S: So, we do not wish to butcher people or expel them from our cities or confiscate their property just like that. But when these actions are beneficial we wish to perform them, and when they are harmful we do not wish to do so. For we wish for whatever is good, as you say, but we do not wish for what is neither good nor bad, or what is bad, do we? Do you think what I am saying is true or not, Polus? Why do you not answer?

468c

PO: True.

ἀλλ' ἐκεῖνο οὐ ἔνεκα ταῦτα ποιοῦμεν; ΠΩΛ. μάλιστα. ΣΩ. οὐκ ἄρα σφάττειν βουλόμεθα οὐδ' ἐκβάλλειν ἐκ τῶν πόλεων οὐδὲ χρήματα ἀφαιρεῖσθαι ἀπλῶς οὕτως, ἀλλ' ἐὰν μὲν ὠφέλιμα ᾗ ταῦτα, βουλόμεθα πράττειν αὐτά, βλαβερά δὲ ὄντα οὐ βουλόμεθα. τὰ γὰρ ἀγαθὰ βουλόμεθα, ὡς φῆς σύ, τὰ δὲ μήτε ἀγαθὰ μήτε κακὰ οὐ βουλόμεθα, οὐδὲ τὰ κακὰ. ἦ γάρ; ἀληθῆ σοι δοκῶ λέγειν, ὦ Πῶλε, ἢ οὐ; τί οὐκ ἀποκρίνη; ΠΩΛ. ἀληθῆ.

468d

S: Therefore, since we are agreed on all this, if anyone, either a tyrant or a rhetorician, kills someone or banishes them from the city or confiscates their possessions, thinking that it is better for himself and it happens to be worse, this man is obviously doing whatever seems best to him. Is this so?

468d

PO: Yes.

468d

S: Now, is he also doing what he wishes, if these actions happen to be bad for him? Why do you not answer?

468d

PO: Well, I don't think that he is doing what he wishes.

ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν εἴπερ ταῦτα ὁμολογοῦμεν, εἴ τις ἀποκτείνει τινὰ ἢ ἐκβάλλει ἐκ πόλεως ἢ ἀφαιρεῖται χρήματα, εἴτε τύραννος ὢν εἴτε ῥήτωρ, οἴομενος ἄμεινον εἶναι αὐτῷ, τυγχάνει δὲ ὃν κάκιον, οὗτος δήπου ποιεῖ ἃ δοκεῖ αὐτῷ; ἦ γάρ; ΠΩΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν καὶ ἃ βούλεται, εἴπερ τυγχάνει ταῦτα κακὰ ὄντα; τί οὐκ ἀποκρίνη; ΠΩΛ. ἀλλ' οὐ μοι δοκεῖ ποιεῖν ἃ βούλεται. ΣΩ. ἔστιν οὖν ὅπως ὁ τοιοῦτος

468e

S: So, is there any sense in which such a person is exercising enormous power in that city, since, as you agreed, the exercise of enormous power is something good?

468e

PO: There is not.

468e

S: Then, I spoke the truth when I said that it is possible for a man who is doing what seems best to him in a city not to be exercising enormous power or doing what he wishes.

468e

PO: Yes, Socrates, as if you would not welcome the opportunity of doing whatever seems best to you in the city, given the choice, nor would you envy someone whom you saw killing whoever seemed to him to deserve it, or confiscating his property or putting people in chains.

μέγα δύναται ἐν τῇ πόλει ταύτῃ, εἴπερ ἐστὶ τὸ μέγα δύνασθαι ἀγαθόν τι κατὰ τὴν σὴν ὁμολογίαν; ΠΩΛ. οὐκ ἔστιν. ΣΩ. ἀληθῆ ἄρα ἐγὼ ἔλεγον, λέγων ὅτι ἔστιν ἄνθρωπον ποιοῦντα ἐν πόλει ἃ δοκεῖ αὐτῷ μὴ μέγα δύνασθαι μηδὲ ποιεῖν ἃ βούλεται. ΠΩΛ. ὥς δὴ σύ, ὦ Σώκρατες, οὐκ ἂν δέξαιο ἐξεῖναί σοι ποιεῖν ὅτι δοκεῖ σοι ἐν τῇ πόλει μᾶλλον ἢ μή, οὐδὲ ζηλοῖς ὅταν ἴδῃς τινὰ ἢ ἀποκτείναντα ὃν ἔδοξεν αὐτῷ ἢ ἀφελόμενον χρήματα ἢ δῆσαντα. ΣΩ. δικαίως λέγεις ἢ ἀδίκως;

469a

S: Do you mean justly or unjustly?

469a

PO: Whatever he does, isn't it enviable in either case?

469a

S: Mind what you say, Polus.

469a

PO: Why so?

469a

S: Because the unenviable must not be envied, nor should the wretched. In fact, they should be pitied.

469a

PO: What's this? Do you think that the men I am referring to are in that situation?

469a

S: How could they not be?

ΠΩΛ. ὁπότερ' ἂν ποιῇ, οὐκ ἀμφοτέρως ζηλωτόν ἐστιν; ΣΩ. εὐφήμει, ὦ Πῶλε. ΠΩΛ. τί δή; ΣΩ. ὅτι οὐ χρή οὔτε τοὺς ἀζηλώτους ζηλοῦν οὔτε τοὺς ἀθλίους, ἀλλ' ἐλεεῖν. ΠΩΛ. τί δέ; οὕτω σοι δοκεῖ ἔχειν περὶ ὧν ἐγὼ λέγω τῶν ἀνθρώπων; ΣΩ. πῶς γὰρ οὔ; ΠΩΛ. ὅστις οὖν ἀποκτείνουσιν ὃν ἂν δόξη αὐτῷ, δικαίως ἀποκτεινύς, ἄθλιος δοκεῖ σοι εἶναι καὶ ἐλεινός; ΣΩ. οὐκ ἔμοιγε, οὐδὲ μέντοι ζηλωτός. ΠΩΛ. οὐκ ἄρτι ἄθλιον ἔφησθα εἶναι;

469b

PO: Well, do you think someone is wretched and pitiable when he has killed someone who seems to him to deserve it and the killing is just?

469b

S: I do not think so, but he is not enviable either.

469b

PO: Didn't you say just now that he is wretched?

469b

S: That was the person who did the killing unjustly, and he is pitiable as well. But the one who does it justly is unenviable.

469b

PO: Surely it is the person who has been unjustly killed who is pitiable and wretched.

469b

S: Less than the person who killed him, Polus, and less than someone who is justly killed.

469b

PO: How can that be, Socrates?

469b

S: On the basis that doing injustice happens to be the greatest of evils.

ΣΩ. τὸν ἀδίκως γε, ὃ ἐταῖρε, ἀποκτείναντα, καὶ ἐλεινόν γε πρὸς τὸν δὲ δικαίως ἀζηλωτον. ΠΩΛ. ἢ που ὅ γε ἀποθνήσκων ἀδίκως ἐλεινός τε καὶ ἄθλιός ἐστιν. ΣΩ. ἦττον ἢ ὁ ἀποκτεινύς, ὦ Πῶλε, καὶ ἦττον ἢ ὁ δικαίως ἀποθνήσκων. ΠΩΛ. πῶς δῆτα, ὦ Σώκρατες; ΣΩ. οὕτως, ὡς μέγιστον

τῶν κακῶν τυγχάνει ὃν τὸ ἀδικεῖν. ΠΩΛ. ἦ γὰρ τοῦτο μέγιστον; οὐ τὸ ἀδικεῖσθαι μεῖζον; ΣΩ. ἥκιστα γε. ΠΩΛ. σὺ ἄρα βούλοιο ἂν ἀδικεῖσθαι μᾶλλον ἢ ἀδικεῖν;

469c

PO: Is it the greatest? Isn't it a greater evil to suffer injustice?

469c

S: Not in the least.

469c

PO: So, would you prefer to suffer injustice rather than do injustice?

469c

S: I myself would prefer neither. But if it were necessary either to do injustice or to suffer injustice, I would choose to suffer injustice rather than do injustice.

469c

PO: So, you would not welcome being a tyrant?

469c

S: Not if you mean what I mean by being a tyrant anyway.

469c

PO: Well, I mean what I said already, being able to do whatever seems best to you in the city – killing, banishing, and doing everything based upon your own opinion.

ΣΩ. βουλοίμην μὲν ἂν ἔγωγε οὐδέτερα· εἰ δ' ἀναγκαῖον εἶη ἀδικεῖν ἢ ἀδικεῖσθαι, ἐλοίμην ἂν μᾶλλον ἀδικεῖσθαι ἢ ἀδικεῖν. ΠΩΛ. σὺ ἄρα τυραννεῖν οὐκ ἂν δέξαιο; ΣΩ. οὐκ, εἰ τὸ τυραννεῖν γε λέγεις ὅπερ ἐγώ. ΠΩΛ. ἀλλ' ἔγωγε τοῦτο λέγω ὅπερ ἄρτι, ἐξεῖναι ἐν τῇ πόλει, ὃ ἂν δοκῇ αὐτῷ, ποιεῖν τοῦτο, καὶ ἀποκτείνονται καὶ ἐκβάλλονται καὶ πάντα πράττοντι κατὰ τὴν αὐτοῦ δόξαν. ΣΩ. ὦ μακάριε, ἐμοῦ δὴ λέγοντος τῷ λόγῳ ἐπιλαβοῦ.

469d

S: Bless you. Then think about what I am going to say. Suppose I were in a crowded market-place carrying a dagger under my arm, and I said to you, “Polus, I have just been granted a wonderful and tyrannical

power. Yes, if it should seem to me that one of these men whom you see deserves to die right now, the man I think should die shall die. And if it should seem to me that one of them should have his head smashed, smashed it will be there and then. And if his cloak should be torn, torn it will be, so great is the power I shall exercise in this city.” Now, if you did not believe me and I were to show you the dagger, you would probably look at it and say, “Socrates, anyone at all could exercise great power in this manner since, based on this approach, you could also burn down any house you thought you should, and the dockyards of Athens, triremes included, and all the ships, public as well as private.” But this is not really the exercise of great power, doing what seems best to you. Or do you think it is?

εἰ γὰρ ἐγὼ ἐν ἀγορᾷ πληθούσῃ λαβὼν ὑπὸ μάλης ἐγχειρίδιον λέγοιμι πρὸς σέ ὅτι ὦ Πῶλε, ἐμοὶ δύναμις τις καὶ τυραννὶς θαυμασία ἄρτι προσγένονεν· ἐὰν γὰρ ἄρα ἐμοὶ δόξῃ τινὰ τουτωνὶ τῶν ἀνθρώπων ὧν σὺ ὀρᾷς αὐτίκα μάλα δεῖν τεθνάναι, τεθνήξει οὗτος ὃν ἂν δόξῃ· κἄν τινα δόξῃ μοι τῆς κεφαλῆς αὐτῶν καταγῆναι δεῖν, κατεαγὼς ἔσται αὐτίκα μάλα, κἄν θοιμάτιον διεσχίσθαι, διεσχισμένον ἔσται—οὕτω

469e

PO: Of course not, not when it's done in this way anyway.

μέγα ἐγὼ δύναμαι ἐν τῇδε τῇ πόλει, εἰ οὖν ἀπιστοῦντί σοι δείξαιμι τὸ ἐγχειρίδιον, ἴσως ἂν εἴποις ἰδὼν ὅτι ὦ Σώκρατες, οὕτω μὲν πάντες ἂν μέγα δύναιντο, ἐπεὶ κἄν ἐμπρησθεῖη οἰκία τουτῷ τῷ τρόπῳ ἥντινά σοι δοκοῖ, καὶ τά γε Ἀθηναίων νεώρια καὶ αἱ τριήρεις καὶ τὰ πλοῖα πάντα καὶ τὰ δημόσια καὶ τὰ ἴδια· ἀλλ' οὐκ ἄρα τοῦτ' ἔστιν τὸ μέγα δύνασθαι, τὸ ποιεῖν ἃ δοκεῖ αὐτῷ· ἢ δοκεῖ σοι; ΠΩΛ. οὐ δῆτα οὕτω γε.

470a

S: Now, can you say why you deprecate power of this sort?

470a

PO: I can.

470a

S: Why so? Tell me.

470a

PO: Because it is necessary for the person who behaves in this way to undergo punishment.

470a

S: And is it not bad to undergo punishment?

470a

PO: Very much so.

470a

S: In that case, my wonderful friend, once again you are of the view that, provided acting as seems best to you corresponds to acting beneficially, it is good, and this seemingly is the possession of great power. But, if not, it is bad and is insignificant power. But let us also consider this. Do we not agree that it is sometimes good to do the deeds we mentioned, to kill and to banish people and confiscate their property, and sometimes it is not?

ΣΩ. ἔχεις οὖν εἰπεῖν δι' ὅτι μέμφῃ τὴν τοιαύτην δύναμιν; ΠΩΛ. ἔγωγε.
 ΣΩ. τί δὴ; λέγε. ΠΩΛ. ὅτι ἀναγκαῖον τὸν οὕτω πράττοντα ζημιοῦσθαί ἐστιν. ΣΩ. τὸ δὲ ζημιοῦσθαι οὐ κακόν; ΠΩΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν, ὃ θαυμάσιε, τὸ μέγα δύνασθαι πάλιν αὖ σοι φαίνεται, ἐὰν μὲν πράττοντι ἃ δοκεῖ ἔπῃται τὸ ὠφελίμως πράττειν, ἀγαθόν τε εἶναι, καὶ τοῦτο, ὡς ἔοικεν, ἐστὶν τὸ μέγα δύνασθαι· εἰ δὲ μή, κακὸν καὶ σμικρὸν δύνασθαι.

470b

PO: Very much so.

470b

S: Then this point, it seems, is agreed by you and by me.

470b

PO: Yes.

470b

S: So, when do you say it is better to do these deeds? Tell me what distinction you make.

470b

PO: You should answer that question, Socrates.

σκεψώμεθα δὲ καὶ τόδε· ἄλλο τι ὁμολογοῦμεν ἐνίστε μὲν ἄμεινον εἶναι ταῦτα ποιεῖν ἢ νυνδὴ ἐλέγομεν, ἀποκτείνονται τε καὶ ἐξελαύνειν ἀνθρώπους καὶ ἀφαιρεῖσθαι χρήματα, ἐνίστε δὲ οὐ; ΠΩΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. τοῦτο μὲν δὴ, ὡς ἔοικε, καὶ παρὰ σοῦ καὶ παρ' ἐμοῦ ὁμολογεῖται. ΠΩΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. πότε οὖν σὺ φῆς ἄμεινον εἶναι ταῦτα ποιεῖν; εἰπέ τίνα ὄρον ὀρίζῃ. ΠΩΛ. σὺ μὲν οὖν, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἀπόκριναι ταῦτο τοῦτο.

470c

S: Well, Polus, if it is more pleasant for you to hear this from me, I say that whenever anyone does these deeds justly, it is better. Whenever anyone does them unjustly, it is worse.

470c

PO: Oh! You are so hard to refute, Socrates! Couldn't a mere child refute you and show you are not speaking the truth?

470c

S: Then I shall be very grateful to the child, and equally so to you if you happen to refute me and rid me of folly. So do not tire of doing good deeds for a man who is your friend. Refute me.

ΣΩ. ἐγὼ μὲν τοίνυν φημί, ὦ Πῶλε, εἴ σοι παρ' ἐμοῦ ἥδιόν ἐστιν ἀκούειν, ὅταν μὲν δικαίως τις ταῦτα ποιῇ, ἄμεινον εἶναι, ὅταν δὲ ἀδίκως, κάκιον. ΠΩΛ. χαλεπὸν γέ σε ἐλέγξει, ὦ Σώκρατες· ἀλλ' οὐχὶ καὶν παῖς σε ἐλέγξειεν ὅτι οὐκ ἀληθῆ λέγεις; ΣΩ. πολλὴν ἄρα ἐγὼ τῷ παιδὶ χάριν ἔξω, ἴσην δὲ καὶ σοί, ἐάν με ἐλέγξης καὶ ἀπαλλάξης φλυαρίας. ἀλλὰ μὴ κάμης φίλον ἄνδρα εὐεργετῶν, ἀλλ' ἔλεγχε. ΠΩΛ. ἀλλὰ μὴν, ὦ Σώκρατες, οὐδὲν γέ σε δεῖ παλαιοῖς

470d

PO: Well then, Socrates, there is no need to refer to ancient deeds in order to refute you. Indeed, recent and not so recent events are enough to refute you and show that many people who act unjustly are happy.

470d

S: What sort of events?

470d

PO: You see, don't you, that this Archelaus fellow, the son of Perdiccas, is ruling Macedonia?

470d

S: Not really, but I have heard this.

470d

PO: Well, do you think he is happy or is he wretched?

470d

S: I do not know, Polus, for I have not yet been in the man's company.

πράγμασιν ἐλέγχειν· τὰ γὰρ ἐχθὲς καὶ πρώην γεγονότα ταῦτα ἱκανὰ σε ἐξελέγξει ἐστὶν καὶ ἀποδείξει ὥς πολλοὶ ἀδικοῦντες ἄνθρωποι εὐδαίμονες εἰσιν. ΣΩ. τὰ ποῖα ταῦτα; ΠΩΛ. Ἀρχέλαον δήπου τοῦτον τὸν Περδίκκου ὀρᾷς ἄρχοντα Μακεδονίας; ΣΩ. εἰ δὲ μή, ἀλλ' ἀκούω γε. ΠΩΛ. εὐδαίμων οὖν σοι δοκεῖ εἶναι ἢ ἄθλιος; ΣΩ. οὐκ οἶδα, ὦ Πῶλε· οὐ γάρ πω συγγέγονα τῷ ἀνδρί.

470e

PO: What's this? You would know if you were in his company, but otherwise you do not simply recognise that he is happy?

470e

S: By Zeus, of course I do not.

470e

PO: Then, Socrates, it is obvious that you will say that you do not recognise that even the Great King is happy.¹⁴

470e

S: And I shall be speaking the truth, for I do not know how he stands with regard to justice and education.

470e

PO: Come now, is all happiness contained in this?

470e

S: That is what I say anyway, Polus. For I assert that the noble and good men and women are happy, while the unjust and degenerate are wretched.

ΠΩΛ. τί δέ; συγγενόμενος ἄν γνοίης, ἄλλως δὲ αὐτόθεν οὐ γινώσκεις ὅτι εὐδαιμονεῖ; ΣΩ. μὰ Δί' οὐ δῆτα. ΠΩΛ. δῆλον δὴ, ὃ Σώκρατες, ὅτι οὐδὲ τὸν μέγαν βασιλέα γινώσκειν φήσεις εὐδαίμονα ὄντα. ΣΩ. καὶ ἀληθῆ γε ἐρῶ· οὐ γὰρ οἶδα παιδείας ὅπως ἔχει καὶ δικαιοσύνης. ΠΩΛ. τί δέ; ἐν τούτῳ ἢ πᾶσα εὐδαιμονία ἐστίν; ΣΩ. ὥς γε ἐγὼ λέγω, ὃ Πῶλε· τὸν μὲν γὰρ καλὸν καὶ ἀγαθὸν ἄνδρα καὶ γυναῖκα εὐδαίμονα εἶναι φημι, τὸν δὲ ἄδικον καὶ πονηρὸν ἄθλιον.

471a

PO: So by your account, this Archelaus fellow is wretched?

471a

S: Yes, my friend, if he is unjust.

471a

PO: But how could he not be unjust? None of the authority he now exercises belonged to him, as he was born of a woman who was a slave of Alcetas, the brother of Perdiccas, so, by right, he was a slave of Alcetas. And if he had wished to enact what is just, he would have acted as a slave to Alcetas and would have been happy, according to your account. But now, wonder of wonders, he has become wretched, since he has perpetrated enormous injustices. Anyway, he first sent for this man, his own master and uncle, on the pretext of restoring the authority that Perdiccas had taken from him. Once he had entertained Alcetas, he got him drunk along with his son Alexander – Archelaus' own cousin of almost the same age – threw them into a wagon, led them away by night, slit their throats, and they were never seen again. Having perpetrated these injustices, he failed to notice that he had become utterly wretched, and he did not mend his ways. No, a little later he showed no wish to become happy by rearing his own seven-year-old brother, the legitimate son of Perdiccas, in a just manner and bestowing the throne upon him, to whom it devolved by right. Instead, he threw him into a well and drowned him, and told the boy's mother, Cleopatra, that he had fallen in and died whilst running after a goose. And of course, since he has behaved more unjustly than anyone in Macedonia, he is the most wretched of all the Macedonians,

and not the happiest. And perhaps there is some Athenian, who, following your example, would prefer to be any other Macedonian rather than Archelaus.

ΠΩΛ. ἄθλιος ἄρα οὗτός ἐστιν ὁ Ἀρχέλαος κατὰ τὸν σὸν λόγον; ΣΩ. εἶπερ γε, ὦ φίλε, ἄδικος. ΠΩΛ. ἀλλὰ μὲν δὴ πῶς οὐκ ἄδικος; ᾧ γε προσήκει μὲν τῆς ἀρχῆς οὐδὲν ἦν νῦν ἔχει, ὄντι ἐκ γυναικὸς ἢ ἦν δούλη Ἀλκέτου τοῦ Περδίκκου ἀδελφοῦ, καὶ κατὰ μὲν τὸ δίκαιον δοῦλος ἦν Ἀλκέτου, καὶ εἰ ἐβούλετο τὰ δίκαια ποιεῖν, ἐδούλευεν ἂν Ἀλκότη καὶ ἦν εὐδαίμων κατὰ τὸν σὸν λόγον. νῦν δὲ θαυμασίως ὥς ἄθλιος γέγονεν, ἐπεὶ τὰ μέγιστα ἠδίκηκεν· ὅς γε πρῶτον μὲν τοῦτον αὐτὸν τὸν δεσπότην καὶ θεῖον μεταπεψάμενος ὥς ἀποδώσων τὴν ἀρχὴν ἦν Περδίκκας αὐτὸν ἀφείλετο, ξενίσας καὶ καταμεθύσας αὐτόν τε καὶ τὸν υἱὸν αὐτοῦ Ἀλέξανδρον, ἀνεψιὸν αὐτοῦ, σχεδὸν ἡλικιώτην, ἐμβαλὼν εἰς ἅμαξαν, νύκτωρ ἐξαγαγὼν ἀπέσφαξέν τε καὶ ἠφάνισεν ἀμφοτέρους. καὶ ταῦτα ἀδικήσας ἔλαθεν ἑαυτὸν ἀθλιώτατος γενόμενος καὶ οὐ μετεμέλησεν αὐτῷ, ἀλλ' ὀλίγον ὕστερον τὸν ἀδελφόν, τὸν γνήσιον τοῦ Περδίκκου υἱόν, παῖδα ὥς ἐπτέτη, οὗ ἡ ἀρχὴ ἐγίγνετο κατὰ τὸ δίκαιον, οὐκ ἐβουλήθη εὐδαίμων γενέσθαι δικαίως ἐκθρέψας καὶ ἀποδοὺς τὴν ἀρχὴν ἐκείνῳ, ἀλλ' εἰς φρέαρ ἐμβαλὼν καὶ ἀποπνίξας πρὸς τὴν μητέρα αὐτοῦ Κλεοπάτραν χῆνα ἔφη διώκοντα ἐμπεσεῖν καὶ ἀποθανεῖν. τοιγάρτοι νῦν, ἅτε μέγιστα ἠδίκηκώς τῶν ἐν Μακεδονίᾳ, ἀθλιώτατός ἐστιν πάντων Μακεδόνων, ἀλλ' οὐκ εὐδαιμονέστατος, καὶ ἴσως ἔστιν ὅστις Ἀθηναίων ἀπὸ σοῦ

471d

S: Indeed, Polus, at the beginning of these discussions I praised you because I thought you had been well educated in rhetoric but had neglected dialectic. And now, is this the argument by which a child could refute me? And do you think I have been refuted by you, by means of this argument, I who assert that those who act unjustly are not happy? Where is the refutation, good man? On the contrary, I do not agree with anything you are saying.

471d

PO: You actually don't want to, yet you are thinking what I am saying.

ἀρξάμενος δέξαιτ' ἂν ἄλλος ὅστισοῦν Μακεδόνων γενέσθαι μᾶλλον ἢ Ἀρχέλαος. ΣΩ. καὶ κατ' ἀρχὰς τῶν λόγων, ὦ Πῶλε, ἔγωγέ σε ἐπῆνεσα ὅτι μοι δοκεῖς εὖ πρὸς τὴν ρητορικὴν πεπαιδεῦσθαι, τοῦ δὲ διαλέγεσθαι ἡμεληκέναι· καὶ νῦν ἄλλο τι οὗτός ἐστιν ὁ λόγος, ὃ με καὶ ἂν παῖς ἐξελέγξειε, καὶ ἐγὼ ὑπὸ σοῦ νῦν, ὡς σὺ οἶει, ἐξελήλεγμαι· τούτῳ τῷ λόγῳ, φάσκων τὸν ἀδικοῦντα οὐκ εὐδαίμονα εἶναι; πόθεν, ὦγαθέ; καὶ μὴν οὐδὲν γέ σοι τούτων ὁμολογῶ ὧν σὺ φής.

471e

S: Bless you! You are trying to refute me in a rhetorical manner, just like those who believe they are engaging in refutation in courts of law. Yes, indeed, in those places, one party seems to refute another once they bring forward many well-regarded witnesses in support of the speeches they deliver, while the opposing speaker furnishes only one or none. But this refutation is of no value with regard to truth. For on occasion, anyone may be subject to false testimony from numerous witnesses who are held in some regard. And now, with few exceptions, all Athenians and strangers alike will say the same things you say, should you wish to bring witnesses against me to say I am not speaking the truth. They will testify for you if you wish: Nicias, the son of Niceratus, and his brothers too, whose tripods stand in a row in the Sanctuary of Dionysus; Aristocrates, the son of Skellias, whose beautiful statue stands in the Pythian precinct, if you wish; the entire household of Pericles too, or any other family you wish to select from among this company.¹⁵ But I, being one, do not agree with you for you do not compel me. Instead, you furnish many false witnesses against me in your efforts to divorce me from my property, the truth. But if I do not produce you yourself as one witness who agrees with what I am saying, then I think I have achieved nothing worth mentioning in relation to the subjects of our discussion. And neither have you, unless I, one solitary person, bear witness for you, and you bid all those others farewell.

Now, this is the particular manner of refutation which you and many

others accept. Yet there is another, which I, for my part, believe in.

So, let us place them side by side and find out if there is any difference between them. What is more, the issues over which we are disputing are not completely trivial. No, to have knowledge of these matters is almost the fairest acquisition of all, and to lack this knowledge is utterly base, for at the heart of all this is knowing or being ignorant, of who is happy and who is not. First, there is the immediate issue under discussion at the moment. You think it is possible for a man to be blessed although he is unjust and acting unjustly, since you think that Archelaus is unjust and yet happy. May we regard this as your viewpoint?

ΠΩΛ. οὐ γὰρ ἐθέλεις, ἐπεὶ δοκεῖ γέ σοι ὡς ἐγὼ λέγω. ΣΩ. ὦ μακάριε, ῥητορικῶς γάρ με ἐπιχειρεῖς ἐλέγχειν, ὥσπερ οἱ ἐν τοῖς δικαστηρίοις ἡγούμενοι ἐλέγχουσιν. καὶ γὰρ ἐκεῖ οἱ ἔτεροι τοὺς ἐτέρους δοκοῦσιν ἐλέγχουσιν, ἐπειδὴ τῶν λόγων ὧν ἂν λέγωσι μάρτυρας πολλοὺς παρέχονται καὶ εὐδοκίμους, ὁ δὲ τάναντία λέγων ἓνα τινὰ παρέχεται ἢ μηδένα. οὗτος δὲ ὁ ἔλεγχος οὐδενὸς ἄξιός ἐστιν πρὸς τὴν ἀλήθειαν· ἐνίστε γὰρ ἂν καὶ καταψευδομαρτυρηθεῖη τις ὑπὸ πολλῶν καὶ δοκούντων εἶναι τι. καὶ νῦν περὶ ὧν σὺ λέγεις ὀλίγου σοι πάντες συμφήσουσιν ταῦτα Ἀθηναῖοι καὶ οἱ ξένοι, ἐὰν βούλη κατ' ἐμοῦ μάρτυρας παρασχέσθαι ὡς οὐκ ἀληθῆ λέγω· μαρτυρήσουσί σοι, ἐὰν μὲν βούλη, Νικίας ὁ Νικηράτου καὶ οἱ ἀδελφοὶ μετ' αὐτοῦ, ὧν οἱ τρίποδες οἱ ἐφεξῆς ἐστῶτές εἰσιν ἐν τῷ Διονυσίῳ, ἐὰν δὲ βούλη, Ἀριστοκράτης ὁ Σκελλίου, οὗ αὖ ἐστιν ἐν Πυθίου τοῦτο τὸ καλὸν ἀνάθημα, ἐὰν δὲ βούλη, ἡ Περικλέους ὅλη οἰκία ἢ ἄλλη συγγένεια ἦντινα ἂν βούλη τῶν ἐνθάδε ἐκλέξασθαι. ἀλλ' ἐγὼ σοι εἰς ὧν οὐχ ὁμολογῶ· οὐ γάρ με σὺ ἀναγκάζεις, ἀλλὰ ψευδομάρτυρας πολλοὺς κατ' ἐμοῦ παρασχόμενος ἐπιχειρεῖς ἐκβάλλειν με ἐκ τῆς οὐσίας καὶ τοῦ ἀληθοῦς. ἐγὼ δὲ ἂν μὴ σὲ αὐτὸν ἓνα ὄντα μάρτυρα παράσχωμαι ὁμολογοῦντα περὶ ὧν λέγω, οὐδὲν οἶμαι ἄξιον λόγου μοι πεπεράνθαι περὶ ὧν ἂν ἡμῖν ὁ λόγος ᾗ· οἶμαι δὲ οὐδὲ σοί, ἐὰν μὴ ἐγὼ σοι μαρτυρῶ εἰς ὧν μόνος, τοὺς δ' ἄλλους πάντας τούτους χαίρειν ἔᾱς. ἔστιν μὲν οὖν οὗτός τις τρόπος

ἐλέγχου, ὥς σύ τε οἶει καὶ ἄλλοι πολλοί· ἔστιν δὲ καὶ ἄλλος, ὃν ἐγὼ αὖ οἶμαι. παραβαλόντες οὖν παρ' ἀλλήλους σκεψώμεθα εἴ τι διοίσουσιν ἀλλήλων. καὶ γὰρ καὶ τυγχάνει περὶ ὧν ἀμφισβητοῦμεν οὐ πάνυ σμικρὰ ὄντα, ἀλλὰ σχεδόν τι ταῦτα περὶ ὧν εἰδέναι τε κάλλιστον μὴ εἰδέναι τε αἰσχιστον· τὸ γὰρ κεφάλαιον αὐτῶν ἐστὶν ἢ γιγνώσκειν ἢ ἀγνοεῖν ὅστις τε εὐδαίμων ἐστὶν καὶ

472d

PO: Very much so.

472d

S: But I say this is impossible. That is one issue we are disputing. So be it. He will be happy although he is acting unjustly, but what if he meets with justice and punishment?

472d

PO: He's least happy, since he would be utterly wretched under those circumstances.

ὅστις μὴ. αὐτίκα πρῶτον, περὶ οὗ νῦν ὁ λόγος ἐστίν, σὺ ἡγῇ οἷόν τε εἶναι μακάριον ἄνδρα ἀδικοῦντά τε καὶ ἄδικον ὄντα, εἴπερ Ἀρχέλαον ἄδικον μὲν ἡγῇ εἶναι, εὐδαίμονα δέ. ἄλλο τι ὥς οὕτω σου νομίζοντος διανοώμεθα; ΠΩΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. ἐγὼ δέ φημι ἀδύνατον. ἔν μὲν τουτὶ ἀμφισβητοῦμεν. εἶεν· ἀδικῶν δὲ δὴ εὐδαίμων ἔσται ἄρ', ἂν τυγχάνῃ δίκης τε καὶ τιμωρίας; ΠΩΛ. ἥκιστα γε, ἐπεὶ οὕτω γ' ἂν ἀθλιώτατος εἴη.

472e

S: But if the person acting unjustly does not meet with justice, then, according to your account, he will be happy.

472e

PO: I agree.

472e

S: But in my view, Polus, the one who is unjust and acting unjustly is utterly wretched anyway. However, he is more wretched if he does not pay a penalty and does not receive punishment as a wrongdoer. But he is less wretched if he does pay a penalty and meets with justice at the hands of gods and men.

ΣΩ. ἀλλ' ἐὰν ἄρα μὴ τυγχάνῃ δίκης ὁ ἀδικῶν, κατὰ τὸν σὸν λόγον εὐδαίμων ἔσται; ΠΩΛ. φημί. ΣΩ. κατὰ δέ γε τὴν ἐμὴν δόξαν, ὦ Πῶλε, ὁ ἀδικῶν τε καὶ ὁ ἄδικος πάντως μὲν ἄθλιος, ἀθλιώτερος μέντοι ἐὰν μὴ διδῷ δίκην μηδὲ τυγχάνῃ τιμωρίας ἀδικῶν, ἥττον δὲ ἄθλιος ἐὰν διδῷ δίκην καὶ τυγχάνῃ δίκης ὑπὸ θεῶν τε καὶ ἀνθρώπων.

473a

PO: You are trying to express some strange notions, Socrates.

473a

S: And I shall also try anyway to make you, my colleague, say the same things to me, for I regard you as a friend. Well then, these are the issues on which we now differ, and you should consider these. Did I not say a while ago that doing injustice is worse than suffering it?

473a

PO: You certainly did.

473a

S: But you said suffering injustice is worse.

473a

PO: Yes.

473a

S: And I said that those who act unjustly are wretched, and I was refuted by you.

473a

PO: Yes, by Zeus.

ΠΩΛ. ἄτοπὰ γε, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἐπιχειρεῖς λέγειν. ΣΩ. πειράσομαι δέ γε καὶ σὲ ποιῆσαι, ὦ ἑταῖρε, ταῦτ' ἐμοὶ λέγειν· φίλον γάρ σε ἡγοῦμαι. νῦν μὲν οὖν ἂν διαφερόμεθα ταῦτ' ἐστίν· σκόπει δὲ καὶ σύ. εἶπον ἐγώ που ἐν τοῖς ἔμπροσθεν τὸ ἀδικεῖν τοῦ ἀδικεῖσθαι κάκιον εἶναι. ΠΩΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. σὺ δὲ τὸ ἀδικεῖσθαι. ΠΩΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. καὶ τοὺς ἀδικοῦντας ἀθλίους ἔφην εἶναι ἐγώ, καὶ ἐξηλέγχθην ὑπὸ σοῦ. ΠΩΛ. ναὶ μὰ Δία.

473b

S: So you think, Polus.

473b

PO: What I think is true.

473b

S: Perhaps, and you say anyway that those who act unjustly are happy, provided they do not pay a penalty.

473b

PO: Yes, certainly.

473b

S: And I say these people are utterly wretched, but those who pay a penalty are less so. Would you also like to refute this?

473b

PO: Oh, Socrates, this is even more difficult to refute than the other.

473b

S: Not at all, Polus, it is impossible! For the truth is never refuted.

ΣΩ. ὥς σύ γε οἶει, ὦ Πῶλε. ΠΩΛ. ἀληθῆ γε οἰόμενος. ΣΩ. ἴσως. σὺ δέ γε εὐδαίμονας αὖ τοὺς ἀδικοῦντας, ἐὰν μὴ διδῶσι δίκην. ΠΩΛ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. ἐγὼ δέ γε αὐτοὺς ἀθλιωτάτους φημί, τοὺς δὲ διδόντας δίκην ἥττον. βούλει καὶ τοῦτο ἐλέγχειν; ΠΩΛ. ἀλλ' ἔτι τοῦτ' ἐκείνου χαλεπώτερόν ἐστιν, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἐξελέγξαι. ΣΩ. οὐ δῆτα, ὦ Πῶλε, ἀλλ' ἀδύνατον· τὸ γὰρ ἀληθές οὐδέποτε ἐλέγχεται. ΠΩΛ. πῶς λέγεις; ἐὰν ἀδικῶν ἄνθρωπος ληφθῇ τυραννίδι

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PO: What are you saying? If a man is caught engaging in unjust action, striving to become a tyrant, and is put on the rack, castrated, has his eyes burned out, and is subjected to a host of other outrageous abuses, sees his own children and wife abused too, and is finally impaled and tarred, will this fellow be happier than if he had evaded this, set himself up as a tyrant, and spent his life ruling the city, doing as he wished, envied and accounted happy by citizens and strangers alike? Are you saying that all this is impossible to refute?

ἐπιβουλεύων, καὶ ληφθεὶς στρεβλῶται καὶ ἐκτέμνηται καὶ τοὺς ὀφθαλμοὺς ἐκκάηται, καὶ ἄλλας πολλὰς καὶ μεγάλας καὶ παντοδαπὰς λῶβας αὐτός τε λωβηθεὶς καὶ τοὺς αὐτοῦ ἐπιδὼν παῖδάς τε καὶ γυναῖκα

τὸ ἔσχατον ἀνασταυρωθῇ ἢ καταπιττωθῇ, οὗτος εὐδαιμονέστερος ἔσται ἢ ἂν διαφυγὼν τύραννος καταστῇ καὶ ἄρχων ἐν τῇ πόλει διαβιῶ ποιῶν ὅτι ἂν βούληται, ζηλωτὸς ὢν καὶ εὐδαιμονιζόμενος ὑπὸ τῶν

473d

S: Now, you are telling horror stories, noble Polus, and a moment ago you were calling witnesses, but you are not engaging in refutation. But in any case, remind me of one detail. Did you say he was striving unjustly to become a tyrant?

473d

Po: I did.

πολιτῶν καὶ τῶν ἄλλων ξένων; ταῦτα λέγεις ἀδύνατον εἶναι ἐξελέγχειν; ΣΩ. μορμολύττη αὖ, ὦ γενναῖε Πῶλε, καὶ οὐκ ἐλέγχεις ἄρτι δὲ ἐμαρτύρου. ὅμως δὲ ὑπόμνησόν με σμικρόν. ἂν ἀδίκως ἐπιβουλεύων τυραννίδι, εἶπες; ΠΩΛ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. εὐδαιμονέστερος μὲν τοίνυν οὐδέποτε ἔσται οὐδέτερος αὐτῶν, οὔτε ὁ κατειργασμένος τὴν τυραννίδα ἀδίκως οὔτε ὁ διδοὺς δίκην—δυοῖν γὰρ ἀθλίοιιν εὐδαιμονέστερος μὲν

473e

S: Then neither of them will ever be happier, neither the one who manages to become a tyrant by unjust means nor the one who pays a penalty, for of two wretches, neither would be happier. However, the one who evades justice and becomes a tyrant is more wretched. What is this, Polus? Are you laughing? Is this yet another form of refutation – to laugh at someone when they say something, but not refute them?

473e

Po: Do you think you haven't been refuted, Socrates, when you are saying things the like of which no man at all would assert? Ask anyone here!

473e

S: Oh, Polus, I am not one of your politicians. And last year I was allotted membership of the Council,¹⁶ but when my tribe¹⁷ had the Presidency¹⁸ and I had to cast my vote, I became a figure of fun as I

was unable to cast it. So, do not call upon me now to take the votes of the people here. Rather, if you do not have a better refutation than these, then, as I said a moment ago, let me have my turn and try out the kind of refutation that I deem necessary. For I know how to furnish just one witness of what I am saying, the person with whom my conversation takes place, but I bid the multitudes farewell. And I know how to take the vote from one, and I do not even engage in discussions with multitudes. Now, let us see if you are prepared, in turn, to provide an opportunity for refutation by answering whatever you are asked. Indeed, I am of the view that both you and I, and all these other men, hold that doing injustice is worse than suffering injustice, and not paying a penalty is worse than paying it.

οὐκ ἂν εἴη—ἀθλιώτερος μέντοι ὁ διαφεύγων καὶ τυραννεύσας. τί τοῦτο, ὦ Πῶλε; γελαῖς; ἄλλο αὖ τοῦτο εἶδος ἐλέγχου ἐστίν, ἐπειδὴν τίς τι εἶπῃ, καταγελαῖν, ἐλέγχειν δὲ μή; ΠΩΛ. οὐκ οἶμι ἐξεληλέγχθαι, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὅταν τοιαῦτα λέγῃς ἃ οὐδεὶς ἂν φήσειεν ἀνθρώπων; ἐπεὶ ἐροῦ τίνα τουτωνί. ΣΩ. ὦ Πῶλε, οὐκ εἰμὶ τῶν πολιτικῶν, καὶ πέρυσιν βουλευεῖν λαχὼν, ἐπειδὴ ἡ φυλὴ ἐπρυτάνευε καὶ ἔδει με ἐπιψηφίζειν, γέλῳτα παρεῖχον καὶ οὐκ ἠπιστάμην ἐπιψηφίζειν. μὴ οὖν μηδὲ νῦν με κέλευε ἐπιψηφίζειν τοὺς παρόντας, ἀλλ' εἰ μὴ ἔχεις τούτων βελτίῳ ἔλεγχον, ὅπερ νυνδὴ ἐγὼ ἔλεγον, ἐμοὶ ἐν τῷ μέρει παράδος, καὶ πείρασαι τοῦ ἐλέγχου οἷον ἐγὼ οἶμαι δεῖν εἶναι. ἐγὼ γὰρ ὣν ἂν λέγω ἓνα μὲν παρασχέσθαι μάρτυρα ἐπίσταμαι, αὐτὸν πρὸς ὃν ἂν μοι ὁ λόγος ᾗ, τοὺς δὲ πολλοὺς ἐῷ χαίρειν, καὶ ἓνα ἐπιψηφίζειν ἐπίσταμαι, τοῖς δὲ

474b

PO: I, for one, don't think that I or any other man at all holds this view. So, would you accept the infliction of injustice in preference to acting unjustly?

474b

S: Yes. You would too, and so would everyone else.

474b

PO: Far from it. No. I wouldn't, you wouldn't, and neither would anyone else.

474b

S: In that case, will you respond?

474b

PO: Yes, certainly. In fact, I am eager to know what precisely you are going to say.

474b

S: Then, Polus, so that you may know, tell me, as if I were questioning you from the beginning, which seems worse to you, doing injustice or suffering injustice?

πολλοῖς οὐδὲ διαλέγομαι. ὅρα οὖν εἰ ἐθελήσεις ἐν τῷ μέρει διδόναι ἔλεγχον ἀποκρινόμενος τὰ ἐρωτώμενα. ἐγὼ γὰρ δὴ οἶμαι καὶ ἐμὲ καὶ σὲ καὶ τοὺς ἄλλους ἀνθρώπους τὸ ἀδικεῖν τοῦ ἀδικεῖσθαι κάκιον ἡγεῖσθαι καὶ τὸ μὴ διδόναι δίκην τοῦ διδόναι. ΠΩΛ. ἐγὼ δέ γε οὔτ' ἐμὲ οὔτ' ἄλλον ἀνθρώπων οὐδένα. ἐπεὶ σὺ δέξαι' ἂν μᾶλλον ἀδικεῖσθαι ἢ ἀδικεῖν; ΣΩ. καὶ σύ γ' ἂν καὶ οἱ ἄλλοι πάντες. ΠΩΛ. πολλοῦ γε δεῖ, ἀλλ' οὔτ' ἐγὼ οὔτε σὺ οὔτ' ἄλλος οὐδεὶς.

474c

PO: Suffering injustice, in my view anyway.

474c

S: But what about this? Which is the more base, doing injustice or suffering injustice? Answer.

474c

PO: Doing injustice.

474c

S: In that case, it is also worse if, in fact, it is more base.

474c

PO: Not in the least.

474c

S: I understand. It seems you do not think that noble and good, bad and base are the same.

474c

PO: Of course not.

ΣΩ. οὐκ οὐκ ἀποκρινῆς; ΠΩΛ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν· καὶ γὰρ ἐπιθυμῶ εἰδέναι ὅτι ποτ' ἔρεῖς. ΣΩ. λέγε δὴ μοι, ἴν' εἰδῆς, ὥσπερ ἂν εἰ ἐξ ἀρχῆς σε ἡρώτων· πότερον δοκεῖ σοι, ὦ Πῶλε, κάκιον εἶναι, τὸ ἀδικεῖν ἢ τὸ ἀδικεῖσθαι; ΠΩΛ. τὸ ἀδικεῖσθαι ἔμοιγε. ΣΩ. τί δὲ δὴ; αἴσχιον πότερον τὸ ἀδικεῖν ἢ τὸ ἀδικεῖσθαι; ἀποκρίνου. ΠΩΛ. τὸ ἀδικεῖν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ κάκιον, εἴπερ αἴσχιον. ΠΩΛ. ἥκιστα γε. ΣΩ. μανθάνω οὐ

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S: What about the following? In the case of anything noble, such as bodies, colours, shapes, sounds and activities, do you refer to each of them as noble without looking to something else? Firstly, for instance, do you not say that noble bodies are noble either on the basis of their use, what each is useful for, or on the basis of some pleasure, if the beholding engenders delight in the beholders? Have you anything besides this to say about the nobility of the body?

474d

PO: I have not.

ταῦτόν ἡγῆ σύ, ὡς ἔοικας, καλόν τε καὶ ἀγαθὸν καὶ κακὸν καὶ αἰσχρόν. ΠΩΛ. οὐ δῆτα. ΣΩ. τί δὲ τότε; τὰ καλὰ πάντα, οἷον καὶ σώματα καὶ χρώματα καὶ σχήματα καὶ φωνὰς καὶ ἐπιτηδεύματα, εἰς οὐδὲν ἀποβλέπων καλεῖς ἐκάστοτε καλὰ; οἷον πρῶτον τὰ σώματα τὰ καλὰ οὐχὶ ἦτοι κατὰ τὴν χρεῖαν λέγεις καλὰ εἶναι, πρὸς δ' ἂν ἕκαστον χρήσιμον ᾗ, πρὸς τοῦτο, ἢ κατὰ ἡδονήν τινα, ἐὰν ἐν τῷ θεωρεῖσθαι χαίρειν ποιῇ τοὺς θεωροῦντας; ἔχεις τι ἐκτὸς τούτων λέγειν περὶ σώματος κάλλους; ΠΩΛ. οὐκ ἔχω. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ τᾶλλα πάντα οὕτω καὶ σχήματα καὶ χρώματα ἢ διὰ ἡδονήν τινα ἢ διὰ ὠφελίαν ἢ δι' ἀμφοτέρα καλὰ προσαγορεύεις; ΠΩΛ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. οὐ καὶ τὰς φωνὰς καὶ τὰ κατὰ τὴν μουσικὴν πάντα ὡσαύτως; ΠΩΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν τὰ γε κατὰ τοὺς νόμους καὶ τὰ ἐπιτηδεύματα οὐ δήπου ἐκτὸς τούτων ἐστίν, τὰ καλὰ, τοῦ ἢ ὠφέλιμα εἶναι ἢ ἡδέα ἢ ἀμφοτέρα.

475a

S: Does not the same apply to all the others, and do you not refer to shapes and colours as noble because of some pleasure or benefit or both?

475a

PO: I do indeed.

475a

S: Do you not also refer similarly to sounds and all elements associated with music?

475a

PO: Yes.

475a

S: And, indeed, in the case of the laws or any activities, these presumably are not noble because of anything apart from being beneficial or pleasant or both.

475a

PO: I don't think so anyway.

475a

S: Does not the same apply to the nobility of whatever we learn?

475a

PO: Yes, certainly. And you are defining this nicely now, Socrates, defining the noble in terms of pleasure and goodness.

475a

S: Do we not define the base in terms of the opposite, in terms of pain and by badness?

475a

PO: Necessarily.

475a

S: So, whenever there are two noble things and one is more noble than the other, it is more noble by exceeding in one or both of these factors, in pleasure or in benefit or in both.

475a

PO: Yes, certainly.

ΠΩΛ. οὐκ ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ τὸ τῶν μαθημάτων κάλλος ὡσαύτως; ΠΩΛ. πάνυ γε καὶ καλῶς γε νῦν ὀρίζῃ, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἡδονῇ τε καὶ ἀγαθῷ ὀριζόμενος τὸ καλόν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τὸ αἰσχρὸν τῷ ἐναντίῳ,

λύπη τε καὶ κακῶ; ΠΩΛ. ἀνάγκη. ΣΩ. ὅταν ἄρα δυοῖν καλοῖν θάτερον κάλλιον ᾦ, ἢ τῷ ἑτέρῳ τούτοις ἢ ἀμφοτέροις ὑπερβάλλον κάλλιον ἐστίν, ἥτοι ἡδονῇ ἢ ὠφελίᾳ ἢ ἀμφοτέροις, ΠΩΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. καὶ ὅταν δὲ δὴ δυοῖν αἰσχροῖν τὸ

475b

S: But when the two are base, and one is more base, it will be more base by exceeding either in pain or in badness. Must not this be so?

475b

PO: Yes.

475b

S: Come then! What was said just now about doing injustice and suffering injustice? Did you not say that suffering injustice is more bad, and doing injustice is more base?

475b

PO: I said so.

475b

S: Therefore, if, in fact, doing injustice is more base than suffering injustice, it is either more painful and would be more base by exceeding it in pain or in badness, or in both. Is this not also necessarily so?

475b

PO: How could it not be so?

ἕτερον αἴσχιον ᾦ, ἥτοι λύπη ἢ κακῶ ὑπερβάλλον αἴσχιον ἔσται· ἢ οὐκ ἀνάγκη; ΠΩΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. φέρε δὴ, πῶς ἐλέγετο νυνδὴ περὶ τοῦ ἀδικεῖν καὶ ἀδικεῖσθαι; οὐκ ἔλεγες τὸ μὲν ἀδικεῖσθαι κάκιον εἶναι, τὸ δὲ ἀδικεῖν αἴσχιον; ΠΩΛ. ἔλεγον. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν εἴπερ αἴσχιον τὸ ἀδικεῖν τοῦ ἀδικεῖσθαι, ἥτοι λυπηρότερόν ἐστιν καὶ λύπη ὑπερβάλλον αἴσχιον ἂν εἴη ἢ κακῶ ἢ ἀμφοτέροις; οὐ καὶ τοῦτο ἀνάγκη; ΠΩΛ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΣΩ. πρῶτον

475c

S: Then let us consider this first. Does the perpetration of injustice exceed the suffering of injustice in pain, and are those who act

unjustly more pained than those who suffer injustice?

475c

PO: Not at all, Socrates. It is not this.

475c

S: So, it does not exceed it in pain anyway.

475c

PO: Certainly not.

475c

S: Therefore, if it does not exceed it in pain, it would not exceed it in both.

475c

PO: Apparently not.

475c

S: In that case only the other factor remains.

475c

PO: Yes.

475c

S: The badness.

475c

PO: So it seems.

475c

S: Therefore, doing injustice would be worse than suffering injustice because it exceeds it in badness.

475c

PO: Yes, that is obvious.

μὲν δὴ σκεψώμεθα, ἄρα λύπη ὑπερβάλλει τὸ ἀδικεῖν τοῦ ἀδικεῖσθαι, καὶ ἀλγοῦσι μᾶλλον οἱ ἀδικοῦντες ἢ οἱ ἀδικούμενοι; ΠΩΛ. οὐδαμῶς, ὦ Σώκρατες, τοῦτό γε. ΣΩ. οὐκ ἄρα λύπη γε ὑπέρχει. ΠΩΛ. οὐ δῆτα. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν εἰ μὴ λύπη, ἀμφοτέροις μὲν οὐκ ἂν ἔτι ὑπερβάλλοι. ΠΩΛ. οὐ φαίνεται. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τῷ ἐτέρῳ λείπεται. ΠΩΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. τῷ κακῷ. ΠΩΛ. ἔοικεν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν κακῷ ὑπερβάλλον τὸ ἀδικεῖν κάκιον ἂν εἴη τοῦ ἀδικεῖσθαι. ΠΩΛ. δῆλον δὴ ὅτι.

475d

S: Do not most men agree, and did you not agree with me a while ago, that doing injustice is more base than suffering injustice?

475d

PO: Yes.

475d

S: But now it turns out to be more bad.

475d

PO: So it seems.

475d

S: Well, would you accept the more base and bad in preference to what is less so? Do not be reluctant to answer, Polus, for no harm will come to you. Just surrender nobly to the argument as though it were a physician. Answer, and either affirm or deny whatever I ask you.

ΣΩ. ἄλλο τι οὖν ὑπὸ μὲν τῶν πολλῶν ἀνθρώπων καὶ ὑπὸ σοῦ ὠμολογεῖτο ἡμῖν ἐν τῷ ἔμπροσθεν χρόνῳ αἴσχιον εἶναι τὸ ἀδικεῖν τοῦ ἀδικεῖσθαι; ΠΩΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. νῦν δέ γε κάκιον ἐφάνη. ΠΩΛ. ἔοικε. ΣΩ. δέξαι οὖν σὺ μᾶλλον τὸ κάκιον καὶ τὸ αἴσχιον ἀντὶ τοῦ ἥττον; μὴ ὀκνεῖ ἀποκρίνασθαι, ὦ Πῶλε· οὐδὲν γὰρ βλαβήσῃ· ἀλλὰ γενναίως τῷ λόγῳ ὥσπερ ἰατρῷ παρέχων ἀποκρίνου, καὶ ἦ

475e

PO: No, I would not accept that, Socrates.

475e

S: Would any other man?

475e

PO: I do not think so, not on the basis of this argument anyway.

475e

S: So, I was speaking the truth. Neither I, nor you, nor any other man, would accept the perpetration of injustice rather than suffer injustice, for it happens to be more bad.

475e

PO: So it appears.

475e

S: Now, you see, Polus, that when one mode of refutation is set alongside the other, there is no resemblance between them. Although everyone else agrees with you except me, you are sufficient for me, one solitary person who agrees with me and testifies for me, and I am taking the vote from you alone and bidding the others farewell. And let that be our conclusion on this matter. Let us go on now and consider the second issue we were disputing about: whether, as you believe, the greatest evil for someone acting unjustly is to pay a penalty or, as I believe, the greater evil is not to pay a penalty. Let us look at it this way. Do you refer to paying a penalty and being justly disciplined for acting unjustly as the same thing?

φάθι ἢ μὴ ἂ ἐρωτῶ. ΠΩΛ. ἀλλ' οὐκ ἂν δεξαίμην, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. ἄλλος δέ τις ἀνθρώπων; ΠΩΛ. οὐ μοι δοκεῖ κατὰ γε τοῦτον τὸν λόγον. ΣΩ. ἀληθῆ ἄρα ἐγὼ ἔλεγον, ὅτι οὐτ' ἂν ἐγὼ οὐτ' ἂν σὺ οὐτ' ἄλλος οὐδεὶς ἀνθρώπων δέξαιτ' ἂν μᾶλλον ἀδικεῖν ἢ ἀδικεῖσθαι· κάκιον γὰρ τυγχάνει ὄν. ΠΩΛ. φαίνεται. ΣΩ. ὁρᾷς οὖν, ὦ Πῶλε, ὁ ἔλεγχος παρὰ τὸν ἔλεγχον παραβαλλόμενος ὅτι οὐδὲν ἔοικεν, ἀλλὰ σοὶ μὲν οἱ ἄλλοι πάντες ὁμολογοῦσιν πλὴν ἐμοῦ, ἐμοὶ δὲ σὺ ἐξαρκεῖς εἰς ὧν

476a

PO: I do.

476a

S: Now, can you deny that everything that is just is noble, insofar as it is just? Think carefully before you answer.

476a

PO: I don't think I can deny this, Socrates.

476a

S: Then consider this too. If someone does something, must there also be something that suffers at the hands of that doer?

476a

PO: I think so.

476a

S: And does it experience what the doer enacts, and in the manner that the doer enacts it? I mean, for instance, that if someone is striking, something must be struck.

μόνος καὶ ὁμολογῶν καὶ μαρτυρῶν, καὶ ἐγὼ σὲ μόνον ἐπιψηφίζων τοὺς ἄλλους ἕω χαίρειν. καὶ τοῦτο μὲν ἡμῖν οὕτως ἔχεται μετὰ τοῦτο δὲ περὶ οὗ τὸ δεύτερον ἡμφεσβητήσαμεν σκεψώμεθα, τὸ ἀδικοῦντα διδόναι δίκην ἄρα μέγιστον τῶν κακῶν ἐστίν, ὡς σὺ ῥου, ἢ μείζον τὸ μὴ διδόναι, ὡς αὖ ἐγὼ ὥμην. σκοπώμεθα δὲ τῇδε· τὸ διδόναι δίκην καὶ τὸ κολάζεσθαι δικαίως ἀδικοῦντα ἄρα τὸ αὐτὸ καλεῖς; ΠΩΛ. ἔγωγε.

476b

PO: It must.

476b

S: And if the striker strikes forcibly or quickly, is whatever is struck, struck in like manner?

476b

PO: Yes.

476b

S: So, is the experience of whatever is struck akin to what the striker does?

476b

PO: Entirely so.

476b

S: Also, in the case in which someone burns, is it necessary that something be burned?

476b

PO: How could it be otherwise?

476b

S: And if he burns intensely or painfully, is whatever is burned, burned in the manner in which the burner burns?

476b

PO: Entirely so.

ΣΩ. ἔχεις οὖν λέγειν ὡς οὐχὶ τά γε δίκαια πάντα καλὰ ἐστίν, καθ' ὅσον δίκαια; καὶ διασκεψάμενος εἰπέ. ΠΩΛ. ἀλλὰ μοι δοκεῖ, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. σκόπει δὴ καὶ τόδε· ἄρα εἴ τίς τι ποιεῖ, ἀνάγκη τι εἶναι καὶ πάσχον ὑπὸ τούτου τοῦ ποιοῦντος; ΠΩΛ. ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ. ΣΩ. ἄρα τοῦτο πάσχον ὃ τὸ ποιοῦν ποιεῖ, καὶ τοιοῦτον οἷον ποιεῖ τὸ ποιοῦν; λέγω δὲ τὸ τοιόνδε· εἴ τις τύπτει, ἀνάγκη τι τύπτεσθαι; ΠΩΛ. ἀνάγκη. ΣΩ. καὶ εἰ σφόδρα τύπτει ἢ ταχὺ ὃ

476c

S: And in the case in which someone cuts, does the same argument apply?

476c

PO: Yes.

476c

S: And if the cut is large or deep or painful, is whatever is cut, cut with the sort of cut that the cutter inflicts?

476c

PO: Apparently.

476c

S: Now, see if you agree with the concise statement I made earlier: in all circumstances, the sort of thing the doer does is the sort of thing the sufferer suffers.

476c

PO: Yes, I agree.

τύπτων, οὕτω καὶ τὸ τυπτόμενον τύπτεσθαι; ΠΩΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. τοιοῦτον ἄρα πάθος τῷ τυπτομένῳ ἐστὶν οἷον ἂν τὸ τύπτον ποιῇ; ΠΩΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ εἰ κάει τις, ἀνάγκη τι κάεσθαι; ΠΩΛ. πῶς γὰρ οὔ; ΣΩ. καὶ εἰ σφόδρα γε κάει ἢ ἀλγεινῶς, οὕτω κάεσθαι τὸ καόμενον ὡς ἂν τὸ καῶν ἀή; ΠΩΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ εἰ τέμνει τι, ὃ αὐτὸς λόγος; τέμνεται γάρ τι. ΠΩΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. καὶ εἰ μέγα γε ἢ βαθὺ τὸ τμήμα ἢ ἀλγεινόν, τοιοῦτον

476d

S: Well, based upon what we have agreed, is paying a penalty something that is suffered or something that is done?

476d

PO: It must be something that is suffered, Socrates.

476d

S: Therefore, it is being done by someone.

476d

PO: How could it not be? By the one who disciplines him.

τμήμα τέμνεται τὸ τεμνόμενον οἶον τὸ τέμνον τέμνει; ΠΩΛ. φαίνεται. ΣΩ. συλλήβδην δὴ ὅρα εἰ ὁμολογεῖς, ὃ ἄρτι ἔλεγον, περὶ πάντων, οἶον ἂν ποιῇ τὸ ποιοῦν, τοιοῦτον τὸ πάσχον πάσχειν. ΠΩΛ. ἀλλ' ὁμολογῶ. ΣΩ. τούτων δὴ ὁμολογουμένων, τὸ δίκην δίδοναι πότερον πάσχειν τί ἐστὶν ἢ ποιεῖν; ΠΩΛ. ἀνάγκη, ὦ Σώκρατες, πάσχειν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ὑπό τινος ποιοῦντος; ΠΩΛ. πῶς γὰρ οὔ; ὑπὸ γε τοῦ κολάζοντος. ΣΩ. ὁ δὲ ὀρθῶς κολάζων

476e

S: And does he who disciplines rightly discipline justly?

476e

PO: Yes.

476e

S: Is he performing just actions or is he not?

476e

PO: The actions are just.

476e

S: Therefore, is it the case that the one who is disciplined and pays a penalty suffers just actions?

476e

PO: Apparently.

476e

S: And it is agreed, I presume, that just actions are noble.

476e

PO: Entirely so.

476e

S: So, one of these people performs what is noble, and the other, the one who is disciplined, experiences this.

476e

PO: Yes.

δικαίως κολάζει; ΠΩΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. δίκαια ποιῶν ἢ οὐ; ΠΩΛ. δίκαια. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ὁ κολαζόμενος δίκην διδούς δίκαια πάσχει; ΠΩΛ. φαίνεται. ΣΩ. τὰ δὲ δίκαιά που καλὰ ὡμολόγηται; ΠΩΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. τούτων ἄρα ὁ μὲν ποιεῖ καλά, ὁ δὲ πάσχει, ὁ κολαζόμενος. ΠΩΛ. ναί.

477a

S: Therefore, since they are noble, are they good? For noble actions are either pleasant or beneficial.

477a

PO: Necessarily.

477a

S: So, the person who pays a penalty experiences what is good?

477a

PO: So it seems.

477a

S: So, he is benefited?

477a

PO: Yes.

477a

S: Is the benefit what I presume it to be? That his soul becomes better, if, in fact, he is justly disciplined.

477a

PO: Quite likely.

477a

S: So, is a person who pays a penalty released from badness of soul?

477a

PO: Yes.

ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν εἴπερ καλὰ, ἀγαθὰ; ἢ γὰρ ἡδέα ἢ ὠφέλιμα. ΠΩΛ. ἀνάγκη.
 ΣΩ. ἀγαθὰ ἄρα πάσχει ὁ δίκην διδούς; ΠΩΛ. ἔοικεν. ΣΩ. ὠφελεῖται ἄρα;
 ΠΩΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. ἄρα ἦν περ ἐγὼ ὑπολαμβάνω τὴν ὠφελίαν; βελτίων τὴν
 ψυχὴν γίγνεται, εἴπερ δικαίως κολάζεται; ΠΩΛ. εἰκός γε. ΣΩ. κακίας
 ἄρα ψυχῆς ἀπαλλάττεται ὁ δίκην διδούς; ΠΩΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. ἄρα οὖν τοῦ
 μεγίστου ἀπαλλάττεται

477b

S: In that case, is he released from the very worst badness? Think about this. When it comes to the state of a man's property, can you envisage any badness besides poverty?

477b

PO: No, only poverty.

477b

S: What about the condition of the body? Would you say that the badness is illness, disease, uncomeliness and the like?

477b

PO: I would.

477b

S: Do you not think that there is also some vice in the soul?

477b

PO: How could there not be?

477b

S: Do you not refer to this as injustice, ignorance, cowardice, and the like?

477b

PO: Yes, certainly.

κακοῦ; ὧδε δὲ σκόπει· ἐν χρημάτων κατασκευῇ ἀνθρώπου κακίαν
 ἄλλην τινὰ ἐνορᾷς ἢ πενίαν; ΠΩΛ. οὐκ, ἀλλὰ πενίαν. ΣΩ. τί δ' ἐν
 σώματος κατασκευῇ; κακίαν ἂν φήσας ἀσθένειαν εἶναι καὶ νόσον καὶ
 αἷσχος καὶ τὰ τοιαῦτα; ΠΩΛ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ ἐν ψυχῇ πονηρίαν
 ἡγῇ τινα εἶναι; ΠΩΛ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΣΩ. ταύτην οὖν οὐκ ἀδικίαν καλεῖς

καὶ ἀμαθίαν καὶ δειλίαν καὶ τὰ τοιαῦτα; ΠΩΛ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ.
οὐκοῦν χρημάτων

477c

S: Since there are wealth, body and soul, these three, you have mentioned three vices, poverty, disease and injustice.

477c

PO: Yes.

477c

S: Which of these vices is the most base? Is it not injustice, in short, the vice of the soul?

477c

PO: Very much so.

477c

S: If it is indeed the most base, is it also the worst?

477c

PO: What do you mean, Socrates?

477c

S: This. On the basis of what was agreed earlier, the base is always base either because it produces the greatest pain or harm, or both.

477c

PO: Certainly.

καὶ σώματος καὶ ψυχῆς, τριῶν ὄντων, τριττὰς εἴρηκας πονηρίας, πενίαν, νόσον, ἀδικίαν; ΠΩΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. τίς οὖν τούτων τῶν πονηριῶν αἰσχίστη; οὐχ ἡ ἀδικία καὶ συλλήβδην ἢ τῆς ψυχῆς πονηρία; ΠΩΛ. πολὺ γε. ΣΩ. εἰ δὴ αἰσχίστη, καὶ κακίστη; ΠΩΛ. πῶς, ὦ Σώκρατες, λέγεις; ΣΩ. ὡδί· ἀεὶ τὸ αἰσχιστόν ἥτοι λύπην μεγίστην παρέχον ἢ βλάβην ἢ ἀμφοτέρα αἰσχιστόν ἐστιν ἐκ τῶν ὡμολογημένων ἐν τῷ ἔμπροσθεν. ΠΩΛ. μάλιστα. ΣΩ. αἰσχιστόν δὲ ἀδικία καὶ σύμπασα ψυχῆς πονηρία νυνδὴ

477d

S: And did we just agree that what is most base is injustice and all vice of the soul?

477d

PO: Yes, we agreed.

477d

S: Therefore, it is either the most distressing, and is the most base of these, because it exceeds in distress or in harm, or in both.

ὡμολόγηται ἡμῖν; ΠΩΛ. ὡμολόγηται γάρ. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἡ ἀνιαρρότατόν ἐστι καὶ ἀνία ὑπερβάλλον αἴσχιστον τούτων ἐστὶν ἡ βλάβη ἢ ἀμφοτέρα; ΠΩΛ. ἀνάγκη. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν ἀλγεινότερόν ἐστιν τοῦ πένεσθαι καὶ κάμνειν τὸ ἄδικον εἶναι καὶ ἀκόλαστον καὶ δειλὸν καὶ ἀμαθῆ; ΠΩΛ. οὐκ ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἀπὸ τούτων γε. ΣΩ. ὑπερφυεῖ τινα ἄρα ὥς μεγάλη βλάβη καὶ κακῷ θαυμασίῳ ὑπερβάλλουσα

477e

PO: Necessarily.

477e

S: Now, are injustice and indiscipline, cowardice and ignorance, more painful than being poor or being ill?

477e

PO: I don't think so, not from these arguments anyway.

477e

S: Now, since by your account at least, the vice of the soul does not exceed the others in pain, it is the most base of them all because it exceeds them extraordinarily in some great harm and astounding badness.

477e

PO: Apparently.

477e

S: However, I presume that whatever exceeds to the greatest extent in harm would be the greatest badness that there is.

477e

PO: Yes.

477e

S: In that case, is injustice, indiscipline and the general vice of the soul the greatest badness that there is?

477e

PO: Apparently.

τᾶλλα ἢ τῆς ψυχῆς πονηρία αἰσχιστόν ἐστι πάντων, ἐπειδὴ οὐκ ἀλγηδόνι γε, ὥς ὁ σὸς λόγος. ΠΩΛ. φαίνεται. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ μήν που τό γε μέγιστη βλάβη ὑπερβάλλον μέγιστον ἂν κακὸν εἴη τῶν ὄντων. ΠΩΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. ἡ ἀδικία ἄρα καὶ ἡ ἀκολασία καὶ ἡ ἄλλη ψυχῆς πονηρία μέγιστον τῶν ὄντων κακόν ἐστιν; ΠΩΛ. φαίνεται. ΣΩ. τίς οὖν τέχνη πενίας ἀπαλλάττει; οὐ χρηματιστική; ΠΩΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. τίς δὲ νόσου; οὐκ ἰατρική;

478a

S: Which skill frees one from poverty? Is it not the skill of money-making?

478a

PO: Yes.

478a

S: What frees us from disease? Is it not medical skill?

478a

PO: Necessarily.

478a

S: And what frees us from vice and injustice? In case you have no ready answer, consider this. Where and to whom do we bring people whose bodies are ill?

478a

PO: To the physicians, Socrates.

478a

S: Where do we bring those who act unjustly or without discipline?

478a

PO: To the judges. Is that what you mean?

478a

S: So, that they may pay a penalty?

478a

PO: I agree.

478a

S: Now, do not the people who discipline them aright do so by recourse to some justice?

478a

PO: Obviously.

ΠΩΛ. ἀνάγκη. ΣΩ. τίς δὲ πονηρίας καὶ ἀδικίας; εἰ μὴ οὕτως εὐπορεῖς, ὥδε σκόπει· ποῖ ἄγομεν καὶ παρὰ τίνας τοὺς κάμνοντας τὰ σώματα; ΠΩΛ. παρὰ τοὺς ἰατρούς, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. ποῖ δὲ τοὺς ἀδικοῦντας καὶ τοὺς ἀκολασταίνοντας; ΠΩΛ. παρὰ τοὺς δικαστὰς λέγεις; ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν δίκην δώσοντας; ΠΩΛ. φημί. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν οὐ δικαιοσύνη τινὶ χρώμενοι κολάζουσιν οἱ ὀρθῶς κολάζοντες; ΠΩΛ. δήλον δή. ΣΩ. χρηματιστικὴ μὲν ἄρα πενίας ἀπαλλάττει,

478b

S: So, wealth-generation frees us from poverty, medical skill from disease, and justice from indiscipline and injustice.

478b

PO: Apparently.

478b

S: Then which of these is the noblest?

478b

PO: Of what?

478b

S: Of money-making, medical skill and justice.

478b

PO: Justice excels by far, Socrates.

478b

S: Furthermore, if, in fact, it is noblest, does it not produce the greatest pleasure or benefit or both?

478b

PO: Yes.

478b

S: Now, is medical treatment pleasant, and are those who undergo medical treatment pleased?

478b

PO: I do not think so.

478b

S: But it is beneficial anyway. Is this so?

478b

PO: Yes.

ιατρικὴ δὲ νόσου, δίκη δὲ ἀκολασίας καὶ ἀδικίας. ΠΩΛ. φαίνεται. ΣΩ. τί οὖν τούτων κάλλιστόν ἐστιν ὧν λέγεις; ΠΩΛ. τίνων λέγεις; ΣΩ. χρηματιστικῆς, ἱατρικῆς, δίκης. ΠΩΛ. πολὺ διαφέρει, ὃ Σώκρατες, ἡ δίκη. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν αὖ ἥτοι ἡδονὴν πλείστην ποιεῖ ἢ ὠφελίαν ἢ ἀμφοτέρω, εἴπερ κάλλιστόν ἐστιν; ΠΩΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν τὸ ἰατρεῦεσθαι ἡδὺ ἐστιν, καὶ χαίρουσιν οἱ ἰατρευόμενοι; ΠΩΛ. οὐκ ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' ὠφέλιμόν γε. ἢ γάρ; ΠΩΛ.

478c

S: For it brings release from enormous badness, and so it is advantageous to endure the distress and become healthy.

478c

PO: How could it not be?

478c

S: Now, on this basis, with regard to the body, would the happiest man be the one who has undergone medical treatment, or the one who was not even ill in the first place?

478c

PO: Obviously the one who was not even ill.

478c

S: Then it seems that happiness is not the release from badness, but not acquiring it in the first place.

478c

PO: This is so.

ναί. ΣΩ. μεγάλου γὰρ κακοῦ ἀπαλλάττεται, ὥστε λυσιτελεῖ ὑπομεῖναι τὴν ἀλγηδόνα καὶ ὑγιῇ εἶναι. ΠΩΛ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν οὕτως ἂν περὶ σῶμα εὐδαιμονέστατος ἄνθρωπος εἴη, ἰατρευόμενος, ἢ μηδὲ κάμνων ἀρχήν; ΠΩΛ. δῆλον ὅτι μηδὲ κάμνων. ΣΩ. οὐ γὰρ τοῦτ' ἦν εὐδαιμονία, ὡς ἔοικε, κακοῦ ἀπαλλαγῇ, ἀλλὰ τὴν ἀρχὴν μηδὲ κτῆσις. ΠΩΛ. ἔστι ταῦτα.

478d

S: What about this? If there are two people possessed of badness, either in body or in soul, which of the two is more wretched, the one who undergoes treatment and is released from the badness, or the one who does not undergo treatment and still has it?

478d

PO: The one who is not treated. So it appears to me.

478d

S: Was paying a penalty not a release from the greatest badness, namely vice?

478d

PO: It was.

478d

S: For justice, I suppose, makes one sound-minded and more just, and is a cure for evil.

478d

PO: Yes.

478d

S: So, the happiest person is the one who is possessed of no badness in soul, since this has turned out to be the worst badness of all.

ΣΩ. τί δέ; ἀθλιώτερος πότερος δυοῖν ἐχόντοιν κακὸν εἴτ' ἐν σώματι εἴτ' ἐν ψυχῇ, ὁ ἰατρευόμενος καὶ ἀπαλλαττόμενος τοῦ κακοῦ, ἢ ὁ μὴ ἰατρευόμενος, ἔχων δέ; ΠΩΛ. φαίνεται μοι ὁ μὴ ἰατρευόμενος. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τὸ δίκην διδόναι μεγίστου κακοῦ ἀπαλλαγὴ ἦν, πονηρίας; ΠΩΛ. ἦν γάρ. ΣΩ. σωφρονίζει γάρ που καὶ δικαιότερους ποιεῖ καὶ ἱατρικὴ

γίγνεται πονηρίας ἢ δίκη. ΠΩΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. εὐδαιμονέστατος μὲν ἄρα ὁ μὴ ἔχων κακίαν ἐν ψυχῇ, ἐπειδὴ τοῦτο

478e

PO: Yes, of course.

478e

S: Second happiest is, presumably, the person who is released from badness.

478e

PO: So it seems.

478e

S: And this is the fellow who is chastised, rebuked, and has paid a penalty.

478e

PO: Yes.

478e

S: So, the fellow who retains his badness and is not released from it lives the worst life.

478e

PO: Apparently.

478e

S: And is this not, in fact, the fellow who perpetrates the greatest injustices, and, despite using unjust means, arranges neither to be chastened nor disciplined nor to pay a penalty, just as you say Archelaus and other tyrants, rhetoricians and men of power contrive?

μέγιστον τῶν κακῶν ἐφάνη. ΠΩΛ. δήλον δὴ. ΣΩ. δεύτερος δέ που ὁ ἀπαλλαττόμενος. ΠΩΛ. ἔοικεν. ΣΩ. οὗτος δ' ἦν ὁ νουθετούμενός τε καὶ ἐπιπληττόμενος καὶ δίκην διδούς. ΠΩΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. κάκιστα ἄρα ζῇ ὁ ἔχων ἀδικίαν καὶ μὴ ἀπαλλαττόμενος. ΠΩΛ. φαίνεται. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν οὗτος τυγχάνει ὦν ὃς ἂν τὰ μέγιστα ἀδικῶν καὶ χρώμενος μεγίστη ἀδικίᾳ διαπράξεται ὥστε μήτε νουθετεῖσθαι

479a

PO: So it seems.

479a

S: Indeed, best of men, in a sense these fellows have almost arranged to be in the same predicament as someone afflicted with serious illnesses who contrives not to pay a penalty to the physicians for the aberrations of the body, or to undergo treatment, fearing the burning and the cutting, just like a child, because it is painful. Or does it not seem like that to you too?

μήτε κολάζεσθαι μήτε δίκην δίδοναι, ὥσπερ σὺ φῆς Ἀρχέλαον παρεσκευάσθαι καὶ τοὺς ἄλλους τυράννους καὶ ῥήτορας καὶ δυνάστας; ΠΩΛ. ἔοικε. ΣΩ. σχεδὸν γάρ που οὗτοι, ὧ ἄριστε, τὸ αὐτὸ διαπεπραγμένοι εἰσὶν ὥσπερ ἂν εἴ τις τοῖς μεγίστοις νοσήμασιν συνισχόμενος διαπράττειτο μὴ δίδοναι δίκην τῶν περὶ τὸ σῶμα ἀμαρτημάτων τοῖς ἰατροῖς μηδὲ ἰατρεύεσθαι, φοβούμενος ὥσπερ ἀνὴρ παῖς τὸ κάεσθαι καὶ τὸ τέμνεσθαι, ὅτι

479b

PO: It does.

479b

S: It seems they are somehow unaware of what health and excellence of body are like. For based upon what we have just concluded, these men who are evading justice, Polus, are also in danger of doing something similar: of clearly discerning the pain thereof but having a blind spot towards its benefit, and of being unaware of how much more wretched it is to live with a soul that is not healthy, a soul that is unsound, unjust and impious. Hence, they do anything so as neither to pay a penalty nor be released from this great badness, providing themselves with possessions and friends and the ability to speak as persuasively as possible. But if what we have agreed is true, Polus, can you see the consequences of the argument? Would you like me to sum them up?

ἀλγεινόν. ἢ οὐ δοκεῖ καὶ σοὶ οὕτω; ΠΩΛ. ἔμοιγε. ΣΩ. ἀγνοῶν γε, ὡς ἔοικεν, οἷόν ἐστιν ἡ ὑγίεια καὶ ἀρετὴ σώματος. κινδυνεύουσι γὰρ ἐκ τῶν νῦν ἡμῖν ὡμολογημένων τοιοῦτόν τι ποιεῖν καὶ οἱ τὴν δίκην φεύγοντες, ὧ Πῶλε, τὸ ἀλγεινὸν αὐτοῦ καθορᾶν, πρὸς δὲ τὸ ὠφέλιμον

τυφλῶς ἔχειν καὶ ἀγνοεῖν ὅσῳ ἀθλιώτερόν ἐστι μὴ ὑγιοῦς σώματος μὴ ὑγιεῖ ψυχῇ συνοικεῖν, ἀλλὰ σαθρᾶ καὶ ἀδίκῳ

479c

PO: Unless you have something else to suggest.

καὶ ἀνοσίῳ, ὅθεν καὶ πᾶν ποιοῦσιν ὥστε δίκην μὴ διδόναι μηδ' ἀπαλλάττεσθαι τοῦ μεγίστου κακοῦ, καὶ χρήματα παρασκευαζόμενοι καὶ φίλους καὶ ὅπως ἂν ὥσιν ὡς πιθανώτατοι λέγειν· εἰ δὲ ἡμεῖς ἀληθῆ ὠμολογήκαμεν, ὦ Πῶλε, ἄρ' αἰσθάνη τὰ συμβαίνοντα ἐκ τοῦ λόγου; ἢ βούλει συλλογισώμεθα αὐτά; ΠΩΛ. εἰ σοί γε δοκεῖ. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν συμβαίνει μέγιστον κακὸν ἢ ἀδικία καὶ τὸ

479d

S: Well, does it follow that injustice, and acting unjustly, is the greatest badness?

479d

PO: So it appears anyway.

479d

S: And did the release from this badness turn out to be the payment of a penalty?

479d

PO: It was probable.

479d

S: And is the non-payment a continuation of the badness?

479d

PO: Yes.

479d

S: So, the second greatest badness is the perpetration of injustice, but the foremost and greatest badness of all is, by nature, doing injustice without paying a penalty.

ἀδικεῖν; ΠΩΛ. φαίνεται γέ. ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν ἀπαλλαγὴ γέ ἐφάνη τούτου τοῦ κακοῦ τὸ δίκην διδόναι; ΠΩΛ. κινδυνεύει. ΣΩ. τὸ δέ γε μὴ διδόναι ἔμμενον τοῦ κακοῦ; ΠΩΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. δεύτερον ἄρα ἐστὶν τῶν κακῶν μεγέθει τὸ ἀδικεῖν· τὸ δὲ ἀδικοῦντα μὴ διδόναι δίκην πάντων μέγιστόν

τε καὶ πρῶτον κακῶν πέφυκεν. ΠΩΛ. ἔοικεν. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν οὐ περὶ τούτου, ὦ φίλε, ἡμφεσβητήσαμεν, σὺ μὲν τὸν Ἀρχέλαον εὐδαιμονίζων τὸν τὰ μέγιστα ἀδικοῦντα

479e

PO: So it seems.

479e

S: Now, is this not, my friend, what we disagreed about: you, for your part, regarding Archelaus as happy, though he perpetrated enormous injustices without paying a penalty; and I, for my part, holding the opposite view, that if either Archelaus or any other person does not pay a penalty when he acts unjustly, he is inevitably wretched, more so than any other person, and that the perpetrator of injustice is always more wretched than the sufferer, and the one who pays no penalty is more wretched than he who pays one? Are these not the assertions I made?

479e

PO: Yes.

479e

S: Has it not been shown that what was asserted is true?

479e

PO: Apparently.

δίκην οὐδεμίαν διδόντα, ἐγὼ δὲ τοῦναντίον οἰόμενος, εἴτε Ἀρχέλαος εἴτ' ἄλλος ἀνθρώπων ὅστισοῦν μὴ δίδωσι δίκην ἀδικῶν, τούτῳ προσήκειν ἀθλίῳ εἶναι διαφερόντως τῶν ἄλλων ἀνθρώπων, καὶ ἀεὶ τὸν ἀδικοῦντα τοῦ ἀδικουμένου ἀθλιώτερον εἶναι καὶ τὸν μὴ διδόντα δίκην τοῦ διδόντος; οὐ ταῦτ' ἦν τὰ ὑπ' ἐμοῦ λεγόμενα; ΠΩΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἀποδέδεικται ὅτι ἀληθῆ ἐλέγετο; ΠΩΛ. φαίνεται.

480a

S: So be it. Now, if this is all true, Polus, what is the great advantage of rhetoric? In fact, on the basis of what is now agreed, a man should be particularly vigilant of himself in case he might act unjustly and get his fill of badness. Is this so?

480a

PO: Entirely so.

480a

S: But if either he or someone else for whom he cares acts unjustly, he will go willingly to wherever he may pay a penalty as quickly as possible, going to a judge just as he would to a physician, hastening lest the disease of injustice be protracted and make the soul fester and become incurable. Or how should we express this, Polus, if what we previously agreed still stands? Must not these assertions, expressed in this way but not otherwise, be in agreement with the earlier ones?

ΣΩ. εἴεν· εἰ οὖν δὴ ταῦτα ἀληθῆ, ὧ Πῶλε, τίς ἡ μεγάλη χρεία ἐστὶν τῆς ῥητορικῆς; δεῖ μὲν γὰρ δὴ ἐκ τῶν νῦν ὡμολογημένων αὐτὸν ἑαυτὸν μάλιστα φυλάττειν ὅπως μὴ ἀδικήσῃ, ὥς ἱκανὸν κακὸν ἔξοντα. οὐ γάρ; ΠΩΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. ἐὰν δέ γε ἀδικήσῃ ἢ αὐτὸς ἢ ἄλλος τις ὧν ἂν κήδεται, αὐτὸν ἐκόντα ἰέναι ἐκεῖσε ὅπου ὡς τάχιστα δώσει δίκην, παρὰ τὸν δικαστὴν ὥσπερ παρὰ τὸν ἰατρὸν,

480b

PO: Well then, Socrates, what should we say?

480b

S: So, rhetoric is not useful to us at all, Polus, in the defence of our own injustice, or that of our parents or companions or children or fatherland, except if it is deployed for the opposite purpose – to prosecute oneself in particular, as one must, and, indeed, any other kinfolk or loved ones when they happen to act unjustly, not in order to conceal this, but to bring the unjust action to light in order that a penalty is paid and health is restored; to compel both himself and the others to show no cowardice, but to submit with closed eyes, worthily and courageously, as if he were being cut or burned by a physician; intent upon the good and the noble, taking no account of the pain; submitting to flogging, if his unjust deeds merit flogging; to imprisonment, if they merit imprisonment; paying the fine, if a fine is imposed; going into exile, if exile is deserved; and submitting to death, if execution is deserved; he himself being the chief accuser of himself,

and of his other kinfolk, and making use of rhetoric for this purpose, so that with their unjust deeds fully exposed, they may be released from the greatest of evils, injustice. Should we formulate it like this, or should we not, Polus?

σπεύδοντα ὅπως μὴ ἐγχρονισθὲν τὸ νόσημα τῆς ἀδικίας ὕπουλον τὴν ψυχὴν ποιήσῃ καὶ ἀνίατον· ἢ πῶς λέγομεν, ὦ Πῶλε, εἴπερ τὰ πρότερον μένει ἡμῖν ὁμολογήματα; οὐκ ἀνάγκη ταῦτα ἐκείνοις οὕτω μὲν συμφωνεῖν, ἄλλως δὲ μή; ΠΩΛ. τί γὰρ δὴ φῶμεν, ὦ Σώκρατες; ΣΩ. ἐπὶ μὲν ἄρα τὸ ἀπολογεῖσθαι ὑπὲρ τῆς ἀδικίας τῆς αὐτοῦ ἢ γονέων ἢ ἐταίρων ἢ παίδων ἢ πατρίδος ἀδικούσης οὐ χρήσιμος οὐδὲν ἢ ῥητορικὴ ἡμῖν, ὦ Πῶλε, εἰ μὴ εἴ τις ὑπολάβοι ἐπὶ τούναντίον—κατηγορεῖν δεῖν μάλιστα μὲν ἑαυτοῦ, ἔπειτα δὲ καὶ τῶν οἰκείων καὶ τῶν ἄλλων ὃς ἂν αἰεὶ τῶν φίλων τυγχάνῃ ἀδικῶν, καὶ μὴ ἀποκρύπτεσθαι ἀλλ’ εἰς τὸ φανερόν ἄγειν τὸ ἀδίκημα, ἵνα δῶ δίκην καὶ ὑγιὲς γένηται, ἀναγκάζειν τε αὐτὸν καὶ τοὺς ἄλλους μὴ ἀποδειλιάειν ἀλλὰ παρέχειν μύσαντα εὖ καὶ ἀνδρείως ὥσπερ τέμνειν καὶ κάειν ἰατρῷ, τὸ ἀγαθὸν καὶ καλὸν διώκοντα, μὴ ὑπολογιζόμενον τὸ ἀλγινόν, ἐὰν μὲν γε πληγῶν ἄξια ἡδικηκῶς ᾗ, τύπτειν παρέχοντα, ἐὰν δὲ δεσμοῦ, δεῖν, ἐὰν δὲ ζημίας, ἀποτίνοντα, ἐὰν δὲ φυγῆς, φεύγοντα, ἐὰν δὲ θανάτου, ἀποθνήσκοντα, αὐτὸν πρῶτον ὄντα κατήγορον καὶ αὐτοῦ καὶ τῶν ἄλλων οἰκείων καὶ ἐπὶ τοῦτο χρώμενον τῇ ῥητορικῇ, ὅπως ἂν καταδήλων τῶν ἀδικημάτων γιγνομένων ἀπαλλάττωνται τοῦ μεγίστου κακοῦ, ἀδικίας. φῶμεν οὕτως ἢ μὴ φῶμεν, ὦ Πῶλε;

480e

PO: It seems absurd to me, Socrates. However, to you it probably seems to be in line with what we said before.

480e

S: Then we must either dispense with the former statements as well, or these latter ones necessarily follow.

480e

PO: Yes, that’s how matters stand.

480e

S: What is more, turning to the opposite case, if it proves necessary to act badly towards someone, be he an enemy or anyone else, then as long as you yourself are not being treated unjustly by that enemy – you do need to be careful about this – and the enemy treats someone else unjustly, one must contrive by every means, in word and in deed, that he pay no penalty and is not brought before a judge. But if he is brought, one must arrange that the enemy is acquitted and does not pay a penalty; and if he has stolen a lot of gold, that he does not repay this but holds on to it and spends it unjustly and godlessly on himself and his own people; and if he is deserving of death for his unjust actions, arrange that he does not suffer death – yea, that this never happens – so that he becomes immortal as an evildoer, and if not, that he lives for as long as possible in such a plight. It seems to me, Polus, that rhetoric is useful for such purposes, seeing that its usefulness to those with no intention of acting unjustly is insignificant, if indeed it has any use at all, since in the previous discussion it appeared not to be useful at all.

ΠΩΛ. ἄτοπα μὲν, ὦ Σώκράτες, ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ, τοῖς μέντοι ἔμπροσθεν ἴσως σοι ὁμολογεῖται. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἢ κάκεῖνα λυτέον ἢ τάδε ἀνάγκη συμβαίνειν; ΠΩΛ. ναί, τοῦτό γε οὕτως ἔχει. ΣΩ. τούναντίον δέ γε αὖ μεταβαλόντα, εἰ ἄρα δεῖ τινα κακῶς ποιεῖν, εἴτ' ἐχθρὸν εἴτε ὄντινόν, ἐὰν μόνον μὴ αὐτὸς ἀδικῇται ὑπὸ τοῦ ἐχθροῦ—τοῦτο μὲν γὰρ εὐλαβητέον—ἐὰν δὲ ἄλλον ἀδικῇ ὁ ἐχθρός, παντὶ τρόπῳ παρασκευαστέον, καὶ πράττοντα καὶ λέγοντα, ὅπως μὴ δῶ δίκην μηδὲ ἔλθῃ παρὰ τὸν δικαστήν· ἐὰν δὲ ἔλθῃ, μηχανητέον ὅπως ἂν διαφύγῃ καὶ μὴ δῶ δίκην ὁ ἐχθρός, ἀλλ' ἐάντε χρυσίον ἢ ἡρπακῶς πολὺ, μὴ ἀποδιδῶ τοῦτο ἀλλ' ἔχων ἀναλίσκῃ καὶ εἰς ἑαυτὸν καὶ εἰς τοὺς ἑαυτοῦ ἀδίκως καὶ ἀθέως, ἐάντε αὖ θανάτου ἄξια ἡδίκηκώς ἢ, ὅπως μὴ ἀποθανεῖται, μάλιστα μὲν μηδέποτε, ἀλλ' ἀθάνατος ἔσται πονηρὸς ὢν, εἰ δὲ μή, ὅπως ὥς

481b

CA: Tell me, Chaerephon, is Socrates serious about all this or is he playing games?

481b

CH: He seems to me, Callicles, to be exceedingly serious. However, there is nothing like asking the man himself.

πλεῖστον χρόνον βιώσεται τοιοῦτος ὢν. ἐπὶ τὰ τοιαῦτα ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ, ὦ Πῶλε, ἡ ῥητορικὴ χρήσιμος εἶναι, ἐπεὶ τῷ γε μὴ μέλλοντι ἀδικεῖν οὐ μεγάλη τίς μοι δοκεῖ ἡ χρεῖα αὐτῆς εἶναι, εἰ δὴ καὶ ἔστιν τις χρεῖα, ὥς ἔν γε τοῖς πρόσθεν οὐδαμῇ ἐφάνη οὔσα. ΚΑΛ. εἰπέ μοι, ὦ Χαιρεφῶν, σπουδάζει ταῦτα Σωκράτης ἢ παίζει; ΧΑΙ. ἐμοὶ μὲν δοκεῖ, ὦ Καλλίκλεις, ὑπερφυῶς σπουδάζειν· οὐδὲν μέντοι οἶον τὸ αὐτὸν ἐρωτᾶν. ΚΑΛ. νῆ τοὺς θεοὺς ἀλλ' ἐπιθυμῶ. εἰπέ μοι, ὦ Σώκρατες,

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CA: By the gods, I am eager to ask. Tell me, Socrates, should we presume that you are now being serious or joking? For if you are serious, and these pronouncements you are making happen to be true, won't the life of every human being be turned upside-down? And won't we all, so it seems, be doing the complete opposite of what we should?

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S: Callicles, if people did not have some experience that was the same, some sharing one experience, others sharing another, but instead one of us underwent a unique experience different from everyone else, it would not be easy for him to describe his own experience to another. And I speak from a recognition that you and I happen to have gone through the same experience. We are two lovers, each with two loves. My two are Alcibiades, the son of Clinias,¹⁹ and philosophy. Yours are the Athenian demos and Demos, the son of Pyrilampes.²⁰ Clever and all as you are, I notice that you constantly change your stance back and forth because you are unable to contradict what your favourite asserts, and what he declares to be the case. In the Assembly, when you are saying something and the Athenian populace deny that this is the case, you change your stance and propose whatever they wish. And also with this fair youth, the son of Pyrilampes, you are affected in a similar fashion, for you are unable to oppose the formulations and

assertions of your favourite. And so, if anyone were ever surprised at what you say when you speak under those influences, because the assertions are so absurd, if you wanted to speak the truth you would probably tell him that unless someone stops your favourite from making those pronouncements, you will never stop uttering them either. Therefore, you should realise that it is also necessary to hear more statements of this sort from me, and you should not be surprised that I make them. Rather, you must stop philosophy, my favourite, from saying what she says.

For she is constantly stating what you are now hearing from me, my dear friend, and she is much less impulsive with me than my other favourite, for the words of this son of Clinias change from one moment to the next, while the words of philosophy are always the same. She is saying what now surprises you, although you were also present yourself as it was spoken. So, as I just said, you should either refute her by proving that doing injustice and acting unjustly without paying a penalty is not the most extreme badness that there is, or else, if you leave this statement unrefuted, by the dog, the god of Egypt,²¹ Callicles, Callicles will not be in agreement with you. Instead he will be in discord throughout his entire life. And yet, best of men, I, for my part, think it better that my lyre be out of tune and discordant, so too the chorus that I provide, and that most of humanity disagree with me and speak against me, rather than that I, being one, should be discordant with and speak against myself.

πότερόν σε θῶμεν νυνὶ σπουδάζοντα ἢ παίζοντα; εἰ μὲν γὰρ σπουδάξεις τε καὶ τυγχάνει ταῦτα ἀληθῆ ὄντα ἃ λέγεις, ἄλλο τι ἢ ἡμῶν ὁ βίος ἀνατετραμμένος ἂν εἴη τῶν ἀνθρώπων καὶ πάντα τὰ ἐναντία πράττομεν, ὡς ἔοικεν, ἢ ἃ δεῖ; ΣΩ. ὦ Καλλίκλεις, εἰ μὴ τι ἦν τοῖς ἀνθρώποις πάθος, τοῖς μὲν ἄλλο τι, τοῖς δὲ ἄλλο τι ἢ τὸ αὐτό, ἀλλὰ τις ἡμῶν ἰδίον τι ἔπασχεν πάθος ἢ οἱ ἄλλοι, οὐκ ἂν ἦν ῥᾶδιον ἐνδείξασθαι τῷ ἑτέρῳ τὸ ἑαυτοῦ πάθημα. λέγω δ' ἐννοήσας ὅτι ἐγὼ τε καὶ σὺ νῦν τυγχάνομεν ταῦτόν τι πεπονθότες, ἐρῶντε δύο ὄντε δυοῖν ἑκάτερος,

ἐγὼ μὲν Ἀλκιβιάδου τε τοῦ Κλεινίου καὶ φιλοσοφίας, σὺ δὲ δυοῖν, τοῦ τε Ἀθηναίων δήμου καὶ τοῦ Πυριλάμπους. αἰσθάνομαι οὖν σου ἐκάστοτε, καίπερ ὄντος δεινοῦ, ὅτι ἂν φῇ σου τὰ παιδικὰ καὶ ὅπως ἂν φῇ ἔχειν, οὐ δυναμένου ἀντιλέγειν, ἀλλ' ἄνω καὶ κάτω μεταβαλλομένου· ἐν τε τῇ ἐκκλησίᾳ, ἐάν τι σοῦ λέγοντος ὁ δῆμος ὁ Ἀθηναίων μὴ φῇ οὕτως ἔχειν, μεταβαλλόμενος λέγεις ἃ ἐκεῖνος βούλεται, καὶ πρὸς τὸν Πυριλάμπους νεανίαν τὸν καλὸν τοῦτον τοιαῦτα ἕτερα πέπονθας. ΣΩ. τοῖς γὰρ τῶν παιδικῶν βουλευμασίν τε καὶ λόγοις οὐχ οἷός τ' εἶ ἐναντιοῦσθαι, ὥστε, εἴ τίς σου λέγοντος ἐκάστοτε ἃ διὰ τούτους λέγεις θαυμάζοι ὡς ἄτοπά ἐστιν, ἴσως εἴποις ἂν αὐτῷ, εἰ βούλοιο τάληθ' ἰλέγειν, ὅτι εἰ μὴ τις παύσει τὰ σὰ παιδικὰ τούτων τῶν λόγων, οὐδὲ σὺ παύσῃ ποτὲ ταῦτα λέγων. νόμιζε τοίνυν καὶ παρ' ἐμοῦ χρῆναι ἕτερα τοιαῦτα ἀκούειν, καὶ μὴ θαύμαζε ὅτι ἐγὼ ταῦτα λέγω, ἀλλὰ τὴν φιλοσοφίαν, τὰ ἐμὰ παιδικὰ, παῦσον ταῦτα λέγουσαν. λέγει γάρ, ὦ φίλε ἑταῖρε, ἃ νῦν ἐμοῦ ἀκούεις, καὶ μοί ἐστιν τῶν ἐτέρων παιδικῶν πολὺ ἥττον ἔμπληκτος· ὁ μὲν γὰρ Κλεινίειος οὗτος ἄλλοτε ἄλλων ἐστὶ λόγων, ἡ δὲ φιλοσοφία ἀεὶ τῶν αὐτῶν, λέγει δὲ ἃ σὺ νῦν θαυμάζεις, παρῆσθα δὲ καὶ αὐτὸς λεγομένοις. ἢ οὖν ἐκείνην ἐξέλεγχον, ὅπερ ἄρτι ἔλεγον, ὡς οὐ τὸ ἀδικεῖν ἐστὶν καὶ ἀδικοῦντα δίκην μὴ διδόναι ἀπάντων ἔσχατον κακῶν· ἢ εἰ τοῦτο ἑάσεις ἀνέλεγκτον, μὰ τὸν κύνα τὸν Αἰγυπτίων θεόν, οὗ σοι ὁμολογήσει Καλλικλῆς, ὦ Καλλίκλεις, ἀλλὰ διαφωνήσει ἐν ἅπαντι τῷ βίῳ. καίτοι ἔγωγε οἶμαι, ὦ βέλτιστε, καὶ τὴν λύραν μοι κρεῖττον εἶναι ἀνάρμοστον τε καὶ διαφωνεῖν, καὶ χορὸν ᾧ χορηγοῖν,

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CA: Socrates, it seems to me that you are out of control in your arguments, like a true mob orator. Yes, you are making these appeals to the mob, now that Polus has met the very same fate that he accused Gorgias of meeting at your hands. Indeed, he pointed out, I believe that when you asked Gorgias whether Gorgias himself would teach justice to someone who came to him, wishing to learn rhetoric but without any knowledge of justice, the man was ashamed and said he would teach him only on account of human convention, because

people would be indignant if he said otherwise. Of course, due to this concession, he himself was forced to speak against himself, the very thing you delight in. And he ridiculed you at the time – rightly so in my view – but now he himself, in turn, has suffered the same fate. And I am not much pleased with Polus on this particular issue, because he conceded to you that doing injustice is more base than suffering injustice. For out of this concession, he, for his part, got tangled up in the discussion at your hands and was reduced to silence, ashamed to say what he was thinking. Yes, Socrates, whilst claiming to be pursuing the truth, you are really diverting us into banalities and populisms, propositions that are not sound by nature, but only by convention. Yet, in general, these two, nature and convention, are opposed to one another. Therefore, if anyone is ashamed and does not dare to say what he thinks, he is compelled to utter contradictions. And of course, having recognised this piece of wisdom, you wreak havoc in the discussions, asking surreptitiously about the natural whenever someone mentions the conventional, and about the conventional when they refer to the natural. It happened just now in the references to doing injustice and suffering injustice. When Polus referred to what is base according to convention, you pursued the argument according to nature. For by nature, everything that is more base, such as suffering injustice, is also more bad, whereas by convention, doing injustice is more base. Indeed, this predicament of suffering injustice does not belong to a man, but to some slave, for whom it is better to die than to live, someone who, on suffering injustice or being mistreated, is unable to defend himself or anyone else he cares for. But in my view, those who set down the laws are the weak people, the multitude. They institute the laws with a view to themselves and their own advantage, and they praise what they praise and censure what they censure. To intimidate the stronger people who have the power to get more than their share, and to ensure they don't get more than the multitude, they say that getting more than your share is base and unjust, and that seeking to have more than

others constitutes unjust activity. For I believe that they themselves, being lesser men, would be delighted with an equal share. Of course, that's why they say that this 'seeking to have more than the multitude' is, by law, unjust and base, and they refer to it as unjust action. And yet I believe that nature itself testifies to this: that it is just for the superior men to have more than the inferior men, and for the more powerful to exceed the less powerful. And it is evident in many cases that this is so, both among animals in general, and in the cities and dynasties of men. What is just is decided in this way: the stronger rule over the weaker and have more than them.

To what conception of justice did Xerxes²² have recourse when he waged war against Greece, or his father against the Scythians? And we could describe countless other instances of this sort. Yet I believe these people are acting in accord with the nature of the just. Yes, by Zeus, in accord with the law of nature anyway, though probably not in accord with the one we institute, moulding the superior and stronger men among us. Capturing them when they are young, as though they were lions, we reduce them to slaves with enchantments and beguilements, declaring that equality is what is needed, and that's what's noble and just. And yet, if a man whose nature is up to the task were to arise, having shrugged off all this, broken it asunder and fled, trampled upon our traditions, aphorisms, verses, and all laws that are opposed to nature, that slave would prove to be our master, and the justice of nature would blaze forth. And it seems to me that Pindar makes the point I am making in the ode in which he says that

*Law the lord of all,
of mortals and immortals both...*

and then he says, it

conducts extreme violence

*with a high hand and renders it just.
My proof lies in the deeds of Heracles,
When, without payment...*²³

It says something of that sort, for I don't know the ode. But it does say that he drove off the cattle of Geryon²⁴ without payment and without permission, because by nature that's what is just. Both the oxen and all the other possessions of the lesser and the weaker belong to the superior and the stronger.

Now, that is the truth of the matter, and you will recognise this once you have bidden farewell to philosophy and moved on to greater things. Yes, philosophy is indeed a delight if it is taken up in due measure at the right age, but if a man continues its practice for longer than necessary, it can ruin people. For even if he has great natural endowments, but engages in philosophy beyond the right age, a man must perforce remain inexperienced in all matters where experience is needed, by anyone who intends to be a noble, good man who is well thought of. In fact, he is rendered inexperienced in the laws governing the city and the language one must use to engage in the business dealings of men, be they public or private, in the pleasures and desires of humanity, and, in short, he becomes completely inexperienced in the ways of the world. So, once they take to any private or political business they become laughing stocks, just as the men of politics would, I presume, become laughable too if they in turn were to take up this activity of yours and its arguments. And this confirms the statement of Euripides that 'each person shines in this and is eager for this',

*Assigning the greater part of the day to this
Where he himself excels...*²⁵

But he shuns and reviles the activity in which he is inferior, and he

praises the other one out of good will towards himself, believing that he himself is praising himself by doing so, but in my view it is best to have a share of both. Insofar as philosophy is educational, it is good to partake thereof, and it is no disgrace for a young man to engage in philosophy. However, if he still engages in philosophy as an older man, he becomes a comical character, Socrates, and I myself have exactly the same feeling towards the philosophers as I do towards people who mumble or behave childishly. For when I see a little child mumbling and being immature, it is still appropriate for him to converse in this manner, so I am pleased and it seems delightful to me, free-spirited and suited to the age of the child. However, when I hear a young child expressing himself articulately, this seems distasteful to me. It offends my ears, and I regard it as more appropriate for a slave. And whenever anyone hears a man mumbling or sees him behaving immaturely, this appears comical and unmanly and deserving of a beating. Now, I myself have the very same feeling towards the philosophers, for I am delighted when I see philosophy in a young adolescent. It seems appropriate to me, and I regard this man as a free-spirited person, and the one who does not engage in philosophy as devoid of freedom, one who will never prove himself worthy of any fair and noble dealings. And yet, when I see an older man still engaging in philosophy and not giving it up, at that stage, Socrates, the man seems to me to be in need of a beating. For as I said just now, even if this man has many natural endowments, he is prone to become unmanly, avoiding the centres and meeting places of the city – in which, as the poet says,²⁶ men become illustrious – slinking away to live the rest of his life whispering with three or four adolescents in a corner, never expressing anything unbridled and visionary to meet the need of the moment.

Now, Socrates, I do have a somewhat friendly disposition towards you, so having been reminded of Zethus, I am now inclined to have the same feeling as he had towards Amphion in Euripides' play.²⁷ In fact, it

occurs to me to say the same sort of things to you as he said to his brother: “Socrates, you care not for what you should, and although your soul has been granted a noble nature, you are pre-eminent in the guise of some youthful figure, and you could neither present speeches before the assemblies of justice in the proper manner, nor proclaim anything persuasive or probable, nor advocate a novel proposal on behalf of someone else.” What’s more, dear Socrates – and don’t be angry with me for I am about to speak with good intentions towards you – doesn’t it seem disgraceful to you to be in the predicament I think you are in, along with the rest of those who are in the habit of pressing philosophy too far? For if someone were now to take hold of you, or anyone else of your sort, and cart you off to prison, claiming that you had acted unjustly when you had done nothing wrong, you know that you wouldn’t know what to do with yourself. No, you would be dizzy, open-mouthed, not knowing what you should say, and on being brought to court, meeting some lowly, knavish accuser, you would be executed if he wanted the death penalty for you. Yes, indeed, Socrates. “How can this be anything wise, a skill that takes a naturally talented man and makes him worse?”, unable either to help himself or to save either himself or anyone else from the utmost dangers, liable to have all his property confiscated by his enemies, living in the city effectively deprived of his rights? And to put it quite crudely, it is possible to slap someone like this across the face and pay no penalty. So, good fellow, heed my entreaty: desist from the practice of refutation. Practise the sweet music of business affairs instead. Practise something that will make you seem intelligent. Leave the subtleties to other people, the nonsensicalities, or fooleries, or whatever they should be called, for these will have you “dwelling in empty halls”.²⁸ Do not envy those who engage in these trifling refutations, but men of substance, reputation and other advantages aplenty.

καὶ πλείστους ἀνθρώπους μὴ ὁμολογεῖν μοι ἀλλ’ ἐναντία λέγειν
μᾶλλον ἢ ἓνα ὄντα ἐμὲ ἐμαυτῷ ἀσύμφωνον εἶναι καὶ ἐναντία λέγειν.

ΚΑΛ. ὦ Σώκρατες, δοκεῖς νεανιεύεσθαι ἐν τοῖς λόγοις ὡς ἀληθῶς δημηγόρος ὢν· καὶ νῦν ταῦτα δημηγορεῖς ταῦτ' ὁ παθόντος Πώλου πάθος ὅπερ Γοργίου κατηγορεῖ πρὸς σέ παθεῖν. ἔφη γάρ που Γοργίαν ἐρωτώμενον ὑπὸ σοῦ, ἐὰν ἀφίκηται παρ' αὐτὸν μὴ ἐπιστάμενος τὰ δίκαια ὁ τὴν ῥητορικὴν βουλόμενος μαθεῖν, εἰ διδάξοι αὐτὸν ὁ Γοργίας, αἰσχυνηθῆναι αὐτὸν καὶ φάναι διδάξειν διὰ τὸ ἔθος τῶν ἀνθρώπων, ὅτι ἀγανακτοῖεν ἂν εἴ τις μὴ φαίη—διὰ δὴ ταύτην τὴν ὁμολογίαν ἀναγκασθῆναι ἐναντία αὐτὸν αὐτῷ εἰπεῖν, σὲ δὲ αὐτὸ τοῦτο ἀγαπᾶν—καὶ σου καταγελᾶν, ὡς γέ μοι δοκεῖν ὀρθῶς, τότε· νῦν δὲ πάλιν αὐτὸς ταῦτ' οὗτο ἔπαθεν. καὶ ἔγωγε κατ' αὐτὸ τοῦτο οὐκ ἄγαμαι Πῶλον, ὅτι σοι συνεχώρησεν τὸ ἀδικεῖν αἴσχιον εἶναι τοῦ ἀδικεῖσθαι· ἐκ ταύτης γὰρ αὖ τῆς ὁμολογίας αὐτὸς ὑπὸ σοῦ συμποδισθεὶς ἐν τοῖς λόγοις ἐπεστομίσθη, αἰσχυνηθεὶς ἃ ἐνόει εἰπεῖν. σὺ γὰρ τῷ ὄντι, ὦ Σώκρατες, εἰς τοιαῦτα ἄγεις φορτικὰ καὶ δημηγορικά, φάσκων τὴν ἀλήθειαν διώκειν, ἃ φύσει μὲν οὐκ ἔστιν καλὰ, νόμῳ δέ. ΚΑΛ. ὡς τὰ πολλὰ δὲ ταῦτα ἐναντί' ἀλλήλοις ἐστίν, ἢ τε φύσις καὶ ὁ νόμος· ἐὰν οὖν τις αἰσχύνηται καὶ μὴ τολμᾷ λέγειν ἅπερ νοεῖ, ἀναγκάζεται ἐναντία λέγειν. ὃ δὴ καὶ σὺ τοῦτο τὸ σοφὸν κατανενοηκῶς κακουργεῖς ἐν τοῖς λόγοις, ἐὰν μὲν τις κατὰ νόμον λέγῃ, κατὰ φύσιν ὑπερωτῶν, ἐὰν δὲ τὰ τῆς φύσεως, τὰ τοῦ νόμου. ὥσπερ αὐτίκα ἐν τούτοις, τῷ ἀδικεῖν τε καὶ τῷ ἀδικεῖσθαι, Πώλου τὸ κατὰ νόμον αἴσχιον λέγοντος, σὺ τὸν λόγον ἐδιώκαθες κατὰ φύσιν. φύσει μὲν γὰρ πᾶν αἴσχιόν ἐστιν ὅπερ καὶ κάκιον, τὸ ἀδικεῖσθαι, νόμῳ δὲ τὸ ἀδικεῖν. οὐδὲ γὰρ ἀνδρὸς τοῦτο γ' ἐστὶν τὸ πάθημα, τὸ ἀδικεῖσθαι, ἀλλ' ἀνδραπόδου τινὸς ᾧ κρεῖττον ἐστὶν τεθνάναι ἢ ζῆν, ὅστις ἀδικούμενος καὶ προπηλακιζόμενος μὴ οἷός τέ ἐστιν αὐτὸς αὐτῷ βοηθεῖν μηδὲ ἄλλῳ οὐ ἂν κήδηται. ἀλλ' οἶμαι οἱ τιθέμενοι τοὺς νόμους οἱ ἀσθενεῖς ἄνθρωποι εἰσιν καὶ οἱ πολλοί. πρὸς αὐτοὺς οὖν καὶ τὸ αὐτοῖς συμφέρον τοὺς τε νόμους τίθενται καὶ τοὺς ἐπαίνους ἐπαινοῦσιν καὶ τοὺς ψόγους ψέγουσιν· ἐκφοβοῦντες τοὺς ἐρρωμενεστέρους τῶν ἀνθρώπων καὶ δυνατοὺς ὄντας πλέον ἔχειν, ἵνα μὴ αὐτῶν πλέον ἔχωσιν, λέγουσιν ὡς αἰσχρὸν καὶ ἄδικον τὸ πλεονεκτεῖν, καὶ τοῦτο ἐστὶν τὸ ἀδικεῖν, τὸ πλέον τῶν ἄλλων ζητεῖν ἔχειν· ἀγαπῶσι γὰρ οἶμαι αὐτοὶ ἂν τὸ ἴσον ἔχωσιν φαυλότεροι ὄντες.

διὰ ταῦτα δὴ νόμῳ μὲν τοῦτο ἄδικον καὶ αἰσχροὺν λέγεται, τὸ πλεόν
ζητεῖν ἔχειν τῶν πολλῶν, καὶ ἀδικεῖν αὐτὸ καλοῦσιν· ἡ δέ γε οἶμαι
φύσις αὐτῇ ἀποφαίνει αὐτό, ὅτι δίκαιόν ἐστιν τὸν ἀμείνων τοῦ χειρόνος
πλεόν ἔχειν καὶ τὸν δυνατώτερον τοῦ ἀδυνατωτέρου. δηλοῖ δὲ ταῦτα
πολλαχοῦ ὅτι οὕτως ἔχει, καὶ ἐν τοῖς ἄλλοις ζώοις καὶ τῶν ἀνθρώπων
ἐν ὅλαις ταῖς πόλεσι καὶ τοῖς γένεσιν, ὅτι οὕτω τὸ δίκαιον κέκριται, τὸν
κρείττω τοῦ ἥττονος ἄρχειν καὶ πλεόν ἔχειν. ἐπεὶ ποῖω δικαίῳ
χρῶμενος Ξέρξης ἐπὶ τὴν Ἑλλάδα ἐστράτευσεν ἢ ὁ πατήρ αὐτοῦ ἐπὶ
Σκύθας; ἢ ἄλλα μυρία ἂν τις ἔχοι τοιαῦτα λέγειν. ἀλλ' οἶμαι οὗτοι κατὰ
φύσιν τὴν τοῦ δικαίου ταῦτα πράττουσιν, καὶ ναὶ μὰ Δία κατὰ νόμον γε
τὸν τῆς φύσεως, οὐ μέντοι ἴσως κατὰ τοῦτον ὃν ἡμεῖς τιθέμεθα· ΚΑΛ.
πλάττοντες τοὺς βελτίστους καὶ ἔρωμενεστάτους ἡμῶν αὐτῶν, ἐκ
νέων λαμβάνοντες, ὥσπερ λέοντας, κατεπάρχοντές τε καὶ γοητεύοντες
καταδουλούμεθα λέγοντες ὡς τὸ ἴσον χρή ἔχειν καὶ τοῦτό ἐστιν τὸ
καλὸν καὶ τὸ δίκαιον. ἐὰν δέ γε οἶμαι φύσιν ἱκανὴν γένηται ἔχων ἀνὴρ,
πάντα ταῦτα ἀποσεισάμενος καὶ διαρρήξας καὶ διαφυγὼν,
καταπατήσας τὰ ἡμέτερα γράμματα καὶ μαγγανεύματα καὶ ἐπὶ δὰς καὶ
νόμους τοὺς παρὰ φύσιν ἅπαντας, ἐπαναστὰς ἀνεφάνη δεσπότης
ἡμέτερος ὁ δοῦλος, καὶ ἐνταῦθα ἐξέλαμψεν τὸ τῆς φύσεως δίκαιον.
δοκεῖ δέ μοι καὶ Πίνδαρος ἅπερ ἐγὼ λέγω ἐνδείκνυσθαι ἐν τῷ ᾠσμάτι
ἐν ᾧ λέγει ὅτι—νόμος ὁ πάντων βασιλεὺς θνατῶν τε καὶ ἀθανάτων·
οὗτος δὲ δῆ, φησίν,—ἄγει δικαίων τὸ βιαιότατον ὑπερτάτῃ χειρὶ·
τεκμαίρομαι ἔργοισιν Ἡρακλῆος, ἐπεὶ—ἀπριάτας— λέγει οὕτω πως—τὸ
γὰρ ᾠσμα οὐκ ἐπίσταμαι—λέγει δ' ὅτι οὔτε πριάμενος οὔτε δόντος τοῦ
Γηρυόνου ἠλάσατο τὰς βοῦς, ὡς τούτου ὄντος τοῦ δικαίου φύσει, καὶ
βοῦς καὶ τᾶλλα κτήματα εἶναι πάντα τοῦ βελτίονός τε καὶ κρείττονος
τὰ τῶν χειρόνων τε καὶ ἥττόνων. τὸ μὲν οὖν ἀληθὲς οὕτως ἔχει, γνῶσθαι
δέ, ἂν ἐπὶ τὰ μείζω ἔλθῃς ἐάσας ἤδη φιλοσοφίαν. φιλοσοφία γάρ τοι
ἐστίν, ᾧ Σώκρατες, χαρίεν, ἂν τις αὐτοῦ μετρίως ᾤσῃται ἐν τῇ ἡλικίᾳ·
ἐὰν δὲ περαιτέρω τοῦ δέοντος ἐνδιατρίψῃ, διαφθορὰ τῶν ἀνθρώπων.
ἐὰν γὰρ καὶ πάνυ εὐφυὴς ᾦ καὶ πόρρω τῆς ἡλικίας φιλοσοφῇ, ἀνάγκη
πάντων ἀπειρον γεγονέναι ἐστὶν ὧν χρή ἔμπειρον εἶναι τὸν μέλλοντα
καλὸν καγαθὸν καὶ εὐδόκιμον ἔσεσθαι ἄνδρα. καὶ γὰρ τῶν νόμων

ἄπειροι γίνονται τῶν κατὰ τὴν πόλιν, καὶ τῶν λόγων οἷς δεῖ χρώμενον ὁμιλεῖν ἐν τοῖς συμβολαίοις τοῖς ἀνθρώποις καὶ ἰδίᾳ καὶ δημοσίᾳ, καὶ τῶν ἡδονῶν τε καὶ ἐπιθυμιῶν τῶν ἀνθρωπείων, καὶ συλλήβδην τῶν ἡθῶν παντάπασιν ἄπειροι γίνονται. ἐπειδὴν οὖν ἔλθωσιν εἰς τινὰ ἰδίαν ἢ πολιτικὴν πράξιν, καταγέλαστοι γίνονται, ὥσπερ γε οἶμαι οἱ πολιτικοί, ἐπειδὴν αὖ εἰς τὰς ὑμετέρας διατριβὰς ἔλθωσιν καὶ τοὺς λόγους, καταγέλαστοί εἰσιν. ΚΑΛ. συμβαίνει γὰρ τὸ τοῦ Εὐριπίδου· λαμπρός τέ ἐστὶν ἕκαστος ἐν τούτῳ, καὶ ἐπὶ τοῦτ' ἐπείγεται, νέμων τὸ πλεῖστον ἡμέρας τούτῳ μέρος, ἵν' αὐτὸς αὐτοῦ τυγχάνει βέλτιστος ὢν· ὅπου δ' ἂν φαῦλος ᾖ, ἐντεῦθεν φεύγει καὶ λοιδορεῖ τοῦτο, τὸ δ' ἕτερον ἐπαινεῖ, εὐνοίᾳ τῇ ἑαυτοῦ, ἡγούμενος οὕτως αὐτὸς ἑαυτὸν ἐπαινεῖν. ἀλλ' οἶμαι τὸ ὀρθότατόν ἐστιν ἀμφοτέρων μετασχεῖν. φιλοσοφίας μὲν ὅσον παιδείας χάριν καλὸν μετέχειν, καὶ οὐκ αἰσχρὸν μεираκίῳ ὄντι φιλοσοφεῖν· ἐπειδὴν δὲ ἤδη πρεσβύτερος ὢν ἄνθρωπος ἔτι φιλοσοφῇ, καταγέλαστον, ὃ Σώκρατες, τὸ χρῆμα γίγνεται, καὶ ἔγωγε ὁμοιότατον πάσχω πρὸς τοὺς φιλοσοφοῦντας ὥσπερ πρὸς τοὺς ψελλιζομένους καὶ παίζοντας. ὅταν μὲν γὰρ παιδίον ἴδω, ὃ ἔτι προσήκει διαλέγεσθαι οὕτω, ψελλιζόμενον καὶ παίζον, χαίρω τε καὶ χαρίεν μοι φαίνεται καὶ ἐλευθέριον καὶ πρέπον τῇ τοῦ παιδίου ἡλικίᾳ, ὅταν δὲ σαφῶς διαλεγόμενον παιδαρίου ἀκούσω, πικρὸν τί μοι δοκεῖ χρῆμα εἶναι καὶ ἀνίᾳ μου τὰ ὦτα καὶ μοι δοκεῖ δουλοπρεπές τι εἶναι· ὅταν δὲ ἀνδρὸς ἀκούσῃ τις ψελλιζόμενον ἢ παίζοντα ὁρᾷ, καταγέλαστον φαίνεται καὶ ἄνανδρον καὶ πληγῶν ἄξιον. ταῦτόν οὖν ἔγωγε τοῦτο πάσχω καὶ πρὸς τοὺς φιλοσοφοῦντας, παρὰ νέῳ μὲν γὰρ μεираκίῳ ὁρῶν φιλοσοφίαν ἄγαμαι, καὶ πρέπειν μοι δοκεῖ, καὶ ἡγοῦμαι ἐλευθερόν τινα εἶναι τοῦτον τὸν ἄνθρωπον, τὸν δὲ μὴ φιλοσοφοῦντα ἀνελεύθερον καὶ οὐδέποτε οὐδενὸς ἀξιώσοντα ἑαυτὸν οὔτε καλοῦ οὔτε γενναίου πράγματος· ὅταν δὲ δὴ πρεσβύτερον ἴδω ἔτι φιλοσοφοῦντα καὶ μὴ ἀπαλλαττόμενον, πληγῶν μοι δοκεῖ ἤδη δεῖσθαι, ὃ Σώκρατες, οὗτος ὁ ἀνὴρ. ὃ γὰρ νυνδὴ ἔλεγον, ὑπάρχει τούτῳ τῷ ἀνθρώπῳ, καὶν πάνυ εὐφυῆς ᾖ, ἀνάνδρῳ γενέσθαι φεύγοντι τὰ μέσα τῆς πόλεως καὶ τὰς ἀγοράς, ἐν αἷς ἔφη ὁ ποιητὴς τοὺς ἄνδρας ἀριπρεπεῖς γίνεσθαι, καταδεδυκότι δὲ τὸν λοιπὸν βίον βιώναι μετὰ

μειρακίων ἐν γωνία τριῶν ἢ τεττάρων ψιθυρίζοντα, ἐλεύθερον δὲ καὶ μέγα καὶ ἱκανὸν μηδέποτε φθέγγασθαι. ἐγὼ δέ, ὦ Σώκρατες, πρὸς σὲ ἐπεικῶς ἔχω φιλικῶς κινδυνεύω οὐκ πεπονθέναι νῦν ὅπερ ὁ Ζῆθος πρὸς τὸν Ἀμφίονα ὁ Εὐριπίδου, οὐπερ ἐμνήσθην. ΚΑΛ. καὶ γὰρ ἐμοὶ τοιαῦτ' ἄττα ἐπέρχεται πρὸς σὲ λέγειν, οἷάπερ ἐκείνος πρὸς τὸν ἀδελφόν, ὅτι ἀμελεῖς, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὣν δεῖ σε ἐπιμελεῖσθαι, καὶ φύσιν ψυχῆς ὧδε γενναίαν μειρακιώδει τινὶ διατρέπεις μορφώματι, καὶ οὐτ' ἂν δίκης βουλαῖσι προσθεῖ' ἂν ὀρθῶς λόγον, οὐτ' εἰκὸς ἂν καὶ πιθανὸν ἂν λάβοις, οὐθ' ὑπὲρ ἄλλου νεανικὸν βούλευμα βουλεύσαιο. καίτοι, ὦ φίλε Σώκρατες—καὶ μοι μηδὲν ἀχθεσθῆς· εὐνοία γὰρ ἐρῶ τῇ σῇ—οὐκ αἰσχρὸν δοκεῖ σοι εἶναι οὕτως ἔχειν ὡς ἐγὼ σὲ οἶμαι ἔχειν καὶ τοὺς ἄλλους τοὺς πόρρω ἀεὶ φιλοσοφίας ἐλαύνοντας; νῦν γὰρ εἴ τις σοῦ λαβόμενος ἢ ἄλλου ὁτοιοῦν τῶν τοιοῦτων εἰς τὸ δεσμωτήριον ἀπάγοι, φάσκων ἀδικεῖν μηδὲν ἀδικοῦντα, οἷσθ' ὅτι οὐκ ἂν ἔχοις ὅτι χρήσαιο σαυτῷ, ἀλλ' ἰλιγγιώης ἂν καὶ χασμῶ οὐκ ἔχων ὅτι εἴποις, καὶ εἰς τὸ δικαστήριον ἀναβὰς, κατηγοροῦ τυχὼν πάνυ φαύλου καὶ μοχθηροῦ, ἀποθάνοις ἂν, εἰ βούλοιτο θανάτου σοι τιμᾶσθαι. καίτοι πῶς σοφὸν τοῦτό ἐστιν, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἥτις εὐφυῆ λαβοῦσα τέχνη φῶτα ἔθηκε χείρονα, μήτε αὐτὸν αὐτῷ δυνάμενον βοηθεῖν μηδ' ἐκσῶσαι ἐκ τῶν μεγίστων κινδύνων μήτε ἑαυτὸν μήτε ἄλλον μηδένα, ὑπὸ δὲ τῶν ἐχθρῶν περισυλᾶσθαι πᾶσαν τὴν οὐσίαν, ἀτεχνῶς δὲ ἄτιμον ζῆν ἐν τῇ πόλει; τὸν δὲ τοιοῦτον, εἴ τι καὶ ἀγροικότερον εἰρησθαι, ἔξεστιν ἐπὶ κόρρης τύπτοντα μὴ διδόναι δίκην. ἀλλ' ὡγαθέ, ἐμοὶ πείθου, παῦσαι δὲ ἐλέγχων, πραγμάτων δ' εὐμουσίαν ἄσκει, καὶ ἄσκει ὁπόθεν δόξεις φρονεῖν, ἄλλοις τὰ κομψὰ ταῦτα ἀφείς, εἴτε ληρήματα χρή φάναι εἶναι εἴτε φλυαρίας, ἐξ ὧν κενοῖσιν ἐγκατοικήσεις δόμοις· ζηλῶν οὐκ ἐλέγχοντας ἄνδρας τὰ μικρὰ

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S: Callicles, if my soul happened to be made of gold, do you not think I would be pleased to discover one of those stones with which they test gold, the best one there is? And if I applied the soul to this, and it confirmed to me that my soul had been properly cared for, would I be

right to accept that I am, finally, in good condition, or would I still need another test?

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CA: Why are you asking this question, Socrates?

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S: I will tell you right now. I think that this chance encounter with you is an encounter with a god-send of this kind.

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CA: In what way?

ταῦτα, ἀλλ' οἷς ἔστιν καὶ βίος καὶ δόξα καὶ ἄλλα πολλὰ ἀγαθὰ. ΣΩ. εἰ χρυσὴν ἔχων ἐτύγχανον τὴν ψυχὴν, ὦ Καλλίκλεις, οὐκ ἂν οἶμι με ἄσμενον εὐρεῖν τούτων τινὰ τῶν λίθων ἧ βασανίζουσιν τὸν χρυσόν, τὴν ἀρίστην, πρὸς ἣντινα ἔμελλον προσαγαγὼν αὐτήν, εἴ μοι ὁμολογήσειεν ἐκείνη καλῶς τεθεραπεῦσθαι τὴν ψυχὴν, εὖ εἴσεσθαι ὅτι ἱκανῶς ἔχω καὶ οὐδέν με δεῖ ἄλλης βασάνου;

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S: I know very well that if you agree with me on the issues about which my soul forms opinions, such agreements then constitute truth itself. For I realise that someone who proposes to test comprehensively whether or not the soul lives aright surely needs to have three qualities, all of which you possess: knowledge, good intentions and frankness. Indeed, I meet many people who are not able to test me because they are not wise like you. There are others who are wise, but they are not prepared to speak the truth to me because they do not care about me, as you do. These two visitors, Gorgias and Polus, despite being wise and being friends of mine, are yet lacking in frankness, and are both more reticent than they need to be. How could they not be? They both ended up in such embarrassment that for shame, each of them dared to contradict themselves in front of a lot of people on issues of the utmost importance. But you possess all those qualities that the others lack, for you have been properly educated, as numerous Athenians would

attest, and you are well disposed towards me.

What evidence do I have? I shall tell you. I know, Callicles, that there are four of you who have become associates in wisdom: yourself, Teisander of Aphidnae, Andron, son of Androtion, and Nausicydes of Cholgargos.²⁹ And I once heard you deliberating on how far one should pursue the practice of wisdom, and I know that an opinion prevailed among you that went something like this: that you should not be eager to engage in philosophy in a serious way; instead you encouraged one another to be careful lest you become wise beyond the limit of necessity and get corrupted without noticing it. Now, when I hear you giving me the same advice you give to your own companions, that is enough evidence for me that you are, in truth, well disposed towards me. And, indeed, you yourself assert, and the speech you made a short time ago confirms, that you are able to speak frankly and be devoid of shame. So, it is evident that this is where we stand on these issues. If you come to agree with me on anything in these discussions, the point in question will at that stage have been adequately tested by you and me, and will not need to be subjected to any other test. For you would never have gone along with it, either from lack of wisdom or excessive shame, and, what is more, you would not make the concession to deceive me, for, as you say yourself, you are my friend. Therefore, agreement between you and me will, in fact, already constitute complete truth. But the most sublime enquiry of all concerns the issues over which you rebuked me: the sort of person a man should be, the pursuits he should engage in and how far he should pursue them, both when he is younger and when he is older. Indeed, if I am acting incorrectly in some aspect of my own life, rest assured that I am not going astray deliberately, but through my own ignorance. And since you have begun to correct me, do not give up. Rather show me, satisfactorily, what it is that I should pursue and the manner in which I may acquire it. And if you find me agreeing with you now, and yet sometime later not enacting what was agreed, you

should regard me as an utter fool, and never correct me again thereafter because I do not deserve it.

But tell me from the beginning, what do you and Pindar claim that the justice that accords with nature actually involves? Is it that the stronger carry off the possessions of the weaker by force, that the superior rule over the inferior, and that better men have more than lesser men? Are you saying that justice is something else, or am I recalling this correctly?

ΚΑΛ. πρὸς τί δὴ τοῦτο ἐρωτᾷς, ὦ Σώκρατες; ΣΩ. ἐγὼ σοι ἐρῶ νῦν οἶμαι ἐγὼ σοι ἐντετυχηκῶς τοιοῦτῳ ἐρμαίῳ ἐντετυχηκέναι. ΚΑΛ. τί δὴ; ΣΩ. εὖ οἶδ' ὅτι, ἂν μοι σὺ ὁμολογήσῃς περὶ ὧν ἡ ἐμὴ ψυχὴ δοξάζει, ταῦτ' ἤδη ἐστὶν αὐτὰ τάληθῃ. ἐννοῶ γὰρ ὅτι τὸν μέλλοντα βασιανεῖν ἱκανῶς ψυχῆς πέρι ὀρθῶς τε ζώσης καὶ μὴ τρία ἄρα δεῖ ἔχειν ἃ σὺ πάντα ἔχεις, ἐπιστήμην τε καὶ εὐνοίαν καὶ παρρησίαν. ἐγὼ γὰρ πολλοῖς ἐντυγχάνω οἱ ἐμὲ οὐχ οἷοί τέ εἰσιν βασιανίζειν διὰ τὸ μὴ σοφοὶ εἶναι ὥσπερ σύ· ἕτεροι δὲ σοφοὶ μὲν εἰσιν, οὐκ ἐθέλουσιν δέ μοι λέγειν τὴν ἀλήθειαν διὰ τὸ μὴ κήδεσθαί μου ὥσπερ σύ· τῷ δὲ ξένῳ τῷδε, Γοργίᾳς τε καὶ πῶλος, σοφῷ μὲν καὶ φίλῳ ἐστὸν ἐμῷ, ἐνδεεστέρω δὲ παρρησίας καὶ αἰσχυντηροτέρῳ μᾶλλον τοῦ δέοντος πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ὦ γε εἰς τοσοῦτον αἰσχύνῃς ἐληλύθατον, ὥστε διὰ τὸ αἰσχύνεσθαι τολμᾷ ἐκάτερος αὐτῶν αὐτὸς αὐτῷ ἐναντία λέγειν ἐναντίον πολλῶν ἀνθρώπων, καὶ ταῦτα περὶ τῶν μεγίστων. σὺ δὲ ταῦτα πάντα ἔχεις ἃ οἱ ἄλλοι οὐκ ἔχουσιν· πεπαίδευσαι τε γὰρ ἱκανῶς, ὥς πολλοὶ ἂν φήσαιεν Ἀθηναίων, καὶ ἐμοὶ εἴ εὖνους. τίني τεκμηρίῳ χρῶμαι; ἐγὼ σοι ἐρῶ. οἶδα ὑμᾶς ἐγώ, ὦ Καλλίκλεις, τέτταρας ὄντας κοινωνοὺς γεγονότας σοφίας, σέ τε καὶ Τεῖσανδρον τὸν Ἀφιδναῖον καὶ Ἄνδρωνα τὸν Ἀνδροτίωνος καὶ Ναυσικύδην τὸν Χολαργέα· καί ποτε ὑμῶν ἐγὼ ἐπήκουσα βουλευομένων μέχρι ὅποι τὴν σοφίαν ἀσκητέον εἴη, καὶ οἶδα ὅτι ἐνίκα ἐν ὑμῖν τοιάδε τις δόξα, μὴ προθυμεῖσθαι εἰς τὴν ἀκρίβειαν φιλοσοφεῖν, ἀλλὰ εὐλαβεῖσθαι παρεκελεύεσθε ἀλλήλοις ὅπως μὴ πέρα τοῦ δέοντος σοφώτεροι γενόμενοι λήσετε διαφθαρέντες. ἐπειδὴ οὖν σου ἀκούω ταῦτα ἐμοὶ συμβουλευόντος ἅπερ τοῖς σεαυτοῦ

ἐταιροτάτοις, ἱκανόν μοι τεκμήριόν ἐστιν ὅτι ὡς ἀληθῶς μοι εὖνους εἶ. καὶ μὴν ὅτι γε οἷος παρρησιάζεσθαι καὶ μὴ αἰσχύνεσθαι, αὐτὸς τε φῆς καὶ ὁ λόγος ὃν ὀλίγον πρότερον ἔλεγες ὁμολογεῖ σοι. ἔχει δὴ οὕτως δῆλον ὅτι τούτων πέρι νυνὶ ἐάν τι σὺ ἐν τοῖς λόγοις ὁμολογήσης μοι, βεβασανισμένον τοῦτ' ἥδη ἔσται ἱκανῶς ὑπ' ἐμοῦ τε καὶ σοῦ, καὶ οὐκέτι αὐτὸ δεήσει ἐπ' ἄλλην βάσανον ἀναφέρειν. οὐ γὰρ ἂν ποτε αὐτὸ συνεχώρησας σὺ οὔτε σοφίας ἐνδείξῃς οὔτ' αἰσχύνης περιουσίᾳ, οὐδ' αὖ ἀπατῶν ἐμὲ συγχωρήσῃς ἂν· φίλος γάρ μοι εἶ, ὡς καὶ αὐτὸς φῆς. τῷ ὄντι οὖν ἢ ἐμὴ καὶ ἢ σὴ ὁμολογία τέλος ἥδη ἔξει τῆς ἀληθείας. ΣΩ. πάντων δὲ καλλίστη ἐστὶν ἡ σκέψις, ᾧ Καλλίκλεις, περὶ τούτων ὧν σὺ δὴ μοι ἐπετίμησας, ποῖόν τινα χρὴ εἶναι τὸν ἄνδρα καὶ τί ἐπιτηδεύειν καὶ μέχρι τοῦ, καὶ πρεσβύτερον καὶ νεώτερον ὄντα. ἐγὼ γὰρ εἴ τι μὴ ὀρθῶς πράττω κατὰ τὸν βίον τὸν ἐμαυτοῦ, εὖ ἴσθι τοῦτο ὅτι οὐχ ἐκὼν ἐξαμαρτάνω ἀλλ' ἀμαθία τῇ ἐμῇ· σὺ οὖν, ὥσπερ ἤρξω νουθετεῖν με, μὴ ἀποστῆς, ἀλλ' ἱκανῶς μοι ἐνδειξαι τί ἔστιν τοῦτο ὃ ἐπιτηδευτέον μοι, καὶ τίνα τρόπον κτησαίμην ἂν αὐτό, καὶ ἐάν με λάβῃς νῦν μὲν σοι ὁμολογήσαντα, ἐν δὲ τῷ ὑστέρω χρόνῳ μὴ ταῦτα πράττοντα ἅπερ ὡμολόγησα, πάνυ με ἡγοῦ βλακκα εἶναι καὶ

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CA: Yes, that's what I said then, and that's what I say now.

μηκέτι ποτέ με νουθετήσης ὕστερον, ὡς μηδενὸς ἄξιον ὄντα. ἐξ ἀρχῆς δέ μοι ἐπανάλαβε πῶς φῆς τὸ δίκαιον ἔχειν καὶ σὺ καὶ Πίνδαρος τὸ κατὰ φύσιν; ἄγειν βίᾳ τὸν κρείττω τὰ τῶν ἡττόνων καὶ ἄρχειν τὸν βελτίῳ τῶν χειρόνων καὶ πλεόν ἔχειν τὸν ἀμείνω τοῦ φαυλοτέρου; μή τι ἄλλο λέγεις τὸ δίκαιον εἶναι, ἢ ὀρθῶς μέμνημαι; ΚΑΛ. ἀλλὰ ταῦτα ἔλεγον καὶ τότε καὶ νῦν λέγω. ΣΩ. πότερον δὲ τὸν αὐτὸν βελτίῳ καλεῖς σὺ καὶ κρείττω;

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S: And do you refer to superior and stronger as the same? Indeed, I was not really able to understand what precisely you were saying. Are you calling the more powerful people stronger? And should the weaker people obey the stronger, which is what I think you were indicating earlier, since the bigger cities attack the smaller ones in

accord with what is just by nature, because they are stronger and more powerful, since the stronger, more powerful and superior are the same? Or is it possible to be superior and yet lesser and weaker, to be stronger and yet in a worse state? Or is the definition of the superior and of the stronger the same? Make this particular distinction for me in a clear manner. Are the superior the stronger, and the more powerful the same, or are they different?

οὐδὲ γάρ τοι τότε οἷός τ' ἢ μαθεῖν σου τί ποτε λέγοις. πότερον τοὺς ἰσχυροτέρους κρείττους καλεῖς καὶ δεῖ ἀκροᾶσθαι τοῦ ἰσχυροτέρου τοὺς ἀσθενεστέρους, οἷόν μοι δοκεῖς καὶ τότε ἐνδείκνυσθαι, ὡς αἱ μεγάλαι πόλεις ἐπὶ τὰς σμικρὰς κατὰ τὸ φύσει δίκαιον ἔρχονται, ὅτι κρείττους εἰσὶν καὶ ἰσχυρότεραι, ὡς τὸ κρείττον καὶ τὸ ἰσχυρότερον καὶ βέλτιον ταῦτόν ὄν, ἢ ἔστι βελτίω μὲν εἶναι, ἥττω δὲ καὶ ἀσθενέστερον, καὶ κρείττω μὲν εἶναι, μοχθηρότερον δέ ἢ ὁ αὐτός

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CA: But I am telling you clearly that they are the same.

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S: In that case, is the multitude not stronger, according to nature, than the individual? And indeed they impose laws upon the individual, as you also said earlier.

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CA: Of course.

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S: So, the laws of the multitude are the laws of the stronger?

488d

CA: Yes, certainly.

488d

S: Are they, therefore, the laws of the superior folk? For according to your argument, I presume the stronger are superior.

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CA: Yes.

488d

S: Are their laws not good, by nature, being the laws of the stronger?

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CA: I agree.

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S: And do the multitude conventionally believe, as you said already, that it is just to maintain equality, and more base to do injustice than to suffer injustice? Is this the case or is it not? And do not get trapped here and become ashamed like the others. Does the multitude conventionally believe this or not: that it is just to have an equal share and no more, and it is more base to do injustice than to suffer injustice? Do not begrudge me an answer to this, Callicles, so that should you agree with me, I may finally attain certainty through you, seeing that a man who is competent to decide has agreed with me.

ὅρος ἐστὶν τοῦ βελτίονος καὶ τοῦ κρείττονος; τοῦτό μοι αὐτὸ σαφῶς διόρισον, ταὐτὸν ἢ ἕτερόν ἐστιν τὸ κρείττον καὶ τὸ βέλτιον καὶ τὸ ἰσχυρότερον; ΚΑΛ. ἀλλ' ἐγὼ σοι σαφῶς λέγω, ὅτι ταὐτόν ἐστιν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν οἱ πολλοὶ τοῦ ἐνὸς κρείττους εἰσὶν κατὰ φύσιν; οἳ δὴ καὶ τοὺς νόμους τίθενται ἐπὶ τῷ ἐνί, ὥσπερ καὶ σὺ ἄρτι ἔλεγες. ΚΑΛ. πῶς γὰρ οὔ; ΣΩ. τὰ τῶν πολλῶν ἄρα νόμιμα τὰ τῶν κρειττόνων ἐστίν. ΚΑΛ. πάνυ γε.

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CA: Well, the multitude at any rate do conventionally believe this.

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S: So, it is not only by convention, but also by nature, that doing injustice is more base than suffering injustice, and that the maintenance of equality is just. And so, it is very likely that you were not speaking the truth and your criticism of me was incorrect when you said that nature and convention are opposed, and that I knew this and wreaked havoc in the arguments by referring to convention whenever someone spoke on the basis of nature, and referring to nature when they spoke on the basis of convention.

ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τὰ τῶν βελτιόνων; οἱ γὰρ κρείττους βελτίους πολὺ κατὰ τὸν σὸν λόγον. ΚΑΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τὰ τούτων νόμιμα κατὰ φύσιν καλὰ, κρειπτόνων γε ὄντων; ΚΑΛ. φημί. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν οἱ πολλοὶ νομίζουσιν οὕτως, ὥς ἄρτι αὖ σὺ ἔλεγες, δίκαιον εἶναι τὸ ἴσον ἔχειν καὶ αἴσχιον τὸ ἀδικεῖν τοῦ ἀδικεῖσθαι; ἔστιν ταῦτα ἢ οὐ; καὶ ὅπως μὴ ἀλώσῃ ἐνταῦθα σὺ αὖ αἰσχυνόμενος. νομίζουσιν, ἢ οὐ, οἱ πολλοὶ τὸ ἴσον ἔχειν ἀλλ' οὐ τὸ πλεόν δίκαιον εἶναι, καὶ αἴσχιον τὸ ἀδικεῖν τοῦ ἀδικεῖσθαι; μὴ φθόνει μοι ἀποκρίνασθαι τοῦτο, Καλλίκλεις, ἴν', ἐάν μοι ὁμολογήσῃς, βεβαιώσωμαι ἤδη παρὰ σοῦ, ἅτε ἱκανοῦ ἀνδρὸς διαγνῶναι ὠμολογηκός. ΚΑΛ. ἀλλ' οἱ γε πολλοὶ νομίζουσιν οὕτως. ΣΩ. οὐ νόμῳ ἄρα μόνον ἐστὶν αἴσχιον τὸ ἀδικεῖν τοῦ

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CA: This man will not cease talking nonsense! Tell me, Socrates, are you not ashamed, at your age, to be chasing after words and making out that it is a godsend if someone goes awry in expressing himself? Indeed, do you think I am saying that being stronger is something different from being superior? Did I not tell you long ago that I declare the superior and stronger to be the same? Or do you think I am saying that if a mob of slaves and people of all sorts were to get together, worthless except perhaps for their physical strength, and these fellows were to make some pronouncements, that such pronouncements would constitute law?

ἀδικεῖσθαι, οὐδὲ δίκαιον τὸ ἴσον ἔχειν, ἀλλὰ καὶ φύσει ὥστε κινδυνεύεις οὐκ ἀληθῆ λέγειν ἐν τοῖς πρόσθεν οὐδὲ ὀρθῶς ἐμοῦ κατηγορεῖν λέγων ὅτι ἐναντίον ἐστὶν ὁ νόμος καὶ ἡ φύσις, ἃ δὴ καὶ ἐγὼ γνοὺς κακουργῶ ἐν τοῖς λόγοις, ἐάν μὲν τις κατὰ φύσιν λέγῃ, ἐπὶ τὸν νόμον ἄγων, ἐάν δέ τις κατὰ νόμον, ἐπὶ τὴν φύσιν. ΚΑΛ. οὐτοσί ἀνὴρ οὐ παύσεται φλυαρῶν. εἶπέ μοι, ὦ Σώκρατες, οὐκ αἰσχύνη τηλικούτος ὢν ὀνόματα θηρεύων, καὶ

489c

S: So be it, my utterly wise Callicles. Is that your meaning?

489c

CA: Yes, very much so.

489c

S: Well, my divine friend, I myself have been guessing for some time that you meant something of this sort by ‘the stronger’, and I am eager to understand clearly what you are saying. For I presume that you do not regard two as superior to one, nor your slaves as superior to you because they are stronger than you. So tell me once more, from the beginning, what precisely you mean by ‘the superior’, since they are not the stronger? And, my wonderful friend, instruct me more gently to begin with, so that I do not leave your school.

ἐάν τις ῥήματι ἀμάρτη, ἔρμαιον τοῦτο ποιούμενος; ἐμὲ γὰρ οἶει ἄλλο τι λέγειν τὸ κρεῖττους εἶναι ἢ τὸ βελτίους; οὐ πάλαί σοι λέγω ὅτι ταῦτόν φημι εἶναι τὸ βέλτιον καὶ τὸ κρεῖττον; ἢ οἶμαι με λέγειν, ἐὰν συρφετός συλλεγῇ δούλων καὶ παντοδαπῶν ἀνθρώπων μηδενὸς ἀξίων πλὴν ἴσως τῷ σώματι ἰσχυρίσασθαι, καὶ οὗτοι φῶσιν, αὐτὰ ταῦτα εἶναι νόμιμα; ΣΩ. εἶεν, ὦ σοφώτατε Καλλίκληις· οὕτω λέγεις; ΚΑΛ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. ἀλλ’ ἐγὼ μὲν, ὦ δαιμόνιε, καὶ αὐτὸς πάλαί τοιπαζω τοιοῦτόν τί σε λέγειν τὸ κρεῖττον, καὶ ἀνερωτῶ γλιχόμενος σαφῶς εἰδέναι ὅτι λέγεις. οὐ γὰρ δήπου σύ γε τοὺς δύο βελτίους ἡγῇ τοῦ ἑνός, οὐδὲ τοὺς σοὺς δούλους βελτίους σοῦ, ὅτι ἰσχυρότεροί εἰσιν ἢ σύ. ἀλλὰ πάλιν ἐξ ἀρχῆς εἰπὲ τί ποτε λέγεις τοὺς βελτίους, ἐπειδὴ οὐ τοὺς ἰσχυροτέρους; καὶ ὦ θαυμάσιε πρᾶγότερόν με προδίδασκε, ἵνα μὴ ἀποφοιτήσω παρὰ σοῦ.

489e

CA: You are being ironical, Socrates.

489e

S: By Zethus, I am not, Callicles, to refer to the character you invoked just now, when you were being highly ironical towards me. Come on, tell us! Who do you say are the superior?

489e

CA: I mean the better.

489e

S: Do you not see that you yourself are uttering words but explaining nothing? Will you not tell us whether by the superior and the stronger

you mean the more intelligent, or someone else?

489e

CA: Yes, by Zeus, that is what I mean, emphatically so.

ΚΑΛ. εἰρωνεύη, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. μὰ τὸν Ζῆθον, ὦ Καλλίκλεις, ὃ σὺ χρώμενος πολλὰ νυνδὴ εἰρωνεύου πρὸς με· ἀλλ' ἴθι εἰπέ, τίνας λέγεις τοὺς βελτίους εἶναι; ΚΑΛ. τοὺς ἀμείνους ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. ὁρᾷς ἄρα ὅτι σὺ αὐτὸς ὀνόματα λέγεις, δηλοῖς δὲ οὐδέν; οὐκ ἐρεῖς, τοὺς βελτίους καὶ κρείττους πότερον τοὺς φρονιμωτέρους λέγεις ἢ ἄλλους τινάς; ΚΑΛ. ἀλλὰ ναὶ μὰ Δία τούτους λέγω, καὶ σφόδρα γε.

490a

S: So, in most cases, according to your argument, one man of intelligence is stronger than ten thousand who are devoid of intelligence, and this man should rule and the others should be ruled, and the ruler should have more than those who are ruled. Yes, this is what I think you wish to say, and I am not trapping you with words, if the one is stronger than the ten thousand.

490a

CA: Indeed, that is what I mean. For I believe this is just, by nature: those who are superior and more intelligent rule over, and have more than, the lesser people.

ΣΩ. πολλάκις ἄρα εἷς φρονῶν μυρίων μὴ φρονούντων κρείττων ἐστὶν κατὰ τὸν σὸν λόγον, καὶ τοῦτον ἄρχειν δεῖ, τοὺς δ' ἄρχεσθαι, καὶ πλέον ἔχειν τὸν ἄρχοντα τῶν ἀρχομένων· τοῦτο γάρ μοι δοκεῖς βούλεσθαι λέγειν—καὶ οὐ ῥήματι θηρεύω—εἰ ὁ εἷς τῶν μυρίων κρείττων. ΚΑΛ. ἀλλὰ ταῦτ' ἔστιν ἃ λέγω. τοῦτο γὰρ οἶμαι ἐγὼ τὸ δίκαιον εἶναι φύσει, τὸ βελτίῳ ὄντι καὶ φρονιμώτερον καὶ ἄρχειν καὶ πλέον ἔχειν τῶν φαυλοτέρων.

490b

S: Hold it there! What exactly are you saying now? Suppose we are together, in the same place just as we are now, a large gathering with a large common store of food and drink, and suppose we are a mixed group, some strong, others weak. But one of us is more intelligent

about these matters as he is a physician, although in all likelihood he would be physically stronger than some but weaker than others. Will this fellow be superior and stronger in these matters, as he is more intelligent about them than we are?

490b

CA: Entirely so.

ΣΩ. ἔχε δὴ αὐτοῦ. τί ποτε αὖ νῦν λέγεις; ἔὰν ἐν τῷ αὐτῷ ὦμεν, ὥσπερ νῦν, πολλοὶ ἄθροοι, καὶ ἡμῖν ἢ ἐν κοινῷ πολλὰ σιτία καὶ ποτά, ὦμεν δὲ παντοδαποί, οἱ μὲν ἰσχυροί, οἱ δ' ἄσθενεῖς, εἷς δὲ ἡμῶν ἢ φρονιμώτερος περὶ ταῦτα, ἱατρὸς ὢν, ἢ δέ, οἷον εἰκός, τῶν μὲν ἰσχυρότερος, τῶν δὲ ἄσθενέστερος, ἄλλο τι ἢ οὗτος, φρονιμώτερος ἡμῶν ὢν, βελτίων καὶ κρείττων ἔσται εἰς ταῦτα; ΚΑΛ. πάνυ γε.

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S: Now, should he have more of these provisions than the rest of us because he is superior? Or, in virtue of his authority, should this man distribute them all, and yet obtain no more than anyone else by consuming them and diverting them towards his own person, if he is to avoid paying a penalty? And should some get more while others get less? And if the superior man happens to be more feeble than everyone else, should he get less than everyone else, Callicles? Or does it not work like this, my friend?

ΣΩ. ἢ οὖν τούτων τῶν σιτίων πλέον ἡμῶν ἐκτέον αὐτῷ, ὅτι βελτίων ἐστίν, ἢ τῷ μὲν ἄρχειν πάντα ἐκεῖνον δεῖ νέμειν, ἐν τῷ δὲ ἀναλίσκειν τε αὐτὰ καὶ καταχρῆσθαι εἰς τὸ ἑαυτοῦ σῶμα οὐ πλεονεκτητέον, εἰ μὴ μέλλει ζημιοῦσθαι, ἀλλὰ τῶν μὲν πλέον, τῶν δ' ἔλαττον ἐκτέον· ἔὰν δὲ τύχη πάντων ἄσθενέστατος ὢν, πάντων ἐλάχιστον τῷ βελτίστῳ, ὃ Καλλίκλεις; οὐχ οὕτως, ὡγαθέ; ΚΑΛ. περὶ σιτία, λέγεις, καὶ ποτὰ καὶ ἱατροὺς καὶ φλυαρίας·

490d

CA: You keep referring to food and drink and physicians and fooleries, but I am not talking about these.

490d

S: Are you not saying that the more intelligent person is superior? Say yes or no.

490d

CA: I am.

490d

S: And should the superior not have more?

490d

CA: Not of food and drink though.

490d

S: I understand. But maybe it applies to clothing, and the most accomplished weaver has the largest cloak, and goes about dressed in the utmost variety and finery.

490d

CA: What has clothing got to do with this?

ἐγὼ δὲ οὐ ταῦτα λέγω. ΣΩ. πότερον οὐ τὸν φρονιμώτερον βελτίω λέγεις; φάθι ἢ μή. ΚΑΛ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' οὐ τὸν βελτίω πλέον δεῖν ἔχειν; ΚΑΛ. οὐ σιτίων γε οὐδὲ ποτῶν. ΣΩ. μανθάνω, ἀλλ' ἴσως ἱματίων, καὶ δεῖ τὸν ὑφαντικώτατον μέγιστον ἱμάτιον ἔχειν καὶ πλεῖστα καὶ κάλλιστα ἀμπεχόμενον περιέναι; ΚΑΛ. ποίων ἱματίων; ΣΩ. ἀλλ' εἰς ὑποδήματα δῆλον ὅτι δεῖ πλεονεκτεῖν τὸν

490e

S: But in relation to shoes it is obvious that the man who is most intelligent in this area, the utterly superior man, should have more. The cobbler should walk about shod in the grandest and greatest number of shoes.

490e

CA: Why mention shoes? You are talking persistent nonsense!

490e

S: Well, if that is not the sort of thing you mean, then it is probably something like this. For instance, a man of farming stock, intelligent with respect to the land, noble and good, this fellow should probably

have more seeds and use as much seed as he possibly can on his own land.

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CA: You keep on saying the same things, Socrates!

490e

S: Not only that, Callicles, but also in relation to the same issues.

φρονιμώτατον εἰς ταῦτα καὶ βέλτιστον. τὸν σκυτοτόμον ἴσως μέγιστα δεῖ ὑποδήματα καὶ πλεῖστα ὑποδεδεμένον περιπατεῖν. ΚΑΛ. ποῖα ὑποδήματα; φλυαρεῖς ἔχων. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' εἰ μὴ τὰ τοιαῦτα λέγεις, ἴσως τὰ τοιαῦδε· οἶον γεωργικὸν ἄνδρα περὶ γῆν φρόνιμόν τε καὶ καλὸν καὶ ἀγαθόν, τοῦτον δὴ ἴσως δεῖ πλεονεκτεῖν τῶν σπερμάτων καὶ ὡς πλείστῳ σπέρματι χρῆσθαι εἰς τὴν αὐτοῦ γῆν. ΚΑΛ. ὥς ἀεὶ ταῦτα λέγεις, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. οὐ μόνον γε, ὦ Καλλίκλεις, ἀλλὰ καὶ περὶ τῶν αὐτῶν.

491a

CA: Yes, by the gods, you are absolutely always talking about cobblers, clothes-cleaners, cooks and physicians – you never stop – as if these had anything to do with the argument.

491a

S: So, why will you not say who it relates to? What is it that the superior, more intelligent man has more of, and justly so? Or will you neither accept what I am suggesting, nor propose anything yourself?

491a

CA: But I have been saying this for quite some time. Firstly, by those who are superior, I mean neither cobblers nor cooks, but those who are intelligent in relation to the affairs of the city and the manner in which it may be well administered. And they are not merely intelligent, but also courageous, competent to bring their plans to completion without faltering through softness of soul.

ΚΑΛ. νῆ τοὺς θεούς, ἀτεχνῶς γε ἀεὶ σκυτέας τε καὶ κναφέας καὶ μαγείρους λέγων καὶ ἰατροὺς οὐδὲν παύη, ὥς περὶ τούτων ἡμῖν ὄντα τὸν λόγον. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν σὺ ἐρεῖς περὶ τίνων ὁ κρεῖττων τε καὶ

φρονιμώτερος πλέον ἔχων δικαίως πλεονεκτεῖ; ἢ οὔτε ἐμοῦ ὑποβάλλοντος ἀνέξῃ οὔτ' αὐτὸς ἐρεῖς; ΚΑΛ. ἀλλ' ἔγωγε καὶ πάλαι λέγω. πρῶτον μὲν τοὺς κρείττους οἱ εἰσιν οὐ σκυτοτόμους λέγω οὐδὲ μαγείρους, ἀλλ'

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S: Do you see, utterly superior Callicles, that your accusation against me is not the same as my accusation against you? You claim that I am always saying the same things, and you censure me for this. But I make the opposite accusation of you, that you never say the same things in relation to the same issues, but one moment you define the superior and stronger as the more powerful, then again as the more intelligent. And now you arrive holding an alternative view, some more courageous people are proposed by you as the stronger and superior. But, good fellow, tell me once and for all, who exactly do you say are superior and stronger, and in what respect?

οἱ ἂν εἰς τὰ τῆς πόλεως πράγματα φρόνιμοι ᾧσιν, ὅντινα ἂν τρόπον εὖ οἰκοῖτο, καὶ μὴ μόνον φρόνιμοι, ἀλλὰ καὶ ἀνδρεῖοι, ἱκανοὶ ὄντες ἃ ἂν νοήσωσιν ἐπιτελεῖν, καὶ μὴ ἀποκάμνωσι διὰ μαλακίαν τῆς ψυχῆς. ΣΩ. ὁρᾷς, ᾧ βέλτιστε Καλλίκλεις, ὥς οὐ ταῦτά σύ τ' ἐμοῦ κατηγορεῖς καὶ ἐγὼ σοῦ; σὺ μὲν γὰρ ἐμὲ φῆς αἰεὶ ταῦτά λέγειν, καὶ μέμφῃ μοι ἐγὼ δὲ σοῦ τούναντίον, ὅτι οὐδέποτε ταῦτά λέγεις περὶ τῶν αὐτῶν, ἀλλὰ τότε μὲν τοὺς

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CA: But I have already said that they are the men who are intelligent in relation to the affairs of the city, and who are courageous. For it is fitting for these people to rule the cities, and that is what justice is. These people have more than the others. The rulers have more than the ruled.

βελτίους τε καὶ κρείττους τοὺς ἰσχυροτέρους ὠρίζου, αὐθις δὲ τοὺς φρονιμωτέρους, νῦν δ' αὖ ἕτερόν τι ἥκει ἔχων· ἀνδρειότεροί τινες ὑπὸ σοῦ λέγονται οἱ κρείττους καὶ οἱ βελτίους. ἀλλ', ὦγαθέ, εἰπὼν ἀπαλλάγηθι τίνας ποτὲ λέγεις τοὺς βελτίους τε καὶ κρείττους καὶ εἰς

ὅτι. ΚΑΛ. ἀλλ' εἰρηκά γε ἔγωγε τοὺς φρονίμους εἰς τὰ τῆς πόλεως πράγματα καὶ ἀνδρείους. τούτους γὰρ

491d

S: But what about themselves, my friend? Are they ruling or being ruled?

491d

CA: What do you mean?

491d

S: I mean each one ruling himself. Or do you think there is no need for someone to rule himself, but only to rule others?

491d

CA: What do you mean by ruling himself?

491d

S: Nothing contrived, just what most people mean: being sound-minded, master of himself, ruling over pleasures and desires within himself.

491d

CA: How innocent of you. You are saying that the foolish people are the sound-minded people.

προσῆκει τῶν πόλεων ἄρχειν, καὶ τὸ δίκαιον τοῦτ' ἐστίν, πλεον ἔχειν τούτους τῶν ἄλλων, τοὺς ἄρχοντας τῶν ἀρχομένων. ΣΩ. τί δέ; αὐτῶν, ὦ ἑταῖρε, τί; ἢ τι ἄρχοντας ἢ ἀρχομένους; ΚΑΛ. πῶς λέγεις; ΣΩ. ἕνα ἕκαστον λέγω αὐτὸν ἑαυτοῦ ἄρχοντα· ἢ τοῦτο μὲν οὐδὲν δεῖ, αὐτὸν ἑαυτοῦ ἄρχειν, τῶν δὲ ἄλλων; ΚΑΛ. πῶς ἑαυτοῦ ἄρχοντα λέγεις; ΣΩ. οὐδὲν ποικίλον ἀλλ' ὥσπερ οἱ πολλοί, σώφρονα ὄντα καὶ ἐγκρατῆ αὐτὸν ἑαυτοῦ, τῶν ἡδονῶν καὶ ἐπιθυμιῶν

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S: How could I be? Anyone can see that that is not what I am saying.

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CA: It certainly is, Socrates! For how could a person become happy whilst in slavery to anyone else at all? No, I will speak frankly now, and tell you what is noble and just according to nature. Anyone who

would live rightly should allow his own desires to be as great as possible and not restrain them, but be competent to minister unto them when they are at their utmost, through courage and intelligence, and satisfy them with whatever the desire of the moment is for. But in my view, most people are unable to do this, and so out of shame they criticise people of this sort, concealing their own impotence. And, as I said earlier, they claim that this lack of restraint is base, enslaving the naturally superior men. Being unable themselves to attain fulfilment of their desires, they praise sound-mindedness and justice on account of their own cowardice. Yet for men who, from the very outset, are either sons of kings or are themselves naturally competent to secure some authority, be it a tyranny or a power-group, what in truth could be more base and ignoble for these men than sound-mindedness and justice? When they are allowed the benefit of good things with no interference from anyone, what could be worse than they themselves imposing a master on themselves – the law, word and censure of the majority of men? Or how could they avoid becoming wretched on account of this ‘benefit’ of justice and sound-mindedness, whereby they bestow no more upon their friends than upon their enemies, even though they are ruling in their own city? But in truth, Socrates – since you claim to pursue the truth – the fact of the matter is that luxury, lack of restraint and freedom, provided they have support, constitute excellence and happiness, while all else, the niceties and the unnatural contrivances of humanity, are foolishness, and of no value.

ἄρχοντα τῶν ἐν ἑαυτῷ. ΚΑΛ. ὡς ἡδὺς εἴ τοὺς ἡλιθίους λέγεις τοὺς σώφρονας. ΣΩ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; οὐδεὶς ὅστις οὐκ ἂν γνοίῃ ὅτι οὐ τοῦτο λέγω. ΚΑΛ. πάνυ γε σφόδρα, ὦ Σώκρατες. ἐπεὶ πῶς ἂν εὐδαίμων γένοιτο ἄνθρωπος δουλεύων ὀτρωῶν; ἀλλὰ τοῦτ' ἐστὶν τὸ κατὰ φύσιν καλὸν καὶ δίκαιον, ὃ ἐγὼ σοι νῦν παρρησιαζόμενος λέγω, ὅτι δεῖ τὸν ὀρθῶς βιωσόμενον τὰς μὲν ἐπιθυμίας τὰς ἑαυτοῦ ἔαν ὡς μεγίστας εἶναι καὶ μὴ κολάζειν, ταύταις δὲ ὡς μεγίσταις οὐσαις ἱκανὸν εἶναι ὑπηρετεῖν δι' ἀνδρείαν καὶ φρόνησιν, καὶ ἀπομιμνῆσθαι ὧν ἂν αἰεὶ ἡ

ἐπιθυμία γίγνηται. ἀλλὰ τοῦτ' οἶμαι τοῖς πολλοῖς οὐ δυνατόν· ὅθεν ψέγουσιν τοὺς τοιούτους δι' αἰσχύνην, ἀποκρυπτόμενοι τὴν αὐτῶν ἀδυναμίαν, καὶ αἰσχρὸν δὴ φασιν εἶναι τὴν ἀκολασίαν, ὅπερ ἐν τοῖς πρόσθεν ἐγὼ ἔλεγον, δουλούμενοι τοὺς βελτίους τὴν φύσιν ἀνθρώπους, καὶ αὐτοὶ οὐ δυνάμενοι ἐκπορίζεσθαι ταῖς ἡδοναῖς πλήρωσιν ἐπαινοῦσιν τὴν σωφροσύνην καὶ τὴν δικαιοσύνην διὰ τὴν αὐτῶν ἀνανδρίαν. ἐπεὶ ὅσοις ἐξ ἀρχῆς ὑπῆρξεν ἢ βασιλέων ὑέσιν εἶναι ἢ αὐτοὺς τῇ φύσει ἱκανοὺς ἐκπορίσασθαι ἀρχὴν τινα ἢ τυραννίδα ἢ δυναστείαν, τί ἂν τῇ ἀληθείᾳ αἷσχιον καὶ κάκιον εἴη σωφροσύνης καὶ δικαιοσύνης τούτοις τοῖς ἀνθρώποις, οἷς ἐξὸν ἀπολαύειν τῶν ἀγαθῶν καὶ μηδενὸς ἐμποδῶν ὄντος, αὐτοὶ ἑαυτοῖς δεσπότην ἐπαγάγοιντο τὸν τῶν πολλῶν ἀνθρώπων νόμον τε καὶ λόγον καὶ ψόγον; ἢ πῶς οὐκ ἂν ἄθλιοι γεγονότες εἶεν ὑπὸ τοῦ καλοῦ τοῦ τῆς δικαιοσύνης καὶ τῆς σωφροσύνης, μηδὲν πλεον νέμοντες τοῖς φίλοις τοῖς αὐτῶν ἢ τοῖς ἐχθροῖς, καὶ ταῦτα ἄρχοντες ἐν τῇ ἑαυτῶν πόλει; ἀλλὰ τῇ ἀληθείᾳ, ὧς Σώκρατες, ἦν φῆς σὺ διώκειν, ὧδ' ἔχει· τρυφὴ καὶ ἀκολασία καὶ ἐλευθερία, ἐὰν ἐπικουρίαν ἔχη, τοῦτ' ἐστὶν ἀρετὴ τε καὶ εὐδαιμονία, τὰ δὲ ἄλλα ταῦτ' ἐστὶν τὰ καλλωπίσματα, τὰ παρὰ φύσιν συνθήματα ἀνθρώπων, φλυαρία καὶ οὐδενὸς ἄξια.

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S: Callicles, the frankness with which you tackle the argument is not devoid of nobility. Indeed, you are now stating clearly what others are thinking, but they are reluctant to express this. So, I ask you not to relent in any way, so that the manner in which a person should live may actually become evident. Now tell me, do you say that the desires should not be restrained if a man is to be as he should be? Rather, letting them develop to the utmost, should he prepare satisfaction for them from any source whatsoever, and does this constitute excellence?

ΣΩ. οὐκ ἀγεννῶς γε, ὧς Καλλίκλεις, ἐπεξέρχη τῷ λόγῳ παρρησιαζόμενος· σαφῶς γὰρ σὺ νῦν λέγεις ἃ οἱ ἄλλοι διανοοῦνται μὲν, λέγειν δὲ οὐκ ἐθέλουσιν. δέομαι οὖν ἐγὼ σου μηδενὶ τρόπῳ ἀνεῖναι, ἵνα τῷ ὄντι κατάδηλον γένηται πῶς βιωτέον. καί μοι λέγε· τὰς

μὲν ἐπιθυμίας φῆς οὐ κολαστέον, εἰ μέλλει τις οἶον δεῖ εἶναι, ἔωντα δὲ αὐτὰς ὥς μεγίστας πλήρωσιν αὐταῖς ἀμόθεν γέ ποθεν ἐτοιμάζειν, καὶ

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CA: Yes. That is what I declare.

492e

S: So, it would not be correct to say that those who are in need of nothing are happy?

492e

CA: No, for in that case stones and corpses would be happiest.

492e

S: But surely the life you are describing is awful too. In fact, I would not be surprised if Euripides is speaking the truth, in the lines where he says,

Who knows whether being alive is being dead

*And being dead is being alive.*³⁰

And we perhaps are actually dead, for I heard at some stage, from one of the wise, that we are now dead and the body is our tomb, while this part of the soul in which the desires reside is prone to persuasion and to fluctuation back and forth. And some subtle person – perhaps a Sicilian or an Italian – told a story involving a play upon the words, and due to its credulous and persuadable nature he called it a pitcher, and the mindless people he called ‘uninitiated’, and the part of the soul of the mindless people in which the desires reside, the unrestrained and the unconfined part of it, he compared to a leaking pitcher because of its insatiability. Now, this fellow, in contrast to yourself, Callicles, indicates that these uninitiated people are the most wretched of those in Hades, by which he means ‘the unseen’, and they carry water to their leaky pitcher in another such leaky vessel, a sieve. And according to the person who told me this, he means that the sieve is the soul, and he likened the soul of the mindless people to a sieve because it is leaking, since due to disbelief and forgetfulness it is

unable to retain anything.

Now, this is all somewhat strange, yet it does indicate what I wish to prove to you, if I am able, in order to persuade you to change your stance and choose an orderly life, ever content and satisfied with what you have at any moment, rather than a life without restraint, and devoid of satisfaction. Well, am I persuading you, and are you changing to the view that the orderly people are happier than those without restraint? Or would you not change your position, even if I were to relate many more stories of this kind?

τοῦτο εἶναι τὴν ἀρετὴν; ΚΑΛ. φημὶ ταῦτα ἐγώ. ΣΩ. οὐκ ἄρα ὀρθῶς λέγονται οἱ μηδενὸς δεόμενοι εὐδαιμόνες εἶναι. ΚΑΛ. οἱ λίθοι γὰρ ἂν οὕτω γε καὶ οἱ νεκροὶ εὐδαιμονέστατοι εἶεν. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ μὲν δὴ καὶ ὥς γε σὺ λέγεις δεινὸς ὁ βίος. οὐ γάρ τοι θαυμάζοιμ' ἂν εἰ Εὐριπίδης ἀληθῆ ἐν τοῖσδε λέγει, λέγων—τίς δ' οἶδεν, εἰ τὸ ζῆν μὲν ἐστὶ κατθανεῖν, τὸ κατθανεῖν δὲ ζῆν; καὶ ἡμεῖς τῷ ὄντι ἴσως τέθναμεν· ἤδη γάρ του ἔγωγε καὶ ἤκουσα τῶν σοφῶν ὥς νῦν ἡμεῖς τέθναμεν καὶ τὸ μὲν σῶμά ἐστιν ἡμῖν σῆμα, τῆς δὲ ψυχῆς τοῦτο ἐν ᾧ ἐπιθυμίαι εἰσὶ τυγχάνει ὃν οἶον ἀναπειθεσθαι καὶ μεταπίπτειν ἄνω κάτω, καὶ τοῦτο ἄρα τις μυθολογῶν κομπῶς ἀνήρ, ἴσως Σικελὸς τις ἢ Ἰταλικός, παράγων τῷ ὀνόματι διὰ τὸ πιθανόν τε καὶ πειστικὸν ὠνόμασε πίθον, τοὺς δὲ ἀνοήτους ἀμυήτους, τῶν δ' ἀνοήτων τοῦτο τῆς ψυχῆς οὗ αἱ ἐπιθυμίαι εἰσὶ, τὸ ἀκόλαστον αὐτοῦ καὶ οὐ στεγανόν, ὥς τετρημένος εἴη πίθος, διὰ τὴν ἀπληστίαν ἀπεικάσας. τοῦναντίον δὴ οὗτος σοί, ᾧ Καλλίκλεις, ἐνδείκνυται ὥς τῶν ἐν Ἄιδου—τὸ αἰδὲς δὴ λέγων—οὗτοι ἀθλιώτατοι ἂν εἶεν, οἱ ἀμύητοι, καὶ φοροῖεν εἰς τὸν τετρημένον πίθον ὕδωρ ἐτέρῳ τοιοῦτῳ τετρημένῳ κοσκίνῳ. τὸ δὲ κόσκινον ἄρα λέγει, ὥς ἔφη ὁ πρὸς ἐμὲ λέγων, τὴν ψυχὴν εἶναι· τὴν δὲ ψυχὴν κοσκίνῳ ἀπήκασεν τὴν τῶν ἀνοήτων ὥς τετρημένην, ἅτε οὐ δυναμένην στέγειν δι' ἀπιστίαν τε καὶ λήθην. ταῦτ' ἐπεικῶς μὲν ἐστὶν ὑπὸ τι ἄτοπα, δηλοῖ μὴν ὃ ἐγὼ βούλομαι σοὶ ἐνδειξάμενος, ἐάν πως οἴος τε ᾧ, πεῖσαι μεταθέσθαι, ἀντὶ τοῦ ἀπλήστως καὶ ἀκολάστως ἔχοντος βίου τὸν κοσμίως καὶ τοῖς αἰὶ παροῦσιν ἱκανῶς καὶ ἐξαρκούντως ἔχοντα βίον ἐλέσθαι. ἀλλὰ πότερον

493d

CA: The latter option is truer, Socrates.

493d

S: Come on then, I will relate another image from the same school as this one. Yes, consider whether you are saying something of this sort about the lives of the sound-minded and unrestrained people. It is as if two men each have a number of pitchers, and in one case they are sound and full of wine, honey and milk. And there are many others with a variety of contents, but the supply of each of these is meagre and hard to come by and is made available with considerable exertion and difficulty. In one case, once filled, the man neither replenishes them nor worries about them, and on account of this he is at peace. But in the other case, as with the other man, the supply can be made available but it is hard to come by, and the vessels are leaky and unsound, so he is compelled to fill them constantly, night and day, or suffer intense pain. Now, since this is what their lives are like, would you say that the life of the unrestrained person is happier than that of the orderly person? In saying all this, do I persuade you at all to go along with the view that the orderly life is better than the unrestrained life, or are you unpersuaded?

πείθω τί σε καὶ μετατίθεσθαι εὐδαιμονεστέρους εἶναι τοὺς κοσμίους τῶν ἀκολάστων, ἢ οὐδ' ἂν ἄλλα πολλὰ τοιαῦτα μυθολογῶ, οὐδέν τι μᾶλλον μεταθήσῃ; ΚΑΛ. τοῦτ' ἀληθέστερον εἴρηκας, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. φέρε δὴ, ἄλλην σοι εἰκόνα λέγω ἐκ τοῦ αὐτοῦ γυμνασίου τῇ νῦν. σκόπει γὰρ εἰ τοιόνδε λέγεις περὶ τοῦ βίου ἐκατέρου, τοῦ τε σώφρονος καὶ τοῦ ἀκολάστου, οἷον εἰ δυοῖν ἀνδροῖν ἐκατέρῳ πίθοι πολλοὶ εἶεν καὶ τῷ μὲν ἐτέρῳ ὑγιεῖς καὶ πλήρεις, ὁ μὲν οἴνου, ὁ δὲ μέλιτος, ὁ δὲ γάλακτος, καὶ ἄλλοι πολλοὶ πολλῶν,νάματα δὲ σπάνια καὶ χαλεπὰ ἐκάστου τούτων εἴη καὶ μετὰ πολλῶν πόνων καὶ χαλεπῶν ἐκποριζόμενα· ΣΩ. ὁ μὲν οὖν ἕτερος πληρωσάμενος μήτ' ἐποχετεύει μήτε τι φροντίζει, ἀλλ' ἔνεκα τούτων ἡσυχίαν ἔχει· τῷ δ' ἐτέρῳ τὰ μὲννάματα, ὥσπερ καὶ ἐκείνῳ, δυνατὰ μὲν πορίζεσθαι, χαλεπὰ δέ, τὰ δ' ἀγγεῖα τετρημένα καὶ σαθρά, ἀναγκάζοιτο δ' ἀεὶ καὶ νύκτα καὶ

494a

CA: You do not persuade me, Socrates. For one man no longer has any pleasure at all once he has been filled, but as I said just now that is to live like a stone, no longer experiencing delight or tribulation once you have been filled up. But living a life of pleasure involves taking, inasmuch as you can.

ἡμέραν πιμπλάναι αὐτά, ἢ τὰς ἐσχάτας λυποῖτο λύπας· ἄρα τοιούτου ἑκατέρου ὄντος τοῦ βίου, λέγεις τὸν τοῦ ἀκολάστου εὐδαιμονέστερον εἶναι ἢ τὸν τοῦ κοσμίου; πείθω τί σε ταῦτα λέγων συγχωρῆσαι τὸν κόσμιον βίον τοῦ ἀκολάστου ἀμείνω εἶναι, ἢ οὐ πείθω; ΚΑΛ. οὐ πείθεις, ὦ Σώκρατες. τῷ μὲν γὰρ πληρωσαμένῳ ἐκείνῳ οὐκέτ' ἔστιν ἡδονὴ οὐδεμία, ἀλλὰ τοῦτ' ἔστιν, ὃ νυνδὴ ἐγὼ ἔλεγον, τὸ ὥσπερ λίθον ζῆν, ἐπειδὴν

494b

S: But if a lot is to flow in, mustn't a lot flow out? And mustn't the holes for the outflow be of considerable size?

494b

CA: Very much so.

494b

S: In that case, you are describing the life of a gull rather than a corpse or a stone. Are you referring to something like being hungry, and eating when you are hungry?

494b

CA: I am.

494b

S: Or being thirsty, and drinking when you are thirsty?

494b

CA: That's what I mean, and having all the other desires, and delighting in being able to satisfy them and live happily.

πληρώση, μήτε χαίροντα ἔτι μήτε λυπούμενον. ἀλλ' ἐν τούτῳ ἔστιν τὸ ἡδέως ζῆν, ἐν τῷ ὡς πλεῖστον ἐπιρρεῖν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἀνάγκη γ', ἂν πολὺ ἐπιρρέῃ, πολὺ καὶ τὸ ἀπιὸν εἶναι, καὶ μεγάλ' ἅττα τὰ τρήματα εἶναι ταῖς

ἐκροαῖς; ΚΑΛ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. χαραδριοῦ τινα αὖ σὺ βίον λέγεις, ἀλλ' οὐ νεκροῦ οὐδὲ λίθου. καί μοι λέγε· τὸ τοιόνδε λέγεις οἷον πεινῆν καὶ πεινῶντα ἐσθίειν; ΚΑΛ. ἔγωγε.

494c

S: Excellent, well said! Proceed as you have begun and take care that you suffer no shame. And it seems I must exhibit no shame either. So, tell me firstly whether someone who is itchy, and is scratching with unlimited scope for scratching, who spends his life scratching, is living happily.

494c

CA: How strange you are, Socrates, an out and out rabble-rouser!

494c

S: Yes, indeed, Callicles, and I shocked Polus and Gorgias and made them ashamed, but you should be neither shocked nor ashamed, for you are courageous. So, just answer the question.

494c

CA: In that case, I declare that the scratcher also lives pleasantly.

494c

S: Since he lives pleasantly, does he also live happily?

494c

CA: Certainly.

ΣΩ. καὶ διψῆν γε καὶ διψῶντα πίνειν; ΚΑΛ. λέγω, καὶ τὰς ἄλλας ἐπιθυμίας ἀπάσας ἔχοντα καὶ δυνάμενον πληροῦντα χαίροντα εὐδαιμόνως ζῆν. ΣΩ. εὖγε, ὦ βέλτιστε· διατέλει γὰρ ὥσπερ ἡρξω, καὶ ὅπως μὴ ἀπαισχυνῇ. δεῖ δέ, ὥς ἔοικε, μὴδ' ἐμὲ ἀπαισχυνθῆναι. καὶ πρῶτον μὲν εἶπε εἰ καὶ ψωρῶντα καὶ κνησιῶντα, ἀφθόνως ἔχοντα τοῦ κνῆσθαι, κνώμενον διατελοῦντα τὸν βίον εὐδαιμόνως ἔστι ζῆν.

494d

S: Is this so if he only scratches his head? What if I ask you about other parts? Consider how you would reply, Callicles, if someone were to ask about all the parts in turn, working down from there. And what about the ultimate consideration in all this, the life of the catamites?³¹ Is this

not terrible, shameful and wretched? Or will you dare to say that these fellows are happy provided they have unlimited access to what they want?

ΚΑΛ. ὥς ἄτοπος εἶ, ὦ Σώκρατες, καὶ ἀτεχνῶς δημηγόρος. ΣΩ. τοιγάρτοι, ὦ Καλλίκλεις, Πῶλον μὲν καὶ Γοργίαν καὶ ἐξέπληξα καὶ αἰσχύνεσθαι ἐποίησα, σὺ δὲ οὐ μὴ ἐκπλαγῆς οὐδὲ μὴ αἰσχυνομένης ἀνδρεῖος γὰρ εἶ. ἀλλ' ἀποκρίνου μόνον. ΚΑΛ. φημὶ τοίνυν καὶ τὸν κνώμενον ἡδέως ἂν βῶναι. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν εἴπερ ἡδέως, καὶ εὐδαιμόνως; ΚΑΛ. πάνυ γε.

494e

CA: Are you not ashamed at leading our discussion onto topics of this kind, Socrates?

494e

S: Am I the one who led us there, my noble friend? Or was it the person who said, in such absolute terms, that those who enjoy pleasure, regardless of how they enjoy it, are happy, and who did not distinguish between good pleasures and bad ones? But you should also declare now whether you are saying that pleasure and good are the same, or that there are some pleasures that are not good.

ΣΩ. πότερον εἰ τὴν κεφαλὴν μόνον κνησιῶ—ἢ ἔτι τί σε ἐρωτῶ; ὅρα, ὦ Καλλίκλεις, τί ἀποκρινῇ, ἐάν τις σε τὰ ἐχόμενα τούτοις ἐφεξῆς ἅπαντα ἐρωτᾷ. καὶ τούτων τοιούτων ὄντων κεφάλαιον, ὁ τῶν κιναιδῶν βίος, οὗτος οὐ δεινὸς καὶ αἰσχρὸς καὶ ἄθλιος; ἢ τούτους τολμήσεις λέγειν εὐδαίμονας εἶναι, ἐὰν ἀφθόνως ἔχωσιν ὧν δέονται; ΚΑΛ. οὐκ αἰσχύνη εἰς τοιαῦτα ἄγων, ὦ Σώκρατες, τοὺς λόγους; ΣΩ. ἢ γὰρ ἐγὼ ἄγω ἐνταῦθα, ὦ γενναῖε, ἢ ἐκεῖνος ὃς ἂν φῇ ἀνέδην οὕτω τοὺς χαίροντας, ὅπως ἂν χαίρωσιν,

495a

CA: Well, since my responses will be contradictory if I say they are different, I declare that they are the same.

495a

S: You are undermining your opening assertions, Callicles, and will no longer be investigating things that are, in an adequate manner, along

with me if you actually speak contrary to your own opinions.

495a

CA: The same goes for you, Socrates.

εὐδαίμονας εἶναι, καὶ μὴ διορίζηται τῶν ἡδονῶν ὅποια ἀγαθὰ καὶ κακαί; ἀλλ' ἔτι καὶ νῦν λέγε πότερον φῆς εἶναι τὸ αὐτὸ ἡδὺ καὶ ἀγαθόν, ἢ εἶναί τι τῶν ἡδέων ὃ οὐκ ἔστιν ἀγαθόν; ΚΑΛ. ἵνα δὴ μοι μὴ ἀνομολογούμενος ἦ ὁ λόγος, ἐὰν ἕτερον φήσω εἶναι, τὸ αὐτὸ φημὶ εἶναι. ΣΩ. διαφθείρεις, ὦ Καλλίκλεις, τοὺς πρώτους λόγους, καὶ οὐκ ἂν ἔτι μετ' ἐμοῦ ἱκανῶς τὰ ὄντα ἐξετάζοις, εἴπερ παρὰ τὰ δοκοῦντα σαυτῷ ἐρεῖς.

495b

S: Then if I am actually doing this, neither of us is acting correctly. But, blessed man, consider the possibility that the good may not be this unqualified gratification. Indeed, if this is how matters stand, then the many shameful conclusions I hinted at just now, and many more besides, must follow.

495b

CA: That's what you think anyway, Socrates.

495b

S: And do you really hold to those views, Callicles?

495b

CA: I do.

ΚΑΛ. καὶ γὰρ σύ, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. οὐ τοίνυν ὀρθῶς ποιῶ οὔτ' ἐγώ, εἴπερ ποιῶ τοῦτο, οὔτε σύ. ἀλλ', ὦ μακάριε, ἄθρει μὴ οὐ τοῦτο ἦ τὸ ἀγαθόν, τὸ πάντως χαίρειν· ταῦτά τε γὰρ τὰ νυνδὴ αἰνιχθέντα πολλὰ καὶ αἰσχροῖα φαίνεται συμβαίνοντα, εἰ τοῦτο οὕτως ἔχει, καὶ ἄλλα πολλά. ΚΑΛ. ὥς σύ γε οἶει, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. σὺ δὲ τῷ ὄντι, ὦ Καλλίκλεις, ταῦτα ἰσχυρίζῃ; ΚΑΛ. ἔγωγε.

495c

S: So, should we tackle this argument on the basis that you are serious about it?

495c

CA: Yes, very much so.

495c

S: Come on then, since that is what you think. Make the following distinctions for me. I presume there is something you refer to as knowledge?

495c

CA: There is.

495c

S: And did you not say just now that courage is something that may accompany knowledge?

495c

CA: I said so indeed.

495c

S: So, on the basis that courage is different from knowledge, you referred to two things?

495c

CA: Most emphatically.

495c

S: What about this? Are pleasure and knowledge the same or different?

ΣΩ. ἐπιχειρῶμεν ἄρα τῷ λόγῳ ὡς σοῦ σπουδάζοντος; ΚΑΛ. πάνυ γε σφόδρα. ΣΩ. ἴθι δὴ μοι, ἐπειδὴ οὕτω δοκεῖ, διελοῦ τάδε ἐπιστήμην που καλεῖς τι; ΚΑΛ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. οὐ καὶ ἀνδρείαν νυνδὴ ἔλεγές τινα εἶναι μετὰ ἐπιστήμης; ΚΑΛ. ἔλεγον γάρ. ΣΩ. ἄλλο τι οὖν ὡς ἕτερον τὴν ἀνδρείαν τῆς ἐπιστήμης δύο ταῦτα ἔλεγε; ΚΑΛ. σφόδρα γε. ΣΩ. τί δέ; ἡδονὴν καὶ ἐπιστήμην ταῦτὸν ἢ ἕτερον;

495d

CA: Different of course, O wisest of men.

495d

S: And is courage different from pleasure?

495d

CA: How could it not be?

495d

S: Come then, make sure we remember that Callicles of Acharnae declares pleasure and good to be the same, but knowledge and courage to be different from one another, and from the good.

495d

CA: And Socrates of Alopece disagrees with us on this. Or does he agree?

ΚΑΛ. ἕτερον δήπου, ὦ σοφώτατε σύ. ΣΩ. ἦ καὶ ἀνδρείαν ἐτέραν ἡδονῆς; ΚΑΛ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΣΩ. φέρε δὴ ὅπως μεμνησόμεθα ταῦτα, ὅτι Καλλικλῆς ἔφη Ἀχαρνεὺς ἡδὺ μὲν καὶ ἀγαθὸν ταὐτὸν εἶναι, ἐπιστήμην δὲ καὶ ἀνδρείαν καὶ ἀλλήλων καὶ τοῦ ἀγαθοῦ ἕτερον. ΚΑΛ. Σωκράτης δέ γε ἡμῖν ὁ Ἀλωπεκῆθεν οὐχ ὁμολογεῖ ταῦτα. ἦ ὁμολογεῖ;

495e

S: He does not agree, and I do not think Callicles will agree either once he sees himself correctly. Indeed, tell me. Do you not believe that those who are acting well are characterised by the opposite quality to those who act badly?

495e

CA: I do.

495e

S: Well then, since these are opposite to one another, must not the same consideration apply to them as applies to being healthy and to being ill? For a person is obviously not healthy and ill at the same time, nor is he rid of health and illness at the same time.

495e

CA: What do you mean?

ΣΩ. οὐχ ὁμολογεῖ οἷμαι δέ γε οὐδὲ Καλλικλῆς, ὅταν αὐτὸς αὐτὸν θεάσῃται ὀρθῶς. εἰπὲ γάρ μοι, τοὺς εὖ πράττοντας τοῖς κακῶς πράττουσιν οὐ τὸνναντίον ἡγῇ πάθος πεπονθέναι; ΚΑΛ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν, εἴπερ ἐναντία ἐστὶν ταῦτα ἀλλήλοις, ἀνάγκη περὶ αὐτῶν ἔχειν ὥσπερ περὶ ὑγιείας ἔχει καὶ νόσου; οὐ γὰρ ἅμα δήπου ὑγιαίνει τε καὶ

νοσεῖ ὁ ἄνθρωπος, οὐδὲ ἅμα ἀπαλλάττεται ὑγιείας τε καὶ νόσου. ΚΑΛ. πῶς λέγεις; ΣΩ. οἷον περὶ οὗτου βούλει τοῦ σώματος ἀπολαβῶν

496a

S: For example, take any part of the body you wish, and consider it. Can a person get the disease of the eyes called ophthalmia?

496a

CA: Of course he can.

496a

S: And the same eyes are obviously not, simultaneously, healthy.

496a

CA: Not at all.

496a

S: But what happens when he is rid of the ophthalmia? Is he also rid of the health at that stage, and does he end up rid of both at the same time?

496a

CA: Not in the least.

σκόπει. νοσεῖ που ἄνθρωπος ὀφθαλμούς, ᾧ ὄνομα ὀφθαλμία; ΚΑΛ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΣΩ. οὐ δήπου καὶ ὑγιαίνει γε ἅμα τοὺς αὐτούς; ΚΑΛ. οὐδ' ὁπωστιοῦν. ΣΩ. τί δὲ ὅταν τῆς ὀφθαλμίας ἀπαλλάττεται; ἄρα τότε καὶ τῆς ὑγιείας ἀπαλλάττεται τῶν ὀφθαλμῶν καὶ τελευτῶν ἅμα ἀμφοτέρων ἀπῆλλακται; ΚΑΛ. ἥκιστα γε. ΣΩ. θαυμάσιον γὰρ

496b

S: Yes, I think that would be a strange and illogical outcome. Is that so?

496b

CA: Very much so.

496b

S: Rather, I believe we acquire either of them and lose them in turn.

496b

CA: I agree.

496b

S: Does not the same go for strength and weakness?

496b

CA: Yes.

496b

S: And for swiftiness and slowness?

496b

CA: Certainly.

οἶμαι καὶ ἄλογον γίγνεται· ἦ γάρ; ΚΑΛ. σφόδρα γε. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' ἐν μέρει οἶμαι ἐκάτερον καὶ λαμβάνει καὶ ἀπολλύει; ΚΑΛ. φημί. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ ἰσχὺν καὶ ἀσθένειαν ὡσαύτως; ΚΑΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. καὶ τάχος καὶ βραδυτήτα; ΚΑΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. ἦ καὶ τᾶγαθὰ καὶ τὴν εὐδαιμονίαν καὶ τᾶναντία τούτων, κακὰ τε καὶ ἀθλιότητα, ἐν μέρει λαμβάνει καὶ ἐν μέρει ἀπαλλάττεται ἐκατέρου; ΚΑΛ. πάντως δήπου.

496c

S: And for anything good and for happiness, and the opposites of these, anything bad and wretchedness. Are they acquired in turn, and are we quit of either of them in turn?

496c

CA: That is totally obvious.

496c

S: So, if we were to find any qualities that a person is quit of and possesses at the same time, it is obvious that these would not be the good and the bad. Do we agree on this? And give this very serious consideration before you reply.

496c

CA: But I couldn't agree more!

496c

S: Let us go back to what we agreed upon earlier. Did you say that hunger was pleasant or unpleasant? I am referring just to the hunger.

496c

CA: I say it is unpleasant, but to eat when hungry is pleasant.

ΣΩ. ἐὰν εὕρωμεν ἄρα ἅττα ὧν ἅμα τε ἀπαλλάττεται ἄνθρωπος καὶ ἅμα ἔχει, δηλὸν ὅτι ταῦτά γε οὐκ ἂν εἴη τό τε ἀγαθὸν καὶ τὸ κακόν. ὁμολογοῦμεν ταῦτα; καὶ εὖ μάλα σκεψάμενος ἀποκρίνου. ΚΑΛ. ἀλλ' ὑπερφυῶς ὡς ὁμολογῶ. ΣΩ. ἴθι δὴ ἐπὶ τὰ ἔμπροσθεν ὡμολογημένα. τὸ πεινῆν ἔλεγες πότερον ἡδὺ ἢ ἀνιαρὸν εἶναι; αὐτὸ λέγω τὸ πεινῆν. ΚΑΛ. ἀνιαρὸν ἔγωγε· τὸ μέντοι πεινῶντα ἐσθίειν ἡδὺ

496d

S: So do I. I understand. However, the hunger itself is unpleasant, is it not?

496d

CA: I agree.

496d

S: Does not the same go for thirst?

496d

CA: Very much so.

496d

S: Now, should I ask you even more questions, or do you agree that all lack and desire is unpleasant?

496d

CA: I do. Stop asking.

496d

S: So be it. And do you agree that to drink when thirsty is pleasant?

496d

CA: I do.

496d

S: So, this formulation 'when thirsty' obviously means 'when in pain'.

496d

CA: Yes.

496d

S: And the drinking is both the satisfaction of the lack, and a pleasure.

496d

CA: Yes.

496d

S: Therefore, whilst the drinking takes place, you say there is enjoyment.

496d

CA: Certainly.

496d

S: When you are thirsty anyway.

496d

CA: I agree.

496d

S: And experiencing pain?

496d

CA: Yes.

λέγω. ΣΩ. μανθάνω· ἀλλ' οὖν τό γε πεινῆν αὐτὸ ἀνιαρόν. ἢ οὐχί; ΚΑΛ. φημί. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ τὸ διψῆν; ΚΑΛ. σφόδρα γε. ΣΩ. πότερον οὖν ἔτι πλείω ἐρωτῶ, ἢ ὁμολογεῖς ἅπασαν ἔνδειαν καὶ ἐπιθυμίαν ἀνιαρόν εἶναι; ΚΑΛ. ὁμολογῶ, ἀλλὰ μὴ ἐρώτα. ΣΩ. εἶεν· διψῶντα δὲ δὴ πίνειν ἄλλο τι ἢ ἡδὺ φῆς εἶναι; ΚΑΛ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τούτου οὐ λέγεις τὸ μὲν διψῶντα λυπούμενον δήπου ἐστίν;

496e

S: Now, are you aware of the conclusion that whenever you say that you drink whilst thirsty, you are saying that you experience enjoyment and are in pain simultaneously? Does this not occur at the same time and in the same place, be it in soul or in body? I do not think it makes any difference which it is. Is this the case or is it not?

496e

CA: It is.

496e

S: However, you do declare that acting well and acting badly at the same time is impossible.

496e

CA: Yes, I do.

496e

S: And yet you have agreed that it is possible to have enjoyment whilst experiencing displeasure.

496e

CA: Apparently.

ΚΑΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. τὸ δὲ πίνειν πλήρωςίς τε τῆς ἐνδείας καὶ ἡδονῇ; ΚΑΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν κατὰ τὸ πίνειν χαίρειν λέγεις; ΚΑΛ. μάλιστα. ΣΩ. διψῶντά γε. ΚΑΛ. φημί. ΣΩ. λυπούμενον; ΚΑΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. αἰσθάνη οὖν τὸ συμβαῖνον, ὅτι λυπούμενον χαίρειν λέγεις ἅμα, ὅταν διψῶντα πίνειν λέγῃς; ἢ οὐχ ἅμα τοῦτο γίγνεται κατὰ τὸν αὐτὸν τόπον καὶ χρόνον εἴτε ψυχῆς εἴτε σώματος βούλει; οὐδὲν γὰρ οἶμαι διαφέρει. ἔστι ταῦτα ἢ οὐ; ΚΑΛ. ἔστιν. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ μὴν εὖ γε πράττοντα κακῶς

497a

S: So, enjoyment is not ‘acting well’, nor is displeasure ‘acting badly’, and consequently pleasure turns out to be different from the good.

497a

CA: I don’t understand these wise utterances of yours, Socrates.

497a

S: You do understand but you are playing the simpleton, Callicles. Just move on to the next point anyway so that you may know how wise you are to admonish me. Does not each of us cease being thirsty and simultaneously cease being pleased by the drinking?

497a

CA: I do not know what you mean.

πράττειν ἅμα ἀδύνατον φῆς εἶναι. ΚΑΛ. φημί γάρ. ΣΩ. ἀνιώμενον δέ γε χαίρειν δυνατὸν ὠμολόγηκας. ΚΑΛ. φαίνεται. ΣΩ. οὐκ ἄρα τὸ χαίρειν ἔστιν εὖ πράττειν οὐδὲ τὸ ἀνιάσθαι κακῶς, ὥστε ἕτερον γίγνεται τὸ ἡδὺ τοῦ ἀγαθοῦ. ΚΑΛ. οὐκ οἶδ’ ἅττα σοφίζῃ, ὦ Σώκратες. ΣΩ. οἶσθα, ἀλλὰ ἀκκίζῃ, ὦ Καλλίκλεις; καὶ πρόιθι γε ἔτι εἰς τὸ ἔμπροσθεν, ὅτι ἔχων ληρεῖς ἵνα εἰδῆς ὡς σοφὸς

497b

GO: Don't be like that, Callicles, but answer him for our sake too so that the arguments may be concluded.

497b

CA: But Socrates is always like this, Gorgias. He asks petty, worthless questions, and refutes people.

497b

GO: But why does it matter to you? It is not really up to you to assess their worth, Callicles, but to allow Socrates to carry out his refutation in any way he pleases.

ὥν με νοουθετεῖς, οὐχ ἅμα διψῶν τε ἕκαστος ἡμῶν πέπνυται καὶ ἅμα ἡδόμενος διὰ τοῦ πίνειν; ΚΑΛ. οὐκ οἶδα ὅτι λέγεις. ΓΟΡ. μηδαμῶς, ὦ Καλλίκλεις, ἀλλ' ἀποκρίνου καὶ ἡμῶν ἕνεκα, ἵνα περανθῶσιν οἱ λόγοι. ΚΑΛ. ἀλλ' ἀεὶ τοιοῦτός ἐστιν Σωκράτης, ὦ Γοργία· σμικρὰ καὶ ὀλίγου ἄξια ἀνερωτᾷ καὶ ἐξελέγχει. ΓΟΡ. ἀλλὰ τί σοὶ διαφέρει; πάντως οὐ σὴ αὕτη ἡ τιμή, ὦ Καλλίκλεις· ἀλλ' ὑπόσχες Σωκράτει ἐξελέγξαι ὅπως ἂν βούληται.

497c

CA: Well, since that is what Gorgias thinks, ask your petty, restrictive questions.

497c

S: You are blessed, Callicles, that you have been initiated into the Great Mysteries prior to the Lesser ones.³² I did not realise that this was permitted. Now, answer the question from where you left off. Does not each of us cease being thirsty and simultaneously cease experiencing pleasure?

497c

CA: I agree.

497c

S: In that case, is there cessation of hunger and the other desires, and cessation of pleasures simultaneously?

497c

CA: This is the case.

ΚΑΛ. Ἐρώτα δὴ σὺ τὰ σμικρά τε καὶ στενὰ ταῦτα, ἐπείπερ Γοργία δοκεῖ οὕτως. ΣΩ. εὐδαίμων εἶ, ὦ Καλλίκλεις, ὅτι τὰ μεγάλα μεμύησαι πρὶν τὰ σμικρά· ἐγὼ δ' οὐκ ὥμην θεμιτὸν εἶναι. ὅθεν οὖν ἀπέλιπες ἀποκρίνου, εἰ οὐχ ἅμα παύεται διψῶν ἕκαστος ἡμῶν καὶ ἡδόμενος. ΚΑΛ. φημί. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ πεινῶν καὶ τῶν ἄλλων ἐπιθυμιῶν καὶ ἡδονῶν ἅμα παύεται; ΚΑΛ. ἔστι ταῦτα. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ τῶν λυπῶν

497d

S: Therefore, there is a simultaneous cessation of the pains and the pleasures?

497d

CA: Yes.

497d

S: However, as you have agreed, there is not a simultaneous cessation of whatever is good and whatever is bad. But do you not agree now?

497d

CA: I agree. So what?

497d

S: Then, whatever is good, my friend, turns out not to be the same as whatever is pleasant, nor is what is bad the same as what is unpleasant. For in one case there is simultaneous cessation, and in the other case there is not, because they are different. So, how could whatever is pleasant be the same as whatever is good, or the unpleasant be the same as whatever is bad?

But consider it in the following manner if you prefer, for I do not think you agree based on this approach. Look at it this way. Do you not call good people good, due to the presence of goods, just as you call those to whom beauty is present, beautiful?

καὶ τῶν ἡδονῶν ἅμα παύεται; ΚΑΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ μὴν τῶν ἀγαθῶν γε καὶ κακῶν οὐχ ἅμα παύεται, ὥς σὺ ὠμολόγεις· νῦν δὲ οὐχ ὁμολογεῖς; ΚΑΛ. ἔγωγε· τί οὖν δῆ; ΣΩ. ὅτι οὐ τὰ αὐτὰ γίγνεται, ὦ φίλε, τὰγαθὰ τοῖς ἡδέσιν οὐδὲ τὰ κακὰ τοῖς ἀνιστοῦσι. τῶν μὲν γὰρ ἅμα παύεται, τῶν δὲ

οὐ, ὥς ἐτέρων ὄντων· πῶς οὖν ταῦτ' ἂν εἴη τὰ ἡδέα τοῖς ἀγαθοῖς ἢ τὰ ἀνιαρὰ τοῖς κακοῖς; ἐὰν δὲ βούλῃ, καὶ τῇδε ἐπίσκειπαι (οἶμαι γάρ σοι οὐδὲ ταύτῃ

497e

CA: I do.

497e

S: What about this? Do you refer to the unintelligent and cowards as good men? Well, you did not do so earlier anyway; rather, you said the good were the courageous and intelligent. Or do you not refer to these men as good?

497e

CA: I certainly do.

497e

S: What about this? Have you ever seen an unintelligent child being delighted?

497e

CA: I have.

497e

S: And have you ever yet seen an unintelligent man being delighted?

497e

CA: I think I have, but what about it?

ὁμολογεῖσθαι· ἄθρει δέ) τοὺς ἀγαθοὺς οὐχὶ ἀγαθῶν παρουσίᾳ ἀγαθοὺς καλεῖς, ὥσπερ τοὺς καλοὺς οἷς ἂν κάλλος παρῇ; ΚΑΛ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. τί δέ; ἀγαθοὺς ἄνδρας καλεῖς ἄφρονας καὶ δειλοὺς; οὐ γὰρ ἄρτι γε, ἀλλὰ τοὺς ἀνδρείους καὶ φρονίμους ἔλεγες· ἢ οὐ τούτους ἀγαθοὺς καλεῖς; ΚΑΛ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. τί δέ; παῖδα ἀνόητον χαίροντα ἤδη εἶδες; ΚΑΛ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. ἄνδρα δὲ οὕτω εἶδες ἀνόητον χαίροντα; ΚΑΛ. οἶμαι ἔγωγε· ἀλλὰ τί τοῦτο;

498a

S: Nothing, just answer.

498a

CA: I have seen this.

498a

S: And does someone possessed of intelligence experience pain and delight?

498a

CA: I agree.

498a

S: But who experiences delight and pain to the greatest extent, the intelligent or the foolish?

498a

CA: Well, I don't think they differ very much.

498a

S: That will do. And have you ever seen a cowardly man in battle?

498a

CA: Of course.

498a

S: What about the withdrawal of the enemy? Which of them seemed to you to be most delighted, the cowards or the courageous?

ΣΩ. οὐδέν· ἀλλ' ἀποκρίνου. ΚΑΛ. εἶδον. ΣΩ. τί δέ; νοῦν ἔχοντα λυπούμενον καὶ χαίροντα; ΚΑΛ. φημί. ΣΩ. πότεροι δὲ μᾶλλον χαίρουσι καὶ λυποῦνται, οἱ φρόνιμοι ἢ οἱ ἄφρονες; ΚΑΛ. οἷμαι ἔγωγε οὐ πολὺ τι διαφέρειν. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' ἀρκεῖ καὶ τοῦτο. ἐν πολέμῳ δὲ ἤδη εἶδες ἄνδρα δειλόν; ΚΑΛ. πῶς γὰρ οὔ; ΣΩ. τί οὔν; ἀπιόντων τῶν πολέμιων πότεροί σοι ἐδόκουν μᾶλλον χαίρειν, οἱ δειλοὶ ἢ οἱ ἀνδρεῖοι; ΚΑΛ. ἀμφοτέροι ἔμοιγε

498b

CA: Both, in my view, but perhaps the cowards delight more, or else they are nearly equal.

498b

S: That makes no difference. So, the cowards are delighted too?

498b

CA: Intensely so.

μᾶλλον· εἰ δὲ μή, παραπλησίως γε. ΣΩ. οὐδὲν διαφέρει. χαίρουσιν δ' οὖν καὶ οἱ δειλοί; ΚΑΛ. σφόδρα γε. ΣΩ. καὶ οἱ ἄφρονες, ὥς ἔοικεν. ΚΑΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. προσιόντων δὲ οἱ δειλοὶ μόνον λυποῦνται ἢ καὶ οἱ ἀνδρεῖοι; ΚΑΛ. ἀμφοτέρω. ΣΩ. ἄρα ὁμοίως; ΚΑΛ. μᾶλλον ἴσως οἱ δειλοί. ΣΩ. ἀπιόντων δ' οὐ μᾶλλον χαίρουσιν; ΚΑΛ. ἴσως. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν λυποῦνται μὲν καὶ χαίρουσιν καὶ οἱ ἄφρονες καὶ οἱ φρόνιμοι καὶ οἱ δειλοὶ καὶ οἱ ἀνδρεῖοι παραπλησίως,

498c

S: The fools too, so it seems.

498c

CA: Yes.

498c

S: And at the approach of the enemy, do the cowardly alone experience pain? Or do the courageous do so too?

498c

CA: Both.

498c

S: To a similar extent?

498c

CA: Perhaps the cowardly experience it more.

498c

S: But do they not experience more delight at the withdrawal?

498c

CA: Perhaps.

498c

S: Then according to you, the foolish and the intelligent, the cowardly and the brave, experience pain and delight to a similar extent, although the cowardly experience them to a greater extent than the brave?

498c

CA: I agree.

498c

S: However, the intelligent and courageous are good, while the cowardly and foolish are bad?

498c

CA: Yes.

498c

S: Then the good and the bad experience delight and pain to a similar extent?

498c

CA: I agree.

ὥς σὺ φῆς, μᾶλλον δὲ οἱ δειλοὶ τῶν ἀνδρείων; ΚΑΛ. φημί. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ μὴν οἷ γε φρόνιμοι καὶ οἱ ἀνδρεῖοι ἀγαθοί, οἱ δὲ δειλοὶ καὶ ἄφρονες κακοί; ΚΑΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. παραπλησίως ἄρα χαίρουσιν καὶ λυποῦνται οἱ ἀγαθοὶ καὶ οἱ κακοί; ΚΑΛ. φημί. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν παραπλησίως εἰσὶν ἀγαθοὶ καὶ κακοὶ οἱ ἀγαθοὶ τε καὶ οἱ κακοί; ἢ καὶ ἔτι μᾶλλον ἀγαθοὶ οἱ ἀγαθοὶ καὶ οἱ κακοὶ εἰσιν οἱ κακοί;

498d

S: So, are the good people and the bad people good and bad to a similar extent? Or are the bad people even more good?

498d

CA: By Zeus, I do not know what you are saying.

498d

S: Do you not know that you are saying that the good are good by the presence of goods, and the bad are bad by the presence of what is bad? And that the goods are the pleasures, and what is bad are the displeasures?

498d

CA: I do.

498d

S: Are not the goods, the pleasures, present to those who are experiencing delight, if they are actually experiencing delight?

498d

CA: Obviously.

498d

S: And since goods are present, are not those who experience delight good?

498d

CA: Yes.

498d

S: What about this? Are not bad things, pains, present to those who experience displeasure?

498d

CA: Yes, they are present.

498d

S: And yet you think that the bad people are bad due to the presence of what is bad. Or do you no longer say so?

498d

CA: I do.

498d

S: So, those who experience delight are good, while those who experience displeasure are bad.

498d

CA: Entirely so.

ΚΑΛ. ἀλλὰ μὰ Δί' οὐκ οἶδ' ὅτι λέγεις. ΣΩ. οὐκ οἶσθ' ὅτι τοὺς ἀγαθοὺς ἀγαθῶν φῆς παρουσίᾳ εἶναι ἀγαθοῦς, καὶ κακοῦς δὲ κακῶν; τὰ δὲ ἀγαθὰ εἶναι τὰς ἡδονάς, κακὰ δὲ τὰς ἀνίας; ΚΑΛ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τοῖς χαίρουσιν πάρεστιν τὰγαθὰ, αἱ ἡδοναί, εἴπερ χαίρουσιν; ΚΑΛ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἀγαθῶν παρόντων ἀγαθοὶ εἰσιν οἱ χαίροντες; ΚΑΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. τί δέ; τοῖς ἀνιωμένοις οὐ πάρεστιν τὰ κακὰ, αἱ λυπαι; ΚΑΛ. πάρεστιν.

498e

S: Those who experience these to a greater extent are so to a greater extent. Those who experience these to a lesser extent are so to a lesser extent. Those who experience these to a similar extent are so to a similar extent.

498e

CA: Yes.

498e

S: Now, do you not claim that the intelligent men and the fools, the cowardly and the courageous, are delighted and pained to a similar extent, or that the cowardly experience them even more?

498e

CA: I do.

ΣΩ. κακῶν δέ γε παρουσίᾳ φῆς σὺ εἶναι κακοὺς τοὺς κακοὺς ἢ οὐκέτι φῆς; ΚΑΛ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. ἀγαθοὶ ἄρα οἱ ἂν χαίρωσι, κακοὶ δὲ οἱ ἂν ἀνιῶνται; ΚΑΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. οἱ μὲν γε μᾶλλον μᾶλλον, οἱ δ' ἥττον ἥττον, οἱ δὲ παραπλησίως παραπλησίως; ΚΑΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν φῆς παραπλησίως χαίρειν καὶ λυπεῖσθαι τοὺς φρονίμους καὶ τοὺς ἄφρονας καὶ τοὺς δειλοὺς καὶ τοὺς ἀνδρείους, ἢ καὶ μᾶλλον ἔτι τοὺς δειλοὺς; ΚΑΛ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. συλλόγισαι δὴ κοινῇ μετ' ἐμοῦ τί ἡμῖν συμβαίνει ἐκ τῶν ὠμολογημένων καὶ δις γάρ τοι καὶ τρίς φασιν καλὸν

499a

S: Well, please sum up what follows from all that we have agreed, along with me. For they say it is well to state and investigate anything exalted twice or even thrice. We say that the intelligent and courageous man is good. Is this so?

499a

CA: Yes.

499a

S: But the foolish and cowardly man is bad?

499a

CA: Entirely so.

499a

S: And what is more, the man who experiences delight is good?

499a

CA: Yes.

499a

S: And the man who experiences displeasure is bad?

499a

CA: Necessarily.

499a

S: So, the good and the bad experience displeasure and delight to a similar extent, but perhaps the bad person experiences them more?

499a

CA: Yes.

εἶναι τὰ καλὰ λέγειν τε καὶ ἐπισκοπεῖσθαι. ἀγαθὸν μὲν εἶναι τὸν φρόνιμον καὶ ἀνδρεῖόν φαμεν. ἦ γάρ; ΚΑΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. κακὸν δὲ τὸν ἄφρονα καὶ δειλόν; ΚΑΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. ἀγαθὸν δὲ αὖ τὸν χαίροντα; ΚΑΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. κακὸν δὲ τὸν ἀνιώμενον; ΚΑΛ. ἀνάγκη. ΣΩ. ἀνιᾶσθαι δὲ καὶ χαίρειν τὸν ἀγαθὸν καὶ κακὸν ὁμοίως, ἴσως δὲ καὶ μᾶλλον τὸν κακόν; ΚΑΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ὁμοίως γίγνεται κακὸς καὶ ἀγαθὸς τῷ ἀγαθῷ ἢ καὶ μᾶλλον

499b

S: Does it not turn out that the bad man is good and bad to a similar extent as the good man, or is even more good? Do not these, and those former consequences, follow once someone declares that pleasures and good are the same? Is this not necessarily the case, Callicles?

499b

CA: Socrates, I have been listening to you for some time now, making concessions and reflecting that if someone grants you anything at all, even in jest, you hold onto it in delight just like a child. Do you really think that I, or any other man whatsoever, does not realise that some pleasures are better and some are worse?

ἀγαθὸς ὁ κακός; οὐ ταῦτα συμβαίνει καὶ τὰ πρότερα ἐκεῖνα, ἐάν τις ταῦτ' αὖ φῇ ἡδέα τε καὶ ἀγαθὰ εἶναι; οὐ ταῦτα ἀνάγκη, ὦ Καλλίκλεις; ΚΑΛ. πάλαί τοί σου ἀκροῶμαι, ὦ Σώκρατες, καθομολογῶν, ἐνθυμούμενος ὅτι, κἄν παίζων τίς σοι ἐνδῶ ὅτιοῦν, τούτου ἄσμενος ἔχη ὥσπερ τὰ μειράκια. ὥς δὴ σὺ οἶει ἐμὲ ἢ καὶ ἄλλον ὄντινοῦν

ἀνθρώπων οὐχ ἡγεῖσθαι τὰς μὲν βελτίους ἡδονάς, τὰς δὲ χείρους. ΣΩ.
 ἰοῦ ἰοῦ, ὦ Καλλίκλεις, ὥς πανοῦργος εἶ καί μοι

499c

S: My, my, Callicles. How clever you are, and how like a child you treat me, deceiving me by saying at one moment that this is how matters stand, and the next moment that the same matters stand otherwise. And yet, I had not expected at the outset that I would be intentionally deceived by you since you are my friend. But now I have been played false, and it seems necessary for me, as the old saying goes, ‘to make the best of what is there’ and to accept what you have given me. And, indeed, what you are now saying, it seems, is that certain pleasures are good, while others are bad. Is this so?

ὥσπερ παιδὶ χρῆ, τοτὲ μὲν τὰ αὐτὰ φάσκων οὕτως ἔχειν, τοτὲ δὲ
 ἑτέρως, ἐξαπατῶν με. καίτοι οὐκ ὥμην γε κατ’ ἀρχὰς ὑπὸ σοῦ ἐκόντος
 εἶναι ἐξαπατηθήσεσθαι, ὥς ὄντος φίλου· νῦν δὲ ἐψεύσθην, καὶ ὥς
 ἔοικεν ἀνάγκη μοι κατὰ τὸν παλαιὸν λόγον τὸ παρὸν εὖ ποιεῖν καὶ
 τοῦτο δέχεσθαι τὸ διδόμενον παρὰ σοῦ. ἔστιν δὲ δή, ὥς ἔοικεν, ὃ νῦν
 λέγεις, ὅτι ἡδοναὶ τινὲς εἰσιν αἱ μὲν ἀγαθαί, αἱ δὲ κακαί· ἢ γάρ;

499d

CA: Yes.

499d

S: Well, are the beneficial pleasures good, while the harmful ones are bad?

499d

CA: Certainly.

499d

S: And do the beneficial ones bring about something good, the harmful ones something bad?

499d

CA: I agree.

499d

S: So, do you mean, for instance, in the case of the bodily pleasures we referred to just now, pleasures of eating and drinking, that those producing health or strength or some other physical excellence in the body are good, while those producing the opposite effects to these are bad?

ΚΑΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν ἀγαθαὶ μὲν αἱ ὠφέλιμοι, κακαὶ δὲ αἱ βλαβεραί;
ΚΑΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. ὠφέλιμοι δέ γε αἱ ἀγαθὸν τι ποιοῦσαι, κακαὶ δὲ αἱ
κακὸν τι; ΚΑΛ. φημί. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν τὰς τοιάσδε λέγεις, οἷον κατὰ τὸ σῶμα
ὅς νυνδὴ ἐλέγομεν ἐν τῷ ἐσθίειν καὶ πίνειν ἡδονάς, ἥ ἄρα τούτων αἱ
μὲν ὑγίειαν ποιοῦσαι ἐν τῷ σώματι, ἢ ἰσχὺν ἢ ἄλλην τινὰ ἀρετὴν τοῦ
σώματος, αὗται μὲν ἀγαθαί, αἱ δὲ

499e

CA: Certainly.

499e

S: Does not the same go for pains – some are useful while others are evil?

499e

CA: Inevitably.

499e

S: Should the useful pleasures and pains be selected and enacted?

499e

CA: Yes, certainly.

499e

S: But not the evil ones?

499e

CA: Obviously.

499e

S: Indeed, you may recall that it seemed to us, Polus and I, that everything must somehow be enacted for the sake of whatever is good. Do you also share this view, that the aim of all actions is the good, and all else must be enacted for the sake of that, rather than the other way around? Are you also voting with us, as a third vote?

τάναντία τούτων κακαί; ΚΑΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ λῦπαι ὡσαύτως αἱ μὲν χρησταί εἰσιν, αἱ δὲ πονηραί; ΚΑΛ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τὰς μὲν χρηστὰς καὶ ἡδονὰς καὶ λύπας καὶ αἰρετέον ἐστὶν καὶ πρακτέον; ΚΑΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. τὰς δὲ πονηρὰς οὐ; ΚΑΛ. δῆλον δῆ. ΣΩ. ἔνεκα γάρ που τῶν ἀγαθῶν ἅπαντα ἡμῖν ἔδοξεν πρακτέον εἶναι, εἰ μνημονεύεις, ἐμοί τε καὶ Πῶλῳ. ἄρα καὶ σοὶ συνδοκεῖ οὕτω, τέλος εἶναι ἀπασῶν τῶν πράξεων τὸ ἀγαθόν, καὶ ἐκείνου ἔνεκα δεῖν πάντα τᾶλλα πράττεσθαι

500a

CA: I am.

500a

S: So, everything else, pleasures included, must be enacted for the sake of whatever is good, rather than enacting whatever is good for the sake of the pleasures.

500a

CA: Certainly.

ἀλλ' οὐκ ἐκεῖνο τῶν ἄλλων; σύμψηφος ἡμῖν εἶ καὶ σὺ ἐκ τρίτων; ΚΑΛ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. τῶν ἀγαθῶν ἄρα ἔνεκα δεῖ καὶ τᾶλλα καὶ τὰ ἡδέα πράττειν, ἀλλ' οὐ τὰγαθὰ τῶν ἡδέων. ΚΑΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν παντὸς ἀνδρός ἐστὶν ἐκλέξασθαι ποῖα ἀγαθὰ τῶν ἡδέων ἐστὶν καὶ ὅποια κακά, ἢ τεχνικοῦ δεῖ εἰς ἕκαστον; ΚΑΛ. τεχνικοῦ. ΣΩ. ἀναμνησθῶμεν δὴ ὧν αὐτὸς ἐγὼ πρὸς Πῶλον καὶ Γοργίαν ἐτύγχανον λέγων. ἔλεγον γὰρ αὐτὸς, εἰ μνημονεύεις,

500b

S: Now, does it belong to every man to select what sort of pleasures are good and what sort are bad, or is a skilled person required in each case?

500b

CA: A skilled person is required.

500b

S: Then let us go on, recalling what I was saying to Polus and Gorgias. I said, if you remember, that there are processes that go as far as pleasure and furnish pleasure alone and do not recognise the better

and the worse, and there are processes which do recognise what is good and what is bad. And in the category concerned with pleasure, I placed cookery a practice, but not a skill. In the category concerned with the good, I placed the skill of medicine. And in the name of friendship, Callicles, do not presume that you need to play games with me, and do not respond at random and contrary to your opinions, and do not, again, treat my utterances as some sort of game playing. Indeed, our discussions are concerned with a topic on which even a man of minute intelligence should be most serious, the manner in which a person should live. Is it the one to which you exhort me: namely, engaging in these manly activities, speaking in public, practising rhetoric, and engaging in the mode of politics that you people practise these days? Or is it the life spent in philosophy? And how exactly does this life differ from the other one? Now, perhaps it is best to distinguish them as I tried to do before, and once we have made the distinction and agreed with one another, then consider if these are indeed two ways of life, how they differ from one another, and which of the two we should live by. But perhaps you do not understand what I mean yet.

ὅτι εἶεν παρασκευαῖ αἱ μὲν μέχρι ἡδονῆς, αὐτὸ τοῦτο μόνον παρασκευάζουσαι, ἀγνοοῦσαι δὲ τὸ βέλτιον καὶ τὸ χεῖρον, αἱ δὲ γινώσκουσαι ὅτι τε ἀγαθὸν καὶ ὅτι κακόν· καὶ ἐτίθην τῶν μὲν περὶ τὰς ἡδονὰς τὴν μαγειρικὴν ἐμπειρίαν ἀλλὰ οὐ τέχνην, τῶν δὲ περὶ τὸ ἀγαθὸν τὴν ἰατρικὴν τέχνην. καὶ πρὸς Φιλίου, ὦ Καλλίκλεις, μήτε αὐτὸς οἶον δεῖν πρὸς ἐμὲ παίζειν μηδ' ὅτι ἂν τύχῃς παρὰ τὰ δοκοῦντα ἀποκρίνου, μήτ' αὖ τὰ παρ' ἐμοῦ οὕτως ἀποδέχου ὡς παίζοντος· ὅρᾳς γὰρ ὅτι περὶ τούτου ἡμῖν εἰσιν οἱ λόγοι, οὗ τί ἂν μᾶλλον σπουδάσειέ τις καὶ σμικρὸν νοῦν ἔχων ἄνθρωπος, ἢ τοῦτο, ὄντινα χρή τρόπον ζῆν, πότερον ἐπὶ ὃν σὺ παρακαλεῖς ἐμέ, τὰ τοῦ ἀνδρὸς δὴ ταῦτα πράττοντα, λέγοντά τε ἐν τῷ δήμῳ καὶ ῥητορικὴν ἀσκοῦντα καὶ πολιτευόμενον τοῦτον τὸν τρόπον ὃν ὑμεῖς νῦν πολιτεύεσθε, ἢ ἐπὶ τόνδε τὸν βίον τὸν ἐν φιλοσοφίᾳ, καὶ τί ποτ' ἐστὶν οὗτος ἐκείνου διαφέρων. ἴσως

CA: Not at all.

500d

S: Then I shall relate it to you more clearly. Since we have agreed, you and I, that there is a good and there is a pleasant, that the pleasant is different from the good, that there is a study and process of acquisition belonging to both, one pursuing the pleasant, the other pursuing the good. But first you should either agree or disagree with me about this. Do you agree?

500d

CA: I agree with this.

500d

S: Come on, then. You should agree with me fully on the points I made to our friends here, provided I seemed to you to be speaking the truth at the time. I think I said that cookery did not seem to me to be a skill, but a practice. But in the case of medicine, I said that it considers the nature of whomever it cares for and the motive for whatever it enacts, and is able to give an account of each of these. But the other one cares for pleasure and is directed entirely to that, going about it in an utterly unskilled manner. It provides pleasures without considering either the nature of the pleasure or the motivation for it, utterly irrational, scarcely bothering to count classifications, retaining, through habit and experience, only a memory of what usually happens. Now, in the first place, do you think these have been adequately described? Or do there also seem to be any processes of this kind concerning the soul, some of which involve a skill and possess a certain foresight of what is best for the soul, and others which make light of this, while they, for their part, consider, as in the former case, only the pleasure of the soul and the manner in which this may be brought about, neither investigating which of the pleasures is better or worse, nor studying anything except the gratification alone, be it better or be it worse? Indeed, Callicles, I think these processes exist, and I declare that this sort of thing is flattery in relation to the body or in relation to the soul, or anything whose

pleasure one may care for, without having any concern for the better or the worse. Anyway, do you subscribe to the same opinion as we do on these issues, or do you disagree?

οὐν βέλτιστόν ἐστιν, ὡς ἄρτι ἐγὼ ἐπεχείρησα, διαιρεῖσθαι, διελομένους δὲ καὶ ὁμολογήσαντας ἀλλήλοις, εἰ ἔστιν τούτῳ διττῷ τῷ βίῳ, σκέψασθαι τί τε διαφέρετον ἀλλήλοιν καὶ ὁπότερον βιωτέον αὐτοῖν. ἴσως οὐν οὐπω οἴσθα τί λέγω. ΚΑΛ. οὐ δῆτα. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' ἐγὼ σοι σαφέστερον ἐρῶ. ἐπειδὴ ὁμολογήκαμεν ἐγὼ τε καὶ σὺ εἶναι μὲν τι ἀγαθόν, εἶναι δέ τι ἡδύ, ἕτερον δὲ τὸ ἡδὺ τοῦ ἀγαθοῦ, ἑκατέρου δὲ αὐτοῖν μελέτην τινὰ εἶναι καὶ παρασκευὴν τῆς κτήσεως, τὴν μὲν τοῦ ἡδέος θήραν, τὴν δὲ τοῦ ἀγαθοῦ—αὐτὸ δέ μοι τοῦτο πρῶτον ἢ σύμφαθι ἢ μή. σύμφη; ΚΑΛ. οὕτως φημί. ΣΩ. ἴθι δὴ, ἃ καὶ πρὸς τούσδε ἐγὼ ἔλεγον, διομολόγησαί μοι, εἰ ἄρα σοι ἔδοξα τότε ἀληθὴ λέγειν. ἔλεγον δέ που ὅτι ἡ μὲν ὀψοποικὴ οὐ μοι δοκεῖ τέχνη εἶναι ἀλλ' ἐμπειρία, ἡ δ' ἰατρικὴ, λέγων ὅτι ἡ μὲν τούτου οὐ θεραπεύει καὶ τὴν φύσιν ἔσκεπται καὶ τὴν αἰτίαν ὧν πράττει, καὶ λόγον ἔχει τούτων ἐκάστου δοῦναι, ἡ ἰατρικὴ ἡ δ' ἑτέρα τῆς ἡδονῆς, πρὸς ἣν ἡ θεραπεία αὐτῇ ἐστὶν ἅπασα, κομιδὴ ἀτέχνως ἐπ' αὐτὴν ἔρχεται, οὔτε τι τὴν φύσιν σκεψαμένη τῆς ἡδονῆς οὔτε τὴν αἰτίαν, ἀλόγως τε παντάπασιν ὡς ἔπος εἰπεῖν οὐδὲν διαριθμησαμένη, τριβὴ καὶ ἐμπειρία μνήμην μόνον σωζομένη τοῦ εἰωθότος γίγνεσθαι, ᾧ δὴ καὶ πορίζεται τὰς ἡδονάς. ταῦτ' οὐν πρῶτον σκόπει εἰ δοκεῖ σοι ἱκανῶς λέγεσθαι, καὶ εἶναί τινες καὶ περὶ ψυχὴν τοιαῦται ἄλλαι πραγματεῖαι, αἱ μὲν τεχνικαί, προμήθειάν τινα ἔχουσαι τοῦ βελτίστου περὶ τὴν ψυχὴν, αἱ δὲ τούτου μὲν ὀλιγωροῦσαι, ἐσκεμμένοι δ' αὖ, ὥσπερ ἐκεῖ, τὴν ἡδονὴν μόνον τῆς ψυχῆς, τίνα ἂν αὐτῇ τρόπον γίγνοιτο, ἥτις δὲ ἡ βελτίων ἢ χεῖρων τῶν ἡδονῶν, οὔτε σκοπούμεναι οὔτε μέλον αὐταῖς ἄλλο ἢ χαρίζεσθαι

501c

CA: I don't agree, but I am going along with this so that you may conclude the discussion, and so that I may gratify Gorgias here.

μόνον, εἴτε βέλτιον εἴτε χεῖρον. ἐμοὶ μὲν γάρ, ὦ Καλλίκλεις, δοκοῦσιν τε εἶναι, καὶ ἔγωγέ φημι τὸ τοιοῦτον κολακεῖαν εἶναι καὶ περὶ σῶμα

καὶ περὶ ψυχὴν καὶ περὶ ἄλλο ὅτου ἂν τις τὴν ἡδονὴν θεραπεύῃ, ἀσκέπτως ἔχων τοῦ ἀμείνονός τε καὶ τοῦ χείρονος σὺ δὲ δὴ πότερον συγκατατίθεσαι ἡμῖν περὶ τούτων τὴν αὐτὴν δόξαν ἢ ἀντίφης; ΚΑΛ. οὐκ ἔγωγε, ἀλλὰ συγχωρῶ, ἵνα σοι καὶ περανθῇ ὁ λόγος καὶ Γοργία τῷδε χαρίσωμαι.

501d

S: And does this apply to a single soul, but not to two or many?

501d

CA: No, it applies to two or many.

501d

S: Is it not also possible to gratify a gathering of souls, all at the same time, without considering what is best?

501d

CA: Yes, I think so.

501d

S: Now, can you say what particular activities bring this about? But if you like, it is better that as I ask questions, you agree if the suggestion seems to you to belong to that category, but otherwise disagree. And first, let us consider flute-playing. Does this not seem to you, Callicles, to be an activity of this kind, one that pursues only our pleasure and thinks of nothing else?

ΣΩ. πότερον δὲ περὶ μὲν μίαν ψυχὴν ἔστιν τοῦτο, περὶ δὲ δύο καὶ πολλάς οὐκ ἔστιν; ΚΑΛ. οὐκ, ἀλλὰ καὶ περὶ δύο καὶ περὶ πολλάς. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ ἀθρόαις ἅμα χαρίζεσθαι ἔστι, μηδὲν σκοπούμενον τὸ βέλτιστον; ΚΑΛ. οἶμαι ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. ἔχεις οὖν εἰπεῖν αἵτινές εἰσιν αἱ ἐπιτηδεύσεις αἱ τοῦτο ποιοῦσαι; μᾶλλον δέ, εἰ βούλει, ἐμοῦ ἐρωτῶντος, ἢ μὲν ἂν σοι δοκῇ τούτων εἶναι, φάθι, ἢ δ' ἂν μή, μὴ φάθι.

501e

CA: It seems so to me anyway.

501e

S: Does not the same go for all activities of that sort, such as playing the cithara in competitions?

501e

CA: Yes.

501e

S: What about the instruction of the dramatic choruses or the composition of poetic verses? Is it not obvious to you that they are also like this? Or do you think Cinesias, son of Meles,³³ gives some consideration to how he may say the kind of thing that will enable his hearers to become better people, or instead how he is going to gratify the crowd of spectators?

πρῶτον δὲ σκεψώμεθα τὴν αὐλητικὴν. οὐ δοκεῖ σοι τοιαύτη τις εἶναι, ὧς Καλλίκλεις, τὴν ἡδονὴν ἡμῶν μόνον διώκειν, ἄλλο δ' οὐδὲν φροντίζειν; ΚΑΛ. ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ αἱ τοιαίδε ἅπασαι, οἷον ἡ κιθαριστικὴ ἢ ἐν τοῖς ἀγῶσιν; ΚΑΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. τί δὲ ἡ τῶν χορῶν διδασκαλία καὶ ἡ τῶν διθυράμβων ποίησις; οὐ τοιαύτη τίς σοι καταφαίνεται; ἢ ἡγῇ τι φροντίζειν Κινησίαν τὸν Μέλητος, ὅπως ἐρεῖ τι τοιοῦτον ὅθεν ἂν οἱ ἀκούοντες βελτίους γίγνουντο, ἢ ὅτι μέλλει

502a

CA: Obviously the latter, Socrates, in the case of Cinesias anyway.

502a

S: What about his father, Meles? Do you think he sang to the cithara with a view to what is best, or did the man even consider what is most pleasant? Indeed, his singing inflicted pain upon the spectators. But think about this. Does it seem to you that all singing to the cithara and all composition of poetic verses have been devised for the sake of pleasure?

502a

CA: I think so.

χαριεῖσθαι τῷ ὄχλῳ τῶν θεατῶν; ΚΑΛ. δῆλον δὴ τοῦτό γε, ὧς Σώκρατες, Κινησίου γε πέρι. ΣΩ. τί δὲ ὁ πατήρ αὐτοῦ Μέλης; ἢ πρὸς τὸ βέλτιστον βλέπων ἐδόκει σοι κιθαρωδεῖν; ἢ ἐκεῖνος μὲν οὐδὲ πρὸς τὸ ἥδιστον; ἡνία γὰρ ἄδων τοὺς θεατάς. ἀλλὰ δὴ σκόπει· οὐχὶ ἢ τε κιθαρωδική

δοκεῖ σοι πᾶσα καὶ ἡ τῶν διθυράμβων ποίησις ἡδονῆς χάριν ηὔρησθαι; ΚΑΛ. ἔμοιγε.

502b

S: But what about the solemn one herself, the wonder that is the composition of tragic verses? What is she intent upon? What, in your view, is her endeavour and intention? Is it only to gratify the spectators? Or in the case where something is pleasant and gratifying to them, but evil, does she engage in a struggle so as not to utter this? And if something happens to be unpleasant but beneficial, will she speak and sing this whether it delights them or not? Which of these two approaches does the composition of tragic verses seem to you to adopt?

ΣΩ. τί δὲ δὴ ἡ σεμνὴ αὕτη καὶ θαυμαστή, ἡ τῆς τραγωδίας ποίησις, ἐφ' ᾧ ἐσπούδακεν; πότερόν ἐστιν αὐτῆς τὸ ἐπιχείρημα καὶ ἡ σπουδή, ὥς σοὶ δοκεῖ, χαρίζεσθαι τοῖς θεαταῖς μόνον, ἢ καὶ διαμάχεσθαι, ἐάν τι αὐτοῖς ἡδὺ μὲν ἦ καὶ κεχαρισμένον, πονηρὸν δέ, ὅπως τοῦτο μὲν μὴ ἐρεῖ, εἰ δέ τι τυγχάνει ἀηδὲς καὶ ὠφέλιμον, τοῦτο δὲ καὶ λέξει καὶ ἄσεται, ἐάντε χαίρωσιν ἐάντε μή; ποτέρως σοι δοκεῖ παρεσκευάσθαι ἡ τῶν τραγωδιῶν ποίησις; ΚΑΛ. δῆλον δὴ τοῦτό γε, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὅτι πρὸς τὴν

502c

CA: Well, Socrates, it is obviously the latter, the one that is most intent on pleasure and the gratification of the spectators.

502c

S: Did we not say just now that this sort of thing is flattery, Callicles?

502c

CA: Certainly.

502c

S: Come now, if someone were to strip poetic composition of all its melody, rhythm and metre, would the residue turn out to be nothing but words?

502c

CA: Necessarily.

502c

S: Are not those words spoken to a considerable crowd and to the populace?

502c

CA: I agree.

502c

S: So, poetic skill is a kind of public speaking.

ἡδονὴν μᾶλλον ὥρμηται καὶ τὸ χαρίζεσθαι τοῖς θεαταῖς. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τὸ τοιοῦτον, ὃ Καλλίκλεις, ἔφαμεν νυνδὴ κολακείαν εἶναι; ΚΑΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. φέρε δὴ, εἴ τις περιέλοι τῆς ποιήσεως πάσης τό τε μέλος καὶ τὸν ῥυθμὸν καὶ τὸ μέτρον, ἄλλο τι ἢ λόγοι γίνονται τὸ λειπόμενον; ΚΑΛ. ἀνάγκη. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν πρὸς πολὺν ὄχλον καὶ δῆμον οὔτοι λέγονται οἱ λόγοι; ΚΑΛ. φημί. ΣΩ. δημηγορία ἄρα τίς ἐστὶν ἡ ποιητική.

502d

CA: So it appears.

ΚΑΛ. φαίνεται. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ῥητορικὴ δημηγορία ἂν εἴη· ἢ οὐ ῥητορεύειν δοκοῦσί σοι οἱ ποιηταὶ ἐν τοῖς θεάτροις; ΚΑΛ. ἔμοιγε. ΣΩ. νῦν ἄρα ἡμεῖς ηὐρήκαμεν ῥητορικὴν τινα πρὸς δῆμον τοιοῦτον οἷον παίδων τε ὁμοῦ καὶ γυναικῶν καὶ ἀνδρῶν, καὶ δούλων καὶ ἐλευθέρων, ἦν οὐ πάνυ ἀγάμεθα· κολακικὴν γὰρ αὐτὴν φαμεν εἶναι. ΚΑΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. εἶεν· τί δὲ ἢ πρὸς τὸν Ἀθηναίων δῆμον ῥητορικὴ

502e

S: Would it not be rhetorical public speaking, or do you think that the poets do not engage in rhetoric in the theatres?

502e

CA: I think they do.

502e

S: So, we have now discovered a type of rhetoric directed to a kind of populace that consists of women and children alike, of men both enslaved and free, a rhetoric we do not greatly admire, for we assert that it is based on flattery.

502e

CA: Very much so.

502e

S: So be it. But what about the rhetoric directed to the Athenian populace and the other assemblies of free men in the cities? What exactly are we to make of it? Do the rhetoricians seem to you to speak always with regard to what is best, working out how the citizens may be as good as possible on account of their speeches? Or do these fellows aim at the gratification of the citizens, belittle the common good for the sake of their own private interest, and associate with the populace as though they were children, merely trying to gratify them but thinking nothing of whether they will be better or worse as a result of all this?

καὶ τοὺς ἄλλους τοὺς ἐν ταῖς πόλεσιν δῆμους τοὺς τῶν ἐλευθέρων ἀνδρῶν, τί ποτε ἡμῖν αὕτη ἐστίν; πότερόν σοι δοκοῦσιν πρὸς τὸ βέλτιστον ἀεὶ λέγειν οἱ ῥήτορες, τούτου στοχαζόμενοι, ὅπως οἱ πολῖται ὡς βέλτιστοι ἔσονται διὰ τοὺς αὐτῶν λόγους, ἢ καὶ οὗτοι πρὸς τὸ χαρίζεσθαι τοῖς πολίταις ὠρμημένοι, καὶ ἔνεκα τοῦ ἰδίου τοῦ αὐτῶν ὀλιγωροῦντες τοῦ κοινοῦ, ὥσπερ παισὶ προσομιλοῦσι τοῖς δήμοις, χαρίζεσθαι αὐτοῖς πειρώμενοι μόνον, εἰ δέ γε βελτίους ἔσονται ἢ χεῖρους

503a

CA: This is no longer a simple question. There are some who say what they say out of concern for the citizens, but there are others of the sort you are describing.

503a

S: That is sufficient. For if there are indeed two aspects to this, then I presume that one would be flattery and a disgraceful public speaking, while the other would be noble, contriving that the souls of the citizens be as good as possible and constantly striving to utter what is best, regardless of whether it be more pleasant or less pleasant to those who hear it. But this is a rhetoric you have never yet seen. Or if you are able to mention any rhetorician of this kind, why have you never told me who he is?

διὰ ταῦτα, οὐδὲν φροντίζουσιν; ΚΑΛ. οὐχ ἀπλοῦν ἔτι τοῦτο ἐρωτᾷς· εἰσὶ μὲν γὰρ οἱ κηδόμενοι τῶν πολιτῶν λέγουσιν ἅ λέγουσιν, εἰσὶν δὲ καὶ οἴους σὺ λέγεις. ΣΩ. ἔξαρκεῖ. εἰ γὰρ καὶ τοῦτό ἐστι διπλοῦν, τὸ μὲν ἕτερόν που τούτου κολακεία ἂν εἴη καὶ αἰσχροὶ δημηγορία, τὸ δ' ἕτερον καλόν, τὸ παρασκευάζειν ὅπως ὡς βέλτισται ἔσονται τῶν πολιτῶν αἱ ψυχαί, καὶ διαμάχεσθαι λέγοντα τὰ βέλτιστα, εἴτε ἡδίω εἴτε ἀηδέστερα ἔσται τοῖς ἀκούουσιν.

503b

CA: But, by Zeus, I cannot mention anyone to you, not among the contemporary rhetoricians anyway.

503b

S: What about the older generation? Can you name anyone, on account of whom the Athenians are reputed to have become better after that person began speaking in public? Indeed, I do not know who the person is.

ἀλλ' οὐ πώποτε σὺ ταύτην εἶδες τὴν ῥητορικὴν· ἢ εἴ τινα ἔχεις τῶν ῥητόρων τοιοῦτον εἰπεῖν, τί οὐχὶ καὶ ἐμοὶ αὐτὸν ἔφρασας τίς ἐστιν; ΚΑΛ. ἀλλὰ μὰ Δία οὐκ ἔχω ἔγωγέ σοι εἰπεῖν τῶν γε νῦν ῥητόρων οὐδένα. ΣΩ. τί δέ; τῶν παλαιῶν ἔχεις τινὰ εἰπεῖν δι' ὄντινα αἰτίαν ἔχουσιν Ἀθηναῖοι βελτίους γεγονέναι, ἐπειδὴ ἐκεῖνος ἤρξατο δημηγορεῖν, ἐν τῷ πρόσθεν χρόνῳ χειροῦς ὄντες; ἐγὼ μὲν γὰρ οὐκ οἶδα τίς ἐστιν οὗτος.

503c

CA: Is that so? Do you not hear people say that Themistocles was a good man, Cimon too, and Miltiades, and Pericles himself, who died recently, whom you yourself have heard?

503c

S: Yes, Callicles, if what you described earlier is true excellence, the satisfaction of your own desires and those of others. However, if this is not the case, and instead, as in the earlier discussion, we are compelled to agree that the satisfaction of some desires make a person better and these should be fulfilled, while others make him worse and

should not be fulfilled, and there is a skill involved in this as we thought, can you still claim that any of those four men turned out to be someone with this sort of skill?

ΚΑΛ. τί δέ; Θεμιστοκλέα οὐκ ἀκούεις ἄνδρα ἀγαθὸν γεγονότα καὶ Κίμωνα καὶ Μιλτιάδην καὶ Περικλέα τουτονὶ τὸν νεωστὶ τετελευτηκότα, οὗ καὶ σὺ ἀκήκοας; ΣΩ. εἰ ἔστιν γε, ὦ Καλλίκλεις, ἦν πρότερον σὺ ἔλεγες ἀρετὴν, ἀληθείας, τὸ τὰς ἐπιθυμίας ἀποπιμπλάναι καὶ τὰς αὐτοῦ καὶ τὰς τῶν ἄλλων· εἰ δὲ μὴ τοῦτο, ἀλλ' ὅπερ ἐν τῷ ὑστέρω λόγῳ ἠναγκάσθημεν ἡμεῖς ὁμολογεῖν—ὅτι αἱ μὲν τῶν ἐπιθυμιῶν πληρούμεναι βελτίῳ ποιοῦσι τὸν ἄνθρωπον,

503d

CA: I cannot find any basis for saying so.

503d

S: But if you search properly you will find one. So, we should examine this in a calm manner and see whether any of these men prove to be a person of this kind. Come on, would not the good man, whose speech is aimed at what is best, say what he says not at random, but with something particular in view? Indeed, he is just like the other artificers, each looking to their own work, selecting whatever they bring to bear not at random, but in such a way as to give a particular form to whatever they are working on. Take, for example, painters, builders, shipwrights and all the other artisans, any one of them you want. See how he places whatever he places in a particular order, and compels this to fit with that and to be in harmony until he has wrought the entire into an organised and orderly entity. And the same goes for the other artificers and those we mentioned earlier, the trainers and physicians who are concerned with the body, and presumably order and organise the body. Do we agree that this is the case or not?

ταύτας μὲν ἀποτελεῖν, αἱ δὲ χεῖρω, μή, τοῦτο δὲ τέχνη τις εἴη—τοιοῦτον ἄνδρα τούτων τινὰ γεγονέναι οὐκ ἔχω ἔγωγε πῶς εἶπω. ΚΑΛ. ἀλλ' ἐὰν ζητῇς καλῶς, εὐρήσεις. ΣΩ. ἴδωμεν δὴ οὕτως ἄτρεμα

σκοπούμενοι εἴ τις τούτων τοιοῦτος γέγονεν· φέρε γάρ, ὁ ἀγαθὸς ἀνὴρ καὶ ἐπὶ τὸ βέλτιστον λέγων, ἃ ἂν λέγῃ ἄλλο τι οὐκ εἰκῇ ἐρεῖ, ἀλλ' ἀποβλέπων πρὸς τι; ὥσπερ καὶ οἱ ἄλλοι πάντες δημιουργοὶ βλέποντες πρὸς τὸ αὐτῶν ἔργον ἕκαστος οὐκ εἰκῇ ἐκλεγόμενος προσφέρει πρὸς τὸ ἔργον τὸ αὐτῶν, ἀλλ' ὅπως ἂν εἰδὸς τι αὐτῶ σχῇ τοῦτο ὃ ἐργάζεται. ΣΩ. οἷον εἰ βούλει ἰδεῖν τοὺς ζωγράφους, τοὺς οἰκοδόμους, τοὺς ναυπηγούς, τοὺς ἄλλους πάντας δημιουργούς, ὅντινα βούλει αὐτῶν, ὡς εἰς τάξιν τινὰ ἕκαστος ἕκαστον τίθησιν ὃ ἂν τιθῇ, καὶ προσαναγκάζει τὸ ἕτερον τῷ ἑτέρῳ πρέπον τε εἶναι καὶ ἀρμόττειν, ἕως ἂν τὸ

504a

CA: Let this be the case.

504a

S: Would a household possessing organisation and order be effective, and would a disorganised one be degenerate?

504a

CA: I agree.

504a

S: Does not the same go for a ship?

ἅπαν συστήσεται τεταγμένον τε καὶ κεκοσμημένον πρᾶγμα· καὶ οἳ τε δὴ ἄλλοι δημιουργοὶ καὶ οὓς νυνδὴ ἐλέγομεν, οἱ περὶ τὸ σῶμα, παιδοτρίβαι τε καὶ ἰατροί, κοσμοῦσί που τὸ σῶμα καὶ συντάττουσιν. ὁμολογοῦμεν οὕτω τοῦτ' ἔχειν ἢ οὐ; ΚΑΛ. ἔστω τοῦτο οὕτω. ΣΩ. τάξεως ἄρα καὶ κόσμου τυχοῦσα οἰκία χρηστὴ ἂν εἴη, ἀταξίας δὲ μοχθηρά; ΚΑΛ. φημί. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ πλοῖον ὡσαύτως;

504b

CA: Yes.

504b

S: And do we also say this about our own bodies?

504b

CA: Very much so.

504b

S: And what about the soul? Will it be effective when possessed of disorder or when possessed of some organisation and order?

504b

CA: Based on what was said earlier, it is also necessary to accept this.

504b

S: Now, what is the name of the condition that arises in the body from organisation and order?

504b

CA: You probably mean health and strength.

ΚΑΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν καὶ τὰ σώματά φαμεν τὰ ἡμέτερα; ΚΑΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. τί δ' ἡ ψυχῇ; ἀταξίας τυχοῦσα ἔσται χρηστή, ἢ τάξεώς τε καὶ κόσμου τινός; ΚΑΛ. ἀνάγκη ἐκ τῶν πρόσθεν καὶ τοῦτο συνομολογεῖν. ΣΩ. τί οὖν ὀνομά ἐστιν ἐν τῷ σώματι τῷ ἐκ τῆς τάξεώς τε καὶ τοῦ κόσμου γιγνομένῳ; ΚΑΛ. Ὑγίειαν καὶ ἰσχὺν ἴσως λέγεις.

504c

S: I do. But what about the condition engendered in the soul from organisation and order? Try to find its name and state it as you did in the other case.

504c

CA: Why don't you state it yourself, Socrates?

504c

S: Well, I shall say it if that is more pleasing to you, and you should agree if you think I am speaking truly. And, if not, you should refute me and you should not yield to me. For I think that the name of this organisation of the body is 'healthiness' and, from this, health arises in it, and so do the other excellences of the body. Is this the case or is it not?

504c

CA: It is.

ΣΩ. ἔγωγε. τί δὲ αὖ τῷ ἐν τῇ ψυχῇ ἐγγιγνομένῳ ἐκ τῆς τάξεως καὶ τοῦ κόσμου; πειρῶ εὑρεῖν καὶ εἰπεῖν ὥσπερ ἐκεῖ τὸ ὄνομα. ΚΑΛ. τί δὲ οὐκ αὐτὸς λέγεις, ὦ Σώκρατες; ΣΩ. ἀλλ' εἴ σοι ἥδιόν ἐστιν, ἐγὼ ἐρῶ· σὺ δέ,

ἂν μὲν σοι δοκῶ ἐγὼ καλῶς λέγειν, φάθι, εἰ δὲ μή, ἔλεγχε καὶ μὴ ἐπίτρεπε. ἐμοὶ γὰρ δοκεῖ ταῖς μὲν τοῦ σώματος τάξεσιν ὄνομα εἶναι ὑγιεινόν, ἐξ οὗ ἐν αὐτῷ ἡ ὑγίεια γίγνεται καὶ ἡ ἄλλη ἀρετὴ τοῦ σώματος, ἔστιν ταῦτα ἢ οὐκ ἔστιν; ΚΑΛ. ἔστιν.

504d

S: On the other hand, I think that the names of the organisation and order of the soul are lawfulness and law, and from these it becomes lawful and orderly, and these conditions are justice and sound-mindedness. Do you agree or not?

504d

CA: Be it so.

504d

S: Then, looking towards these, this rhetorician who is skilled and good also brings the speeches he delivers, and all his actions too, to bear upon the souls. And when he bestows a gift, he will bestow it, and when he confiscates something, he will confiscate it, with his mind ever intent upon how justice may arise in the souls of his fellow citizens and injustice may be banished; how sound-mindedness may be engendered and indiscipline banished; how excellence in general may be engendered and evils done away with. Do you agree or not?

ΣΩ. ταῖς δέ γε τῆς ψυχῆς τάξεσι καὶ κοσμήσεσιν νόμιμόν τε καὶ νόμος, ὅθεν καὶ νόμιμοι γίνονται καὶ κόσμιοι· ταῦτα δ' ἔστιν δικαιοσύνη τε καὶ σωφροσύνη. φῆς ἢ οὐ; ΚΑΛ. ἔστω. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν πρὸς ταῦτα βλέπων ὁ ῥήτωρ ἐκεῖνος, ὁ τεχνικός τε καὶ ἀγαθός, καὶ τοὺς λόγους προσοίσει ταῖς ψυχαῖς οὓς ἂν λέγῃ, καὶ τὰς πράξεις ἀπάσας, καὶ δῶρον ἐάν τι διδῶ, δώσει, καὶ ἐάν τι ἀφαιρῇται, ἀφαιρήσεται, πρὸς τοῦτο αἰετὸν τὸν νοῦν ἔχων, ὅπως ἂν αὐτοῦ τοῖς πολίταις

504e

CA: I agree.

504e

S: Indeed, what is the benefit, Callicles, in giving a person, sick in body, in a degenerate condition, a lot of food – even the most pleasant

– or drink, or anything else that does not benefit him one bit more and, on the contrary, may rightly be said to benefit him less? Is this so?

δικαιοσύνη μὲν ἐν ταῖς ψυχαῖς γίγνηται, ἀδικία δὲ ἀπαλλάττεται, καὶ σωφροσύνη μὲν ἐγγίγνηται, ἀκολασία δὲ ἀπαλλάττεται, καὶ ἡ ἄλλη ἀρετὴ ἐγγίγνηται, κακία δὲ ἀπίη. συγχωρεῖς ἢ οὐ; ΚΑΛ. συγχωρῶ. ΣΩ. τί γὰρ ὄφελος, ὦ Καλλίκλεις, σώματί γε κάμνοντι καὶ μοχθηρῶς διακειμένῳ σιτία πολλὰ διδόναι καὶ τὰ ἥδιστα ἢ ποτὰ ἢ ἄλλ' ὅτιοῦν, ὃ μὴ ὀνήσει αὐτὸ ἔσθ' ὅτι πλεον ἐκ τούναντίον κατὰ γε τὸν δίκαιον λόγον καὶ ἔλαττον; ἔστι ταῦτα;

505a

CA: Be it so.

505a

S: For in my view it is not advantageous for a person to live with degeneracy of the body, since it is necessary under those circumstances to live in a degenerate manner. Or is this not so?

505a

CA: Yes.

505a

S: Do not the physicians, for the most part, allow a person to satisfy his desires, such as eating as much as he wants when he is hungry and drinking when thirsty, as long as the person is healthy? However, when he is ill, they hardly allow him to be sated by the objects of his desire at all. Do you also agree with this?

ΚΑΛ. ἔστω. ΣΩ. οὐ γὰρ οἶμαι λυσιτελεῖ μετὰ μοχθηρίας σώματος ζῆν ἀνθρώπῳ· ἀνάγκη γὰρ οὕτω καὶ ζῆν μοχθηρῶς. ἢ οὐχ οὕτως; ΚΑΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ τὰς ἐπιθυμίας ἀποπιμπλάναι, οἷον πεινῶντα φαγεῖν ὅσον βούλεται ἢ διψῶντα πιεῖν, ὑγιαίνοντα μὲν ἐῷσιν οἱ ἰατροὶ ὡς τὰ πολλά, κάμνοντα δὲ ὡς ἔπος εἰπεῖν οὐδέποτε ἐῷσιν ἐμπίμπλασθαι ὧν ἐπιθυμεῖ; συγχωρεῖς τοῦτό γε καὶ σύ; ΚΑΛ. ἔγωγε.

505b

CA: I do.

505b

S: And in the case of the soul, excellent man, is there not the same tendency? As long as it is corrupt, foolish, undisciplined, unjust and unholy, it needs to be shut away from the desires and not be allowed to engage in any other activities apart from those whereby it will be made better. Do you agree or not?

505b

CA: I agree.

505b

S: For presumably that is what is better for the soul itself?

505b

CA: Very much so.

505b

S: Now, is the shutting away from what is desired equivalent to discipline?

505b

CA: Yes.

505b

S: So, being disciplined is better for the soul than the indiscipline which you were advocating a moment ago.

ΣΩ. περὶ δὲ ψυχὴν, ὃ ἄριστε, οὐχ ὁ αὐτὸς τρόπος; ἕως μὲν ἂν πονηρὰ ᾦ, ἀνόητός τε οὔσα καὶ ἀκόλαστος καὶ ἄδικος καὶ ἀνόσιος, εἴργειν αὐτὴν δεῖ τῶν ἐπιθυμιῶν καὶ μὴ ἐπιτρέπειν ἄλλ' ἅττα ποιεῖν ἢ ἀφ' ὧν βελτίων ἔσται· φῆς ἢ οὐ; ΚΑΛ. φημί. ΣΩ. οὕτω γάρ που αὐτῇ ἄμεινον τῇ ψυχῇ; ΚΑΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τὸ εἴργειν ἐστὶν ἀφ' ὧν ἐπιθυμεῖ κολάζειν; ΚΑΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. τὸ κολάζεσθαι ἄρα τῇ ψυχῇ ἄμεινόν ἐστιν ἢ ἡ ἀκολασία, ὥσπερ σὺ νυνδὴ ὦου.

505c

CA: I don't know what you are talking about, Socrates. Just ask someone else.

505c

S: This man cannot put up with being helped and undergoing for himself the process with which our discussion is concerned – being disciplined.

505c

CA: Nor does anything you are saying interest me, and I gave you these answers to oblige Gorgias.

505c

S: So be it. What shall we do now? We are cut off in mid-argument.³⁴

505c

CA: Decide for yourself.

505c

S: But they say that it is not lawful to leave off, even in the middle of stories. Rather, they should be given a conclusion so that they do not go about without a head. So, you should also answer the remaining questions so that our argument may acquire a head.

ΚΑΛ. οὐκ οἶδ' ἅττα λέγεις, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἀλλ' ἄλλον τινὰ ἐρώτα. ΣΩ. οὗτος ἀνὴρ οὐχ ὑπομένει ὠφελούμενος καὶ αὐτὸς τοῦτο πάσχων περὶ οὗ ὁ λόγος ἐστί, κολαζόμενος. ΚΑΛ. οὐδέ γέ μοι μέλει οὐδὲν ὧν σὺ λέγεις, καὶ ταῦτά σοι Γοργίου χάριν ἀπεκρινάμην. ΣΩ. εἶεν· τί οὖν δὴ ποιήσομεν; μεταξὺ τὸν λόγον καταλύομεν; ΚΑΛ. αὐτὸς γνώση. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' οὐδὲ τοὺς μύθους φασὶ μεταξὺ θέμις εἶναι

505d

CA: How forceful you are, Socrates! But if you take my advice you will bid farewell to this argument, or else you should converse with someone else.

505d

S: Well, who else is willing? For we should not leave the argument incomplete.

505d

CA: Could you not work through the argument yourself, either speaking on your own behalf or responding to yourself?

505d

S: So that the saying of Epicharmus may be fulfilled in me: “The words that were spoken by two men, I, one man, must rise to delivering.”³⁵ Anyway, it seems to be absolutely necessary, so that is how we should do it then. I, for one, think that we should possess a thirst for victory when it comes to knowing what the truth is, and what is false, in relation to the matters we are discussing. Indeed, it is a good, common to everyone, that this be made manifest. Now, I shall proceed with the argument based upon how it seems to me. However, if any of you think I am agreeing with myself contrary to things that are, you should pull me up and refute me. For I am not really saying what I am saying as someone who has some comprehensive knowledge. No, I am seeking along with you, and so if someone who contradicts me proves to have a point, I shall be the first to go along with him. Yet, I am asking all this assuming that the argument should be brought to a conclusion. However, if you do not wish to do so, let us bid it farewell at this stage and go our ways.

καταλείπειν, ἀλλ’ ἐπιθέντας κεφαλὴν, ἵνα μὴ ἄνευ κεφαλῆς περιίῃ. ἀποκρίναι οὖν καὶ τὰ λοιπὰ, ἵνα ἡμῖν ὁ λόγος κεφαλὴν λάβῃ. ΚΑΛ. ὡς βίαιος εἶ, ὦ Σώκρατες. ἐὰν δὲ ἐμοὶ πείθῃ, ἐάσεις χαίρειν τοῦτον τὸν λόγον, ἢ καὶ ἄλλῳ τῷ διαλέξῃ. ΣΩ. τίς οὖν ἄλλος ἐθέλει; μὴ γάρ τοι ἀτελῇ γε τὸν λόγον καταλίπωμεν. ΚΑΛ. αὐτὸς δὲ οὐκ ἂν δύναιο διελθεῖν τὸν λόγον, ἢ λέγων κατὰ σαυτὸν ἢ ἀποκρινόμενος σαυτῷ; ΣΩ. ἵνα μοι τὸ τοῦ Ἐπιχάρμου γένηται, ἃ πρὸ τοῦ δύο ἄνδρες ἔλεγον, εἷς ὢν ἱκανὸς γένωμαι. ἀτὰρ κινδυνεύει ἀναγκαιότατον εἶναι οὕτως. εἰ μέντοι ποιήσομεν, οἶμαι ἔγωγε χρῆναι πάντας ἡμᾶς φιλονίκως ἔχειν πρὸς τὸ εἰδέναι τὸ ἀληθές τί ἐστὶν περὶ ὧν λέγομεν καὶ τί ψεῦδος· κοινὸν γὰρ ἀγαθὸν ἅπασιν φανερόν γενέσθαι αὐτό. ΣΩ. δίδειμι

506a

GO: Well, Socrates, I don’t think we need to go our ways, but you need to work through the argument, and it appears to me that the others think so too. Indeed, I myself wish to hear you going through the remaining issues by yourself.

μὲν οὖν τῷ λόγῳ ἐγὼ ὥς ἄν μοι δοκῇ ἔχειν· ἐὰν δέ τῳ ὑμῶν μὴ τὰ ὄντα δοκῶ ὁμολογεῖν ἑμαυτῷ, χρηὴ ἀντιλαμβάνεσθαι καὶ ἐλέγχειν. οὐδὲ γάρ τοι ἔγωγε εἰδὼς λέγω ἢ λέγω, ἀλλὰ ζητῶ κοινῇ μεθ' ὑμῶν, ὥστε, ἂν τι φαίνεται λέγων ὁ ἀμφισβητῶν ἐμοί, ἐγὼ πρῶτος συγχωρήσομαι. λέγω μέντοι ταῦτα, εἰ δοκεῖ χρεῖν διαπερανθῆναι τὸν λόγον· εἰ δὲ μὴ βούλεσθε, ἔωμεν ἤδη χαίρειν καὶ ἀπίωμεν. ΓΟΡ. ἀλλ' ἐμοὶ μὲν οὐ δοκεῖ, ὦ Σώκρατες, χρεῖν αἰ πω

506b

S: But of course, Gorgias, so do I, although I would gladly have conversed further with Callicles here until I had given him the statement of Amphion in response to that of Zethus. However, Callicles, since you are not willing to conclude the argument, you should at least interject as you hear me if you think I am expressing anything badly, and should you refute me, I shall not be angry with you as you were with me. Instead, you will be inscribed as my greatest benefactor.

ἀπιέναι, ἀλλὰ διεξελθεῖν σε τὸν λόγον· φαίνεται δέ μοι καὶ τοῖς ἄλλοις δοκεῖν. βούλομαι γὰρ ἔγωγε καὶ αὐτὸς ἀκοῦσαί σου αὐτοῦ διόντος τὰ ἐπίλοιπα. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ μὲν δὴ, ὦ Γοργία, καὶ αὐτὸς ἡδέως μὲν ἂν Καλλικλεῖ τούτῳ ἔτι διελεγόμην, ἕως αὐτῷ τὴν τοῦ Ἀμφίονος ἀπέδωκα ῥῆσιν ἀντὶ τῆς τοῦ Ζήθου· ἐπειδὴ δὲ σύ, ὦ Καλλίκλεις, οὐκ ἐθέλεις συνδιαπερᾶναι τὸν λόγον, ἀλλ' οὖν ἐμοῦ γε ἀκούων ἐπιλαμβάνου, ἐάν τί σοι δοκῶ μὴ

506c

CA: Speak on, good man, and finish it yourself.

506c

S: Then hear me as I take up the argument from the beginning.

Are the pleasant and the good the same?

They are not the same, as Callicles and I have agreed.

Is the pleasant enacted for the sake of the good, or the good for the

sake of the pleasant?

The pleasant for the sake of the good.

Is pleasure that from which, when it has arisen, we are pleased? And is good that from which, when it is present, we are good?

Very much so.

But of course we are good, and so too is everything else that is good, from some excellence that arises.

I think this is necessarily the case, Callicles.

And yet the excellence of anything, of an implement, a body, or indeed a soul, or of every living creature, does not best arise in a random manner, but through organisation, correctness, and a skill that has been assigned to each. Is this the case?

Yes, I agree.

So, is the excellence of each an arrangement and an ordering due to organisation?

I would say so.

Then each of the things that are is rendered good by a certain order engendered in each, and particular to each.

So it seems to me anyway.

Then is a soul too, possessing its own order, better than a disordered one?

It must be.

But of course, the one possessed of order is orderly?

How could it not be?

And the orderly is sound-minded?

Most necessarily.

So, the sound-minded soul is good.

Now, dear friend, Callicles, I have nothing else to say in opposition to all this. However, if you have, teach it.

καλῶς λέγειν. καί με ἐὰν ἐξελέγχῃς, οὐκ ἀχθεσθήσομαι σοι ὥσπερ σὺ ἐμοί, ἀλλὰ μέγιστος εὐεργέτης παρ' ἐμοὶ ἀναγεγράψῃ. ΚΑΛ. λέγε, ὠγαθέ, αὐτὸς καὶ πέραινε. ΣΩ. ἄκουε δὴ ἐξ ἀρχῆς ἐμοῦ ἀναλαβόντος τὸν λόγον. ἄρα τὸ ἡδὺ καὶ τὸ ἀγαθὸν τὸ αὐτὸ ἐστίν;—οὐ ταυτόν, ὡς ἐγὼ καὶ Καλλικλῆς ὡμολογήσαμεν.—πότερον δὲ τὸ ἡδὺ ἔνεκα τοῦ ἀγαθοῦ πρακτέον, ἢ τὸ ἀγαθὸν ἔνεκα τοῦ ἡδέος;—τὸ ἡδὺ ἔνεκα τοῦ ἀγαθοῦ.—ἡδὺ δέ ἐστιν τοῦτο οὗ παραγενομένου ἡδόμεθα, ἀγαθὸν δὲ οὗ παρόντος ἀγαθοί ἐσμεν;—πάνυ γε.—ἀλλὰ μὴν ἀγαθοί γέ ἐσμεν καὶ ἡμεῖς καὶ τᾶλλα πάντα ὅς' ἀγαθὰ ἐστίν, ἀρετῆς τινος παραγενομένης;—ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ ἀναγκαῖον εἶναι, ὦ Καλλίκλεις.—ἀλλὰ μὲν δὴ ἢ γε ἀρετὴ ἐκάστου, καὶ σκεύους καὶ σώματος καὶ ψυχῆς αὖ καὶ ζώου παντός, οὐ τῷ εἰκῇ κάλλιστα παραγίγνεται, ἀλλὰ τάξει καὶ ὀρθότητι καὶ τέχνῃ, ἣτις ἐκάστω ἀποδέδοται αὐτῶν· ἄρα ἔστιν ταῦτα;—ἐγὼ μὲν γάρ φημι.—τάξει ἄρα τεταγμένον καὶ κεκοσμημένον ἐστὶν ἡ ἀρετὴ ἐκάστου;—φαίην ἂν ἔγωγε.—κόσμος τις ἄρα ἐγγενόμενος ἐν ἐκάστω ὁ ἐκάστου οἰκείος ἀγαθὸν παρέχει ἕκαστον τῶν ὄντων;—ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ.—καὶ ψυχὴ ἄρα κόσμον ἔχουσα τὸν ἐαυτῆς ἀμείνων τῆς ἀκοσμήτου;—ἀνάγκη.—ἀλλὰ μὴν ἢ γε κόσμον ἔχουσα κοσμία;—πῶς γὰρ οὐ μέλλει;— ΣΩ. ἡ δέ

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CA: Speak on, my good man.

507a

S: Well, I say that if the good soul is sound-minded, the one affected by the opposite of sound-mindedness is bad, and that is the one devoid of sound-mindedness and discipline.

Very much so.

And, indeed, the sound-minded person would perform actions that are appropriate in relation both to gods and men, for those who perform inappropriate actions would not be exercising sound-mindedness.

This is necessarily the case.

And, indeed, in relation to men, those who are performing appropriate actions would be performing just actions, and in relation to gods, holy actions, and the person who performs just and holy actions is necessarily just and holy.

This is so.

Then again, he is necessarily courageous too, for it is not the part of a sound-minded man either to pursue or flee from whatever is not appropriate. No, he should flee from and pursue whatever he ought to flee from or pursue, be they actions, persons, pleasures or pains, and endure steadfastly wherever he ought. Consequently, it is very necessary, Callicles, just as we were explaining, that the sound-minded man, being just, courageous and holy, be a perfectly good man. And the good man, whenever he acts, acts well and nobly, and he who acts well must be blessed and happy, while the corrupt man, acting in an evil manner, must be wretched. And this fellow, the undisciplined man

whom you were praising, would be in an opposite condition to the sound-minded man.

So, I am setting down these principles in this manner, and I declare that they are true. And if this is true, then someone who wishes to be happy must, it seems, pursue and practise sound-mindedness, and each of us must flee from indiscipline as fast as his feet will carry him. And we should contrive as best we can not to be lacking in any discipline, and if it is lacking, either in ourselves, in any member of our household, in an individual, or in a city, then justice and discipline must be imposed if they are going to be happy. This, in my view anyway, is the vision one should look to in life, and all one's own efforts and those of the city should be directed towards this, the manner in which justice and sound-mindedness will be available to the person who is to be blessed. This is how one should act, not allowing desires to be undisciplined and endeavouring to satisfy them, an endless vexation, living the life of a thief. For a person of this sort would be friendly neither to God nor to another human being, for he is unable to commune, and to anyone devoid of communion there would be no friendship. And the wise declare, Callicles, that communion, friendship, orderliness, sound-mindedness and justice hold heaven and earth, gods and men, together. And on account of this, my friend, they refer to the whole as an 'order', and not as a 'disorder' or 'indiscipline'. But I think you have not applied your mind to these matters, and although you are wise in this area, you are unaware that geometrical equality is a great power among both gods and men, and so, because you neglect geometry, you think it necessary to practise taking more. So be it. Now, we should either refute this argument so that the happy are not happy due to the acquisition of justice and sound-mindedness, and the wretched are not wretched due to evil, or else, if this argument is true, we should consider the consequences. All those consequences follow, Callicles, the ones you asked if I was serious about, when I said that one should prosecute

oneself, one's son and one's friend, if they do anything wrong, and that rhetoric should be used for this. And the ones you thought that Polus conceded due to shame also turn out to be true. Doing injustice, insofar as it is more shameful than suffering injustice, is more base to that extent. And he who intends to be a rhetorician in the proper sense must also be just and knowledgeable in matters of justice, and have knowledge of all aspects of justice. That is what Polus, in turn, stated that Gorgias agreed to out of shame.

Now, having established all this, let us consider the precise issue on which you censure me, and whether or not it is valid to assert that I am unable to assist either myself or any of my friends or family members, or deliver them from extreme dangers: that I am just like an outcast, subject to the whim of any random person who, to use that bold phrase of yours, wishes to slap me across the face, or to confiscate my property, or to expel me from the city, or ultimately to kill me. And according to your argument, to be in such a predicament is the most base condition of all. And although my argument has been stated many times already, there is no reason not to state it again. I deny, Callicles, that being slapped across the face unjustly is the most base experience possible, nor is having one's body or one's purse picked. No, striking me or cutting me and what belongs to me in an unjust manner is more base and more evil, and, indeed, stealing, enslaving, house-breaking and, in short, any unjust action whatsoever towards me and mine is both more evil and more base for the perpetrator of the injustice than for me, the sufferer of the injustice. Once all this had become evident to us in this way earlier, in the previous discussions, it was fastened and secured by – if it is not too crude an expression – arguments of iron and adamant, or that is how they seem anyway. And if you, or someone more forceful than you, does not break them, anyone who says anything different from what I am now saying will be unable to speak properly. Indeed, my argument is always the same. I myself do not know how these matters stand;

however, no one I have ever met, and no one today, is able to say otherwise without being ridiculous.

Now I, for my part, am proposing that this is how matters stand. Yet if this is the case for the doer of injustice, and injustice is the greatest of evils, and even greater than this greatest of evils, if that is possible, is doing injustice without paying a penalty, what assistance should a man, in truth, be able to provide to himself to avoid being ridiculous? Is it not the kind that averts the greatest harm? Yes, this really must be the assistance which it is utterly base not to be able to proffer either to oneself or to one's own friends and family members. The second worst baseness relates to the second worst harm, the third to the third worst, and so on. The beauty of being able to assist against each evil, and the baseness of being unable to assist, are proportional to the natural magnitude of each evil. Is this the case or is it otherwise, Callicles?

γε κοσμία σώφρων;—πολλή ἀνάγκη.—ἡ ἄρα σώφρων ψυχὴ ἀγαθή. ἐγὼ μὲν οὐκ ἔχω παρὰ ταῦτα ἄλλα φάναι, ὦ φίλε Καλλίκλεις· σὺ δ' εἰ ἔχεις, δίδασκε. ΚΑΛ. λέγ', ὦγαθέ. ΣΩ. λέγω δὴ ὅτι, εἰ ἡ σώφρων ἀγαθὴ ἐστίν, ἡ τούναντίον τῇ σώφρονι πεπονθυῖα κακὴ ἐστίν· ἣν δὲ αὕτη ἡ ἄφρων τε καὶ ἀκόλαστος.—πάνυ γε.—καὶ μὴν ὁ γε σώφρων τὰ προσήκοντα πράττει ἂν καὶ περὶ θεοὺς καὶ περὶ ἀνθρώπους οὐ γὰρ ἂν σωφρονοῖ τὰ μὴ προσήκοντα πράττων;—ἀνάγκη ταῦτ' εἶναι οὕτω.—καὶ μὴν περὶ μὲν ἀνθρώπους τὰ προσήκοντα πράττων δίκαι' ἂν πράττοι, περὶ δὲ θεοὺς ὅσια· τὸν δὲ τὰ δίκαια καὶ ὅσια πράττοντα ἀνάγκη δίκαιον καὶ ὅσιον εἶναι.—ἔστι ταῦτα.—καὶ μὲν δὴ καὶ ἀνδρεῖόν γε ἀνάγκη· οὐ γὰρ δὴ σώφρωνος ἀνδρός ἐστίν οὔτε διώκειν οὔτε φεύγειν ἢ μὴ προσήκει, ἀλλ' ἢ δεῖ καὶ πράγματα καὶ ἀνθρώπους καὶ ἡδονὰς καὶ λύπας φεύγειν καὶ διώκειν, καὶ ὑπομένοντα καρτερεῖν ὅπου δεῖ ὥστε πολλὴ ἀνάγκη, ὦ Καλλίκλεις, τὸν σώφρονα, ὥσπερ διήλθομεν, δίκαιον ὄντα καὶ ἀνδρεῖον καὶ ὅσιον ἀγαθὸν ἄνδρα εἶναι τελέως, τὸν δὲ ἀγαθὸν εὖ τε καὶ καλῶς πράττειν ἢ ἂν πράττη, τὸν δ' εὖ πράττοντα μακάριόν τε καὶ εὐδαίμονα εἶναι, τὸν δὲ πονηρὸν καὶ κακῶς πράττοντα ἄθλιον· οὗτος δ'

ἂν εἴη ὁ ἐναντίως ἔχων τῷ σώφρονι, ὁ ἀκόλαστος, ὃν σὺ ἐπῆνεις. ἐγὼ μὲν οὖν ταῦτα οὕτω τίθεται καὶ φημι ταῦτα ἀληθῆ εἶναι· εἰ δὲ ἔστιν ἀληθῆ, τὸν βουλόμενον, ὡς ἔοικεν, εὐδαίμονα εἶναι σωφροσύνην μὲν διωκτέον καὶ ἀσκητέον, ἀκολασίαν δὲ φευκτέον ὡς ἔχει ποδῶν ἕκαστος ἡμῶν, καὶ παρασκευαστέον μάλιστα μὲν μηδὲν δεῖσθαι τοῦ κολάζεσθαι, ἐὰν δὲ δεηθῇ ἢ αὐτὸς ἢ ἄλλος τις τῶν οἰκείων, ἢ ιδιώτης ἢ πόλις, ἐπιθετέον δίκην καὶ κολαστέον, εἰ μέλλει εὐδαίμων εἶναι. οὗτος ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ ὁ σκοπὸς εἶναι πρὸς ὃν βλέποντα δεῖ ζῆν, καὶ πάντα εἰς τοῦτο τὰ αὐτοῦ συντείνοντα καὶ τὰ τῆς πόλεως, ὅπως δικαιοσύνη παρέσται καὶ σωφροσύνη τῷ μακαρίῳ μέλλοντι ἔσεσθαι, οὕτω πράττειν, οὐκ ἐπιθυμίας ἑῶντα ἀκολάστους εἶναι καὶ ταύτας ἐπιχειροῦντα πληροῦν, ἀνήνυτον κακόν, ληστοῦ βίον ζῶντα. οὔτε γὰρ ἂν ἄλλῳ ἀνθρώπῳ προσφιλέας ἂν εἴη ὁ τοιοῦτος οὔτε θεῷ· κοινωνεῖν γὰρ ἀδύνατος, ὅτῳ δὲ μὴ ἔνι κοινωνία, φιλία οὐκ ἂν εἴη. ΣΩ. φασὶ δ' οἱ σοφοί, ὧ Καλλίκλεις, καὶ οὐρανὸν καὶ γῆν καὶ θεοὺς καὶ ἀνθρώπους τὴν κοινωνίαν συνέχειν καὶ φιλίαν καὶ κοσμιότητα καὶ σωφροσύνην καὶ δικαιοσύνην, καὶ τὸ ὅλον τοῦτο διὰ ταῦτα κόσμον καλοῦσιν, ὧ ἑταῖρε, οὐκ ἀκοσμίαν οὐδὲ ἀκολασίαν. σὺ δέ μοι δοκεῖς οὐ προσέχειν τὸν νοῦν τούτοις, καὶ ταῦτα σοφὸς ὢν, ἀλλὰ λέληθέν σε ὅτι ἡ ἰσότης ἢ γεωμετρικὴ καὶ ἐν θεοῖς καὶ ἐν ἀνθρώποις μέγα δύναται, σὺ δὲ πλεονεξίαν οἶε δεῖν ἀσκεῖν· γεωμετρίας γὰρ ἀμελεῖς. εἴτεν· ἢ ἐξελεγκτέος δὴ οὗτος ὁ λόγος ἡμῖν ἔστιν, ὡς οὐ δικαιοσύνης καὶ σωφροσύνης κτήσεται εὐδαίμονες οἱ εὐδαίμονες, κακίας δὲ οἱ ἄθλιοι, ἢ εἰ οὗτος ἀληθής ἐστιν, σκεπτέον τί τὰ συμβαίνοντα. τὰ πρόσθεν ἐκεῖνα, ὧ Καλλίκλεις, συμβαίνει πάντα, ἐφ' οἷς σύ με ἤρου εἰ σπουδάζων λέγοιμι, λέγοντα ὅτι κατηγορητέον εἴη καὶ αὐτοῦ καὶ ὕεος καὶ ἑταίρου, ἐάν τι ἀδικῇ, καὶ τῇ ῥητορικῇ ἐπὶ τοῦτο χρηστέον· καὶ ἂ Πῶλον αἰσχύνῃ ῥου συγχωρεῖν, ἀληθῆ ἄρα ἦν, τὸ εἶναι τὸ ἀδικεῖν τοῦ ἀδικεῖσθαι ὅσῳ περ αἵσχιον τοσοῦτῳ κάκιον· καὶ τὸν μέλλοντα ὀρθῶς ῥητορικὸν ἔσεσθαι δίκαιον ἄρα δεῖ εἶναι καὶ ἐπιστήμονα τῶν δικαίων, ὃ αὖ Γοργίαν ἔφη πῶλος δι' αἰσχύνῃν ὁμολογῆσαι. τούτων δὲ οὕτως ἐχόντων σκεψόμεθα τί ποτ' ἐστὶν ἂν σὺ ἐμοὶ ὀνειδίζεις, ἄρα καλῶς λέγεται ἢ οὐ, ὡς ἄρα ἐγὼ οὐχ οἷός τ' εἰμὶ βοηθῆσαι οὔτε ἐμαυτῷ οὔτε τῶν φίλων οὐδενὶ οὐδὲ

τῶν οἰκείων, οὐδ' ἐκσῶσαι ἐκ τῶν μεγίστων κινδύνων, εἰμὶ δὲ ἐπὶ τῷ βουλομένῳ ὥσπερ οἱ ἄτιμοι τοῦ ἐθέλοντος, ἄντε τύπτειν βούληται, τὸ νεανικὸν δὴ τοῦτο τὸ τοῦ σοῦ λόγου, ἐπὶ κόρρης, ἔαντε χρήματα ἀφαιρεῖσθαι, ἔαντε ἐκβάλλειν ἐκ τῆς πόλεως, ἔαντε, τὸ ἔσχατον, ἀποκτεῖναι· καὶ οὕτω διακεῖσθαι πάντων δὴ αἴσχιτον ἔστιν, ὡς ὁ σὸς λόγος. ὁ δὲ δὴ ἐμὸς ὅστις, πολλάκις μὲν ἤδη εἴρηται, οὐδὲν δὲ κωλύει καὶ ἔτι λέγεσθαι· οὐ φημι, ὦ Καλλίκλεις, τὸ τύπτεσθαι ἐπὶ κόρρης ἀδίκως αἴσχιτον εἶναι, οὐδέ γε τὸ τέμνεσθαι οὔτε τὸ σῶμα τὸ ἐμὸν οὔτε τὸ βαλλάντιον, ἀλλὰ τὸ τύπτειν καὶ ἐμὲ καὶ τὰ ἐμὰ ἀδίκως καὶ τέμνειν καὶ αἴσχιον καὶ κάκιον, καὶ κλέπτειν γε ἅμα καὶ ἀνδραποδίζεσθαι καὶ τοιχωρυχεῖν καὶ συλλήβδην ὅτιοῦν ἀδικεῖν καὶ ἐμὲ καὶ τὰ ἐμὰ τῷ ἀδικοῦντι καὶ κάκιον καὶ αἴσχιον εἶναι ἢ ἐμοὶ τῷ ἀδικουμένῳ. ΣΩ. ταῦτα ἡμῖν ἄνω ἐκεῖ ἐν τοῖς πρόσθεν λόγοις οὕτω φανέντα, ὡς ἐγὼ λέγω, κατέχεται καὶ δέδεται, καὶ εἰ ἀγροικότερόν τι εἰπεῖν ἔστιν, σιδηροῖς καὶ ἀδαμαντίνους λόγοις, ὡς γοῦν ἂν δόξειεν οὕτως, οὐς σὺ εἰ μὴ λύσεις ἢ σοῦ τις νεανικώτερος, οὐχ οἷόν τε ἄλλως λέγοντα ἢ ὡς ἐγὼ νῦν λέγω καλῶς λέγειν· ἐπεὶ ἔμοιγε ὁ αὐτὸς λόγος ἔστιν αἰεὶ, ὅτι ἐγὼ ταῦτα οὐκ οἶδα ὅπως ἔχει, ὅτι μέντοι ὦν ἐγὼ ἐντετύχηκα, ὥσπερ νῦν, οὐδεὶς οἷός τ' ἔστιν ἄλλως λέγων μὴ οὐ καταγέλαστος εἶναι. ἐγὼ μὲν οὖν αὖ τίθημι ταῦτα οὕτως ἔχειν· εἰ δὲ οὕτως ἔχει καὶ μέγιστον τῶν κακῶν ἔστιν ἡ ἀδικία τῷ ἀδικοῦντι καὶ ἔτι τούτου μεῖζον μεγίστου ὄντος, εἰ οἷόν τε, τὸ ἀδικοῦντα μὴ διδόναι δίκην, τίνα ἂν βοήθειαν μὴ δυνάμενος ἄνθρωπος βοηθεῖν ἑαυτῷ καταγέλαστος ἂν τῇ ἀληθείᾳ εἴη; ἄρα οὐ ταύτην, ἣτις ἀποτρέψει τὴν μεγίστην ἡμῶν βλάβην; ἀλλὰ πολλὴ ἀνάγκη ταύτην εἶναι τὴν αἰσχίστην βοήθειαν μὴ δύνασθαι βοηθεῖν μήτε αὐτῷ μήτε τοῖς αὐτοῦ φίλοις τε καὶ οἰκείοις, δευτέραν δὲ

509c

CA: It is not otherwise.

509c

S: So, of the two – doing injustice and suffering injustice – we declare doing injustice to be the greatest evil, and suffering injustice to be the lesser. Now, with what should a man be provided so that he may assist

himself and obtain both of these benefits, the one that comes from not acting unjustly, and the one that comes from not suffering injustice? Is it a power or a wish? What I mean is this. If he does not wish to suffer injustice, will he not suffer injustice, or if he has been provided with the power of not suffering injustice, will he not suffer it?

τὴν τοῦ δευτέρου κακοῦ καὶ τρίτην τὴν τοῦ τρίτου καὶ τᾶλλα οὕτως ὥς ἐκάστου κακοῦ μέγεθος πέφυκεν, οὕτω καὶ κάλλος τοῦ δυνατὸν εἶναι ἐφ' ἕκαστα βοηθεῖν καὶ αἰσχύνῃ τοῦ μή. ἄρα ἄλλως ἢ οὕτως ἔχει, ὧ Καλλίκλεις; ΚΑΛ. οὐκ ἄλλως. ΣΩ. δυοῖν οὖν ὄντοι, τοῦ ἀδικεῖν τε καὶ ἀδικεῖσθαι, μεῖζον μὲν φαμεν κακὸν τὸ ἀδικεῖν, ἔλαττον δὲ τὸ ἀδικεῖσθαι. τί οὖν ἂν παρασκευασάμενος ἄνθρωπος βοηθήσειεν αὐτῷ,

509d

CA: Well, that's obvious anyway. The power would be needed.

ὥστε ἀμφοτέρας τὰς ὠφελίας ταύτας ἔχειν, τὴν τε ἀπὸ τοῦ μὴ ἀδικεῖν καὶ τὴν ἀπὸ τοῦ μὴ ἀδικεῖσθαι; πότερά δύναμιν ἢ βούλησιν; ὧδε δὲ λέγω· πότερον ἐὰν μὴ βούληται ἀδικεῖσθαι, οὐκ ἀδικήσεται, ἢ ἐὰν δύναμιν παρασκευάσῃ τοῦ μὴ ἀδικεῖσθαι, οὐκ ἀδικήσεται; ΚΑΛ. δηλὸν δὴ τοῦτο γέ, ὅτι ἐὰν δύναμιν. ΣΩ. τί δὲ δὴ τοῦ ἀδικεῖν; πότερον ἐὰν μὴ βούληται ἀδικεῖν, ἱκανὸν τοῦτ' ἐστίν—οὐ γὰρ ἀδικήσῃ—ἢ καὶ ἐπὶ

509e

S: And in the case of doing injustice? If he does not wish to act unjustly, is that sufficient to avoid acting unjustly? Or is some power needed for this too, and the provision of some skill which, unless it is learned and practised, he will act unjustly? Why do you not give me an answer to this question anyway, Callicles? Do you think that Polus and I were or were not compelled to agree in the right way in those earlier discussions when we agreed that no one wishes to do injustice, but all those who do injustice do injustice unwillingly?

τοῦτο δεῖ δύναμιν τινα καὶ τέχνην παρασκευάσασθαι, ὥς, ἐὰν μὴ μάθῃ αὐτὰ καὶ ἀσκήσῃ, ἀδικήσῃ; τί οὐκ αὐτό γέ μοι τοῦτο ἀπεκρίνω, ὧ Καλλίκλεις, πότερόν σοι δοκοῦμεν ὁρθῶς ἀναγκασθῆναι ὁμολογεῖν ἐν

τοῖς ἔμπροσθεν λόγοις ἐγώ τε καὶ πῶλος ἢ οὐ, ἡνίκα ὠμολογήσαμεν μηδένα βουλόμενον ἀδικεῖν, ἀλλ' ἄκοντας τοὺς ἀδικοῦντας πάντας ἀδικεῖν;

510a

CA: I grant you that this is the case, Socrates, so that the argument may be concluded.

510a

S: Then it seems that a power and a certain skill must be provided for this purpose too, so that we do not act unjustly.

510a

CA: Certainly.

510a

S: Now, what precisely is the skill of equipping ourselves to suffer no injustice, or the least possible? Decide whether your view is the same as mine. Indeed, it seems to me that one should either rule in the city oneself, even as a tyrant, or else be an associate of the existing constitution.

ΚΑΛ. ἔστω σοι τοῦτο, ὦ Σώκρατες, οὕτως, ἵνα διαπεράνης τὸν λόγον. ΣΩ. καὶ ἐπὶ τοῦτο ἄρα, ὡς ἔοικεν, παρασκευαστέον ἐστὶ δύναμιν τινα καὶ τέχνην, ὅπως μὴ ἀδικήσωμεν. ΚΑΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. τίς οὖν ποτ' ἐστὶν τέχνη τῆς παρασκευῆς τοῦ μηδὲν ἀδικεῖσθαι ἢ ὡς ὀλίγιστα; σκέψαι εἰ σοὶ δοκεῖ ἢ περ ἐμοί. ἐμοὶ μὲν γὰρ δοκεῖ ἥδε· ἢ αὐτὸν ἄρχειν δεῖν ἐν τῇ πόλει ἢ καὶ τυραννεῖν, ἢ τῆς ὑπαρχούσης πολιτείας ἐταῖρον εἶναι. ΚΑΛ. ὀρθῶς, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὡς ἐγὼ ἔτοιμός εἰμι ἐπαινεῖν,

510b

CA: Observe, Socrates, how willing I am to praise you when you make a good point. Yes, I think that was a very good point.

510b

S: Then decide whether you think this is nicely expressed too. It seems to me that one person is friend to another to the greatest extent possible on the basis stated by the ancients and the wise, 'like unto like'. Do you not think so too?

510b

CA: I do.

ἂν τι καλῶς λέγῃς; τοῦτό μοι δοκεῖς πάνυ καλῶς εἰρηκέναι. ΣΩ. σκόπει δὴ καὶ τόδε ἐάν σοι δοκῶ εὖ λέγειν. φίλος μοι δοκεῖ ἕκαστος ἐκάστῳ εἶναι ὡς οἷόν τε μάλιστα, ὥνπερ οἱ παλαιοὶ τε καὶ σοφοὶ λέγουσιν, ὁ ὅμοιος τῷ ὁμοίῳ. οὐ καὶ σοί; ΚΑΛ. ἔμοιγε. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ὅπου τύραννός ἐστιν ἄρχων ἄγριος καὶ ἀπαίδευτος, εἴ τις τούτου ἐν τῇ πόλει πολὺ βελτίων εἴη, φοβοῖτο δήπου ἂν αὐτὸν ὁ τύραννος καὶ τούτῳ ἐξ ἅπαντος

510c

S: Therefore, wherever a crude and uneducated tyrant is ruler, and someone in the city is much better than this fellow, the tyrant would obviously fear him, and he would never become a friend to the tyrant with his entire mind.

510c

CA: This is so.

510c

S: Nor, if someone was far inferior, would that man be his friend either. For the tyrant would despise him, and would never take him seriously as he would a friend.

510c

CA: That is also true.

510c

S: There remains only one man deserving of the title ‘friend’ to such a person, someone of similar character, who censures and applauds the same things and who is willing to be ruled and submit to his rulership. This fellow will wield great power in this city, and no one will treat him unjustly and get away with it. Is this not the case?

τοῦ νοῦ οὐκ ἂν ποτε δύναίτο φίλος γενέσθαι; ΚΑΛ. ἔστι ταῦτα. ΣΩ. οὐδέ γε εἴ τις πολὺ φαυλότερος εἴη, οὐδ’ ἂν οὗτος καταφρονοῖ γὰρ ἂν αὐτοῦ ὁ τύραννος καὶ οὐκ ἂν ποτε ὡς πρὸς φίλον σπουδάσειεν. ΚΑΛ. καὶ ταῦτ’ ἀληθῆ. ΣΩ. λείπεται δὴ ἐκεῖνος μόνος ἄξιος λόγου φίλος τῷ

τοιούτῳ, ὃς ἂν ὁμοίῃθης ὧν, ταῦτ'α ψέγων καὶ ἐπαινῶν, ἐθέλῃ ἄρχεσθαι καὶ ὑποκεῖσθαι τῷ ἄρχοντι. οὗτος μέγα

510d

CA: Yes.

510d

S: So, if one of the young people in this city were to think, ‘By what means may I acquire great power, and have no one treat me unjustly?’, the way for him to do so, it seems, is to accustom himself from his very youth to delight in and to detest the same things as the despot, and contrive that he be as like unto that fellow as possible. Is this not so?

510d

CA: Yes.

510d

S: Then, according to your argument, immunity from unjust treatment and great power in the city will have been attained in this case.

510d

CA: Very much so.

ἐν ταύτῃ τῇ πόλει δυνήσεται, τοῦτον οὐδεὶς χαίρων ἀδικήσει. οὐχ οὕτως ἔχει; ΚΑΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. εἰ ἄρα τις ἐννοήσειεν ἐν ταύτῃ τῇ πόλει τῶν νέων, τίνα ἂν τρόπον ἐγὼ μέγα δυναίμην καὶ μηδεὶς με ἀδικοῖ; αὕτη, ὡς ἔοικεν, αὐτῷ ὁδός ἐστιν, εὐθὺς ἐκ νέου ἐθίζειν αὐτὸν τοῖς αὐτοῖς χαίρειν καὶ ἄχθεσθαι τῷ δεσπότη, καὶ παρασκευάζειν ὅπως ὅτι μάλιστα ὅμοιος ἔσται ἐκείνῳ. οὐχ οὕτως; ΚΑΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τούτῳ τὸ μὲν μὴ ἀδικεῖσθαι καὶ μέγα

510e

S: Now, does this also apply to not acting unjustly? Or is this very different, since he is like the ruler who is unjust and wields great power alongside him? Yes, I believe anyway that in this regard his contrivance will be the exact opposite, to be able to do as much

injustice as possible and not pay any penalty for acting unjustly. Is this so?

510e

CA: Apparently.

510e

S: Therefore the greatest evil will befall him, being corrupted and mutilated in soul, through power and his imitation of the despot.

δύνασθαι, ὡς ὁ ὑμέτερος λόγος, ἐν τῇ πόλει διαπεπράζεται. ΚΑΛ. πάννυ γε. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν καὶ τὸ μὴ ἀδικεῖν; ἢ πολλοῦ δεῖ, εἴπερ ὅμοιος ἔσται τῷ ἄρχοντι ὄντι ἀδίκῳ καὶ παρὰ τούτῳ μέγα δυνήσεται; ἀλλ' οἶμαι ἔγωγε, πᾶν τοῦναντίον οὕτως ἢ παρασκευῇ ἔσται αὐτῷ ἐπὶ τὸ οἶν τε εἶναι ὡς πλεῖστα ἀδικεῖν καὶ ἀδικοῦντα μὴ διδόναι δίκην. ἧ γάρ; ΚΑΛ. φαίνεται.

511a

CA: I don't know how you manage to continually twist the arguments this way and that, Socrates. Do you not realise that this imitator will put anyone who does not imitate the tyrant to death, if he wishes, and confiscate his possessions?

511a

S: I do realise that, good Callicles, unless I am deaf anyway, since I am hearing it constantly from you and from Polus just now, and from almost everyone else in the city. But you hear me. He will kill him, if he wishes, but as a degenerate person killing a good and noble person.

511a

CA: Yes, isn't that what's most annoying?

511a

S: Not to a man possessing intelligence, as the argument indicates. Or do you think that a man should contrive to live for as long as possible, and study those skills that preserve us always from danger, such as the one you also directed me to study, the rhetoric that keeps us safe in courts of law?

ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τὸ μέγιστον αὐτῷ κακὸν ὑπάρξει μοχθηρῷ ὄντι τὴν ψυχὴν καὶ λελωβημένῳ διὰ τὴν μίμησιν τοῦ δεσπότου καὶ δύναμιν. ΚΑΛ. οὐκ

οἶδ' ὅπῃ στρέφεις ἐκάστοτε τοὺς λόγους ἄνω καὶ κάτω, ὦ Σώκρατες· ἢ οὐκ οἶσθα ὅτι οὗτος ὁ μιμούμενος τὸν μὴ μιμούμενον ἐκείνον ἀποκτενεῖ, ἐὰν βούληται, καὶ ἀφαιρήσεται τὰ ὄντα.

511b

CA: Yes, by Zeus, and I am giving you sound advice.

ΣΩ. οἶδα, ὦγαθὲ Καλλίκλεις, εἰ μὴ κωφός γ' εἰμί, καὶ σοῦ ἀκούων καὶ Πώλου ἄρτι πολλάκις καὶ τῶν ἄλλων ὀλίγου πάντων τῶν ἐν τῇ πόλει· ἀλλὰ καὶ σὺ ἐμοῦ ἄκουε, ὅτι ἀποκτενεῖ μέν, ἂν βούληται, ἀλλὰ πονηρὸς ὢν καλὸν κάγαθὸν ὄντα. ΚΑΛ. οὐκοῦν τοῦτο δὴ καὶ τὸ ἀγανακτητόν; ΣΩ. οὐ νοῦν γε ἔχοντι, ὡς ὁ λόγος σημαίνει. ἢ οἷε δεῖν τοῦτο παρασκευάζεσθαι ἄνθρωπον, ὡς πλεῖστον χρόνον ζῆν, καὶ μελετᾶν τὰς τέχνας ταύτας αἱ ἡμᾶς ἀεὶ ἐκ τῶν

511c

S: What about this, best of men? Do you also think the knowledge of swimming is something august?

511c

CA: By Zeus, I do not.

511c

S: And yet it does save people from death whenever they end up in the sort of danger where this knowledge is needed. But if you think this is trivial, I will refer you to a more important knowledge than this, the piloting of ships, which saves not only souls, but also bodies and property from extreme dangers, just as rhetoric does. It is unpretentious and orderly, and it does not strike self-important poses as if engaged in some remarkable activity. But having engaged in the same activity as the courtroom advocates, getting you safely from Aegina³⁶ to here, it charges two obols,³⁷ I think. And if it is a journey from Egypt or the Pontus,³⁸ for this enormous service, having given safe passage to everyone I have just mentioned – yourself, your children, your property and your womenfolk – and having landed them in the harbour, it charges two drachmas at the very most. And the person who possesses this skill and has engaged in these activities

disembarks and walks about on shore beside his ship with a modest demeanour. Indeed, he understands enough to figure out that it is unclear which of the passengers he has benefited by not allowing them to be drowned at sea, and which of them he has harmed, knowing that he disembarked them no better either in body or soul than when he embarked them. He figures out, therefore, that on the one hand, if someone afflicted with serious, incurable bodily diseases does not drown, he is wretched because he did not die, and he is not benefited by the pilot. Yet on the other hand, if someone has numerous diseases of something more exalted than the body, namely the soul, and these are incurable, he reckons that this man's life is not worth living and he will not be benefiting this man if he saves him from the sea, or a court-action, or anything else whatsoever. He knows, rather, that it is not better for a degenerate person to be alive, for he must perforce live badly.

For these reasons, it is not conventional for the pilot to give himself airs, even though he does save us. Nor, for that matter, my wonderful friend, does the military mechanic who is sometimes able, no less than the general, not to mention the pilot or anyone else, to save people. Indeed, on occasion he saves entire cities. You do not think he is comparable to a courtroom advocate, do you? And yet, if he were to speak after the manner of you people, Callicles, solemnising his profession, he would bury you with words, proclaiming and extolling the need to become mechanics, setting the other professions at naught, for he would have a plausible argument. But you despise this man and his skill nonetheless, and you would call him 'mechanic' as a term of reproach, and you would not be prepared to give your daughter to his son, nor would you yourself accept that man's daughter. And yet, given the basis on which you praise your own profession, for what just reason do you despise the mechanic and the others you mentioned just now? I know you would claim to be better, and from better stock. But if 'better' is not what I say it is, and

excellence is just saving yourself and your own possessions, regardless of the sort of person you happen to be, then your censure turns out to be laughable, be it of a mechanic or a physician or any other skills that have been devised in order to save people. But, blessed man, look again lest the noble and the good may be something else besides saving and being saved. For he who is truly a man must not be attached to life, and must give up the notion of living for a particular period of time. Rather, having turned these matters over to the god, and given credence to women, who say that one should not flee from fate, he should consider this. In what way may a person best live the span of life that he will live? Should he assimilate himself to the constitution under which he abides? And should you now become as much like the Athenian populace as you can if you are going to be beloved of them, and wield great power in the city? See if there is advantage in this for you and for me, my miraculous friend, so that we do not suffer the fate they impute to those women of Thessaly who pull down the moon,³⁹ and this choice of ours, this power in the city, be at the cost of all that is dearest to us. But if you believe that any person could bestow upon you the sort of skill that would make you extremely powerful in this city, while being unlike its constitution – perhaps better, perhaps worse – then in my view you have not been properly advised, Callicles. For you need to be not just their imitator, but like them in your own nature if you are going to achieve anything genuine in friendship with the Athenian demos, or indeed, by Zeus, with Demos, the son of Ppyrilampes. So, whoever renders you most like unto them will make you a politician, in the way that you want to be a politician, and a rhetorician too. For every populace is delighted by speeches delivered after their own fashion, but they are troubled by anything alien to this. Do you have anything different to say my friend? Can we say anything against this, Callicles?

κινδύνων σώζουσιν, ὥσπερ καὶ ἦν σὺ κελεύεις ἐμὲ μελετᾶν τὴν ῥητορικὴν τὴν ἐν τοῖς δικαστηρίοις διασώζουσαν; ΚΑΛ. ναὶ μὰ Δία ὀρθῶς γέ σοι συμβουλεύων. ΣΩ. τί δέ, ὦ βέλτιστε; ἢ καὶ ἡ τοῦ νεῖν

ἐπιστήμη σεμνή τίς σοι δοκεῖ εἶναι; ΚΑΛ. μὰ Δί' οὐκ ἔμοιγε. ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν σῶζει γε καὶ αὕτη ἐκ θανάτου τοὺς ἀνθρώπους, ὅταν εἷς τι τοιοῦτον ἐμπέσωσιν οὗ δεῖ ταύτης τῆς ἐπιστήμης. εἰ δ' αὕτη σοι δοκεῖ σμικρὰ εἶναι, ἐγὼ σοι μείζω ταύτης ἐρῶ, τὴν κυβερνητικὴν, ἣ οὐ μόνον τὰς ψυχὰς σῶζει ἀλλὰ καὶ τὰ σώματα καὶ τὰ χρήματα ἐκ τῶν ἐσχάτων κινδύνων, ὥσπερ ἡ ῥητορική. καὶ αὕτη μὲν προσεσταλμένη ἐστὶν καὶ κοσμία, καὶ οὐ σεμνύνεται ἐσχηματισμένη ὡς ὑπερήφανόν τι διαπραττομένη, ἀλλὰ ταῦτα διαπραξαμένη τῇ δικανικῇ, ἐὰν μὲν ἐξ Αἰγίνης δεῦρο σώσῃ, οἶμαι δὲ ὀβολοὺς ἐπράξατο, ἐὰν δὲ ἐξ Αἰγύπτου ἢ ἐκ τοῦ Πόντου, ἐὰν ἀμπελου, ταύτης τῆς μεγάλης εὐεργεσίας, σώσασα ἃ νυνδὴ ἔλεγον, καὶ αὐτὸν καὶ παῖδας καὶ χρήματα καὶ γυναῖκας, ἀποβιβάσας εἰς τὸν λιμένα δύο δραχμὰς ἐπράξατο, καὶ αὐτὸς ὁ ἔχων τὴν τέχνην καὶ ταῦτα διαπραξάμενος ἐκβάς παρὰ τὴν θάλατταν καὶ τὴν ναῦν περιπατεῖ ἐν μετρίῳ σχήματι· λογίζεσθαι γὰρ οἶμαι ἐπίσταται ὅτι ἄδηλόν ἐστιν οὐστινὰς τε ὠφέληκεν τῶν συμπλεόντων οὐκ ἐάσας καταποντωθῆναι καὶ οὐστινας ἔβλαψεν, εἰδὼς ὅτι οὐδὲν αὐτοὺς βελτίους ἐξεβίβασεν ἢ οἷοι ἐνέβησαν, οὔτε τὰ σώματα οὔτε τὰς ψυχὰς. ΣΩ. λογίζεται οὖν ὅτι οὐκ, εἰ μὲν τις μεγάλους καὶ ἀνιάτοις νοσήμασιν κατὰ τὸ σῶμα συνεχόμενος μὴ ἀπεπνίγη, οὗτος μὲν ἄθλιός ἐστιν ὅτι οὐκ ἀπέθανεν, καὶ οὐδὲν ὑπ' αὐτοῦ ὠφέληται· εἰ δέ τις ἄρα ἐν τῷ τοῦ σώματος τιμιωτέρῳ, τῇ ψυχῇ, πολλὰ νοσήματα ἔχει καὶ ἀνιάτα, τούτῳ δὲ βιωτέον ἐστὶν καὶ τοῦτον ὀνήσει, ἅντε ἐκ θαλάττης ἅντε ἐκ δικαστηρίου ἐάντε ἄλλοθεν ὀποθενοῦν σώσῃ, ἀλλ' οἶδεν ὅτι οὐκ ἄμεινόν ἐστιν ζῆν τῷ μοχθηρῷ ἀνθρώπῳ· κακῶς γὰρ ἀνάγκη ἐστὶν ζῆν διὰ ταῦτα οὐ νόμος ἐστὶ σεμνύνεσθαι τὸν κυβερνήτην, καίπερ σῶζοντα ἡμᾶς, οὐδέ γε, ὧ θαυμάσιε, τὸν μηχανοποιόν, ὃς οὔτε στρατηγοῦ, μὴ ὅτι κυβερνήτου, οὔτε ἄλλου οὐδενὸς ἐλάττω ἐνίστε δύναται σῶζειν· πόλεις γὰρ ἔστιν ὅτε ὅλας σῶζει. μή σοι δοκεῖ κατὰ τὸν δικανικὸν εἶναι; καίτοι εἰ βούλοιο λέγειν, ὧ Καλλίκλεις, ἅπερ ὑμεῖς, σεμνύνων τὸ πρᾶγμα, καταχώσειεν ἂν ὑμᾶς τοῖς λόγοις, λέγων καὶ παρακαλῶν ἐπὶ τὸ δεῖν γίνεσθαι μηχανοποιούς, ὡς οὐδὲν τᾶλλα ἐστὶν ἱκανὸς γὰρ αὐτῷ ὁ λόγος. ἀλλὰ σὺ οὐδὲν ἤττον αὐτοῦ καταφρονεῖς καὶ τῆς τέχνης τῆς ἐκείνου, καὶ ὡς ἐν ὀνειδίζει ἀποκαλέσαις ἂν

μηχανοποιόν, καὶ τῷ ὑεὶ αὐτοῦ οὐτ' ἂν δοῦναι θυγατέρα ἐθέλοις, οὐτ' ἂν αὐτὸς λαβεῖν τὴν ἐκείνου. καίτοι ἐξ ὧν τὰ σαυτοῦ ἐπαινεῖς, τίνι δικαίῳ λόγῳ τοῦ μηχανοποιοῦ καταφρονεῖς καὶ τῶν ἄλλων ὧν νυνδὴ ἔλεγον; οἷδ' ὅτι φαίης ἂν βελτίων εἶναι καὶ ἐκ βελτιόνων. τὸ δὲ βέλτιον εἰ μὴ ἔστιν ὃ ἐγὼ λέγω, ἀλλ' αὐτὸ τοῦτ' ἐστὶν ἀρετὴ, τὸ σῶζειν αὐτὸν καὶ τὰ ἑαυτοῦ ὄντα ὁποῖός τις ἔτυχεν, καταγέλαστός σοι ὁ φόβος γίγνεται καὶ μηχανοποιοῦ καὶ ἱατροῦ καὶ τῶν ἄλλων τεχνῶν ὅσαι τοῦ σῶζειν ἔνεκα πεποίηται. ἀλλ', ὦ μακάριε, ὅρα μὴ ἄλλο τι τὸ γενναῖον καὶ τὸ ἀγαθὸν ἢ τὸ σῶζειν τε καὶ σῶζεσθαι. μὴ γὰρ τοῦτο μέν, τὸ ζῆν ὅποσονδὴ χρόνον, τὸν γε ὡς ἀληθῶς ἄνδρα ἐατέον ἐστὶν καὶ οὐ φιλοψυχητέον, ἀλλὰ ἐπιτρέψαντα περὶ τούτων τῷ θεῷ καὶ πιστεύσαντα ταῖς γυναιξίν ὅτι τὴν εἰμαρμένην οὐδ' ἂν εἷς ἐκφύγοι, τὸ ἐπὶ τούτῳ σκεπτέον τίν' ἂν τρόπον τοῦτον ὃν μέλλοι χρόνον βιῶναι ὡς ἄριστα βιοίῃ, ΣΩ. ἄρα ἐξομοίων αὐτὸν τῇ πολιτείᾳ ταύτῃ ἐν ἣ ἂν οἰκῇ, καὶ νῦν δὲ ἄρα δεῖ σὲ ὡς ὁμοιότατον γίνεσθαι τῷ δήμῳ τῷ Ἀθηναίων, εἰ μέλλεις τούτῳ προσφιλεῖς εἶναι καὶ μέγα δύνασθαι ἐν τῇ πόλει τοῦθ' ὅρα εἰ σοὶ λυσιτελεῖ καὶ ἐμοί, ὅπως μὴ, ὦ δαιμόνιε, πεισόμεθα ὅπερ φασι τὰς τὴν σελήνην καθαιρούσας, τὰς θετταλίδας σὺν τοῖς φιλτάτοις ἢ αἵρεσις ἡμῖν ἔσται ταύτης τῆς δυνάμεως τῆς ἐν τῇ πόλει. εἰ δέ σοι οἶει ὄντινοῦν ἀνθρώπων παραδώσειν τέχνην τινὰ τοιαύτην, ἥτις σε ποιήσει μέγα δύνασθαι ἐν τῇ πόλει τῇδε ἀνόμοιον ὄντα τῇ πολιτείᾳ εἴτ' ἐπὶ τὸ βέλτιον εἴτ' ἐπὶ τὸ χεῖρον, ὡς ἐμοὶ δοκεῖ, οὐκ ὀρθῶς βουλευή, ὦ Καλλίκλεις; οὐ γὰρ μιμητὴν δεῖ εἶναι ἀλλ' αὐτοφυῶς ὅμοιον τούτοις, εἰ μέλλεις τι γνήσιον ἀπεργάζεσθαι εἰς φιλίαν τῷ Ἀθηναίων δήμῳ καὶ ναὶ μὰ Δία τῷ Πυριλάμπους γε πρὸς. ὅστις οὖν σε τούτοις ὁμοιότατον ἀπεργάσεται, οὗτός σε ποιήσει, ὡς ἐπιθυμεῖς πολιτικὸς εἶναι, πολιτικὸν καὶ ῥητορικόν· τῷ αὐτῶν γὰρ

513c

CA: You seem to me – I do not know how – to be expressing this well, Socrates, but I have experienced what most people experience. I am not entirely persuaded by you.

513c

S: The love of the populace residing in your soul is opposing me, Callicles, but if we consider these same issues more frequently, thoroughly and better, you will be persuaded. But now you should recollect that we said there are two means of caring for anything, be it soul or body. One operates with pleasure as its aim, the other aims for the very best, does not engage in gratification, and is assertive. Is that not how we defined them at the time?

ἦθαι λεγομένων τῶν λόγων ἕκαστοι χαίρουσι, τῷ δὲ ἀλλοτρίῳ ἄχθονται, εἰ μὴ τι σὺ ἄλλο λέγεις, ὃ φίλη κεφαλή. λεγόμεν τι πρὸς ταῦτα, ὃ Καλλίκλεις; ΚΑΛ. οὐκ οἶδ' ὄντινά μοι τρόπον δοκεῖς εὖ λέγειν, ὃ Σώκρατες, πέπονθα δὲ τὸ τῶν πολλῶν πάθος· οὐ πάνυ σοι πείθομαι. ΣΩ. ὁ δῆμου γὰρ ἔρως, ὃ Καλλίκλεις, ἐνὼν ἐν τῇ ψυχῇ τῇ σῇ ἀντιστατεῖ μοι· ἀλλ' ἐὰν πολλάκις ἴσως καὶ βέλτιον

513d

CA: Entirely so.

513d

S: Is not the one that aims at pleasure ignoble, amounting to nothing but flattery? Is this so?

513d

CA: Be it so, if you wish it so.

513d

S: While the other, whether it happens to be body or soul that we are caring for, intends that it will be as good as possible.⁴⁰

513d

CA: Entirely so.

ταῦτ' αὐτὰ διασκοπώμεθα, πεισθήσῃ. ἀναμνήσθητι δ' οὖν ὅτι δύο ἔφαμεν εἶναι τὰς παρασκευὰς ἐπὶ τὸ ἕκαστον θεραπεύειν, καὶ σῶμα καὶ ψυχὴν, μίαν μὲν πρὸς ἡδονὴν ὁμιλεῖν, τὴν ἑτέραν δὲ πρὸς τὸ βέλτιστον, μὴ καταχαριζόμενον ἀλλὰ διαμαχόμενον. οὐ ταῦτα ἦν ἂ τότε ὠριζόμεθα; ΚΑΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἡ μὲν ἑτέρα, ἡ πρὸς ἡδονήν, ἀγεννὴς καὶ οὐδὲν ἄλλο ἢ κολακεία τυγχάνει οὕσα· ἡ γάρ;

513e

S: Must we therefore take the city and the citizens in hand in this manner and care for them, making the citizens themselves as good as possible? For surely in the absence of this, as we found in our earlier discussions, there is no advantage in bestowing any other service whatsoever when the understanding of those who are going to acquire a lot of money or authority over something, or any other power at all, is not noble and good. Should we declare that this is so?

513e

CA: Entirely so, if it pleases you more.

ΚΑΛ. ἔστω, εἰ βούλει, σοὶ οὕτως. ΣΩ. ἡ δέ γε ἑτέρα, ὅπως ὡς βέλτιστον ἔσται τοῦτο, εἴτε σῶμα τυγχάνει ὃν εἴτε ψυχή, ὃ θεραπεύομεν; ΚΑΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν οὕτως ἐπιχειρητέον ἡμῖν ἐστὶν τῇ πόλει καὶ τοῖς πολίταις θεραπεύειν, ὡς βελτίστους αὐτοὺς τοὺς πολίτας ποιοῦντας; ἄνευ γὰρ δὴ τούτου, ὡς ἐν τοῖς ἔμπροσθεν ἠύρισκομεν, οὐδὲν ὄφελος ἄλλην εὐεργεσίαν οὐδεμίαν

514a

S: Now, Callicles, suppose that we were embarking upon civic affairs, and we encouraged one another to engage in construction projects involving large structures such as walls, dockyards or temples. Would we need to examine ourselves and find out firstly whether or not we had knowledge of this skill of construction, and from whom we learned it? Would we need to do this or not?

προσφέρειν, ἐὰν μὴ καλὴ κάγαθὴ ἡ διάνοια ἢ τῶν μελλόντων ἢ χρήματα πολλὰ λαμβάνειν ἢ ἀρχὴν τινων ἢ ἄλλην δύναμιν ἡντινοῦν. φῶμεν οὕτως ἔχειν; ΚΑΛ. πάνυ γε, εἴ σοι ἥδιον. ΣΩ. εἰ οὖν παρεκαλοῦμεν ἀλλήλους, ὦ Καλλίκλεις, δημοσίᾳ πράζοντες τῶν πολιτικῶν πραγμάτων ἐπὶ τὰ οἰκοδομικά, ἢ τειχῶν ἢ νεωρίων ἢ ἱερῶν ἐπὶ τὰ μέγιστα οἰκοδομήματα, πότερον ἔδει ἂν ἡμᾶς σκέψασθαι ἡμᾶς αὐτοὺς καὶ

514b

CA: Entirely so.

514b

S: And secondly, would we also have to find out whether we had ever constructed any structure at all, privately, either for one of our friends or for ourselves, and whether this structure was beautiful or ugly. And if we found through these deliberations that our teachers had been notable and good, and we had constructed many beautiful structures whilst with our teachers, and many indeed on our own after we left those teachers, under such circumstances it would make sense for us to embark upon public projects. However, if we were able neither to point out our own teachers, nor any structures at all, or a lot of worthless ones, it would then be stupid, I presume, to turn our hands to public projects, or encourage one another to do so. Should we assert that this is a correct formulation or not?

ἐξετάσαι πρῶτον μὲν εἰ ἐπιστάμεθα τὴν τέχνην ἢ οὐκ ἐπιστάμεθα, τὴν οἰκοδομικὴν, καὶ παρὰ τοῦ ἐμάθομεν; ἔδει ἂν ἢ οὐ; ΚΑΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν δεύτερον αὖ τόδε, εἴ τι πώποτε οἰκοδόμημα ὠκοδομήκαμεν ἰδίᾳ ἢ τῶν φίλων τινὶ ἢ ἡμέτερον αὐτῶν, καὶ τοῦτο τὸ οἰκοδόμημα καλὸν ἢ αἰσχρὸν ἐστίν· καὶ εἰ μὲν ηὐρίσκομεν σκοπούμενοι διδασκάλους τε ἡμῶν ἀγαθοὺς καὶ

514c

CA: Entirely so.

ἐλλογίμους γεγονότας καὶ οἰκοδομήματα πολλὰ μὲν καὶ καλὰ μετὰ τῶν διδασκάλων ὠκοδομημένα ἡμῖν, πολλὰ δὲ καὶ ἴδια ἡμῶν ἐπειδὴ τῶν διδασκάλων ἀπηλλάγημεν, οὕτω μὲν διακειμένων, νοῦν ἐχόντων ἦν ἂν ἰέναι ἐπὶ τὰ δημόσια ἔργα· εἰ δὲ μήτε διδάσκαλον εἶχομεν ἡμῶν αὐτῶν ἐπιδιδέξαι οἰκοδομήματά τε ἢ μηδὲν ἢ πολλὰ καὶ μηδενὸς ἄξια, οὕτω δὴ ἀνόητον ἦν δήπου ἐπιχειρεῖν τοῖς δημοσίοις ἔργοις καὶ παρακαλεῖν ἀλλήλους ἐπ' αὐτά. φῶμεν ταῦτα ὀρθῶς λέγεσθαι

514d

S: Would this not also apply to all other situations where, having embarked upon public service, we might encourage one another to enter public service perhaps as properly qualified physicians, for instance? Presumably we would scrutinise one another – I, you, and

you, me – asking, “Come on, Socrates. By the gods, where does your own body stand in respect of health? Has anyone else, slave or free, ever been quit of disease through the agency of Socrates?” And I think I would make other enquiries of that sort about you. And if we did not find anyone, citizen or stranger, man or woman, who had been improved in body through our agency, by Zeus, Callicles, would it not be laughable, in truth, if human stupidity were to attain such a level that before practising on a private basis, often in a haphazard manner but often working systematically and exercising the skill properly, we were to encourage ourselves and other people of this sort to turn a hand to public service and, as the saying goes, attempt to learn pottery by working on a large vessel? Do you not think it would be stupid to act in this way?

ἢ οὐ; ΚΑΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν οὕτω πάντα, τά τε ἄλλα κἂν εἰ ἐπιχειρήσαντες δημοσιεύειν παρεκαλοῦμεν ἀλλήλους ὥς ἱκανοὶ ἰατροὶ ὄντες, ἐπεσκεψάμεθα δήπου ἂν ἐγὼ τε σὲ καὶ σὺ ἐμέ, φέρε πρὸς θεῶν, αὐτὸς δὲ ὁ Σωκράτης πῶς ἔχει τὸ σῶμα πρὸς ὑγίειαν; ἢ ἤδη τις ἄλλος διὰ Σωκράτην ἀπηλλάγη νόσου, ἢ δοῦλος ἢ ἐλεύθερος; κἂν ἐγὼ οἶμαι περὶ σοῦ ἕτερα τοιαῦτα ἐσκόπουν· καὶ εἰ μὴ ἠύρισκομεν δι’ ἡμᾶς μηδένα

514e

CA: I do.

βελτίω γεγονότα τὸ σῶμα, μήτε τῶν ξένων μήτε τῶν ἀστῶν, μήτε ἄνδρα μήτε γυναῖκα, πρὸς Διός, ὧ Καλλίκλεις, οὐ καταγέλαστον ἂν ἦν τῇ ἀληθείᾳ, εἰς τοσοῦτον ἀνοίας ἐλθεῖν ἀνθρώπους, ὥστε, πρὶν ἰδιωτεύοντας πολλὰ μὲν ὅπως ἐτύχομεν ποιῆσαι, πολλὰ δὲ κατορθῶσαι καὶ γυμνάσασθαι ἱκανῶς τὴν τέχνην, τὸ λεγόμενον δὴ τοῦτο ἐν τῷ πίθῳ τὴν κεραμείαν ἐπιχειρεῖν μαθάνειν, καὶ αὐτούς τε δημοσιεύειν ἐπιχειρεῖν καὶ ἄλλους τοιούτους παρακαλεῖν; οὐκ ἀνόητόν σοι δοκεῖ ἂν εἶναι οὕτω πράττειν; ΚΑΛ. ἔμοιγε.

515a

S: But now, best of men, since you have just begun to engage in civic affairs, and since you are encouraging me and censuring me because I am not engaged in this, shall we not scrutinise one another? So come on, has Callicles already made any of our citizens better? Is there anyone who was previously degenerate, unjust, undisciplined and stupid, be he citizen or stranger, slave or free, who became noble and good through the agency of Callicles? Tell me, if anyone scrutinises you on these bases, Callicles, what will you say? What person will you claim to have made better through their association with you? Why are you reluctant to answer if there really is some achievement of yours from your days as a private citizen, before you turned your hand to public service?

ΣΩ. νῦν δέ, ὦ βέλτιστε ἀνδρῶν, ἐπειδὴ σὺ μὲν αὐτὸς ἄρτι ἄρχῃ πράττειν τὰ τῆς πόλεως πράγματα, ἐμὲ δὲ παρακαλεῖς καὶ ὀνειδίζεις ὅτι οὐ πράττω, οὐκ ἐπισκεψόμεθα ἀλλήλους, φέρε, Καλλικλῆς ἤδη τινὰ βελτίῳ πεποίηκεν τῶν πολιτῶν; ἔστιν ὅστις πρότερον πονηρὸς ὢν, ἄδικός τε καὶ ἀκόλαστος καὶ ἄφρων, διὰ Καλλικλέα καλὸς τε καὶ ἀγαθὸς γέγονεν, ἢ ξένος ἢ ἀστός, ἢ δοῦλος ἢ ἐλεύθερος; λέγε μοι,

515b

CA: You have a thirst for victory, Socrates.

515b

S: No, I am not asking out of a thirst for victory, but as someone who truly wishes to know the precise manner in which you think political activity should be conducted among us. Or, once you embark upon civic affairs among us, will you really care for anything else besides the issue of how we citizens may become as good as possible? Have we not agreed several times already that this is what a political man should do? Have we agreed or not? Please answer. I shall answer on your behalf. We have agreed. In that case, if this is the service a good man should furnish to his own city, recollect and tell me now about the men you mentioned a short while ago, Pericles, Cimon, Miltiades and Themistocles. Do you still think these men were good citizens?

ἐάν τις σε ταῦτα ἐξετάζη, ὦ Καλλίκλεις, τί ἐρεῖς; τίνα φήσεις βελτίω πεποιηκέναι ἄνθρωπον τῇ συνουσίᾳ τῇ σῇ; ὁκνεῖς ἀποκρίνασθαι, εἴπερ ἔστιν τι ἔργον σὸν ἔτι ἰδιωτεύοντος, πρὶν δημοσιεύειν ἐπιχειρεῖν; ΚΑΛ. φιλόνομος εἶ, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' οὐ φιλονικία γε ἐρωτῶ, ἀλλ' ὡς ἀληθῶς βουλόμενος εἰδέναι ὄντινά ποτε τρόπον οἶει δεῖν πολιτεύεσθαι ἐν ἡμῖν. ἢ ἄλλου του ἄρα ἐπιμελήσῃ ἡμῖν ἐλθὼν ἐπὶ τὰ τῆς πόλεως πράγματα ἢ ὅπως ὅτι βέλτιστοι οἱ πολῖται ὦμεν; ἢ οὐ πολλάκις ἤδη ὠμολογήκαμεν τοῦτο δεῖν πράττειν τὸν πολιτικὸν ἄνδρα; ὠμολογήκαμεν ἢ οὐ; ἀποκρίνου. ὠμολογήκαμεν· ἐγὼ ὑπὲρ σοῦ ἀποκρινοῦμαι. εἰ τοίνυν τοῦτο δεῖ τὸν ἀγαθὸν ἄνδρα παρασκευάζειν τῇ ἑαυτοῦ πόλει, νῦν μοι ἀναμνησθεῖς εἰπὲ περὶ ἐκείνων τῶν ἀνδρῶν ὧν ὀλίγῳ πρότερον ἔλεγες, εἰ ἔτι σοι δοκοῦσιν ἀγαθοὶ πολῖται γεγονέναι,

515d

CA: I do.

515d

S: Then, since they were good, it is obvious that each of them made the citizens better rather than worse. Did they do this or not?

515d

CA: Yes.

515d

S: In that case, when Pericles began speaking in the Assembly, were the Athenians worse than when he delivered his final speeches?

515d

CA: Probably.

515d

S: Surely, best of men, this is not probably, but necessarily the case, based on what we have agreed, if, in fact, Pericles was, at any rate, a good citizen.

Περικλῆς καὶ Κίμων καὶ Μιλτιάδης καὶ Θεμιστοκλῆς. ΚΑΛ. ἔμοιγε. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν εἴπερ ἀγαθοί, δηλον ὅτι ἕκαστος αὐτῶν βελτίους ἐποίει τοὺς πολίτας ἀντὶ χειρόνων. ἐποίει ἢ οὐ; ΚΑΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ὅτε Περικλῆς ἤρχετο λέγειν ἐν τῷ δήμῳ, χείρους ἦσαν οἱ Ἀθηναῖοι ἢ ὅτε τὰ

τελευταῖα ἔλεγεν; ΚΑΛ. ἴσως. ΣΩ. οὐκ ἴσως δὴ, ὃ βέλτιστε, ἀλλ' ἀνάγκη ἐκ τῶν ὠμολογημένων, εἴπερ ἀγαθός γ' ἦν ἐκεῖνος πολίτης.

515e

CA: What about it?

515e

S: Nothing. But tell me this as well. Do the Athenians claim to have become better through the agency of Pericles, or quite the contrary, to have been corrupted by the man? Indeed, what I hear anyway is that Pericles turned the Athenians into lazy, cowardly, blabbering money-lovers by first instituting paid public service.

515e

CA: You have heard all this from admirers of Sparta, Socrates.

515e

S: But there is something else that I do not just hear but know full well, and so do you: that Pericles was well regarded at first, and the Athenians levelled no charge of baseness against him when they were in a worse state. However, once they had become good and noble through his agency, towards the end of Pericles' life, they charged him with embezzlement, and indeed almost condemned him to death on the obvious ground that he was corrupt.

ΚΑΛ. τί οὖν δὴ; ΣΩ. οὐδέν· ἀλλὰ τόδε μοι εἶπε ἐπὶ τούτῳ, εἰ λέγονται Ἀθηναῖοι διὰ Περικλέα βελτίους γεγονέναι, ἢ πᾶν τούναντίον διαφθαρῆναι ὑπ' ἐκείνου. ταυτὶ γὰρ ἔγωγε ἀκούω, Περικλέα πεπονημένον Ἀθηναίους ἀργούς καὶ δειλοὺς καὶ λάλους καὶ φιλαργύρους, εἰς μισθοφορίαν πρῶτον καταστήσαντα. ΚΑΛ. τῶν τὰ ὧτα κατεαγότων ἀκούεις ταῦτα, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ τάδε οὐκέτι ἀκούω, ἀλλ' οἶδα σαφῶς καὶ ἐγὼ καὶ σύ, ὅτι τὸ μὲν πρῶτον ηὐδοκίμει Περικλῆς καὶ οὐδεμίαν αἰσχρὰν δίκην κατεψηφίσαντο αὐτοῦ Ἀθηναῖοι, ἤνίκα χεῖρους ἦσαν· ἐπειδὴ δὲ καλοὶ καγαθοὶ ἐγεγόνεσαν

516a

CA: What of it? Does it follow that Pericles was a bad person?

516a

S: Yet it seems that someone who cares for donkeys or horses or oxen would be bad if he were the sort of person who took charge of them when they neither trampled him nor gored him nor bit him, and turned them out so wild that they performed all these mischiefs. Or do you not think that any caretaker of any living creature whatsoever is bad who takes charge of them when gentle and turns them out wilder than when he took them on? Do you think this or not?

ὅπ' αὐτοῦ, ἐπὶ τελευτῇ τοῦ βίου τοῦ Περικλέους, κλοπὴν αὐτοῦ κατεψηφίσαντο, ὀλίγου δὲ καὶ θανάτου ἐτίμησαν, δῆλον ὅτι ὡς πονηροῦ ὄντος. ΚΑΛ. τί οὖν; τούτου ἔνεκα κακὸς ἦν Περικλῆς; ΣΩ. ὄνων γοῦν ἂν ἐπιμελητῆς καὶ ἵππων καὶ βοῶν τοιοῦτος ὢν κακὸς ἂν ἐδόκει εἶναι, εἰ παραλαβὼν μὴ λακτίζοντας ἑαυτὸν μηδὲ κυρίττοντας μηδὲ δάκνοντας ἀπέδειξε ταῦτα ἅπαντα ποιοῦντας δι' ἀγριότητα. ἢ οὐ δοκεῖ σοι

516b

CA: Entirely so, just to gratify you.

516b

S: Then you should also gratify me by answering this question. Is a human being also one of those living creatures, or is he not?

516b

CA: How could he not be?

516b

S: And did Pericles not care for human beings?

516b

CA: Yes.

516b

S: What now? Should they not have become more just rather than more unjust through his agency, based on what we have agreed a moment ago, if he really took charge of them as a man who was good in relation to civic affairs?

κακὸς εἶναι ἐπιμελητῆς ὅστισοῦν ὅτουοῦν ζῶου, ὃς ἂν παραλαβὼν ἡμερώτερα ἀποδείξει ἀγριώτερα ἢ παρέλαβε; δοκεῖ ἢ οὐ; ΚΑΛ. πάνυ γε,

ἵνα σοι χάρισωμαι. ΣΩ. καὶ τόδε τοίνυν μοι χάρισαι ἀποκρινάμενος·
 πότερον καὶ ὁ ἄνθρωπος ἐν τῶν ζώων ἐστὶν ἢ οὐ; ΚΑΛ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΣΩ.
 οὐκοῦν ἀνθρώπων Περικλῆς ἐπεμέλετο; ΚΑΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. τί οὖν; οὐκ ἔδει
 αὐτούς, ὥς ἄρτι ὠμολογοῦμεν, δικαιότερους γεγονέναι ἀντὶ
 ἀδικωτέρων ὑπ' ἐκείνου, εἴπερ

516c

CA: Entirely so.

516c

S: Are not just people civilised, according to Homer?⁴¹ But what do you say? Is this not the case?

516c

CA: Yes.

516c

S: And yet, Pericles rendered them more uncivilised than when he took charge of them, and these mischiefs were directed against himself, the last person he would have wanted it for.

516c

CA: Do you want me to agree with you?

516c

S: If you think I am speaking the truth.

516c

CA: Well, let it be so.

516c

S: Now, since they were more uncivilised, were they not more unjust and bad?

516c

CA: Be it so.

516c

S: So, according to this argument, Pericles was not good at civic affairs.

ἐκεῖνος ἐπεμελεῖτο αὐτῶν ἀγαθός ὢν τὰ πολιτικά; ΚΑΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ.
 οὐκοῦν οἱ γε δίκαιοι ἡμεροί, ὥς ἔφη Ὅμηρος· σὺ δὲ τί φῆς; οὐχ οὕτως;

ΚΑΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ μὴν ἀγριωτέρους γε αὐτοὺς ἀπέφηνεν ἢ οἴους παρέλαβεν, καὶ ταῦτ' εἰς αὐτόν, ὃν ἥκιστ' ἂν ἐβούλετο. ΚΑΛ. βούλει σοι ὁμολογήσω; ΣΩ. εἰ δοκῶ γε σοι ἀληθῆ λέγειν. ΚΑΛ. ἔστω δὴ ταῦτα. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν εἴπερ ἀγριωτέρους, ἀδικωτέρους τε καὶ χεῖρους;

516d

CA: You say he was not anyway.

516d

S: By Zeus, even you said so, based on what you have agreed. But tell me again about Cimon. Did not the very people he was caring for ostracise him so that they would not hear his voice for ten years? And did they not do the same things to Themistocles, and punish him with exile too? And they voted to cast Miltiades, the hero of Marathon, into the pit, and were it not for the presiding official he would have been thrown in. However, if these fellows were good men, as you claim, they would never have suffered those misfortunes. It is not the fate of good charioteers that at the beginning of their careers they are not prone to fall out of the chariots, but when they have tended their horses and have themselves become better charioteers, they are prone to fall out then. This is not the case, either in charioteering or in any other activity. Or do you think it is?

ΚΑΛ. ἔστω. ΣΩ. οὐκ ἄρ' ἀγαθὸς τὰ πολιτικὰ Περικλῆς ἦν ἐκ τούτου τοῦ λόγου. ΚΑΛ. οὐ σύ γε φῆς. ΣΩ. μὰ Δί' οὐδέ γε σὺ ἐξ ὧν ὠμολόγεις. πάλιν δὲ λέγε μοι περὶ Κίμωνος· οὐκ ἐξωστράκισαν αὐτόν οὔτοι οὐς ἐθεράπευεν, ἵνα αὐτοῦ δέκα ἐτῶν μὴ ἀκούσειαν τῆς φωνῆς; καὶ Θεμιστοκλέα ταῦτ' αὐτὰ ἐποίησαν καὶ φυγῇ προσεζημίωσαν; Μιλτιάδην δὲ τὸν Μαραθῶνι εἰς τὸ βάραθρον

516e

CA: I do not.

ἐμβαλεῖν ἐψηφίσαντο, καὶ εἰ μὴ διὰ τὸν πρύτανιν, ἐνέπεσεν ἄν; καίτοι οὔτοι, εἰ ἦσαν ἄνδρες ἀγαθοί, ὥς σὺ φῆς, οὐκ ἄν ποτε ταῦτα ἔπασχον. οὐκ οἶ γε ἀγαθοὶ ἡνίοχοι κατ' ἀρχὰς μὲν οὐκ ἐκπίπτουσιν ἐκ τῶν ζευγῶν, ἐπειδὰν δὲ θεραπεύσωσιν τοὺς ἵππους καὶ αὐτοὶ ἀμείνους

γένωνται ἡνίοχοι, τότε ἐκπίπτουσιν· οὐκ ἔστι ταῦτ' οὔτ' ἐν ἡνιοχείᾳ οὔτ' ἐν ἄλλῳ ἔργῳ οὐδενί· ἢ δοκεῖ σοι; ΚΑΛ. οὐκ ἔμοιγε. ΣΩ. ἀληθεῖς ἄρα, ὡς ἔοικεν, οἱ ἔμπροσθεν λόγοι ἦσαν,

517a

S: So, it seems that our previous statements were true. We know not a single man in this city who has become good in relation to civic affairs. You agree that there are none among the present generation, and although you selected those four men from the previous generation, they actually turned out to be on a par with the moderns. And so, if they were rhetoricians, they did not employ the true rhetoric, or they would not have been cast out, nor did they use the flattering kind either.

ὅτι οὐδένα ἡμεῖς ἴσμεν ἄνδρα ἀγαθὸν γεγονότα τὰ πολιτικὰ ἐν τῇδε τῇ πόλει. σὺ δὲ ὠμολόγεις τῶν γε νῦν οὐδένα, τῶν μέντοι ἔμπροσθεν, καὶ προείλου τούτους τοὺς ἄνδρας· οὗτοι δὲ ἀνεφάνησαν ἐξ ἴσου τοῖς νῦν ὄντες, ὥστε, εἰ οὗτοι ῥήτορες ἦσαν, οὔτε τῇ ἀληθινῇ ῥητορικῇ ἐχρῶντο—οὐ γὰρ ἂν ἐξέπεσον—οὔτε τῇ κολακικῇ. ΚΑΛ. ἀλλὰ μέντοι πολλοῦ γε δεῖ, ὦ Σώκратες, μή ποτέ τις τῶν νῦν ἔργα τοιαῦτα ἐργάσεται οἷα τούτων ὅστις

517b

CA: But surely, Socrates, none of today's men will ever accomplish anything like what was accomplished by anyone of those four you care to choose.

517b

S: You extraordinary man! I am not criticising these fellows either, not as servants of the city anyway. No, they seem to me to have been of greater service than our contemporaries, and better able to provide the city with what it desired. However, when it came to redirecting those desires rather than pandering to them, persuading and compelling them to the one whereby the citizens were going to be better, in this respect these men of the past were, in a way, no different from those of the present day. Yet this is the sole task of a good citizen. But I agree with you, that in providing ships, walls and

dockyards, and anything else like that, those men were more ingenious than these contemporaries of ours.

Now, you and I are engaging in comical behaviour in these arguments. For throughout our entire discussion we are being borne around unceasingly to the same place, each ignorant of what the other is saying. So, I believe you have agreed many times, and realised that this activity itself is something twofold, both in relation to the body and in relation to the soul. One aspect affords a service by which it can provide food when our bodies are hungry, drink when they are thirsty, clothing, bedding and shoes when they are cold, or whatever else the bodies come to desire. And I am deliberately describing this to you based on the same illustrations so that you may understand more easily. Now, if someone can provide these either as a retailer, a merchant or as a manufacturer of any of these things themselves, being a baker or a cook or weaver or cobbler or tanner, it is little wonder that such a person seems, both to himself and others, to be an attendant of the body. Thus does it seem, to everyone who does not know, that besides all of these activities, there is a particular skill of gymnastics and medicine, which is the true attendance upon the body, and this indeed deserves to rule over all of those other skills and make use of what they produce, because this skill knows what food and drink is useful or detrimental to the excellence of the body, while all the others are ignorant of this. Accordingly, those other skills are slavish, servile and devoid of freedom in their dealings with the body, while gymnastics and medicine are, in justice, their mistress.

Now, when I say that these same considerations also apply to the soul, you seem to me to understand, and on occasion you agree, as though you know what I mean. But then you come along a little later, claiming that there have been men in this city who were good and noble citizens. But once I ask you who they were, you offer as exemplars men engaged in civic affairs, just as if I were to ask you about

gymnastic affairs and which men had become good at this and are good attendants of our bodies, and you were to inform me, in all seriousness, that Thearion the breadmaker, and Mithaikos who wrote the book on Sicilian cookery, and Sarambos the wine merchant prove themselves wonderful attendants upon our bodies as these fellows provide us with wonderful bread in one case, and with food and wine in the other instances.

Perhaps you might get angry if I were to tell you, “My man, you understand nothing about gymnastics. You tell me of men who are servants and satisfiers of desires, while appreciating nothing good and noble about them, who stuff and fatten people’s bodies in any way they can, destroy the natural flesh of the people too, and are praised for doing so. These people, for their part, through inexperience, do not blame the banqueters for causing the diseases, and the wasting of their very flesh when disease arrives a long time later, brought on by the excess indulged without regard to the rules of health. No, they blame whoever happens to be around at the time, and who offers them any advice, and they would do these men harm if they could. And they praise the previous fellows who are responsible for the problems.” And you are now behaving just like this, Callicles, praising men who have feasted these citizens by feeding them up on whatever they desired. Yes, they say that these men have made this city great. But they are not aware that it is bloated and festering because of those men of old. For, omitting sound-mindedness and justice, they have filled up the city with harbours and dockyards and walls and tribute-money and nonsense of that sort, yet whenever a bout of debilitation afflicts her, they blame the present-day advisers, and praise Themistocles and Cimon and Pericles, the men who caused the problems. And they will probably attack you if you are not careful, and my own companion Alcibiades⁴² too, whenever they lose what they had to begin with, along with all they have acquired since. Not that you have direct responsibility for the problems, but perhaps you do

share some responsibility.

What is more, I also see an absurd process going on these days, and I hear about it too in relation to the men of old. For I observe that whenever the city proceeds against one of its political men on the grounds that he acted unjustly, they get angry and complain bitterly because they are treated so terribly. They argue that having done so much good for the city, they are now being destroyed by it in an unjust manner. But this is a complete lie, for not one protector of a city could ever be destroyed by the very city that he was protecting. Indeed, the circumstances of those who make themselves out to be politicians, and those who set themselves up as sophists, are probably the same. In fact, the sophists, though wise in other respects, engage in this strange process by which, having claimed to be teachers of excellence, they frequently accuse their own pupils of treating them unjustly by withholding payment from them and failing to afford them any gratitude for being so well treated by them. Now, what process could be more irrational than this description by which men, who have become good and just, whose injustice has been eradicated by their teacher, who have come to possess justice, behave unjustly on account of that which they do not possess? Does this not seem strange to you, my friend? In truth, Callicles, you have made it necessary for me to engage in mob oratory, through your reluctance to answer me.

βούλει εἴργασται. ΣΩ. ὦ δαιμόνιε, οὐδ' ἐγὼ ψέγω τούτους ὥς γε διακόνους εἶναι πόλεως, ἀλλὰ μοι δοκοῦσι τῶν γε νῦν διακονικώτεροι γεγενέσθαι καὶ μᾶλλον οἷοί τε ἐκπορίζειν τῇ πόλει ὧν ἐπεθύμει. ἀλλὰ γὰρ μεταβιβάζειν τὰς ἐπιθυμίας καὶ μὴ ἐπιτρέπειν, πείθοντες καὶ βιαζόμενοι ἐπὶ τοῦτο ὅθεν ἔμελλον ἀμείνους ἔσσεσθαι οἱ πολῖται, ὡς ἔπος εἰπεῖν οὐδὲν τούτων διέφερον ἐκείνοι· ὅπερ μόνον ἔργον ἐστὶν ἀγαθοῦ πολίτου. ναῦς δὲ καὶ τείχη καὶ νεώρια καὶ ἄλλα πολλὰ τοιαῦτα καὶ ἐγὼ σοι ὁμολογῶ δεινότερους εἶναι ἐκείνους τούτων ἐκπορίζειν. πρᾶγμα οὖν γελοῖον ποιούμεεν ἐγὼ τε καὶ σὺ ἐν τοῖς λόγοις ἐν παντὶ γὰρ τῷ χρόνῳ ὃν διαλεγόμεθα οὐδὲν παυόμεθα εἰς τὸ αὐτὸ ἀεὶ

περιφερόμενοι καὶ ἀγνοοῦντες ἀλλήλων ὅτι λέγομεν. ἐγὼ γοῦν σε
 πολλάκις οἶμαι ὠμολογηκέναι καὶ ἐγνωκέναι ὡς ἄρα διττὴ αὕτη τις ἢ
 πραγματεία ἔστιν καὶ περὶ τὸ σῶμα καὶ περὶ τὴν ψυχὴν, καὶ ἡ μὲν ἑτέρα
 διακονικὴ ἔστιν, ἥ δυνάτὸν εἶναι ἐκπορίζειν, ἐὰν μὲν πεινῇ τὰ σώματα
 ἡμῶν, σιτία, ἐὰν δὲ διψῇ, ποτά, ἐὰν δὲ ῥιγῶ, ἱμάτια, στρώματα,
 ὑποδήματα, ἄλλ' ὧν ἔρχεται σώματα εἰς ἐπιθυμίαν· καὶ ἐξεπίτηδές σοι
 διὰ τῶν αὐτῶν εἰκόνων λέγω, ἵνα ῥᾶον καταμάθῃς. τούτων γὰρ
 ποριστικὸν εἶναι ἢ κάπηλον ὄντα ἢ ἔμπορον ἢ δημιουργόν του αὐτῶν
 τούτων, σιτοποιὸν ἢ ὀψοποιὸν ἢ ὑφάντην ἢ σκυτοτόμον ἢ
 σκυτοδεψόν, οὐδὲν θαυμαστόν ἐστιν ὄντα τοιοῦτον δόξαι καὶ αὐτῷ καὶ
 τοῖς ἄλλοις θεραπευτὴν εἶναι σώματος, παντὶ τῷ μὴ εἰδότι ὅτι ἔστιν τις
 παρὰ ταύτας ἀπάσας τέχνη γυμναστικὴ τε καὶ ἰατρικὴ, ἡ δὴ τῷ ὄντι γε
 ἐστὶν σώματος θεραπεία, ἥνπερ καὶ προσήκει τούτων ἄρχειν πασῶν
 τῶν τεχνῶν καὶ χρῆσθαι τοῖς τούτων ἔργοις διὰ τὸ εἰδέναι ὅτι χρηστὸν
 καὶ πονηρὸν τῶν σιτίων ἢ ποτῶν ἐστὶν εἰς ἀρετὴν σώματος, τὰς δ'
 ἄλλας πάσας ταύτας ἀγνοεῖν· ΣΩ. διὸ δὴ καὶ ταύτας μὲν δουλοπρεπεῖς
 τε καὶ διακονικὰς καὶ ἀνελευθέρους εἶναι περὶ σώματος πραγματεῖαν,
 τὰς ἄλλας τέχνας, τὴν δὲ γυμναστικὴν καὶ ἰατρικὴν κατὰ τὸ δίκαιον
 δεσποίνας εἶναι τούτων. ταῦτά οὖν ταῦτα ὅτι ἔστιν καὶ περὶ ψυχὴν,
 τοτὲ μὲν μοι δοκεῖς μανθάνειν ὅτι λέγω, καὶ ὁμολογεῖς ὡς εἰδὼς ὅτι
 ἐγὼ λέγω· ἡκεῖς δὲ ὀλίγον ὕστερον λέγων ὅτι ἄνθρωποι καλοὶ κάγαθοὶ
 γεγόνασιν πολῖται ἐν τῇ πόλει, καὶ ἐπειδὴν ἐγὼ ἐρωτῶ οἵτινες, δοκεῖς
 μοι ὁμοιοτάτους προτείνεισθαι ἀνθρώπους περὶ τὰ πολιτικά, ὥσπερ ἂν
 εἰ περὶ τὰ γυμναστικά ἐμοῦ ἐρωτῶντος οἵτινες ἀγαθοὶ γεγόνασιν ἢ
 εἰσὶν σωμάτων θεραπευταί, ἔλεγές μοι πάνυ σπουδάζων, Θεαρίων ὁ
 ἀρτοκόπος καὶ Μίθαικος ὁ τὴν ὀψοποιίαν συγγεγραφῶς τὴν Σικελικὴν
 καὶ Σάραμβος ὁ κάπηλος, ὅτι οὗτοι θαυμαῖοι γεγόνασιν σωμάτων
 θεραπευταί, ὁ μὲν ἄρτους θαυμαστοὺς παρασκευάζων, ὁ δὲ ὄψον, ὁ δὲ
 οἶνον. ἴσως ἂν οὖν ἡγανάκτεις, εἴ σοι ἔλεγον ἐγὼ ὅτι Ἄνθρωπε, ἐπάειξ
 οὐδὲν περὶ γυμναστικῆς διακόνους μοι λέγεις καὶ ἐπιθυμιῶν
 παρασκευαστὰς ἀνθρώπους, οὐκ ἐπαίοντας καλὸν κάγαθον οὐδὲν περὶ
 αὐτῶν, οἳ, ἂν οὕτω τύχωσιν, ἐμπλήσαντες καὶ παχύναντες τὰ σώματα
 τῶν ἀνθρώπων, ἐπαινούμενοι ὑπ' αὐτῶν, προσαπολοῦσιν αὐτῶν καὶ

τὰς ἀρχαίας σάρκας· οἱ δ' αὖ δι' ἀπειρίαν οὐ τοὺς ἐστιῶντας αἰτιάσονται τῶν νόσων αἰτίους εἶναι καὶ τῆς ἀποβολῆς τῶν ἀρχαίων σαρκῶν, ἀλλ' οἱ ἂν αὐτοῖς τύχῳσι τότε παρόντες καὶ συμβουλευόντες τι, ὅταν δὴ αὐτοῖς ἦκη ἡ τότε πλησμονὴ νόσον φέρουσα συχνῶ ὕστερον χρόνῳ, ἅτε ἄνευ τοῦ ὑγιεινοῦ γεγονυῖα, τούτους αἰτιάσονται καὶ ψέξουσιν καὶ κακόν τι ποιήσουσιν, ἂν οἷοί τ' ᾧσι, τοὺς δὲ προτέρους ἐκείνους καὶ αἰτίους τῶν κακῶν ἐγκωμιάσουσιν. καὶ σὺ νῦν, ὦ Καλλίκλεις, ὁμοιότατον τούτῳ ἐργάζῃ· ἐγκωμιάζεις ἀνθρώπους, οἱ τούτους εἰστιάκασιν εὐωχοῦντες ὧν ἐπεθύμουν. ΣΩ. καὶ φασὶ μεγάλην τὴν πόλιν πεποιηκέναι αὐτούς· ὅτι δὲ οἶδεῖ καὶ ὕπουλός ἐστιν δι' ἐκείνους τοὺς παλαιούς, οὐκ αἰσθάνονται. ἄνευ γὰρ σωφροσύνης καὶ δικαιοσύνης λιμένων καὶ νεωρίων καὶ τειχῶν καὶ φόρων καὶ τοιούτων φλυαριῶν ἐμπεπλήκασιν τὴν πόλιν· ὅταν οὖν ἔλθῃ ἡ καταβολὴ αὕτη τῆς ἀσθεनेίας, τοὺς τότε παρόντας αἰτιάσονται συμβούλους, Θεμιστοκλέα δὲ καὶ Κίμωνα καὶ Περικλέα ἐγκωμιάσουσιν, τοὺς αἰτίους τῶν κακῶν· σοῦ δὲ ἴσως ἐπιλήψονται, ἐὰν μὴ εὐλαβῇ, καὶ τοῦ ἐμοῦ ἐταίρου Ἀλκιβιάδου, ὅταν καὶ τὰ ἀρχαῖα προσαπολλύωσι πρὸς οἷς ἐκτίσαντο, οὐκ αἰτίων ὄντων τῶν κακῶν ἀλλ' ἴσως συναιτίων. καίτοι ἔγωγε ἀνόητον πρᾶγμα καὶ νῦν ὁρῶ γιγνόμενον καὶ ἀκούω τῶν παλαιῶν ἀνδρῶν πέρι. αἰσθάνομαι γάρ, ὅταν ἡ πόλις τινὰ τῶν πολιτικῶν ἀνδρῶν μεταχειρίζεται ὥς ἀδικοῦντα, ἀγανακτοῦντων καὶ σχετλιαζόντων ὥς δεινὰ πάσχουσι· πολλὰ καὶ ἀγαθὰ τὴν πόλιν πεποικότες ἄρα ἀδίκως ὑπ' αὐτῆς ἀπόλλυνται, ὥς ὁ τούτων λόγος. τὸ δὲ ὅλον ψευδὸς ἐστίν· προστάτης γὰρ πόλεως οὐδ' ἂν εἷς ποτε ἀδίκως ἀπόλοιτο ὑπ' αὐτῆς τῆς πόλεως ἥς προστατεῖ. κινδυνεύει γὰρ ταῦτόν εἶναι, ὅσοι τε πολιτικοὶ προσποιοῦνται εἶναι καὶ ὅσοι σοφισταί. καὶ γὰρ οἱ σοφισταί, τᾶλλα σοφοὶ ὄντες, τοῦτο ἄτοπον ἐργάζονται πρᾶγμα· φάσκοντες γὰρ ἀρετῆς διδάσκαλοι εἶναι πολλάκις κατηγοροῦσιν τῶν μαθητῶν ὥς ἀδικοῦσι σφᾶς αὐτούς, τούς τε μισθοὺς ἀποστεροῦντες καὶ ἄλλην χάριν οὐκ ἀποδιδόντες,

519d

CA: But were you not the one who was unable to speak unless someone responded to you?

519d

S: So it seemed, anyway. But now, since you are unwilling to answer me, I am protracting my utterances quite considerably. But, good man, tell me in the name of friendship, does it not seem irrational to you for someone who claims to have made someone else good to censure that person, because having become good through his agency, and still being good, he is an evildoer after all?

εὖ παθόντες ὑπ' αὐτῶν. καὶ τούτου τοῦ λόγου τί ἂν ἀλογώτερον εἴη πρᾶγμα, ἀνθρώπους ἀγαθοὺς καὶ δικαίους γενομένους, ἐξαιρεθέντας μὲν ἀδικίαν ὑπὸ τοῦ διδασκάλου, σχόντας δὲ δικαιοσύνην, ἀδικεῖν τούτῳ ᾧ οὐκ ἔχουσιν; οὐ δοκεῖ σοι τοῦτο ἄτοπον εἶναι, ὦ ἑταῖρε; ὥς ἀληθῶς δημηγορεῖν με ἠνάγκασας, ὦ Καλλίκλεις, οὐκ ἐθέλων ἀποκρίνεσθαι. ΚΑΛ. σὺ δ' οὐκ ἂν οἴός τ' εἶης λέγειν, εἰ μὴ τίς σοι ἀποκρίνοιτο;

519e

CA: It seems so, to me anyway.

519e

S: Do you not hear this sort of thing from those men who claim to educate people towards excellence?

519e

CA: I do. But what can you say about people who are worthless?

519e

S: And what can you say about those who, whilst claiming to have taken charge of the city and cared for it, so that it will be as good as it possibly can be, turn around when circumstances dictate, and accuse it of being a gross evil doer? Do you think these fellows differ at all from the others? Sophist and rhetorician are the same, bless you, or nearly so, and very similar, just as I was saying to Polus. But you, through ignorance, think that rhetoric is something glorious, and you despise the other activity. But in truth, to the extent that law-making is more noble than jurisprudence, and gymnastic than medicine, so too is sophistry more noble than rhetoric. And I for one believe that the popular speakers and sophists alone are not permitted to censure

the very personage whom they educate, on the grounds that he is corrupt in his dealing with themselves, or else they would, by this same argument, be accusing themselves of not benefiting those whom they claim to benefit. Is this not so?

ΣΩ. ἔοικά γε· νῦν γοῦν συχνούς τείνω τῶν λόγων, ἐπειδὴ μοι οὐκ ἐθέλεις ἀποκρίνεσθαι. ἀλλ', ὠγαθέ, εἰπέ πρὸς Φιλίου, οὐ δοκεῖ σοι ἄλογον εἶναι ἀγαθὸν φάσκοντα πεποιηκέναι τινὰ μέμφεσθαι τούτῳ ὅτι ὑφ' ἑαυτοῦ ἀγαθὸς γεγονώς τε καὶ ὦν ἔπειτα πονηρός ἐστιν; ΚΑΛ. ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἀκούεις τοιαῦτα λεγόντων τῶν φασκόντων παιδεύειν ἀνθρώπους εἰς ἀρετήν; ΚΑΛ. ἔγωγε· ἀλλὰ τί ἂν λέγοις ἀνθρώπων πέρι οὐδενὸς ἀξίων; ΣΩ. τί δ' ἂν περὶ ἐκείνων λέγοις, οἳ φάσκοντες προεστάναι τῆς πόλεως καὶ ἐπιμελεῖσθαι ὅπως ὡς βελτίστη ἔσται, πάλιν αὐτῆς κατηγοροῦσιν, ὅταν τύχωσιν, ὡς πονηροτάτης; οἷε τι διαφέρειν τούτους ἐκείνων; ταῦτόν, ὦ μακάρι', ἐστὶν σοφιστὴς καὶ ῥήτωρ, ἢ ἐγγύς τι καὶ παραπλήσιον, ὥσπερ ἐγὼ ἔλεγον πρὸς Πῶλον· σὺ δὲ δι' ἄγνοίαν τὸ μὲν πάγκαλόν τι οἷε εἶναι, τὴν ῥητορικὴν, τοῦ δὲ καταφρονεῖς. τῇ δὲ ἀληθείᾳ κάλλιον ἐστὶν σοφιστικὴ ῥητορικῆς ὅσῳ περ νομοθετικὴ δικαστικῆς καὶ γυμναστικὴ ἱατρικῆς· μόνοις δ' ἔγωγε καὶ ὥμην τοῖς δημηγόροις τε καὶ σοφισταῖς οὐκ ἐγχωρεῖν μέμφεσθαι τούτῳ τῷ πράγματι ὃ αὐτοῖς παιδεύουσιν, ὡς πονηρόν ἐστιν εἰς σφᾶς, ἢ τῷ αὐτῷ λόγῳ τούτῳ ἅμα καὶ ἑαυτῶν κατηγορεῖν ὅτι οὐδὲν ὠφελήκασιν οὓς φασιν ὠφελεῖν. οὐχ οὕτως ἔχει;

520c

CA: Entirely so.

520c

S: And if what I said is true, I presume it is acceptable for them alone, so it seems, to bestow this service without a fee. For in the case of some other service, someone who has received the benefit might perhaps withhold the recompense. For instance, someone who has become a fast runner through the agency of a trainer might do so if the trainer were to bestow the service without stipulating a fee and arranging to get the money as soon as the swiftness had been

bestowed. Yet it is certainly not on account of slowness, I presume, that people act unjustly, but on account of injustice. Is this so?

ΚΑΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. καὶ προσέσθαι γε δήπου τὴν εὐεργεσίαν ἄνευ μισθοῦ, ὥς τὸ εἰκός, μόνοις τούτοις ἐνεχώρει, εἶπερ ἀληθῆ ἔλεγον. ἄλλην μὲν γὰρ εὐεργεσίαν τις εὐεργετηθεὶς, οἷον ταχὺς γενόμενος διὰ παιδοτρίβην, ἴσως ἂν ἀποστερήσειε τὴν χάριν, εἰ προοῖτο αὐτῷ ὁ παιδοτρίβης καὶ μὴ συνθέμενος αὐτῷ μισθὸν ὅτι μάλιστα ἅμα μεταδιδούς τοῦ τάχους λαμβάνοι

520d

CA: Yes.

520d

S: Therefore, if someone eradicates this injustice itself, he should not fear that any injustice will ever befall him, and this service alone may be bestowed without any risk if anyone is really able to make another person good. Is this not the case?

520d

CA: I agree.

520d

S: So, for these reasons, it seems there is no disgrace in taking money for giving advice on other matters, such as house-building or on other areas of expertise.

τὸ ἀργύριον· οὐ γὰρ δὴ τῇ βραδυτῇτι οἷμαι ἀδικοῦσιν οἱ ἄνθρωποι, ἀλλ' ἀδικίᾳ· ἧ γάρ; ΚΑΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν εἴ τις αὐτὸ τοῦτο ἀφαιρεῖ, τὴν ἀδικίαν, οὐδὲν δεινὸν αὐτῷ μήποτε ἀδικηθῇ, ἀλλὰ μόνῳ ἀσφαλὲς ταύτην τὴν εὐεργεσίαν προσέσθαι, εἶπερ τῷ ὄντι δύναιτό τις ἀγαθοὺς ποιεῖν. οὐχ οὕτω; ΚΑΛ. φημί. ΣΩ. διὰ ταῦτ' ἄρα, ὥς ἔοικε, τὰς μὲν ἄλλας συμβουλὰς συμβουλεύειν λαμβάνοντα ἀργύριον, οἷον οἰκοδομίας περὶ ἢ τῶν ἄλλων τεχνῶν, οὐδὲν αἰσχρόν.

520e

CA: So it seems anyway.

520e

S: And yet, when it comes to advising on how one may be as good as possible and best manage one's own household and city, it is regarded as a disgrace to refuse to give advice on this unless someone gives you money. Is this so?

520e

CA: Yes.

520e

S: And the reason for this is, of course, that this is the only service that makes the recipient of the benefit desire to confer a benefit in return. Accordingly, it seems to be a good sign if someone who has conferred a benefit through this service is treated well in return, and it is not a good sign if he is not. Is this how matters stand?

ΚΑΛ. ἔοικέ γε. ΣΩ. περὶ δέ γε ταύτης τῆς πράξεως, ὄντιν' ἂν τις τρόπον ὡς βέλτιστος εἶη καὶ ἄριστα τὴν αὐτοῦ οἰκίαν διοικοῖ ἢ πόλιν, αἰσχροὺς νενόμισται μὴ φάναι συμβουλεύειν, ἔαν μή τις αὐτῷ ἀργύριον διδῷ. ἢ γάρ; ΚΑΛ. ναί. ΣΩ. δηλον γὰρ ὅτι τοῦτο αἴτιόν ἐστιν, ὅτι μόνη αὕτη τῶν εὐεργεσιῶν τὸν εὖ παθόντα ἐπιθυμεῖν ποιεῖ ἀντ' εὖ ποιεῖν, ὥστε καλὸν δοκεῖ τὸ σημεῖον εἶναι, εἰ εὖ ποιήσας ταύτην τὴν εὐεργεσίαν ἀντ' εὖ πείσεται· εἰ δὲ μή, οὐ. ἔστι ταῦτα οὕτως ἔχοντα;

521a

CA: It is.

521a

S: Now, define which of these services to the city you are encouraging me to engage in, the one that struggles with the Athenians, like a physician, so that they will become as good as possible, or the one where I serve them and minister to their pleasure? Tell me the truth, Callicles, for it is right that since you were so frank with me in the beginning, you continue to say what you are thinking. So, speak out truly and nobly.

521a

CA: Well then, I mean that you should act as their servant.

ΚΑΛ. ἔστιν. ΣΩ. ἐπὶ ποτέραν οὖν με παρακαλεῖς τὴν θεραπείαν τῆς πόλεως, διόρισόν μοι· τὴν τοῦ διαμάχεσθαι Ἀθηναίοις ὅπως ὡς βέλτιστοι ἔσονται, ὡς ἰατρόν, ἢ ὡς διακονήσοντα καὶ πρὸς χάριν ὁμιλήσοντα; τάληθῃ μοι εἰπέ, ὦ Καλλίκλεις· δίκαιος γὰρ εἶ, ὥσπερ ἥρξω παρρησιάζεσθαι πρὸς ἐμέ, διατελεῖν ἃ νοεῖς λέγων. καὶ νῦν εὖ καὶ γενναίως εἰπέ. ΚΑΛ. λέγω τοίνυν ὅτι ὡς διακονήσοντα.

521b

S: So, noblest of men, you are encouraging me to act as their flatterer.

521b

CA: Yes, if it pleases you to be so blunt, Socrates. Since if you do not engage in this...

521b

S: Please do not say what you have said many times, that whoever wishes will kill me so that I, for my part, do not have to say that he will do so as an evil man killing a good man. Nor should you say that he will confiscate all my possessions, so that I, for my part, do not have to say that once he has confiscated them, he will not know how he should use them. Rather, having confiscated them from me in an unjust manner, he will make use of them in the unjust manner in which he acquired them, and if he uses them unjustly he uses them basely, and if he uses them basely he uses them badly.

ΣΩ. κολακεύσοντα ἄρα με, ὦ γενναϊότατε, παρακαλεῖς. ΚΑΛ. εἴ σοι Μυσόν γε ἥδιον καλεῖν, ὦ Σώκρατες· ὡς εἰ μὴ ταῦτά γε ποιήσεις— ΣΩ. μὴ εἴπῃς ὃ πολλάκις εἴρηκας, ὅτι ἀποκτενεῖ με ὁ βουλόμενος, ἵνα μὴ αὐτὸ καὶ ἐγὼ εἴπω, ὅτι Πονηρός γε ὢν ἀγαθὸν ὄντα· μὴδ' ὅτι ἀφαιρήσεται ἐάν τι ἔχω, ἵνα μὴ αὐτὸ ἐγὼ εἴπω ὅτι ἀλλ' ἀφελόμενος οὐχ ἕξει ὅτι χρήσεται αὐτοῖς, ἀλλ' ὥσπερ με ἀδίκως ἀφείλετο, οὕτως καὶ

521c

CA: You seem to me, Socrates, to believe that you will not suffer a single one of these misfortunes, as though you dwelt apart and could not be hauled into court, probably by some utterly corrupt and quite ordinary person.

521c

S: Well, I am, in truth, a fool, Callicles, if I do not believe that in this city of ours anything can happen to anyone. However, I do know that if I were to end up in court facing one of these dangers you refer to, the one who prosecuted me would be an evil-doer, for no worthy person would take an innocent man to court, and it would be nothing strange if I were put to death. Would you like me to tell you why I expect all this?

λαβὼν ἀδίκως χρήσεται, εἰ δὲ ἀδίκως, αἰσχυρῶς, εἰ δὲ αἰσχυρῶς, κακῶς. ΚΑΛ. ὥς μοι δοκεῖς, ὦ Σώκρατες, πιστεύειν μηδ' ἂν ἔν τούτων παθεῖν, ὥς οἰκῶν ἐκποδὼν καὶ οὐκ ἂν εἰσαχθεὶς εἰς δικαστήριον ὑπὸ πάνυ ἴσως μοχθηροῦ ἀνθρώπου καὶ φαύλου. ΣΩ. ἀνόητος ἄρα εἰμί, ὦ Καλλίκλεις, ὥς ἀληθῶς, εἰ μὴ οἶομαι ἐν τῇδε τῇ πόλει ὄντινόν ἂν ὅτι τύχοι, τοῦτο παθεῖν. τόδε μέντοι εὖ οἶδ' ὅτι, ἐάνπερ εἰσίσω εἰς δικαστήριον περὶ

521d

CA: Entirely so.

521d

S: I believe that I am one of few Athenians – I do not say I am the only one – who has taken to the true skill of civic affairs, and I am the only person these days who engages in civic affairs, since any words I ever speak are spoken not with a view to gratification, but with a view to what is best rather than what is most pleasant. And, having no desire to engage in those subtleties that you recommend, I shall have nothing to say in the courtroom. And the same argument that I presented to Polus applies to me, for I shall be judged as a physician would be judged before a jury of children on the accusations of a cook. Yes, consider this. What defence would a person like this, trapped in these circumstances, make if someone were to accuse him, saying, “O children, this man here has inflicted many evils upon you, yes, on yourselves. And he maims the very youngest of you by cutting and burning, he induces distress by withering and choking you, gives you bitter potions and makes you go hungry and thirsty, unlike me who have feasted you sumptuously on a great variety of pleasant delights.”

What do you think a physician caught up in such an evil predicament would be able to say? And if he were to speak the truth, that “Children, I have carried out all of these procedures for the sake of health”, would there not be an enormous outcry from such jurors as those?

τούτων τινὸς κινδυνεύων, ὃ σὺ λέγεις, πονηρός τις μ’ ἔσται ὁ εἰσάγων—οὐδεὶς γὰρ ἂν χρηστὸς μὴ ἀδικοῦντ’ ἄνθρωπον εἰσαγάγοι—καὶ οὐδέν γε ἄτοπον εἰ ἀποθάνοιμι. βούλει σοι εἶπω δι’ ὅτι ταῦτα προσδοκῶ; ΚΑΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. οἶμαι μετ’ ὀλίγων Ἀθηναίων, ἵνα μὴ εἶπω μόνος, ἐπιχειρεῖν τῇ ὡς ἀληθῶς πολιτικῇ τέχνῃ καὶ πράττειν τὰ πολιτικὰ μόνος τῶν νῦν· ἅτε οὖν οὐ πρὸς χάριν λέγων τοὺς λόγους οὕς λέγω ἐκάστοτε, ἀλλὰ πρὸς τὸ βέλτιστον, οὐ πρὸς τὸ ἥδιστον, καὶ οὐκ ἐθέλων ποιεῖν ἃ σὺ παραινεις, τὰ κομψὰ ταῦτα, οὐχ ἔξω ὅτι λέγω ἐν τῷ δικαστηρίῳ. ὁ αὐτὸς δέ μοι ἥκει λόγος ὅνπερ πρὸς Πῶλον ἔλεγον· κρινοῦμαι γὰρ ὡς ἐν παιδίῳ ἰατρός ἂν κρίνοιτο κατηγοροῦντος ὁψοποιοῦ. ΣΩ. σκόπει γάρ, τί ἂν ἀπολογοῖτο ὁ τοιοῦτος ἄνθρωπος ἐν τούτοις ληφθεὶς, εἰ αὐτοῦ κατηγοροῖ τις λέγων ὅτι ὦ παῖδες, πολλὰ ὑμᾶς καὶ κακὰ ὅδε εἴργασται ἀνὴρ καὶ αὐτούς, καὶ τοὺς νεωτάτους ὑμῶν διαφθείρει τέμνων τε καὶ κάων, καὶ ἰσχυαίνων καὶ πνίγων ἀπορεῖν ποιεῖ, πικρότατα πώματα διδούς καὶ πεινῆν καὶ διψῆν ἀναγκάζων, οὐχ ὥσπερ ἐγὼ πολλὰ καὶ ἡδέα καὶ παντοδαπὰ ἡυώχουν ὑμᾶς τί ἂν οἶει ἐν τούτῳ τῷ κακῷ ἀποληφθέντα ἰατρὸν ἔχειν εἰπεῖν; ἢ εἰ εἴποι τὴν ἀλήθειαν, ὅτι ταῦτα πάντα ἐγὼ ἐποίουν, ὦ παῖδες, ὑγιεινῶς, πόσον τι οἶει ἂν ἀναβοῆσαι τοὺς τοιούτους δικαστάς; οὐ μέγα; ΚΑΛ. ἴσως οἴεσθαι γε χρή. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν οἶει ἐν πάσῃ ἀπορίᾳ ἂν αὐτὸν ἔχουσθαι ὅτι

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CA: Probably. I should think so.

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S: Do you not think he would be in utter perplexity as to what he should say?

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CA: Entirely so.

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S: Now, I know that I too would find myself in such a predicament as this were I to be landed in court. Indeed, I would not even be able to recount any pleasures I have provided to them which these people regard as services or benefits, and I would envy neither those who provide them nor the people to whom they are provided. And if someone were to say that I corrupt the young people by reducing them to perplexity, or that I revile the older generation by speaking bitter words to them in public or in private, I would be unable to state the truth that “I say all this and I enact all this in a just manner, O gentlemen of the jury”, to use your phrase, Callicles. And I would have nothing else to say either, and so I would suffer whatever fate might decree.

χρὴ εἰπεῖν; ΚΑΛ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. τοιοῦτον μέντοι καὶ ἐγὼ οἶδα ὅτι πάθος πάθοιμι ἂν εἰσελθὼν εἰς δικαστήριον. οὔτε γὰρ ἡδονὰς ἅς ἐκπεπόρικα ἔξω αὐτοῖς λέγειν, ἅς οὗτοι εὐεργεσίας καὶ ὠφελίας νομίζουσιν, ἐγὼ δὲ οὔτε τοὺς πορίζοντας ζηλῶ οὔτε οἷς πορίζεται. ἐάν τέ τις με ἢ νεωτέρους φῇ διαφθείρειν ἀπορεῖν ποιοῦντα, ἢ τοὺς πρεσβυτέρους κακηγορεῖν λέγοντα πικροὺς λόγους ἢ ἰδίᾳ ἢ δημοσίᾳ, οὔτε τὸ ἀληθὲς ἔξω εἰπεῖν, ὅτι δικαίως

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CA: Well, Socrates, do you think a man who is unable to help himself when he is in this situation is well established in the city?

πάντα ταῦτα ἐγὼ λέγω, καὶ πράττω τὸ ὑμέτερον δὴ τοῦτο, ὧ ἄνδρες δικασταί, οὔτε ἄλλο οὐδέν· ὥστε ἴσως, ὅτι ἂν τύχω, τοῦτο πείσομαι. ΚΑΛ. δοκεῖ οὖν σοι, ὧ Σώκρατες, καλῶς ἔχειν ἄνθρωπος ἐν πόλει οὕτως διακείμενος καὶ ἀδύνατος ὢν ἑαυτῷ βοηθεῖν; ΣΩ. εἰ ἐκεῖνό γε ἐν αὐτῷ ὑπάρχοι, ὧ Καλλίκλεις, ὃ σὺ πολλάκις ὡμολόγησας· εἰ βεβηθηκῶς εἴη αὐτῷ, μήτε περὶ

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S: Yes, Callicles, if he possessed one quality which you have accepted on a number of occasions: if he has assisted himself not to be unjust, neither towards gods nor men, neither in word nor in deed. For we

have agreed many times that this assistance to oneself is the most powerful. So, if someone were to convict me of being unable to help myself or anyone else through this kind of assistance, I would be ashamed, whether I was convicted by many people, by a few, or one on one. And if I were to be put to death on account of this particular inability, I would be troubled by that. But if I were put to death because I lack the flattering kind of rhetoric, I know very well that you would see me bearing death lightly. For no one is afraid of dying itself, unless he is utterly irrational and cowardly. Rather he is afraid of acting unjustly. For the worst of all calamities is to arrive in Hades with one's soul full of injustices. And if you wish, I am prepared to give you an account indicating that this is the case.

ἀνθρώπους μήτε περὶ θεοὺς ἄδικον μηδὲν μήτε εἰρηκῶς μήτε εἰργασμένος. αὕτη γὰρ τῆς βοηθείας ἑαυτῷ πολλάκις ἡμῖν ὠμολόγηται κρατίστη εἶναι. εἰ μὲν οὖν ἐμέ τις ἐξελέγχοι ταύτην τὴν βοήθειαν ἀδύνατον ὄντα ἑμαυτῷ καὶ ἄλλῳ βοηθεῖν, αἰσχυνοίμην ἂν καὶ ἐν πολλοῖς καὶ ἐν ὀλίγοις ἐξελεγχόμενος καὶ μόνος ὑπὸ μόνου, καὶ εἰ διὰ ταύτην τὴν ἀδυναμίαν ἀποθνήσκοιμι, ἀγανακτοίην ἄν· εἰ δὲ κολακικῆς ῥητορικῆς ἐνδεία τελευτῶν ἔγωγε, εὖ οἶδα ὅτι ῥαδίως ἴδοις ἂν με φέροντα

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CA: Well, since you have concluded the other issues, conclude this too.

τὸν θάνατον. αὐτὸ μὲν γὰρ τὸ ἀποθνήσκειν οὐδεὶς φοβεῖται, ὅστις μὴ παντάπασιν ἀλόγιστός τε καὶ ἄνανδρός ἐστιν, τὸ δὲ ἀδικεῖν φοβεῖται· πολλῶν γὰρ ἀδικημάτων γέμοντα τὴν ψυχὴν εἰς Ἄιδου ἀφικέσθαι πάντων ἔσχατον κακῶν ἐστιν. εἰ δὲ βούλει, σοὶ ἐγώ, ὡς τοῦτο οὕτως ἔχει, ἐθέλω λόγον λέξαι. ΚΑΛ. ἀλλ' ἐπέπερ γε καὶ τᾶλλα ἐπέρανας, καὶ τοῦτο πέρανον.

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S: Then, listen to a very beautiful narrative, as they say, one which I believe you may regard as a myth, but which I regard as an account, for whatever I am about to recount to you I shall recount as the truth.

Indeed, as Homer explains, Zeus, Poseidon and Pluto made a distribution of the sovereignty after they inherited it from their father.⁴³ Now, there was a law relating to humanity from the time of Cronus, which had always been in place, and still is among the gods. Those people who have passed their lives in a just and holy manner depart, after they die,

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to the Isles of the Blest to dwell in complete happiness far from evils, while those who have lived in an unjust and godless manner go to the prison-house of retribution and justice that they call Tartarus. But in the time of Cronus, and even more recently under the sovereignty of Zeus, their judges were alive, and they were judged whilst still alive on the very day they were going to die, and so the cases were judged badly. Then both Pluto and the attendants from the Isles of the Blest went to Zeus and reported that undeserving people were making their way to them in either place. So Zeus said, “Well, I shall stop this from happening.

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The cases are indeed being decided badly at present, for those who are judged are judged whilst fully clothed because they are judged whilst still living. So, many people possessing degenerate souls are clothed in beautiful bodies, lineage and wealth, and once there is a trial, numerous witnesses appear on their behalf testifying that they have lived in a just manner. Now, the judges are overwhelmed by all this, and what is more, they themselves are fully clothed as they make their judgements, having concealed their own souls behind eyes and ears and the entire body. All of these, both their own clothing and that of the people being judged, become a screen in front of them.

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So, in the first place,” he said, “their foreknowledge of death must be stopped, for at present they know in advance. And so Prometheus has been instructed to put an end to this foreknowledge of theirs.⁴⁴ Hereafter, they must be judged naked of all those additions, for

judgement must be passed when they have died. And their judge must be naked, dead, immediately beholding their soul itself with his soul itself once each person has died, bereft of kindred, having left that entire order behind him on the earth, so that the judgement may be just.

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Now I, having recognised these issues before you did, have made judges of my own sons, two from Asia, Minos and Rhadamanthus, and one from Europe, Aeacus.⁴⁵ Accordingly, as soon as people die, they will pass judgement in the meadow, at the fork from which two roads lead, one to the Isles of the Blest and the other to Tartarus. Rhadamanthus will judge those from Asia, Aeacus those from Europe, and I shall bestow seniority upon Minos to give a final judgement in

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case either of the others are in perplexity, so that the decision about the destination of human beings may be as just as possible.”

Well, Callicles, this is what I have heard and believe to be true, and on the basis of those accounts I conclude that certain consequences follow. It seems to me that death happens to be nothing else but the separation from one another of two entities, the soul and the body.

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And yet once they have been separated from one another, both of them retain their own condition, which is no worse than when the man was alive, and so the body retains its own nature, and all the care it was given and all the afflictions it suffered are plain to be seen. For instance, if someone’s body was large either by nature or through nurture or both, the corpse of this man will be large once he has died, and if he was fat it will be fat when he is dead, and the same goes for the other characteristics.

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And what is more, if he had long hair his corpse will be long-haired, and if he was a rogue who merited whipping and he had the scars, the

imprints of the blows on his body, either from whips or from other injuries during his life, one can see that the corpse also has these when he is dead. Or if someone's limbs were broken or deformed during his life, those same features will be in evidence when he has died.

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And, in short, whatever bodily features he developed while he was alive will also be in evidence, all of them or most of them, for some time after he has died.

And so, Callicles, it seems to me that the same argument applies to the soul. Everything in the soul is plain to be seen once it has been stripped of the body, both the natural qualities and the effects that the person retains in his soul due to the conduct of particular actions. Now, when they arrive in front of the judge, those from Asia stand before Rhadamanthus, and Rhadamanthus stops them and beholds the soul of each, not knowing whose soul it is.

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And very often, having come across the Great King, or some other king or potentate, he observes that there is nothing healthy in the soul, rather it bears the marks of scourging and is full of scars

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which his own behaviour has imprinted upon his soul on account of oath breaking and injustices. Its ways are all crooked due to falsity and pretence, and nothing is straight because its nurture was devoid of truth. And he sees the soul full of distortion and deformity due to licence, luxury, insolence and unrestrained actions. Having seen this, he sends it away in dishonour straight to the confine, where on arrival it will await the afflictions that are appropriate to it.

It is proper that all who undergo punishment,

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and are punished by another in the correct manner, either become better and are benefited, or else act as examples to other people so that others who see them being afflicted by whatever they suffer may become better out of fear. Now, those who are benefited, and make retribution before gods and men, are the people who have engaged in transgressions that are curable. Nevertheless, it is through pain and suffering that the benefit comes to them, both here and in Hades, for they cannot be quit of injustice in any other way. However, those who have engaged in utterly unjust actions and are rendered incurable on account of such injustices are the ones who act as examples to others.

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These people themselves are no longer benefited at all, since they are incurable. But other people are benefited when they see them suffering the most enormous, most painful and most fearful afflictions throughout eternity on account of their transgressions, simply hanging up as examples there, in Hades, in the prison-house, a spectacle and a warning to those unjust people who are continually arriving there. And if what Polus says is true, then I maintain that Archelaus will be one of these, as will anyone else who is a tyrant of that sort. And I believe most of these examples to other people have come from the ranks of tyrants,

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kings, potentates and those who administer the affairs of our cities, for these people, on account of their immense power, also engage in the most enormous and unholy transgressions. Homer bears witness to these claims when he represents kings and potentates as the ones who are punished throughout eternity in Hades – Tantalus and Sisyphus and Tityus.⁴⁶ But no one represents Thersites, or any other wrongdoer who is a private citizen, as being incurable and afflicted by these enormous punishments, for in my view he lacked the immense power and so is more fortunate than those who do possess power.

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Anyway, Callicles, the people who become extreme evildoers come indeed from the ranks of the powerful, yet there is nothing to prevent good men from arising among them too, and those who do arise deserve great admiration. Indeed, Callicles, it is difficult, and deserving of much praise, to live one's life in a just manner having come by an enormous power to act unjustly.

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Few people of this sort arise. And yet they have arisen, both here and elsewhere, and in my view there will be more of them, noble and good in this excellence of managing in a just manner whatever is entrusted to them. One even became extremely well respected among the other Greeks as well, Aristides,⁴⁷ son of Lysimachus. But, best of men, most of the powerful people became corrupt.

Now, as I was saying, once the judge Rhadamanthus gets hold of someone like this, he knows nothing else about him at all, neither who he is nor who he is descended from, except that he is an evil doer.

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And having discerned this, he dispatches him to Tartarus with a mark indicating whether he is regarded as curable or incurable, and when he arrives there he suffers whatever is appropriate. But sometimes when he looks upon another soul that has lived a holy life in company with truth, belonging to a private citizen or someone else, especially, or so I assert anyway Callicles, the soul of a philosopher who has performed his own duties and has not been excessively active throughout his life, he is delighted and despatches it to the Isles of the Blest.

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Aeacus also engages in the same activities, both of them holding a staff, but Minos sits and oversees them, he alone holding a sceptre of gold, as Homer's Odysseus says that he saw him

*holding a golden sceptre, passing judgements upon the dead.*⁴⁸

Now then, Callicles, I have been persuaded by these accounts, and I give consideration to how I might present my soul to the judge in the healthiest possible condition.

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So, having bidden farewell to the honours so prized by humanity, practising the truth, I shall endeavour to live my life being as good as I can actually be, and when I die, to die in the same manner. And to the best of my ability I encourage all other people as well, and indeed I exhort you in return towards this life and this struggle, which I assert exceeds all the struggles of this world. And I censure you, because you will be unable to assist yourself whenever you come to the trial and the judgement I have just described.

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Rather, having arrived in front of that judge, the son of Aegina, once he has hold of you and is controlling you, you will gape and you will be dizzy in that place, just as much as I am in this place, and someone will probably slap you contemptuously on the face and splatter you all over with mud.

Well then, perhaps these descriptions seem to you just like a myth an old woman might recount, and you despise them.

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And it would be no surprise if we were to despise them, if, in our search, we were somehow able to discover something better and truer than them. But now you see that the three of you, yourself, Polus and Gorgias, who really are the wisest Greeks of the present day, are unable to prove that one should live any other life than this one, a life which also turns out to be profitable in the hereafter. But in the midst of all these assertions, the others having been refuted, this proposition alone is left undisturbed:

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that it is necessary to be more wary of doing injustice than of suffering injustice; and it is all the more important for a man to work at being good, both in private and in public, rather than seeming good; and if he becomes bad in some respect, he should be punished. And this good, becoming good and paying a penalty by being punished, stands in second place after being good. And all flattery concerning yourself or concerning others, be they few or be they many, must be shunned, and rhetoric should be

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used in this manner, always directed to the just, and so should every other activity.

So heed me, and follow me to a place where, on arrival, you will be happy both in life and after death, as the argument indicates. And let someone despise you as a fool and splatter you with mud if he wants to. Yes, by Zeus, and be bold enough to let him strike you that contemptuous blow, for nothing terrible will befall you if you really are noble and good, practising excellence.

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And after we have practised together in this way, then at that stage, if we deem it useful, we shall contribute to civic affairs, or we shall deliberate upon whatever issues occur to us as we shall be better equipped to deliberate than we are now. Indeed, it is quite disgraceful, given our present condition, that we disport ourselves in a youthful fashion as if we amounted to something, we who are in such an ill-educated state that we never, ever, hold the same views on the same issues, even on issues of the utmost importance.

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So, let us use the argument that has now been revealed to us, just like a guide. It has indicated to us that this way of life is best: to live and to die in the practice of justice and all other excellence. So, let us follow this, and encourage others to do so, and not that way of life that you believe in and encourage upon me, for that is worth nothing, Callicles.

ΣΩ. ἄκουε δὴ, φασί, μάλα καλοῦ λόγου, ὃν σὺ μὲν ἡγήσῃ μῦθον, ὥς ἐγὼ οἶμαι, ἐγὼ δὲ λόγον· ὥς ἀληθῆ γὰρ ὄντα σοι λέξω ἃ μέλλω λέγειν. ὥσπερ γὰρ Ὅμηρος λέγει, διενείμαντο τὴν ἀρχὴν ὁ Ζεὺς καὶ ὁ Ποσειδῶν καὶ ὁ Πλούτων, ἐπειδὴ παρὰ τοῦ πατρὸς παρέλαβον. ἦν οὖν νόμος ὅδε περὶ ἀνθρώπων ἐπὶ Κρόνου, καὶ αἰεὶ καὶ νῦν ἔτι ἔστιν ἐν θεοῖς, τῶν ἀνθρώπων τὸν μὲν δικαίως τὸν βίον διελθόντα καὶ ὁσίως, ἐπειδὴν τελευτήσῃ, εἰς μακάρων νήσους ἀπιόντα οἰκεῖν ἐν πάσῃ εὐδαιμονίᾳ ἐκτὸς κακῶν, τὸν δὲ ἀδίκως καὶ ἀθέως εἰς τὸ τῆς τίσεώς τε καὶ δίκης δεσμωτήριον, ὃ δὴ Τάρταρον καλοῦσιν, ἰέναι. τούτων δὲ δικασταὶ ἐπὶ Κρόνου καὶ ἔτι νεωστὶ τοῦ Διὸς τὴν ἀρχὴν ἔχοντος ζῶντες ἦσαν ζώντων, ἐκείνῃ τῇ ἡμέρᾳ δικάζοντες ἢ μέλλοιεν τελευτᾶν· κακῶς οὖν αἱ δίκαι ἐκρίνοντο. ὅ τε οὖν Πλούτων καὶ οἱ ἐπιμεληταὶ οἱ ἐκ μακάρων νήσων ἰόντες ἔλεγον πρὸς τὸν Δία ὅτι φοιτῶν ἐσφιν ἀνθρωποὶ ἐκατέρωσε ἀνάξιοι. εἶπεν οὖν ὁ Ζεὺς· ἀλλ' ἐγώ, ἔφη, παύσω τοῦτο γιγνόμενον. νῦν μὲν γὰρ κακῶς αἱ δίκαι δικάζονται. ἀμπεχόμενοι γάρ, ἔφη, οἱ κρινόμενοι κρίνονται· ζῶντες γὰρ κρίνονται. πολλοὶ οὖν, ἢ δ' ὅς, ψυχὰς πονηρὰς ἔχοντες ἡμφιεσμένοι εἰσὶ σώματά τε καλὰ καὶ γένη καὶ πλούτους, καί, ἐπειδὴν ἡ κρίσις ἦ, ἔρχονται αὐτοῖς πολλοὶ μάρτυρες, μαρτυρήσοντες ὡς δικαίως βεβιώκασιν· οἱ οὖν δικασταὶ ὑπὸ τε τούτων ἐκπλήττονται, καὶ ἅμα καὶ αὐτοὶ ἀμπεχόμενοι δικάζουσι, πρὸ τῆς ψυχῆς τῆς αὐτῶν ὀφθαλμοὺς καὶ ὤτα καὶ ὅλον τὸ σῶμα προκεκαλυμμένοι. ταῦτα δὴ αὐτοῖς πάντα ἐπίπροσθεν γίνεσθαι, καὶ τὰ αὐτῶν ἀμφιέσματα καὶ τὰ τῶν κρινομένων. πρῶτον μὲν οὖν, ἔφη, παυστέον ἐστὶν προειδόμενος αὐτοὺς τὸν θάνατον· νῦν γὰρ προΐσασσι. τοῦτο μὲν οὖν καὶ δὴ εἴρηται τῷ Προμηθεΐ ὅπως ἂν παύσῃ αὐτῶν. ἔπειτα γυμνοὺς κριτέον ἀπάντων τούτων· τεθνεῶτας γὰρ δεῖ κρίνεσθαι. καὶ τὸν κριτὴν δεῖ γυμνὸν εἶναι, τεθνεῶτα, αὐτῇ τῇ ψυχῇ αὐτὴν τὴν ψυχὴν θεωροῦντα ἐξαίφνης ἀποθανόντος ἐκάστου, ἔρημον πάντων τῶν συγγενῶν καὶ καταλιπόντα ἐπὶ τῆς γῆς πάντα ἐκείνον τὸν κόσμον, ἵνα δικάιᾳ ἡ κρίσις ἦ. ΣΩ. ἐγὼ μὲν οὖν ταῦτα ἐγνωκὼς πρότερος ἢ ὑμεῖς ἐποίησάμην δικαστὰς οὕτως ἐμαυτοῦ, δύο μὲν ἐκ τῆς Ἀσίας, Μίνω τε καὶ Ῥαδάμανθυν, ἕνα δὲ ἐκ τῆς Εὐρώπης, Αἰακόν· οὗτοι οὖν ἐπειδὴν τελευτήσωσι, δικάσουσιν ἐν τῷ λειμῶνι, ἐν τῇ τριόδῳ ἐξ ἧς φέρετον

τῷ ὁδῷ, ἢ μὲν εἰς μακάρων νήσους, ἢ δ' εἰς Τάρταρον. καὶ τοὺς μὲν ἐκ τῆς Ἀσίας Ῥαδάμανθους κρινεῖ, τοὺς δὲ ἐκ τῆς Εὐρώπης Αἰακός· Μίνω δὲ πρεσβεῖα δώσω ἐπιδιακρίνειν, ἐὰν ἀπορητόν τι τῷ ἐτέρῳ, ἵνα ὡς δικαιοσύνη ἢ κρίσις ἢ περὶ τῆς πορείας τοῖς ἀνθρώποις. ταῦτ' ἔστιν, ὧς Καλλίκλεις, ἃ ἐγὼ ἀκηκοὺς πιστεύω ἀληθῆ εἶναι· καὶ ἐκ τούτων τῶν λόγων τοιόνδε τι λογίζομαι συμβαίνειν. ὁ θάνατος τυγχάνει ὦν, ὡς ἐμοὶ δοκεῖ, οὐδὲν ἄλλο ἢ δυοῖν πραγμάτων διάλυσις, τῆς ψυχῆς καὶ τοῦ σώματος, ἀπ' ἀλλήλων· ἐπειδὴν δὲ διαλυθῆτον ἄρα ἀπ' ἀλλήλων, οὐ πολὺ ἥττον ἐκάτερον αὐτοῖν ἔχει τὴν ἔξιν τὴν αὐτοῦ ἥνπερ καὶ ὅτε ἔζη ὁ ἄνθρωπος, τό τε σῶμα τὴν φύσιν τὴν αὐτοῦ καὶ τὰ θεραπεύματα καὶ τὰ παθήματα ἔνδηλα πάντα. οἷον εἴ τινος μέγα ἦν τὸ σῶμα φύσει ἢ τροφῇ ἢ ἀμφοτέρω ζῶντος, τούτου καὶ ἐπειδὴν ἀποθάνῃ ὁ νεκρὸς μέγας, καὶ εἰ παχὺς, παχὺς καὶ ἀποθανόντος, καὶ τᾶλλα οὕτως· καὶ εἰ αὖ ἐπετήδευε κομᾶν, κομήτης τούτου καὶ ὁ νεκρὸς. μαστιγίας αὖ εἴ τις ἦν καὶ ἔχνη εἶχε τῶν πληγῶν οὐλὰς ἐν τῷ σώματι ἢ ὑπὸ μαστίγων ἢ ἄλλων τραυμάτων ζῶν, καὶ τεθνεῶτος τὸ σῶμα ἔστιν ἰδεῖν ταῦτα ἔχον· ἢ κατεαγότα εἴ του ἦν μέλη ἢ διεστραμμένα ζῶντος, καὶ τεθνεῶτος ταῦτά ταῦτα ἔνδηλα. ἐνὶ δὲ λόγῳ, οἷος εἶναι παρεσκευάστο τὸ σῶμα ζῶν, ἔνδηλα ταῦτα καὶ τελευτήσαντος ἢ πάντα ἢ τὰ πολλὰ ἐπὶ τινι χρόνον. ταῦτόν δὴ μοι δοκεῖ τοῦτ' ἄρα καὶ περὶ τὴν ψυχὴν εἶναι, ὧς Καλλίκλεις ἔνδηλα πάντα ἐστὶν ἐν τῇ ψυχῇ, ἐπειδὴν γυμνωθῇ τοῦ σώματος, τὰ τε τῆς φύσεως καὶ τὰ παθήματα ἃ διὰ τὴν ἐπιτήδευσιν ἐκάστου πράγματος ἔσχεν ἐν τῇ ψυχῇ ὁ ἄνθρωπος. ἐπειδὴν οὖν ἀφίκωνται παρὰ τὸν δικαστήν, οἱ μὲν ἐκ τῆς Ἀσίας παρὰ τὸν Ῥαδάμανθυν, ὁ Ῥαδάμανθος ἐκείνους ἐπιστήσας θεᾶται ἐκάστου τὴν ψυχὴν, οὐκ εἰδὼς ὅτου ἐστίν, ἀλλὰ πολλακίς τοῦ μεγάλου βασιλέως ἐπιλαβόμενος ἢ ἄλλου ὁποιοῦν βασιλέως ἢ δυνάστου κατεῖδεν οὐδὲν ὑγιὲς ὄν τῆς ψυχῆς, ἀλλὰ διαμεμαστιγωμένην καὶ οὐλῶν μεστὴν ὑπὸ ἐπιτοκίων καὶ ἀδικίας, ΣΩ. ἃ ἐκάστη ἢ πρᾶξις αὐτοῦ ἐξωμόρξατο εἰς τὴν ψυχὴν, καὶ πάντα σκολιὰ ὑπὸ ψεύδους καὶ ἀλαζονείας καὶ οὐδὲν εὐθὺ διὰ τὸ ἄνευ ἀληθείας τεθράφθαι· καὶ ὑπὸ ἐξουσίας καὶ τρυφῆς καὶ ὕβρεως καὶ ἀκρατίας τῶν πράξεων ἀσυμμετρίας τε καὶ αἰσχροτήτος γέμουσαν τὴν ψυχὴν εἶδεν· ἰδὼν δὲ ἀτίμως ταύτην ἀπέπεμψεν εὐθὺ

τῆς φρουρᾶς, οἳ μέλλει ἐλθοῦσα ἀνατλήναι τὰ προσήκοντα πάθη. προσήκει δὲ παντὶ τῷ ἐν τιμωρίᾳ ὄντι, ὑπ' ἄλλου ὀρθῶς τιμωρουμένῳ, ἢ βελτίονι γίνεσθαι καὶ ὀνίνασθαι ἢ παραδείγματι τοῖς ἄλλοις γίνεσθαι, ἵνα ἄλλοι ὀρῶντες πάσχοντα ἃ ἂν πάσχη φοβούμενοι βελτίους γίνωνται. εἰσὶν δὲ οἱ μὲν ὠφελούμενοί τε καὶ δίκην διδόντες ὑπὸ θεῶν τε καὶ ἀνθρώπων οὗτοι οἳ ἂν ἰάσιμα ἀμαρτήματα ἀμάρτωσιν· ὅμως δὲ δι' ἀλγηδόνων καὶ ὀδυνῶν γίνεταί αὐτοῖς ἡ ὠφελία καὶ ἐνθάδε καὶ ἐν Ἀίδου· οὐ γὰρ οἷόν τε ἄλλως ἀδικίας ἀπαλλάττεσθαι. οἳ δ' ἂν τὰ ἔσχατα ἀδικήσωσι καὶ διὰ τὰ τοιαῦτα ἀδικήματα ἀνίατοι γένωνται, ἐκ τούτων τὰ παραδείγματα γίνεταί, καὶ οὗτοι αὐτοὶ μὲν οὐκέτι ὀνίνανται οὐδὲν, ἅτε ἀνίατοι ὄντες, ἄλλοι δὲ ὀνίνανται οἱ τούτους ὀρῶντες διὰ τὰς ἀμαρτίας τὰ μέγιστα καὶ ὀδυνηρότατα καὶ φοβερώτατα πάθη πάσχοντας τὸν αἰεὶ χρόνον, ἀτεχνῶς παραδείγματα ἀνηρητημένους ἐκεῖ ἐν Ἀίδου ἐν τῷ δεσμοτηρίῳ, τοῖς αἰεὶ τῶν ἀδίκων ἀφικνουμένοις θεάματα καὶ νοουθήματα. ὧν ἐγὼ φημι ἓνα καὶ Ἀρχέλαον ἔσεσθαι, εἰ ἀληθῆ λέγει πῶλος, καὶ ἄλλον ὅστις ἂν τοιοῦτος τύραννος ἦ· οἶμαι δὲ καὶ τοὺς πολλοὺς εἶναι τούτων τῶν παραδειγμάτων ἐκ τυράννων καὶ βασιλέων καὶ δυναστῶν καὶ τὰ τῶν πόλεων πραξάντων γεγονότας· οὗτοι γὰρ διὰ τὴν ἐξουσίαν μέγιστα καὶ ἀνοσιώτατα ἀμαρτήματα ἀμαρτάνουσι. μαρτυρεῖ δὲ τούτοις καὶ Ὅμηρος· βασιλέας γὰρ καὶ δυνάστας ἐκεῖνος πεποίηκεν τοὺς ἐν Ἀίδου τὸν αἰεὶ χρόνον τιμωρουμένους, Τάνταλον καὶ Σίσυφον καὶ Τιτυόν· Θερσίτην δέ, καὶ εἴ τις ἄλλος πονηρὸς ἦν ἰδιώτης, οὐδεὶς πεποίηκεν μεγάλας τιμωρίας συνεχόμενον ὡς ἀνίατον—οὐ γὰρ οἶμαι ἐξῆν αὐτῷ· διὸ καὶ εὐδαιμονέστερος ἦν ἢ οἷς ἐξῆν— ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ γάρ, ὦ Καλλίκλεις, ἐκ τῶν δυναμένων εἰσὶ καὶ οἱ σφόδρα πονηροὶ γιγνόμενοι ἄνθρωποι· οὐδὲν μὴν κωλύει καὶ ἐν τούτοις ἀγαθοὺς ἄνδρας ἐγγίγνεσθαι, καὶ σφόδρα γε ἄξιον ἄγασθαι τῶν γιγνομένων· χαλεπὸν γάρ, ὦ Καλλίκλεις, καὶ πολλοῦ ἐπαίνου ἄξιον ἐν μεγάλῃ ἐξουσίᾳ τοῦ ἀδικεῖν γενόμενον δικαίως διαβίῃναι. ὀλίγοι δὲ γίνονται οἱ τοιοῦτοι· ἐπεὶ καὶ ἐνθάδε καὶ ἄλλοι γεγόνασιν, οἶμαι δὲ καὶ ἔσονται καλοὶ κάγαθοι ταύτην τὴν ἀρετὴν τὴν τοῦ δικαίως διαχειρίζειν ἃ ἂν τις ἐπιτρέπη· εἷς δὲ καὶ πάνυ ἐλλόγιμος γέγονεν καὶ εἰς τοὺς ἄλλους Ἑλληνας, Ἀριστείδης ὁ

Λυσιμάχου· οἱ δὲ πολλοί, ὧς ἄριστε, κακοὶ γίνονται τῶν δυναστῶν.
 ὅπερ οὖν ἔλεγον, ἐπειδὴν ὁ Ῥαδάμανθους ἐκεῖνος τοιοῦτόν τινα λάβῃ,
 ἄλλο μὲν περὶ αὐτοῦ οὐκ οἶδεν οὐδέν, οὔθ' ὅστις οὔθ' ὄντινων, ὅτι δὲ
 πονηρός τις καὶ τοῦτο κατιδὼν ἀπέπεμψεν εἰς Τάρταρον,
 ἐπισημηνάμενος, ἔαντε ἰάσιμος ἔαντε ἀνίατος δοκῇ εἶναι· ὁ δὲ ἐκεῖσε
 ἀφικόμενος τὰ προσήκοντα πάσχει. ἐνίοτε δ' ἄλλην εἰσὶδὼν ὁσίως
 βεβιωκυῖαν καὶ μετ' ἀληθείας, ἀνδρὸς ἰδιώτου ἢ ἄλλου τινός, μάλιστα
 μὲν, ἔγωγέ φημι, ὧς Καλλίκλεις, φιλοσόφου τὰ αὐτοῦ πράξαντος καὶ οὐ
 πολυπραγμονήσαντος ἐν τῷ βίῳ, ἡγάσθη τε καὶ ἐς μακάρων νήσους
 ἀπέπεμψε. ταῦτα δὲ ταῦτα καὶ ὁ Αἰακός—ἐκάτερος τούτων ῥάβδον
 ἔχων δικάζει—ὁ δὲ Μίνως ἐπισκοπῶν κάθηται, μόνος ἔχων χρυσοῦν
 σκῆπτρον, ὥς φησιν Ὀδυσσεὺς ὁ Ὀμήρου ἰδεῖν αὐτὸν—χρύσειον
 σκῆπτρον ἔχοντα, θεμιστεύοντα νέκυσιν. ἐγὼ μὲν οὖν, ὧς Καλλίκλεις,
 ὑπὸ τε τούτων τῶν λόγων πέπεισμαι, καὶ σκοπῶ ὅπως ἀποφανοῦμαι
 τῷ κριτῇ ὡς ὑγιεστάτην τὴν ψυχὴν χαίρειν οὖν ἐάσας τὰς τιμὰς τὰς
 τῶν πολλῶν ἀνθρώπων, τὴν ἀλήθειαν ἀσκῶν πειράσομαι τῷ ὄντι ὡς
 ἂν δύνωμαι βέλτιστος ὢν καὶ ζῆν καὶ ἐπειδὴν ἀποθνήσκω
 ἀποθνήσκειν. παρακαλῶ δὲ καὶ τοὺς ἄλλους πάντας ἀνθρώπους, καθ'
 ὅσον δύναμαι, καὶ διὰ καὶ σὲ ἀντιπαρακαλῶ ἐπὶ τοῦτον τὸν βίον καὶ τὸν
 ἀγῶνα τοῦτον, ὃν ἐγὼ φημι ἀντὶ πάντων τῶν ἐνθάδε ἀγώνων εἶναι,
 καὶ ὀνειδίζω σοι ὅτι οὐχ οἷός τ' ἔσῃ σαυτῷ βοηθῆσαι, ὅταν ἡ δίκη σοι ᾗ
 καὶ ἡ κρίσις ᾗ νυνδὴ ἐγὼ ἔλεγον, ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ ἐλθὼν παρὰ τὸν δικαστήν,
 τὸν τῆς Αἰγίνης ὑόν, ἐπειδὴν σου ἐπιλαβόμενος ἄγῃ, χασμήσῃ καὶ
 ἰλιγγιάσεις οὐδὲν ἦττον ἢ ἐγὼ ἐνθάδε σὺ ἐκεῖ, καὶ σε ἴσως τυπτήσῃ τις
 καὶ ἐπὶ κόρρης ἀτίμως καὶ πάντως προπηλακιεῖ. τάχα δ' οὖν ταῦτα
 μῦθος σοι δοκεῖ λέγεσθαι ὥσπερ γραδὸς καὶ καταφρονεῖς αὐτῶν, καὶ
 οὐδέν γ' ἂν ᾗν θαυμαστὸν καταφρονεῖν τούτων, εἴ πῃ ζητοῦντες
 εἴχομεν αὐτῶν βελτίω καὶ ἀληθέστερα εὐρεῖν· νῦν δὲ ὁρᾷς ὅτι τρεῖς
 ὄντες ὑμεῖς, οἵπερ σοφώτατοί ἐστε τῶν νῦν Ἑλλήνων, σύ τε καὶ πῶλος
 καὶ Γοργίας, οὐκ ἔχετε ἀποδεῖξαι ὡς δεῖ ἄλλον τινὰ βίον ζῆν ἢ τοῦτον,
 ὅπερ καὶ ἐκεῖσε φαίνεται συμφέρων. ἀλλ' ἐν τοσοῦτοις λόγοις τῶν
 ἄλλων ἐλεγχομένων μόνος οὗτος ἡρεμεῖ ὁ λόγος, ὡς εὐλαβητέον ἐστὶν
 τὸ ἀδικεῖν μᾶλλον ἢ τὸ ἀδικεῖσθαι, καὶ παντὸς μᾶλλον ἀνδρὶ

μελετητέον οὐ τὸ δοκεῖν εἶναι ἀγαθὸν ἀλλὰ τὸ εἶναι, καὶ ἰδίᾳ καὶ δημοσίᾳ· ἐὰν δέ τις κατὰ τι κακὸς γίγνηται, κολαστέος ἐστί, καὶ τοῦτο δεύτερον ἀγαθὸν μετὰ τὸ εἶναι δίκαιον, τὸ γίγνεσθαι καὶ κολαζόμενον διδόναι δίκην· καὶ πᾶσαν κολακείαν καὶ τὴν περὶ ἑαυτὸν καὶ τὴν περὶ τοὺς ἄλλους, καὶ περὶ ὀλίγους καὶ περὶ πολλούς, φευκτέον· καὶ τῇ ῥητορικῇ οὕτω χρηστέον ἐπὶ τὸ δίκαιον αἰεὶ, καὶ τῇ ἄλλῃ πάσῃ πράξει. ἐμοὶ οὖν πειθόμενος ἀκολούθησον ἐνταῦθα, οἷ ἀφικόμενος εὐδαιμονήσεις καὶ ζῶν καὶ τελευτήσας, ὡς ὁ λόγος σημαίνει. καὶ ἕασόν τινά σου καταφρονῆσαι ὡς ἀνοήτου καὶ προπηλακίσαι, ἐὰν βούληται, καὶ ναὶ μὰ Δία σύ γε θαρρῶν πατάξαι τὴν ἄτιμον ταύτην πληγὴν· οὐδὲν γὰρ δεινὸν πείσῃ, ἐὰν τῷ ὄντι ἧς καλὸς κάγαθός, ἀσκῶν ἀρετὴν. κᾶπειτα οὕτω κοινῇ ἀσκήσαντες, τότε ἤδη, ἐὰν δοκῇ χρῆναι, ἐπιθησόμεθα τοῖς πολιτικοῖς, ἢ ὅποιον ἂν τι ἡμῖν δοκῇ, τότε βουλευσόμεθα, βελτίους ὄντες βουλευέσθαι ἢ νῦν. αἰσχρὸν γὰρ ἔχοντάς γε ὡς νῦν φαινόμεθα ἔχειν, ἔπειτα νεανιεύεσθαι ὡς τὶ ὄντας, οἷς οὐδέποτε ταῦτ᾽ ἀποδοκῇ περὶ τῶν αὐτῶν, καὶ ταῦτα περὶ τῶν μεγίστων—εἰς τοσοῦτον ἤκομεν ἀπαιδευσίας—ὥσπερ οὖν ἡγεμόνι τῷ λόγῳ χρησόμεθα τῷ νῦν παραφανέντι, ὃς ἡμῖν σημαίνει ὅτι οὗτος ὁ τρόπος ἄριστος τοῦ βίου, καὶ τὴν δικαιοσύνην καὶ τὴν ἄλλην ἀρετὴν ἀσκοῦντας καὶ ζῆν καὶ τεθνάναι. τούτῳ οὖν ἐπώμεθα, καὶ τοὺς ἄλλους παρακαλῶμεν, μὴ ἐκείνῳ, ᾧ σὺ πιστεύων ἐμὲ παρακαλεῖς· ἔστι γὰρ οὐδενὸς ἄξιος ὧ Καλλίκλεις.

Notes

¹ Gorgias was a noted and influential rhetorician and sophist from Leontini in Sicily.

² An exhibition was a sample lecture or set speech used to show off the skill of a sophist or professional teacher.

³ Chaerephon was Socrates' close friend who famously asked the oracle at Delphi whether there was anyone wiser than Socrates (Apology 21a). He appears in a number of Plato's dialogues.

⁴ The commercial and civic centre of Athens, and a gathering place.

⁵ Callicles is thought to have been an Athenian political thinker, but there is no further evidence for his existence outside of this dialogue.

⁶ Polus was from Acragas in Sicily. He was an orator and a student of Gorgias. He also appears in Plato's *Phaedrus* and *Theages*.

⁷ Aristophon's brother was Polygnotus, the famous 5th-century mural and vase painter.

⁸ *Iliad* vi.211 and xiv.113.

⁹ Zeuxis was an accomplished painter from Heraclea in the south of modern-day Italy. He was especially known for his facility in reproducing nature.

¹⁰ Themistocles and Pericles were important Athenian statesmen. The Themistoclean walls included both city walls and walls around the port of Piraeus. The later Periclean 'Long Walls' linked Athens with her port.

¹¹ The Middle Wall was built in 444-442 to enclose the military road from Athens to the Piraeus, and ran parallel to the north Long Wall.

¹² A light-hearted oath alluding to the Egyptian dog-headed god, Anubis.

¹³ Anaxagoras was a natural philosopher from Clazomenae, Ionia, who lived a generation before Socrates. The opening line of his book, describing the initial state of the universe, was "All things were together."

¹⁴ The Great King traditionally referred to the King of the Persian Empire.

¹⁵ Socrates mentions three Athenian political leaders – Nicias, an old-fashioned conservative, Aristocrates, an oligarch, and Pericles, a democrat.

¹⁶ The Council consisted of 500 citizens from each of the ten tribes, chosen by lot to serve for one year. Its chief function was to prepare legislation for the Assembly.

¹⁷ The Athenian citizen body was divided into ten tribes which were united politically, militarily and socially, and represented the three regions of Attica – the coast, the plains and the hills.

¹⁸ Each tribe served in rotation on the Executive Committee of the Council. A member was chosen daily by lot to be the president or chairman.

¹⁹ Alcibiades was a prominent and controversial Athenian statesman, orator and general. He was a close associate of Socrates, and two dialogues that bear his name have been attributed to Plato. He also features prominently towards the end of Plato's *Symposium*, where he describes his relationship with Socrates.

²⁰ The Athenian demos refers to the populace of Athens. Demos also happens to be the name of Callicles' beloved.

²¹ This is a light-hearted euphemistic oath alluding to the dog-headed god, Anubis.

²² Xerxes, the son of Darius, was King of the Persian (Achaemenid) Empire.

²³ This fragment is from a lost ode of Pindar.

²⁴ This refers to the Tenth Labour of Heracles. Geryon was a fearsome legendary giant who is described as having had multiple heads and/or bodies.

²⁵ Euripides was one of the three great Athenian tragic playwrights. These lines, from a much-quoted speech by Zethus, appear in his play *Antiope*.

²⁶ *Iliad* ix.441.

²⁷ Amphion is the musician brother of Zethus, who was a herdsman. In *Antiope*, the brothers represent two contrasting ways of life, one artistic, the other practical.

²⁸ Both here and in the lines quoted above, Callicles paraphrases Euripides' *Antiope*.

²⁹ These were wealthy, ambitious and somewhat unscrupulous young men. Teisander was a property owner, Andron an oligarchic politician, and Nausicydes a miller and owner of foreign slaves.

³⁰ These lines are from Euripides' *Phrixus* or *Polyidos*.

³¹ A catamite was the passive partner in male homosexual relationships.

³² This refers to annual initiation rites. The Lesser Mysteries were held in spring in Attica; the Greater Mysteries were held in autumn at the Sanctuary of Demeter and Kore in Eleusis.

³³ Cinesias was a poet who composed choral songs in honour of Dionysus. Meles was a famous cithara player but a very poor singer.

³⁴ Not following Dodds' punctuation, who has this as a question.

³⁵ Epicharmus was a comic poet from Syracuse in Sicily. The source of the line quoted is unknown.

³⁶ Aegina is an island, south of Athens, in the Saronic Gulf.

³⁷ There are six obols in a drachma.

³⁸ The Pontus is the region of northern Asia Minor including the south coast of the Black Sea.

³⁹ There was a widespread belief that Thessalian witches caused eclipses and had to pay for their powers with the loss of a family member.

⁴⁰ Not accepting Dodds' emendation of the manuscript text at this point.

⁴¹ The phrase 'kindly and god-fearing' is used three times in Homer's *Odyssey* vi.120, ix.175, xiii.201.

⁴² Alcibiades was condemned to death in absentia after he had fled to Sparta.

⁴³ *Iliad* xv.187ff.

⁴⁴ Prometheus was the champion and benefactor of mankind to whom he gave fire. His name means 'forethought'.

⁴⁵ Minos, Rhadamanthus and Aeacus were famous judges in their lifetimes who became judges in the underworld after death.

⁴⁶ The punishments of Tantalus, Sisyphus and Tityus are described in Homer's *Odyssey* xi.576-600.

⁴⁷ Aristides was an Athenian politician and general. Nicknamed 'the Just', he was a leader of the Athenian resistance against the Persian invasion.

⁴⁸ *Odyssey* xi.569.